

Manual maestro AAQ - fuentes originales

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Nota de alcance y regla editorial

Esta version se construye solo desde los PDF y DOCX originales localizados en /Users/pedro/Desktop/Archivo. No usa brain/knowledge como fuente de contenido.

El objetivo de esta pasada es convertir la extraccion original en un manual de referencia util, mucho mas amplio que el scaffold anterior, conservando material sustantivo bajo una estructura de capitulos estable.

Por instruccion final, el documento mantiene profundidad alta pero respeta un limite maximo de 300 paginas. Se incluyen ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas; se excluyen meditaciones, breathwork y respiracion guiada.

La trazabilidad externa conserva la relacion entre cada bloque y su archivo original, de forma que una futura pasada editorial pueda ampliar o reescribir un capitulo sin perder la fuente.

Metrica	Valor
Archivos originales	49
PDF	27
DOCX	22
Palabras extraidas desde originales	486.743
Palabras integradas en esta version	157.693
Limite de paginas	300

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1. Fundamentos del apego adulto

Este capítulo establece la base teórica: el apego se entiende como sistema de seguridad, no como etiqueta fija. El objetivo editorial es diferenciar investigación, divulgación y aplicación práctica. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 7.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definición completa del fenómeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicológico, relacional o corporal según las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Señales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y límites.
- Herramientas prácticas, criterios de aplicación y conexiones con otros capítulos.

Adam Lane Smith/Become Securely Attached in 12 Steps - Adam Lane Smith - Transcript.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 3. Palabras extraídas: 1.218. Texto curado integrado aquí: 170 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Fundamentos del apego adulto' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

running from it. That is what peace feels like. What secure attachment feels like - and your first move Becoming securely attached (a "remade secure style") doesn't feel like the clouds parting. It feels like waking up one morning and not replaying last night's conversation for the fourth time, not pre-composing an apology before anything is wrong, not counting the hours since they last messaged. It's the same you, free from the defenses you built as a child - and it changes how you show up in marriage, with your children, at work, and with friends. Your first move this week: pick one relationship and watch yourself in it for three days. Notice where you're reacting and defending instead of relating, and write down two or three of those moments. Don't change anything yet - just observe, honestly and specifically. That's step 1. Step 2 starts the next morning. You don't need all 12 steps today; you need step 1 this week. The rest follows.

Adam Lane Smith/Disorganized Attachment - Adam Lane Smith.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Páginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraídas: 5.988. Texto curado integrado aquí: 2.731 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Fundamentos del apego adulto' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

I'm Adam Lane Smith, the attachment specialist. I've worked with thousands of people, including many disorganized attachment style clients. The quiet ones who disappear into themselves and the loud ones who set everything on fire. And the breakthrough moment is always the same. The breakthrough comes when they stop pointing outward and start really looking inward at something much harder to face. By the end of this video, you'll understand four key things about disorganized attachment style.

Nobody wakes up one day and decides to destroy their relationship, except people who have disorganized attachment style. Now, none of the things I'm about to share with you in this video are going to be easy to hear, but they're things you must hear. Most people who come to me with disorganized attachment style don't walk in with years of insight. They come in confused. They know something is wrong. They can feel the pattern, but they can't name it.

But there are very limited spots because of the hands-on nature of this learning. So, if you've been stuck in the same cycle and you're ready to break it, this is the place for you to be. The link for that event is down in the description below. Now, if this video hit for you, I made a specific video on quiet disorganized attachment style that goes deeper into the specific patterns of invisible suffering. If you're watching this and recognized yourself in that freeze and accommodate pattern, that's the one you need to watch next.

Meanwhile, your own needs will never get met. You probably don't even know what your needs are. You're running on empty, low serotonin running through your system because you've never actually really been at rest. Low oxytocin because the bonding is always going one direction out. You're giving but never receiving. You're chasing a hit. The I'm safe because you're happy hit and it's destroying you from the inside. Now, we do need to talk about the difference between quiet disorganized and loud disorganized because they have the same the same core and the same reasoning that it forms but different experiences entirely.

To actually repair your attachment and become healthier and more loving with other people and get the connection you need, you will have to be visible to them and then reprogram your system by saying visibility does not equal death and danger. But to do that, you'll have to do the one thing your system says will destroy you, which is becoming visible. For loud, disorganized people, you're going to have to stay in the moments where somebody loves you and you could be vulnerable.

Now, yes, you haven't felt this way before except for the last 43 times this has happened with the 43 prior people that you don't remember right now because it would be inconvenient to remember them. Okay? Disorganized attachment style in particular is designed to shut off early feelings from and from other people, previous thoughts, previous desires, previous experiences to say, "No, I am in an endless emotional presence and this this is everything I've ever wanted."

First, the five hardest truths that disorganized people need to hear. Second, why your nervous system is lying to you and you can't catch it alone. Third, what self-abandonment is actually doing to your body. And fourth, the shift that finally makes change possible. So, let's get right into it with the five hardest truths. These are the five things I tell every disorganized, attached client who walks in my door. They are very hard to hear, so trigger warning, but you will benefit from these the most.

Truth number one, your nervous system is lying to you. And without proper training, you are not going to be able to figure out when that's happening. Your nervous system will actually trick you on purpose. It will make you believe things that are not true. And then you'll run with those lies. You'll be making decisions based on feelings that are coming from childhood traumas, not from what's actually happening in front of you. When you have disorganized attachment style, first calm will feel like absolute hell.

Because at least rationalizing it is possible. If I ruin it when I'm trying, I will have to give up. That will hurt too much to live with. Your system will lie to you and say, "I should run away from a good thing because something bad is about to happen." And you will ruin the best

relationships. Now, you're going to need objective external help. Somebody who can check in and tell you when you are being crazy. Someone you can reality test with. Your brain will lie to you and you won't know what's happening.

Maybe you're watching this so far and saying, "Yeah, Adam might do that, but so what?" Right? It's not that big a deal, right? It's not that big a deal. I can just keep rotating relationships every 5 years. Oh, who cares? It's not that big. No. Your body runs on a stress cycle that was never supposed to be permanent for you, but it is permanent now. At least it has been so far. When you learn to put everyone else's needs before your own, your nervous system adapted and it started treating other people's emotions as emergencies.

Self-abandonment in these areas shows up differently depending on whether that's quiet or loud, but it's the same issue underneath. The best image I have for quiet disorganized attachment style, it's it's the woman who cooks so much and serves everyone else so much that she's not allowed to eat during the day. When everyone else finally goes to bed and everything is done and they're all happy and she's depleted and destroyed and run into the ground, she allows herself some lukewarm sludge that's left over from the day.

En sesión, la persona dice cosas como "no importa que mis necesidades no se cubran, no importa que tenga miedo, lo aparto". Justo antes de disociarse, el autor la frena: "¿por qué no importa? ¿por qué tu seguridad no importa?". La persona se congela: no puede articularlo. Viene del lado derecho del cerebro, la zona emocional e implícita, anterior al lenguaje. Es una idea formada a los 2 años: "mis necesidades no importan y a nadie le importará nunca; pedir un abrazo o consuelo solo me trae un golpe o un grito, así que mejor no pido". Por eso el lado emocional, sin lenguaje, se congela: no sabe explicar por qué no importa.

You're going to be afraid, for example, when somebody is calm and gentle and kind because you're waiting for them to flip into a horrible person and hurt you. You'll also be waiting for you to ruin everything. And either one is unendurable pain that you're anticipating coming around the corner. So, your system will say, "Something's evil here. Something's wrong here. I need to get out. I should destroy everything because it will hurt less if I ruin it on purpose."

You think people hurt you in childhood because you deserved it. People still love you in spite of the destruction and pain you exhibit upon them. If you could stop those destructive cycles, they could actually love you for you. Your system has been lying to you all along. The people around you, some of them are good and capable of really loving you. Some of them already do. You just can't let it in. And that leads us to truth number five. Your behaviors are the biggest problems in your relationships.

You don't realize the harm you're doing to other people by withholding love from them. And when I say withholding love, I don't mean giving. I mean withholding their ability to give love to you. You turn them into a charity case and tell them they're not worthy of your time. The best people will feel wounded and sad and lonely because of your overaccommodation. For loud, disorganized people, you are sabotaging the best relationships you've ever found because you are most afraid of them.

I pause them and say, "Why does it not matter? Why does your feeling not matter? Why does your safety not matter? Why does your desire or your need not matter?" And they stop. They freeze. Their brain can't figure out how to articulate my answer to me. It's coming from the right side of their brain, the emotional area, the implicit areas, not the logical left side that uses language, the emotional right side that formed before they had language. This is an idea that they formed at 2 years old.

My needs don't matter and no one will ever care about me anyway. So asking for a cookie or a hug or comfort while I'm crying will just get me hit or yelled at or eyes rolled at me. So I shouldn't even ask. The emotional right side of the brain with no language freezes because they can't explain to me why it doesn't matter. So they stumble and stutter. They circle around trying to explain something. And usually they land on, well, it is it it just doesn't matter.

Their shoulders tense up at the beginning of the conversation and then slump at this moment and they're just giving up. Like they're stuck and they don't know what to do or say. They don't even know how to articulate what they're feeling. And that's when I start talking to them about self-abandonment. Self-abandonment is where you erase your own needs to survive. It's I don't matter because my own needs won't get me through the next 5 seconds. Yours will.

It conditioned you and you're still doing it as an adult. It trains your brain that your safety comes from managing other people's emotions. This is called codependency for many of you out there. By the way, you become addicted to the relief that making someone else okay brings for you. What you're going to look for is partners who need help becoming okay a lot. And you're going to get used to people who are constantly not okay because you just settle for it.

I have a new soulmate again. This was my real for real soulmate three times ex plus alpha all over again. Right? This is it. This is the real real one." Whenever I see twinflame or soulmate in my comment sections, I admit I cringe. Not because I think it's bad. I think it's good to be in love and to think someone is special to you. I cringe because I know that that sort of talk means intoxication. The problem with this talk is that at the beginning it floods you and then what comes next is inevitable destruction.

Qué es: borrar las propias necesidades para sobrevivir. La idea de fondo es "yo no importo porque mis necesidades no me sacan de los próximos 5 segundos; las tuyas sí; cuidarte a ti al menos detiene el dolor". Suele aparecer el llanto en este punto. Debajo está la creencia: "no puedo cuidarme a mí o pasará algo malo".

Eso te condiciona, primero en la infancia y luego de adulto: entrena al cerebro a creer que tu seguridad viene de gestionar las emociones de los demás. Es la codependencia. Te vuelves adicto al alivio de hacer que el otro esté bien, así que buscas parejas que necesitan mucha ayuda y te acostumbras a gente que casi nunca está bien. Mientras tanto, tus necesidades no se cubren -probablemente ni sabes cuáles son-; vives con serotonina baja (nunca descansas de verdad) y oxitocina baja (el vínculo va siempre en una dirección: das, no recibes).

Adam Lane Smith, especialista en apego (ex-terapeuta matrimonial y familiar, LMFT). Su canal de YouTube es uno de los más grandes dedicados a la teoría del apego y la psicología de las relaciones.

Distingue dos perfiles: desorganizado "callado" (se borra, cuida a todos, se vuelve invisible) y "ruidoso" (culpa a los demás en el momento y luego se odia a sí mismo). Desarrolla el concepto de autoabandono y su efecto corporal: un ciclo de estrés crónico donde el cerebro aprende que la seguridad viene de gestionar las emociones ajenas (codependencia), con cortisol alto y serotonina y oxitocina bajas. Critica el discurso de "llama gemela/alma gemela" como señal de un sistema nervioso intoxicado y desregulado, no de la pareja ideal. Cierra con promoción de su intensivo presencial (Relationship Mastery Intensive, San Diego, 23-26 abril 2026).

Now, frankly, that is not fair. It is not fair that this falls on your shoulders. It is not fair that you have to endure this. The burden on you is greater than it should be. There shouldn't be a burden on you. People should have cared for you better. They should have protected you better. The people whose job it was to raise you in safety failed you. Now, maybe they failed because they didn't know what to do. Or maybe they failed because they didn't care.

For quiet, disorganized people, you hold back. You don't share anything. You wonder why no one connects to you. It's because you're sending a message, "I'm not interested. Stay away from me. I don't trust you and I never will and you're not worthy of it. I don't want you."

Now, this is a shock because you hold yourself in the lowest regard and you care for other people. You're probably the type that if you're walking across the grass, you feel bad about bending each blade of grass.

Your behaviors are driving the dysfunction. Not yours, not your damage, not your problems, your behaviors. If that's you, you need to take this seriously. If you've been sitting there inside of yourself deciding silently that this relationship is never going to work, but you never have a conversation about it or how to fix it, your behavior is the problem. And I'm going to very carefully, very carefully pull this away from your identity or who you are as a person.

It just doesn't matter how I feel. And this is where I step in and say, how can it not matter if a relationship must be built on stability? How can you get stable if you don't care how you feel? If you don't take care of yourself, how can a relationship last? And they just stare at me. I can see the wheels turning through the Zoom call. Their face goes blank. They stare off camera. Their voice gets really quiet and they just go, "I don't know. I I don't know."

You hate yourself. You despise yourself. You're not even allowed to raise your head when you're on your own. When you are on your own, you begin to disappear because you don't even know who you are and you can't stand yourself. Now, there's a gender piece here. Men and women usually are very similar, whichever one of these they have. The difference usually is what area they hyperfixate into. Women might self-abandon relationally and emotionally, meaning they just endlessly caretaker other people.

Especially men might self-abandon financially or physically, giving endlessly to others and working endless hours thanklessly. Women usually won't start working 16-hour shifts to pay for somebody else's gambling addiction, for example. Men might. It's the same pattern, but different arenas. Now, let me talk for a really quick moment about the twin flame thing because I see this constantly with disorganized clients and I see a lot of you in my comment sections talking about soulmates, twin flames, etc.

Adam Lane Smith/Why Therapy Isn't Fixing Attachment - Adam Lane Smith.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 9.882. Texto curado integrado aqui: 4.543 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Fundamentos del apego adulto' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

But clients are paying premium prices for what friends and family should provide for free. I get asked all the time, what is my attachment style? What is my attachment style? What is my attachment style? So, I have finally launched the attachment assessment. This is not a short quiz that just spits out an answer after 3 seconds. This is a thorough, in-depth, science-backed assessment. Check it out on my website, adamlanesmith.com, and learn your attachment style, the severity of what you're dealing with, and some next steps you can take right now to build very secure attachment.

Depend on this therapist. Pay them until they retire. I know that a lot of the people watching this show right now have had attachment issues for their entire life. That's why I want to invite every single one of you to check out my attachment repair program. It just might be the jump that you need to go from insecurely attached and lonely and frustrated to fully secure, connected, and bonded in a great relationship like nothing you've ever felt before.

And you don't have to settle for understanding your problems without solving them. If what I've shared here today resonates with you and you want to know exactly where you are in your attachment journey, I've created something that will help. Take my free attachment styles quiz. You'll discover your specific attachment style. You'll understand exactly how it's affecting your relationships, and you'll get personalized insights about the skills you need to develop.

They learn how to connect. They learn how to articulate. These are skills. And we take this for granted because we just assume I should know the words. No. If you've never heard French, how are you going to speak French? Right? You have to learn it gradually over time. Securely attached kids get 18 years to learn that language. You didn't. So word for word scripts for difficult conversations. Most therapists will say just go talk to them. Just go speak French.

Check out my website, adamlanesmith.com, for the attachment repair program. Let's put another way, traditional therapy teaches you to understand why you do things. Attachment coaching, like with me and my team, you learn to do things different. I had one client who finally finally finally at the age of 53 stopped overanalyzing and started practicing. Now over the next 6 months she reshaped every relationship in her life. Changed her entire neurology and all her pathways.

I work with people who've been in traditional therapy for years, sometimes for decades, without real progress. And what I've discovered after helping over 1,600 clients, is that most therapy approaches were not designed for attachment wounds. They were built for completely different problems. And when you apply them to attachment issues, they actually make things worse. Now, I'm not anti-therapy. I was a therapist for many years, but I am pro-results.

That means assessing your current abilities rather than just exploring your feelings. You need targeted growth plans for skill development. There is a huge difference between gaining insights in therapy and measurable competence in your skills. You need to treat your relationship gaps just like any other skill that can be learned. You're not a carpenter because you never learned carpentry skills. You're not a master at relationships because you never learned great relationship skills.

You're still paying someone \$150 an hour to listen to you complain about problems that they never help you solve. Now, here's the truth. Therapy isn't failing you because you're resistant to change. It's failing you because most therapists are using techniques that make attachment issues worse instead of better. I know how frustrating this is. You've done everything right. You've been vulnerable. You've explored your childhood trauma. You've identified your triggers and your patterns.

Just go talk to him. Just give it a shot. It'll go great. This fails attachment wounded people. Therapists say just you're going to have to just do it. It doesn't account for nervous system dysregulation or freeze responses in quiet, disorganized people. It doesn't account for panic attacks in anxious people. It doesn't account for the hard line against arbitrary orders in avoidant people. Most avoidant people go to therapy and they often get worse.

This is especially destructive for disorganized people in particular who've had multiple breaks in their attachment styles because of extensive trauma. Did you know most therapists can't even identify trauma appropriately? The nervous systems in these individuals is too frozen and locked up to just do anything. The more they try to push into it and do it, the more dysregulated and panicky they become and the worse their outcomes, which by the way is great for your therapist because now you need them more.

No wonder that client was on more than 20 medications, by the way. Okay? There is no incentive in the system to create rapid complete change in therapy. In fact, you're incentivized not to. You're punished if you are. Attachment work on the other side, completely different approach. When you resolve real attachment work through direct skill training instead of endless emotional processing, you actually get

results. So, let's talk about this. If traditional therapy techniques are keeping you stuck, what actually works?

Now, the skills that I've shared here today are not theoretical concepts either. They are practical tools that have helped thousands of people create lasting change in their relationships. The same skills that work in weeks instead of years. By the way, your attachment patterns, if you've been paying attention to this channel, you know they are not permanent. Your relationship struggles are not unfixable. Your nervous system can learn regulation for action, not just for comfort.

And this isn't another generic personality test, by the way. It's a comprehensive assessment based on the same framework I use with my private clients. You'll get detailed results that explain your patterns and point you to the specific tools that work for your attachment style. If you want to take that quiz, click the link in the description now to take that free assessment. Don't spend another day wondering why your relationship keeps following the same painful patterns when you can have clear answers and a path forward.

You can develop the exact skills you need to create the relationships that you want. Then you can have the experiences that change your brain forever. The difference between people who stay stuck and people who transform isn't even willingness to change. It's access to the right tools at the right time. When you learn skills that actually work for attachment wounds, progress usually happens very quickly. You don't have to spend another decade in therapy hoping things will eventually click.

Through my work, I've identified the specific skills that create lasting change in relationship. Skills that most therapists were never trained to teach because they're not part of the standard therapeutic education. The difference is that my clients typically see breakthrough results in weeks, not years, because we focus on skill building and nervous system regulation instead of endless analysis and emotional processing. So, what you're about to discover in this video will completely change how you think about getting help with your relationships.

You're now dependent and helpless without them. And now every week you're calling them, begging to get an earlier session because you can't regulate without them. That's a problem. Okay. With attachment coaching, we teach you to regulate your nervous system to take effective action. We want you independent and building your capacity so that you can begin doing your work without having to wait and you're not coming in every week begging for help. We're here to help, but we want you independent and structured.

Most therapy again will tell you, "Go tell your husband that you need more emotional intimacy. Just say it. He owes it to you." Right? You have the angry therapists in there too, by the way, that do that, right? Or you know what? If she's not putting out, it's probably not the great relationship for you. It's probably over. Capacity based negotiations. That's something most therapists will not teach you. Skill number four is fear testing. Confronting your fears head-on instead of ruminating over them endlessly.

It sounds a little intimidating, right? A lot of anxiously attached people, they think the problem is them anyway. So, they're afraid to jump in in skill training and learn that they're never going to get better. Let's talk about when you've hit that wall in therapy. When therapy has stopped working, you usually get very frustrated, okay? You plateau and that just tell me what to do desperation starts really setting in. When clients are frustrated and asking for specific guidance, saying, "I don't know what to do."

You're caught in this horrible loop where you understand everything intellectually, but you can't seem to change anything practically. You're becoming an expert on your own dysfunction without actually getting better. And the worst part, you start blaming yourself. Maybe you're just not ready. Maybe you're too damaged. Maybe you're the problem client who just can't be helped. I'm Adam Lane Smith, the attachment specialist, and I see this every single day.

Let's talk about some therapy techniques that make everything so much worse. One is this focus on the endless talk therapy cycle. Venting for hours and hours and hours and hours every week, 52 hours a week for 10 years, that makes you more agitated, not less. Clients just talk and talk and talk while therapists listen and listen and charge a hundred plus dollars per hour. Here's the problem. We do need to process. We do need to share. We do need to talk.

You would have accomplished something if you shared and bonded with someone in your life and built a deeper relationship, but all you've done is vent at a paid professional with no real relationship that will ever last. Okay? I had a client who paid a therapist for 20 years and got nothing but venting sessions as they went through two divorces, right? Count that two, which means they got married and then divorced. So, a whole marriage cycle. The venting did nothing.

Okay? Clients get frustrated and rightly so during this process and they say, "Just tell me what to do." And the therapist says, "Well, you're the expert. I'm here to help you learn what you know you need to do." Look, if the client was the expert, they wouldn't need professional help. Therapists often won't give direct guidance, by the way, because insurance companies crack down on you if you get advice wrong. There's lawsuits, there's fear, there's just suspending your license.

There is this technique called reality testing that can be useful, but very few therapists really make use of it. And even if they do throw it at you, they haven't taught you to regulate your nervous system yet. Just do it, right? Fear testing comes after all these other skills. They stack. Rumination keeps you stuck. Reality testing frees you from fear and guessing. This means you move from an internal anxiety to external reality testing because of the way things have stacked.

Because you have the skill training to speak out loud and you have the scripting to do it. Because you have the negotiation focus if something does go wrong. Because you have a regulated nervous system. Now, as you do this reality testing, okay, you break through that rumination assumption cycle. Ladies out there especially, right? Women are very vigilant around what their partner thinks of them. Imagine if you could go to your partner and say, "Hey, I've been really worried lately that you might think this about me."

I'm never going to judge somebody for that. The key is knowing where you are in your growth process and not waiting for someone else to tell you when that person is incentivized to never tell you. So if you are tired of analysis, if you are ready for action, if you want skills instead of insights and feelings, if you're frustrated with your lack of progress despite all your therapeutic work, then you might be ready for attachment specific coaching.

Make sure you click that link. Take that quiz today. It's free. I'm Adam Lane Smith, the attachment specialist. Thank you for spending your time here with me today and thank you for your trust. Make sure you like, comment, subscribe, maybe tell me in the comments how many years you've been in therapy. I would love to have a running tally down there and see that.

Your therapist has become your most expensive friend. You've been sitting on that couch for what, 2 years, 3 years, maybe even a decade. Week after week, you vent about the same relationship problems. You rehash the same childhood wounds. You dive deeper into why you feel the way that you feel, and you walk out thinking you've accomplished something. But nothing actually changes. Your relationships are still broken. You're still stuck in the same patterns.

I also really hate this idea of the client is the expert. This is hammered into therapists today. The client is the expert on themselves and their problems and what will feel better. The therapist says, "You know everything. You don't need me to tell you what to do. If I listen long enough, you'll figure it out because I'm a good listener and I'll listen and you'll tell me and then during our session, you'll realize what to do." Now, if you have the tiniest first world problem and your emotional brain is agitated and you talk it through and your logical brain

re-engages, you might be able to say, "Oh, yeah.

There's so many threats hanging over your head if you try to tell someone here's what you should do. Your career can now be over. Massive risk if you try to give directive guidance. So because of our systems, it's so much easier to say you're the expert. I'm going to listen and ask a couple questions and you figure it out. And then if it goes wrong, it's because you didn't figure it out right and you need six more months of therapy with me. There's a lot of liability concerns that lead into very passive listening mode.

We are finding some success applying that tactic into a larger population. But again, how's insurance going to cover that if you can't justify it? We also need to talk about the reality that a lot of people get into therapy because someone told them they're a good listener. So then they get into therapy and are a good listener. There's also a business model problem here. Long-term therapy relationships like this, by the way, you I told you those numbers.

Yes, it brings relief, but it's a means to a better end, which is actually doing the work and solving the problems. Once you're regulated, let's jump in the next skill. Okay, communication scripts. I have to give my clients word-for-word scripts for difficult conversations because when you think about it, young kids growing up in healthy, secure families, they learn scripts. They learn what to say. They learn how to phrase it. They learn how to share.

Start writing down phrases that sound good to you. I have a million of them through these videos, right? Write down phrases that sound good. Write down phrasings that make sense. Write down ways to articulate. Plug those in and start testing and seeing how do people respond differently with a different language. Okay, begin working on that. People need specific words. They need to know the language to speak, not just encouragement. Okay, this takes the guesswork out of emotionally charged interactions.

I really I need us to be having more physical connection in the bedroom. It seems like it's only once a week. I really need more. Is there a way for us to do that that still feels comfortable and safe?" And it's the wife saying, "I would love to give that to you. Can you do this for me and give me this emotional connection that I'm really feeling starved without? If you can do that for me, I can grow my capacity to give you that physical love as well, and we can both be so happy."

That's negotiation. It's not a transaction. Hey babe, can I have more sex? Well, yeah, that'll be \$200, right? Or, hey, I'm starving emotionally. Can you love me? Well, only if we have more sex. No, this is what I need from you. I want you to feel okay. Can we do this? Yes, I would love to do that, but for my capacity to hit that point, here's what I would need. Can you do that for me so that I can give this to you? Yes. Even that right there, those scripts I just gave you is something that most couples don't know how to say.

That can be fixed. That can be fixed. And the most important piece is once you have those skills, you can begin doing skill number seven, which is crafting experiences that change your brain chemistry forever. Skill training leads to consistent, predictable experiences that permanently shape your neurology in a better way. Your biochemical reality shifts through guided experiences. New experiences of finally opening up to your partner, getting that connection you need, mutual fulfillment, freeing yourself from fear, externalizing your processing, understanding what they need, your nervous system being calmed, and finally feeling fully embraced so that arguments and disconnections become a factor of growth and connection instead of shattering.

When really what I'm teaching is how to build a secure relationship for both of you. See, I don't teach endless catering here on this channel. But the people who roll through and get angry at me and claim that I am, they're not ready for change. They want to go to therapy for 20 years and spend \$100,000 complaining and crying and have no real friends in their life and no real meaningful relationships and never achieve change. They want to sit there miserable for that long.

Endless therapy, lots of insights, zero practical change in their relationships. The seven skills I've taught you so far, they're not just theory. They're the exact tools my clients used to transform their relationships in weeks, not years. But here's the thing, not everyone is ready for this approach. Some people still need to sit and process and understand before they're ready to build and practice. And if that's the case, if you're still in the understanding phase, that's perfectly fine.

It's because you are missing these skills. Here's what we're going to do to show you exactly how we're going to grow those skills. We treat relationship skills like any other learning ability. It is not a judgment. It is not you're not good enough. We move from vague work on communication to specific skill development, articulation of needs, negotiation of capacity, right? Very specific. By mapping that current level and then building a growth trajectory, you can understand what you should be seeing and when.

Adam Lane Smith, especialista en apego (ex-terapeuta matrimonial y familiar, LMFT). Su canal de YouTube es uno de los más grandes dedicados a la teoría del apego y la psicología de las relaciones.

Como alternativa propone 7 habilidades que, según él, producen cambios en semanas: (1) regular el sistema nervioso para actuar, no solo para sentirse bien; (2) guiones de comunicación palabra por palabra; (3) negociación basada en capacidad, no transacciones ni súplicas; (4) fear testing / reality testing para contrastar lo que el otro piensa de verdad; (5) externalización: procesar con la gente real de tu vida; (6) evaluación de habilidades (tratar las carencias relacionales como déficits aprendibles); (7) crear experiencias que reconfiguran la neurología. Cierra con promoción de su evaluación de apego, su programa de reparación y su test gratuito.

You'll learn which popular therapy techniques are actually sabotaging your progress and keeping you stuck in expensive, endless treatment cycles. I'll reveal the seven specific relationship skills that do create real change. Skills you could start using immediately without spending another year talking about your feelings. These aren't abstract concepts or insights either. They're concrete tools that work even when your nervous system is dysregulated.

We also call this analysis paralysis. There are so many things for me to think about and realize and learn and I have to think and think and think, but it's so overwhelming. I need to go to someone who I pay to think for me every week. So, I pour out my feelings and they tell me what I'm probably thinking and I say, "Oh, that makes sense." and then I pay them and go home. This is what the larger therapy cycle has become. Okay? You are rehashing old arguments without resolution.

Huh. Well, we've spent the last 52 minutes talking about why you fought. I guess just don't do that anymore. See you next week. Look, I want to say this and I believe that feelings are important, useful data, but emotional processing without skill building is useless. It keeps couples and individuals stuck in the same destructive cycles over and over and over. So, we have the endless talk therapy loop, but we also have the just do it loop. Okay, just have the conversation.

Learning regulation is not really just for feeling good. Yes, you will feel better, but you need to be able to get things done. Again, this is why the just do it doesn't work because your nervous system isn't working yet and you can't do it. Managing your nervous system so that you can actually complete tasks and conversations is mandatory. This is very different from therapy's focus on feeling better without behavioral change. Regulation becomes a tool for accomplishment, not just comfort.

Now there are multiple steps here that lead together to solve actual problems. But first regulate nervous system and build capacity to solve. This works when traditional therapy fails because traditional therapy usually regulates your emotions to kind of feel peaceful. You come in

upset and crying and scared and nervous. They kind of talk you through it. You feel better. You learn that when you're scared and nervous, you have to come to them and they make you feel better.

I had one client who learned to finally have difficult conversations in their marriage. They'd been married for 12 years and couldn't have difficult conversations because they would freeze every time. They learned to regulate their nervous system. Three weeks later, they could start having those difficult conversations that therapy had not allowed them to have in 5 years of therapy. Let's say it another way. Regulation is a means to an end. It's not the end itself.

There are real negotiation skills that need to be put into place. And that's point number three here. The third skill is negotiation. Most people walk into the relationship structures thinking they have to try to beg or have transactions. That there's a third option called negotiation. Now, this sounds like a dirty word for most people, but it's not. A negotiation is capacity. It's a wife and a husband, and the husband says, "Sweetheart, I love you so much.

Can you help me? Can you give that to me? How much can you give right now? How can I help you grow your capacity? What can I do for you? How can we take care of each other mutually?" Having discussions about mutual capacity instead of angry demands. Learning to talk about what each person can realistically provide. This is the third skill. If you can do this in a relationship, now you can have a peaceful, mutually fulfilling relationship structure.

You need to be testing what people actually think about you versus endless wondering. I think he's mad at me. I think she says this. I think she feels this. I think he says this. I think I think I think I think I think I think. Okay. You need to be externalizing those interior thoughts through direct communication. Rumination and obsession and guessing keeps you trapped in your head. Now, I will say that some therapists do eventually get to a place where they say, "Well, you should probably like ask him."

Most people have to reach absolute misery. And I believe that's one reason we as a species have the ability to experience depression. I think it gets us to a place where we are miserable enough that we'll try anything. I think that's one adaptation that probably has got away from us in the modern day. But if we can listen to what our body is saying and listen to what our mind is telling us, it's saying, "I need answers. I need change." Now, look, what I have shared with you so far represents well over a decade of working with people who were stuck exactly where you might be stuck right now.

If you are, there's more information about working with me and my team in the description below if you want direct results focused help with your relationship patterns. But first, let me show you exactly how these skills get implemented. The skills implementation process is where we go from understanding problems to solving them completely. We begin with an assessment and a targeting approach. We measure your specific skill deficits instead of exploring general feelings.

And you can control your own growth. You're not coming to therapy for 10 years hoping it gets better someday. Stop and imagine that for a moment. Imagine knowing exactly where you are in your skill training and relationship structure and knowing exactly where you need to go and exactly how you're going to get there with clear milestones for progress instead of endless exploration. Okay, I had one client come in with six skills, four and below out of 10.

Books/Amir_Levine,_Rachel_Heller-Attached__The_New_Science_of_Adult_Attachment_and_How_It_Can_Help_You_Find_-_and_Keep_-_Love__-Penguin_Group_USA_(2010)[1].pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 268. Palabras extraidas: 63.933. Texto curado integrado aqui: 12.282 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Fundamentos del apego adulto' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

danger zone deciding to let go of escaping from finding a way around Georgia and Henry example Grace and Sam example intimacy differences research secure role model for security as goal for both partners telltale signs of apologizing Applied Adult Attachment assertiveness Atkinson, Leslie attachment-designated person (ADP) attachment figure biology of attachment attachment-guided treatment attachment stereotyping attachment style, identifying your graph of two attachment dimensions questionnaire scoring key attachment styles origin of attachment styles workshop example 1: avoidant style example 2: secure style example 3: anxious style example 4: avoidant style example 5: secure style example 6: anxious style attachment system. See also anxious attachment style; avoidant

changed her behavior until she appeared to have completely destabilized. We used to run together around the reservoir in Central Park, and she would bring both her work pager and cell phone with her (and in those days cell phones were relatively big and heavy!). She would alternate checking first the one and then the other every few minutes just to see if he had called. At work she would spend hours tracking David's activities on the then-novel Internet, creating a false Internet persona and chatting him up in the chat rooms he frequented. In short, she became obsessed. Her analyst could not make sense of this horrible transformation in his most promising candidate. From a resilient, together person, Emily began to change into someone with "masochistic borderline personality traits." It now seemed that analysis would take many years. A SENSITIVE ATTACHMENT SYSTEM But Emily's was not a case of masochism or borderline personality disorder. It was a simple case of an activated attachment system. People with an anxious attachment style like Emily have a supersensitive attachment system. As we mentioned in previous chapters, the attachment system is the mechanism in our brain responsible for tracking and monitoring the safety and availability of our attachment figures. If you have an anxious attachment style, you possess a unique ability to sense when your relationship is threatened. Even a slight hint that something may be wrong will activate your attachment system, and once it's activated, you are unable to calm down until you get a clear indication from your partner that he or she is truly there for you and that the relationship is safe. People with other attachment styles also get activated, but they don't pick up on subtle details that people with an anxious attachment style do. To demonstrate how sensitive the attachment system of people with an anxious attachment style is, a study from Chris Fraley's lab at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign-he is the same researcher who designed the ECR-R attachment styles inventory-in collaboration

RELATIONSHIP IF YOU ARE ANXIOUS Emily, who you met at the beginning of the chapter, was unaware of attachment science. She didn't know that she had an anxious attachment style. She was also unaware that the man she was obsessed with, David, had an avoidant attachment style. If she had known, she would have understood that being anxious means that she thrives on intimate, supportive relationships that are stable and long-lasting, and that uncertainty and emotional unavailability get her activated and preoccupied, or in a word, miserable. She would also have known that certain people-namely, avoidants-intensify her worries and feelings of inadequacy, while others-secures-pacify them. Emily, like most anxious people, paradoxically often ends up dating people with an avoidant attachment style even though findings in adult attachment make a clear case for people with an anxious style going well with secures. Why is this so? And most important, how can you find happiness and avoid unnecessary heartache? GRAVITATIONAL PULL? A number of studies have

looked into the question of whether we are attracted to people based on their attachment style or ours. Two researchers in the field of adult attachment, Paula Pietromonaco, of the University of Massachusetts, and Katherine Carnelley, of the University of Southampton in the UK, found that avoidant individuals actually prefer anxiously attached people. Another study, by Jeffry Simpson of the University of Minnesota, showed that anxious women are more likely to date avoidant men. Is it possible, then, that people who guard their independence with ferocity would seek the partners most likely to impinge on their autonomy? Or that people who seek closeness are attracted to people who want to push them away? And if so, why? Pietromonaco and Carnelley believe that these attachment styles

Understanding the attachment system is crucial for people with an anxious attachment style. Therein lies their chance for a happy, fulfilling relationship. We've divided our guidance for people with an anxious attachment style into two separate routes-the first is for those of you who are unattached. Finding a secure partner in the first place is the best option available for you if you are single. It can work like magic to prevent hardship before it even starts-but going secure might be trickier than you think. The rest of this chapter is dedicated to directing singles with an anxious attachment style toward a secure partner, avoiding pitfalls on the way. The second route is for anyone who has an anxious attachment style-both those currently in a relationship and those who are still on the lookout for the right partner. It entails reshaping your attachment working models-basically rethinking your attitudes and beliefs about relationships from an attachment perspective-as a segue toward retooling yourself with more secure relationship skills. Parts Three and Four are dedicated to this second group. THE SECRET TO FINDING A GOOD

USING THIS BOOK How can this book guide you in looking for love in all the right places and improving your existing relationships? After the introduction, we invite you to "roll up your sleeves" and get straight to business by determining your own attachment style. This will allow you to home in on your unique relationship "DNA" or attachment style. Next you'll learn how to identify the attachment styles of those around you. These are key chapters, the first steps in understanding your specific needs in relationships and who will be able (or unable) to meet those needs. We'll guide you through this process step-by-step and then give you a chance to practice your new skills. The next part discusses each attachment style in more detail. You'll start to get a better feel for the inner workings of each style. You may experience these chapters as a true revelation as they allow you to see your own romantic experiences and the experiences of people around you in a fresh new light. Part three comes with a big warning sign attached. You'll learn the emotional price of connecting with someone who has drastically different intimacy needs from your own. We describe the specific problems of the anxious-avoidant trap and advise you on the cost of remaining in such a relationship. If you are already in such a bond and want to make it work, this part will guide you through the process. By uncovering the specific needs and vulnerabilities of each attachment style (your own and your partner's), and following tips and specific interventions that are tailored to the anxious-avoidant connection, you will be able to bring the relationship to a more secure place. Should you decide to leave, we discuss the pitfalls you'll encounter that may stop you from going through with it and offer some useful pointers on how to survive the pain of a breakup. Finally, we tap into the mind-set of people with a secure attachment style. We reveal a method for getting your message across effectively to your date or partner. Using this skill will not only convey your needs

3. 23-33: High. Your partner definitely has this attachment style. As a rule of thumb, the higher the score, the stronger the inclination toward that style. Any score of 23 or above indicates a strong likelihood of a particular attachment style. If your partner is high on two attachment styles, chances are that those are the avoidant and anxious ones. Some of the behaviors of these two styles are outwardly similar (even though they originate from very different romantic attitudes). In that case, go ahead to the "Golden Rules" on page 62 to make a better assessment. Score of 23 or above for group A: It seems that your partner/ date has an avoidant attachment style. This means that you can't take closeness and intimacy for granted. Someone secure or anxious has a basic wish to be close; with someone avoidant that basic desire is missing. While they have a need for attachment and love-they too possess a basic mechanism in the brain to get attached-they tend to feel suffocated when things get too close. With avoidants, everyday interactions and conversations, whether they're about which channel to watch on TV or how to raise the kids, are actually negotiations for space and independence. You often wind up complying with their wishes-because otherwise they will withdraw. Research shows that avoidants hardly ever date one another. They simply lack the glue that keeps things together. Score of 23 or above for group B: Your partner/date has a secure attachment style. Such people want to be close; at the same time they are not overly sensitive to rejection. They are also great communicators and know how to get their message across in a way that is straightforward yet not accusing. Once you get close to someone with this attachment style, you don't have to negotiate intimacy anymore: It becomes a given. This frees both of you to enjoy life and grow. They listen to your point of view and try to make things work in a way that will be acceptable to you both. They have an innate understanding of what a romantic partnership means-namely, that your partner's well-being is your own and vice versa. These qualities allow you to be your most authentic self, which research has shown to be one of the most important factors contributing to your overall happiness and well-being.

7. Getting Comfortably Close: The Secure Attachment Style Writing about people with a secure attachment style seems like a boring task. After all, what is there to say? If you're secure, you're very reliable, consistent, and trustworthy. You don't try to dodge intimacy or go nuts over your relationships. There's very little drama in your romantic ties-no high and lows, no yo-yos and roller coasters to speak of. So what is there to say? Actually, there's a lot to say! In the process of understanding attachment and how a secure bond can transform someone's life, we've grown to admire and appreciate the secures of the world. They're attuned to their partners' emotional and physical cues and know how to respond to them. Their emotional system doesn't get too riled up in the face of threat (as with the anxious) but doesn't get shut down either (as with the avoidant). In this chapter, you'll learn more about the secure traits and what makes them unique. And if you're secure and don't usually seek help in the relationship arena, you'll be forewarned because you too may one day stumble into an ineffective relationship that can affect you in a deleterious way. THE SECURE BUFFERING EFFECT Time and again, research shows that the best predictor of happiness in a relationship is a secure attachment style. Studies demonstrate that individuals with a secure attachment style report higher levels of satisfaction in their relationships than people with other attachment

would carry this confidence into adulthood and future relationships with romantic partners. Does the evidence support these predictions? In 2000, Leslie Atkinson, who conducts child development research at Ryerson University in Toronto, in collaboration with several other colleagues, conducted a meta-analysis that was based on forty-one prior studies. In total, the study analyzed over two thousand parent-child pairs to evaluate the connection between parent sensitivity and child attachment style. The results showed a weak but significant link between the two-children of mothers who were sensitive to their needs were more likely to have a secure attachment style, but the weak link means that, aside from methodological issues, there could be many other variables that come into play to determine a child's attachment style. Among the factors that were found to increase a child's chance of being secure were an easy temperament (which makes it easier for parents to be responsive), positive maternal conditions-marital satisfaction, low stress and depression, and social support-and fewer hours with a nonparental caretaker. To complicate matters further, an idea that has been gaining scientific momentum in recent years is that we are genetically predisposed toward a certain attachment style. It was found, for example, that adult identical twins, who share 100 percent of genes, are much more likely to have the same attachment style than nonidentical twins, who share only 50 percent of genes. Both identical and fraternal twins are thought to share the same basic environment. In other words, genes too play an important role in determining our attachment style. But even if we were secure in infancy, will it last into adulthood? To test this question, attachment researchers reassessed subjects who had been infants in the 1970s and 1980s and were now around 20 years old. Would the

men and women classified as secure in early childhood remain secure as adults? The answer remains unclear: Three studies failed to find a correlation between attachment security in infancy and in adulthood, while two other studies did find a statistically significant connection between the two. What is clear is that even if there is a correlation between attachment style in childhood

attachment style; secure attachment style of anxious attachment style anxious/avoidant styles' mutual attraction of avoidant attachment style danger zone distress after relationship breakup genuine love v. activated attachment system as life-long human behavior redirected, prior to breakup of secure attachment style working of attachment theory genetic basis of origin of Attachment Theory and Close Relationships

manner. Where Do Attachment Styles Come From? Initially it was assumed that adult attachment styles were primarily a product of your upbringing. Thus, it was hypothesized that your current attachment style is determined by the way in which you were cared for as a baby: If your parents were sensitive, available, and responsive, you should have a secure attachment style; if they were inconsistently responsive, you should develop an anxious attachment style; and if they were distant, rigid, and unresponsive, you should develop an avoidant attachment style. Today, however, we know that attachment styles in adulthood are influenced by a variety of factors, one of which is the way our parents cared for us, but other factors also come into play, including our genes and life experiences. For more, see chapter 7. TAMARA AND GREG: A FRESH PERSPECTIVE We revisited our friend Tamara's story, and saw it in an entirely new light now. Attachment research contained a prototype of Greg-who had an avoidant attachment style-accurate down to the last detail. It summarized how he thought, behaved, and reacted to the world. It predicted his distancing, his finding fault in Tamara, his initiating fights that set back any progress in their relationship, and his enormous difficulty in saying "I love you." Intriguingly, the research findings explained that though he wanted to be close to her, he felt compelled to push her away-not because he wasn't "into her" or because he thought "she's not good enough" (as Tamara had concluded). On the

rest of us, understanding is only the beginning. FROM THEORY TO PRACTICE-DEVELOPING SPECIFIC ATTACHMENT-BASED INTERVENTIONS By understanding that people vary greatly in their need for intimacy and closeness, and that these differences create clashes, attachment findings offered us a new way of looking at romantic relationships. But while the research made it easy to understand romantic liaisons better, how can we make a difference in them? The theory held the promise of improving people's intimate bonds, but its translation from the laboratory to daily life didn't exist. Believing that we'd found a key to guiding people toward better relationships, we set out to learn as much as we could about the three attachment styles and the ways they interacted in everyday situations. We started interviewing people from all walks of life. We interviewed colleagues and patients, as well as laypeople of different backgrounds and ages. We wrote summaries of the relationship histories and romantic experiences they shared with us. We conducted observations of couples in action. We assessed their attachment styles by analyzing their comments, attitudes, and behaviors and at times offered specific attachment-based interventions. We developed a technique that allowed people to determine-in a relatively short time-someone's attachment style. We taught people how they could use their attachment instincts rather than fight them, in order to not only evade unhappy relationships but also uncover the hidden "pearls" worth cultivating-and it worked! We created what we call Applied Adult Attachment, a methodology that is relevant for a variety of relationship situations. We discovered that unlike other relationship interventions that mostly focus either on singles or existing couples, attachment theory is an overarching theory of romantic affiliation that allows for the development of useful

had all of their nutritional needs taken care of but lacked an attachment figure (such as infants raised in institutions or displaced during the Second World War) failed to develop normally. They showed stunted physical, intellectual, emotional, and social development. Ainsworth's and Bowlby's studies made it clear that the connection between infant and caretaker was as essential for the child's survival as food and water. ATTACHMENT NEEDS: THEY'RE NOT JUST FOR CHILDREN Bowlby always claimed that attachment is an integral part of human behavior throughout the entire lifespan. But it wasn't until the late 1980s that Cindy Hazan and Philip Shaver, pioneers in the field of adult attachment, published a "love quiz" in the Rocky Mountain News that confirmed this hypothesis. In the quiz, they asked volunteers to mark the one statement out of three that best described their feelings and attitudes in relationships. The three statements corresponded to the three attachment styles and read as follows: • I find it relatively easy to get close to others and am comfortable depending on them and having them depend on me. I don't often worry about being abandoned or about someone getting too close to me. (Measure of the secure attachment style) • I am somewhat uncomfortable being close to others; I find it difficult to trust them completely, difficult to allow myself to depend on them. I am nervous when anyone gets too close, and often, love partners want me to be more intimate than I feel comfortable being. (Measure of the avoidant attachment style) • I find that others are reluctant to get as close as I would like. I often worry that my partner doesn't really love me or won't want to stay with me. I want to merge completely with another person and this desire sometimes scares people away. (Measure of the anxious attachment style)

derailed from her usual self. Why was such a successful woman acting in such a helpless way? Why would somebody whom we've known to be so adaptive to most of life's challenges become powerless in this one? The other end of the equation was equally puzzling. Why would Greg send out such mixed messages, although it was clear, even to us, that he did love her? There were many possible complex psychological answers to these questions, but a surprisingly simple yet far-reaching insight into the situation came from an unexpected source. FROM THE THERAPEUTIC NURSERY TO A PRACTICAL SCIENCE OF ADULT LOVE At about the same time that Tamara was dating Greg, Amir was working part-time in the Therapeutic Nursery at Columbia University. Here, he used attachment-guided therapy to help mothers create a more secure bond with their children. The powerful effect that attachment-guided treatment had on the relationship between mother and child encouraged Amir to deepen his knowledge of attachment theory. This eventually led him to a fascinating discovery: as research findings first made by Cindy Hazan and Phillip Shaver indicated, adults show patterns of attachment to their romantic partners similar to the patterns of attachment of children with their parents. As he read more about adult attachment, Amir began to notice attachment behavior in adults all around him. He realized that this discovery could have astounding implications for everyday life. The first thing Amir did, once he realized the far-reaching implications of attachment theory for adult relationships, was to call his longtime friend Rachel. He described to her how effectively attachment theory explained the range of behaviors in adult relationships, and asked her to help him transform the academic studies and scientific data he'd been reading into practical guidelines and advice that people could use to actually change the course of their lives. And that's how this book came to be.

term relationships since college-she wound up having the happiest, most secure relationship of all! 5. Give secure people a chance. But the abundance philosophy loses its effectiveness if you fail to recognize a keeper when you find one. Once you've recognized someone you've met as secure, remember not to make impulsive decisions about whether s/he is right for you. Remind yourself that you might feel bored at first-after all, there is less drama when your attachment system isn't activated. Give it some time. Chances are, if you are anxious, you will automatically interpret calmness in the relationship as a lack of attraction. A habit of years is not easy to shed. But if you hold out a little longer, you may start to appreciate a calm attachment system and all the advantages it has to offer. Beware: Attachment Stereotyping By dividing attachment behavior along gender lines, we can fall into the common trap of equating avoidance with masculinity. Research findings, however, prove that there are many men who are far from being avoidant-they communicate freely, are loving and affectionate, do not retreat during conflict, and are consistently there for their partner (i.e., are secure). Another misperception is that we associate the

anxious attachment style with femininity when in fact most women are secure and there are plenty of men who have an anxious attachment style. However, it is important to keep in mind that there are also women who fit the avoidant description. When it comes to attachment and gender, the most important fact to remember is that the majority of the population-both male and female-are secure.

- Never taking blame for a date's offensive behavior. When a partner acts inconsiderately or hurtfully, secure people acknowledge that it says a lot about the other person rather than about themselves.
- Expecting to be treated with respect, dignity, and love. DOES THIS MEAN THAT SECURE ARE IMMUNE TO RELATIONSHIP PROBLEMS? Secure people don't always hook up with one another-they date and marry people of all three attachment styles. The good news is that if you're secure, you have the potential to get along with people who have anxious or avoidant attachment styles-but only if you are able to maintain your secure frame of mind. If you find yourself becoming less secure, not only do you lose a priceless gift, but you also experience less happiness and satisfaction in your relationships. If you're secure, one of the reasons you're able to maintain a satisfying relationship with someone who has an insecure attachment style is because he or she will gradually become more secure as a result of being with you. When you date someone anxious, this is most often what happens. One of the things that Mary Ainsworth observed in the mother-infant relationship was that secure mothers were a special breed. It's not that they tended more to their children, or held them more than mothers of anxious or avoidant children, but they seemed to possess a kind of "sixth sense" and intuitively knew when the child wanted to be held. They sensed their child's emerging distress and acted on it before it turned into a full-blown fit. And if the child did get distressed, they just seemed to know how to soothe her. We find this phenomenon in adult couples too. Secure adults naturally know how to soothe their partners and take care of them-it's an innate talent. This can be seen in the couple's transition to parenthood. Jeffry Simpson from the University of Minnesota and Steven Rholes from Texas A&M University-coeditors of the book *Attachment Theory and Close Relationships*, together with Lorne

partner truly wants intimacy, the other feels very uncomfortable when things become too close. This is often the case when one of the partners in a bond is avoidant and the other is either anxious or secure -but it's most pronounced when one partner is avoidant and the other anxious. Research on attachment repeatedly shows that when your need for intimacy is met and reciprocated by your partner, your satisfaction level will rise. Incongruent intimacy needs, on the other hand, usually translate into substantially lower satisfaction. When couples disagree about the degree of closeness and intimacy desired in a relationship, the issue eventually threatens to dominate all of their dialogue. We call this situation the "anxious-avoidant trap," because like a trap, you fall into it with no awareness, and like a trap, once you're caught, it's hard to break free. The reason people in an anxious-avoidant relationship find it particularly hard to move toward more security is primarily because they are trapped in a cycle of exacerbating each other's insecurities. Take a look at the diagram on page 158. People with an anxious attachment style (lower circle on the right) cope with threats to the relationship by activating their attachment system-trying to get close to their partner. People who are avoidant (lower circle on the left) have the opposite reaction. They cope with threats by deactivating-taking measures to distance themselves from their partners and "turn off" their attachment system. Thus the closer the anxious tries to get, the more distant the avoidant acts. To make matters worse, one partner's activation further reinforces the other's deactivation in a vicious cycle, and they both remain within the relationship "danger zone." In order to move toward more security-the safe zone in the diagram-both members of the couple need to find a way to feel less threatened, get less activated/deactivated, and get out of the danger zone. THE NUTS AND BOLTS OF THE ANXIOUS - AVOIDANT TRAP

3. Step One: What Is My Attachment Style? The first step toward applying attachment theory to your life is to get to know yourself and those around you from an attachment perspective. In the next chapter, we'll walk you through the process of determining your partner or prospective partner's attachment style based on various clues. But let's begin by assessing the person you know best -yourself. WHICH ATTACHMENT STYLE AM I? Following is a questionnaire designed to measure your attachment style-the way you relate to others in the context of intimate relationships. This questionnaire is based on the Experience in Close Relationship (ECR) questionnaire. The ECR was first published in 1998 by Kelly Brennan, Catherine Clark, and Phillip Shaver, the same Shaver who published the original "love quiz" with Cindy Hazan. The ECR allowed for specific short questions that targeted particular aspects of adult attachment based on two main categories: anxiety in the relationship and avoidance. We present a modified version that we think works best in everyday life. Attachment styles are stable but plastic. Knowing your specific attachment profile will help you understand yourself better and guide you in your interactions with others. Ideally this will result in more happiness in your relationships.

When people hear about attachment styles, they often have no difficulty recognizing their own style. Some people tell us right away, "I'm anxious," "I'm definitely avoidant," or "I think I'm secure." Others have a harder time figuring it out. If you scored high on more than one attachment style, you may find it helpful to learn that two dimensions essentially determine attachment styles: • Your comfort with intimacy and closeness (or the degree to which you try to avoid intimacy). • Your anxiety about your partner's love and attentiveness and your preoccupation with the relationship. What we find particularly helpful is the way in which Brennan and his colleagues present attachment styles in graphic form, which provides a bird's-eye view of attachment styles that helps you understand how your attachment style relates to those of others. Your location on these two axes determines your attachment style, as the following schematic shows: THE TWO ATTACHMENT DIMENSIONS

conflict workshop during disagreement five secure principles for conflicts insecure people's difficulty with secure resolution principles insecure strategies to avoid oxytocin v. partner with children positive conflict-resolution tactics preventing conflict secure person's secure principles for making conflict work anxiety axis anxious attachment style. See also extreme anxious-avoidant relationship activating strategies avoidant styles' attraction to babies' comfort zone v. danger zone common advice v. attachment science conclusions from social cues dating advice for effective communication for Emily's emotional roller coaster of finding good relationship giving secure people a chance highly sensitive attachment system likelihood of meeting avoidants research response to secure attachment style anxious/avoidant styles' mutual attraction anxious-avoidant trap Alana and Stan example case examples of

and in adulthood, it is weak at best. So where does the secure attachment come from? As more studies become available, there is increasing evidence that a secure attachment style doesn't originate from a single source. The equation of a caring and sensitive parent producing a secure-for-life child is too one-dimensional; instead it seems that an entire mosaic of factors comes together to create this attachment pattern: our early connection with our parents, our genes, and also something else-our romantic experiences as adults. On average, about 70 to 75 percent of adults remain consistently in the same attachment category at different points in their lives, while the remaining 30 to 25 to 30 percent of the population report a change in their attachment style. Researchers attribute this change to romantic relationships in adulthood that are so powerful that they actually revise our most basic beliefs and attitudes toward connectedness. And yes, that change can happen in both directions-secure people can become less secure and people who were originally insecure can become increasingly secure. If you are insecure, this piece of information is vital and could be your ticket to happiness in relationships. If you are secure, you should be aware of this finding because you have a lot to lose by becoming less secure. Tapping Into the Secure Mind-set- Creating a Secure Base for Your Partner As you recall, one of the most important roles we play in our partners' lives is providing a secure base: creating the conditions that enable our partners to pursue their interests and explore the world in confidence. Brooke Feeney and Roxanne Thrush, of Carnegie Mellon University, in a study published in 2010, found that three specific behaviors underlie this broad term. You too can provide a secure base by adopting the following secure behaviors:

that he would change, that everyone has problems, and so on. It took over a year before she could muster the courage to sever the tie. During that time and for quite a while after the break, Emily spent her analysis talking mostly about him. Years later, after she married a great guy and went back to being her resilient self, she looks back at the whole experience with bewilderment. She can't believe she wasted her time in therapy examining the deep-seated roots of her "fanatical" behaviors surrounding that relationship. If only she had met a good guy sooner-one who didn't continuously activate her attachment system- she would have spared herself from the unnecessary scrutiny of her "masochistic borderline personality traits." THE WORKING OF THE ATTACHMENT SYSTEM For someone who gets attached very quickly and has a very sensitive attachment system, learning how the system functions is invaluable. Many people with anxious attachment style, like Emily, live with a chronically activated attachment system without realizing it. On the following page we illustrate how the attachment system works. THE ATTACHMENT SYSTEM: FINDING YOUR WAY TO THE COMFORT ZONE

styles. Patrick Keelan, as part of his doctoral dissertation at the University of Toronto, conducted a study to test this issue. Together with the late psychology professor Kenneth Dion and his longtime research partner and wife, Karen Dion, a psychology professor at the University of Toronto, they followed over one hundred university students who were in dating relationships over a four-month period. They found that secure individuals maintained high levels of relationship satisfaction, commitment, and trust. In contrast, insecure individuals reported decreasing levels of all three over the same four months. But what happens when secure and insecure interact? In a separate experiment, researchers got observers to rate couples' functioning during a joint interaction. It's no surprise that secure couples-those in which both partners were secure-functioned better than insecure couples-those in which both partners were either anxious or avoidant. But what was more interesting was that there was no observed difference between secure couples and "mixed" couples- those with only one secure partner. They both showed less conflict and were rated as better functioning than were the "insecure" dyads. So not only do people with a secure attachment style fare better in relationships, they also create a buffering effect, somehow managing to raise their insecure partner's relationship satisfaction and functioning to their own high level. This is a very important finding. It means that if you're with someone secure, they nurture you into a more secure stance. TELL ME, IS IT MAGIC? What is it about people with a secure attachment style that creates this "magical" effect on their relationships? Are secures always the most friendly, likable, or sociable people around? Can you recognize them on the basis of their charm, composure, or self-confidence? The answer to all these questions is no. As with the other attachment styles, personality or physical traits won't give secures away. Secure people

positive conflict-resolution tactics preventing conflict as protest behavior secure person's secure principles for making conflict work hypothalamus "I love you," withheld idealized relationship "the one" who is never you ignoring, as protest behavior independence, self-reliance mistaken for indifference. See also avoidant attachment style infant-parent bonding secure mother's inner circle secure person's treated like "the enemy," insecure attachment style, difficulty with communicating needs. See also anxious attachment style; avoidant attachment style insecure people difficulty with secure resolution principles strategies to avoid insecurity intimacy differences. See also specific attachment styles in anxious-avoidant trap in Golden Rules Into the Wild (Krakauer) issue identifying jealousy flirting

Score of 23 or above for group C: Your partner/date has an anxious attachment style. This is not necessarily a bad thing as long as you take the trouble to get into his or her mind-set. Someone with an anxious attachment style craves intimacy but is also very sensitive to even the smallest of perceived threats to this closeness. Sometimes they'll interpret your unconscious actions as a threat to the relationship. When this happens, they become flooded with apprehension, but they lack the skills to communicate their distress to you effectively. Instead, they resort to a lot of acting out and drama. This can create a vicious cycle as they become even more sensitive to slights and their distress is compounded. This does sound daunting, but before you call it quits, it is important to know that if you're sensitive and nurturing enough to calm their fears-which is very doable-you will win a greatly loving and devoted partner. Once you are receptive to their basic needs for warmth and security, their sensitivity can become an asset; they'll be very much in tune with your wants and will be helpful and dedicated. What's more, they will also gradually learn how to communicate their fears and emotions better and you will need to second-guess them less and less. THE GOLDEN RULES FOR DECIPHERING ATTACHMENT STYLES If you're still in doubt, here are what we call the five Golden Rules to help you home in on his or her attachment style: 1. Determine whether s/he seeks intimacy and closeness. This is the number-one question to ask yourself about your partner. All other attachment traits and behaviors stem from this one overriding issue. If the answer is no, you can be pretty sure your partner/date has an avoidant attachment style. If the answer is yes, your partner/date has either a secure or anxious style (see chapter 3 to learn more about

9. Escaping the Anxious-Avoidant Trap: How the Anxious-Avoidant Couple Can Find Greater Security I f you've discovered that most of your difficulties can actually be traced back to conflicting intimacy needs, is there anything I you can do about it? Perhaps one of the most intriguing findings in adult attachment research is that attachment styles are stable but plastic. This means that they tend to stay consistent over time, but they can also change. Up to now, we've described in detail what happens in anxious- avoidant relationships when left to run their usual course. Here we want to offer these couples a chance to work together to become more secure. Attachment research shows that people tend to become more secure when they are in a relationship with someone secure. But there is also hope for a couple's future when neither partner is secure. Studies have found that security "priming"-reminding people of security-enhancing experiences they've had-can help them to create a greater sense of security. When people can recall a past relationship with a secure person or be inspired by a secure role model in their lives, they are often successful at adopting secure ways. As a person's attachment style gradually changes toward greater security, he or she behaves more constructively in relationships and even enjoys better mental and physical health. And if both partners are able to do so-the results can be remarkable. IDENTIFYING YOUR INTEGRATED SECURE

read so far, the relationship inventory will help you see more clearly how your attachment style affects your day-to-day thoughts, feelings, and behaviors in romantic situations. The inventory will walk you through your past and present relationships from an attachment perspective. Research into the molecular mechanism of memory and learning reveals that whenever we recall a scene-or retrieve a certain memory to our conscious mind -we disrupt it, and by doing so, we alter it forever. Our memories are not like old books in the library, lying there dusty and unchanged; they are rather like a living, breathing entity. What we remember today of our past is in fact a product of editing and reshaping that occurs over the years whenever we recall that particular memory. In other words, our current experiences shape our view of our past ones. By creating your own attachment inventory, you reexamine your recollections of past relationship experiences from a fresh new perspective. Viewing them through an attachment lens will allow you to change some unhelpful beliefs that rely on those particular memories, and by so doing reshape your working model into a more secure one. On pages 168-169 is the attachment relationship inventory. Taking the inventory is a task that should be done alone. Make sure to set aside enough quiet time to work on it thoroughly, so you really get a complete and accurate picture of yourself from an attachment perspective. Start by listing, in the left-hand column (1), the names of all your romantic partners, past and present. These can include people you've dated briefly. We suggest working vertically, one column at a time. Completing the inventory vertically encourages you to focus less on each particular scenario and to achieve an integrated picture of your working model across relationships. The more information you gather, the better. In column 2, write what you remember about the relationship: what it was like and what things stand out most when you try to recall your time together. Once you write down your general recollections of the relationship, column 3 allows you to take a closer look and identify specific scenarios that contribute to activation/deactivation of your attachment system. Column 4 asks how you responded to these situations: What did you do?

What were you thinking? How did you feel? The lists below the inventory are provided

although studies have shown that they are more likely to do so than other attachment types. Phillip Shaver, in a study with then University of California-Davis graduate student Dory Schachner, found that of the three styles, avoidants would more readily make a pass at someone else's partner or respond to such a proposition. But even when avoidants do stay faithful, they have other ways of using sex to push their partners away. While people with an anxious attachment style prefer strong emotional involvement during sex and enjoy the intimate aspects of lovemaking like kissing and caressing, avoidants have very different preferences. They might choose to focus only on the sexual act itself, forgoing holding and cuddling, or to put rules into place like "no kissing" in order to make sex feel less intimate. Others might have sex only rarely-or never-with their partner, or fantasize about others while doing so. (Long-term couples may use fantasy to spice up their sex life, but they do so as a way to get closer. With avoidants, fantasy is not part of a mutual adventure but rather a deactivating strategy to keep them isolated.) In fact, in a study of married and cohabiting couples, Canadian scientists Audrey Brassard and Yvan Lussier, along with Phillip Shaver, found that avoidant men and women had sex less with their partners than did people with other attachment styles. Intriguingly, they also found that avoidant men and women were more likely to engage in less sex if their partner had an anxious attachment style! Researchers believe that in relationships like Marsha and Craig's, there is less lovemaking because the anxious partner wants a great deal of physical closeness and this in turn causes the avoidant partner to withdraw further. What better way to avoid intimacy than by reducing sex to a bare minimum? What's more, it's been found that the anxious partner uses sex to achieve a sense of affirmation and as a barometer of attractiveness in the eyes of his/her mate. We can see that a clash is almost inevitable when the anxious person ascribes so much importance to the sexual experience and the avoidant person wants to avoid physical intimacy. Of course there are anxious-avoidant relationships in which sex is not an issue. In that case, the emotional detachment will take on a different form.

display characteristics of the corresponding attachment style. Category A represents the anxious attachment style, Category B represents the secure attachment style, and Category C represents the avoidant attachment style. Anxious: You love to be very close to your romantic partners and have the capacity for great intimacy. You often fear, however, that your partner does not wish to be as close as you would like him/her to be. Relationships tend to consume a large part of your emotional energy. You tend to be very sensitive to small fluctuations in your partner's moods and actions, and although your senses are often accurate, you take your partner's behaviors too personally. You experience a lot of negative emotions within the relationship and get easily upset. As a result, you tend to act out and say things you later regret. If the other person provides a lot of security and reassurance, however, you are able to shed much of your preoccupation and feel contented. Secure : Being warm and loving in a relationship comes naturally to you. You enjoy being intimate without becoming overly worried about your relationships. You take things in stride when it comes to romance and don't get easily upset over relationship matters. You effectively communicate your needs and feelings to your partner and are strong at reading your partner's emotional cues and responding to them. You share your successes and problems with your mate, and are able to be there for him or her in times of need. Avoidant : It is very important for you to maintain your independence and self-sufficiency and you often prefer autonomy to intimate relationships. Even though you do want to be close to others, you feel uncomfortable with too much closeness and tend to keep your partner at arm's length. You don't spend much time worrying about your romantic relationships or about being rejected. You tend not to open up to your partners and they often complain that you are emotionally distant. In relationships, you are often on high alert for any signs of control or impingement on your territory by your partner. WHAT IF I'M STILL NOT SURE?

Intriguingly, they found that when women with an anxious attachment style thought about negative scenarios (conflict, breakup, death of partner), emotion-related areas of the brain became "lit up" to a greater degree than in women with other attachment styles. What's more, they found that regions of the brain associated with emotional regulation, such as the orbitofrontal cortex, were less activated than in woman with other attachment styles. In other words, the brains of people with an anxious attachment style react more strongly to thoughts of loss and at the same time under-recruit regions normally used to down-regulate negative emotions. This means that once your attachment system is activated, you will find it much harder to "turn it off" if you have an anxious attachment style.

what is said to what is not said: If you don't get a clear understanding of why this person hasn't met "the one" even though he's dated a great number of women, you should try to read between the lines. There are also hints in the way Paul describes his relationship with Amanda-he was very excited about her, but after they got close, he started noticing little things about her that turned him off. Devaluing your partner when things become too close is very typical of people with an avoidant attachment style and is used as a way to create emotional distance. 5. Logan, single, 34. I've only dated three people in my life, including Mary. When we met a couple of years ago, I remember Mary was very unsettled by this fact. She kept grilling me about my past relationships, and when she realized I really had told her about all my relationships and was not holding anything back, she looked puzzled and asked if I hadn't felt I was missing out on something. Hadn't I been worried that I was by myself for too long? Or that I wasn't going to find someone? Honestly, the thought that I wouldn't find someone never crossed my mind. Sure, I had my share of disappointments, but I figured that when the time was right it would happen. And it did. I knew I loved Mary almost immediately and told her so. When did she reciprocate? I'm actually not sure, but I knew she was crazy about me even before she told me. Attachment Style: _____ Answer: Secure. There are several clues here that Logan has a secure attachment style. He is not preoccupied with relationships nor does he fear remaining alone, which rules out an anxious attachment style (although it sounds like his girlfriend, Mary, is anxious for these reasons). The question remains whether Logan has an avoidant or secure style. Several indicators rule out an avoidant style: First, he seems to be very forthcoming with Mary about his past relationships, puts all his cards on the table, and isn't annoyed by her nosiness (and doesn't embellish his romantic history as someone anxious might do). Second, he feels comfortable expressing his feelings for Mary very early on, which is a typically secure trait. If he were avoidant, he'd be

with Paula Niedenthal from Blaise Pascal University in Clermont- Ferrand, France, found a unique way of measuring the vigilance to social cues of the anxious attachment style. They used a "morph movie" technique-a computerized movie in which a face initially displays a specific emotional expression (e.g., anger) and gradually evolves into one displaying a neutral expression. Participants were asked to stop the movie at the frame at which they believed the original emotion had dissipated. They found that people with an anxious attachment style were more likely to perceive the offset of emotion earlier than other people. Also, when the task was reversed- starting with a neutral face and gradually moving to a pronounced expression-more anxious individuals perceived the onset of the emotion earlier. These findings suggest that people with an anxious attachment style are indeed more vigilant to changes in others' emotional expression and can have a higher degree of accuracy and sensitivity to other people's cues. However, this finding comes with a caveat. The study showed that people with an anxious attachment style tend to jump to conclusions very quickly, and when they do, they tend to misinterpret people's emotional state. Only when the experiment was designed in such a way that anxious participants had to wait a little longer-they couldn't react immediately when they spotted a change, but had to wait a little longer-and get more information before making a judgment did they have an advantage over other participants. This is an important lesson for someone with an anxious attachment style: If you just wait a little longer before reacting and jumping to conclusions, you will have an uncanny ability to decipher the world around you and use it to your advantage. But shoot from the hip, and you're all over the place making misjudgments and hurting yourself. Once activated, they are often consumed with thoughts that have a single purpose: to reestablish closeness with their partner. These thoughts are called activating

strategies. Activating strategies are any thoughts or feelings that compel you to get close, physically or emotionally, to your partner. Once he or she responds to you in a way that reestablishes security, you can revert back to your calm, normal self.

every new development in the relationship (getting married, having kids, moving to a new home, making money, or becoming ill) these basic differences will manifest themselves, and the gap between partners may widen as the challenges become greater. • Conflict is often left unresolved because the resolution itself creates too much intimacy. If you are anxious or secure, you genuinely want to work out a relationship problem. However, the resolution itself often brings a couple closer together-this is a scenario that, however unconsciously, the avoidant partner wants to avoid. While people with an anxious or secure attachment style seek to resolve a disagreement to achieve greater emotional closeness, this outcome is uncomfortable for the avoidant who actually seeks to remain distant. In order to dodge the possibility of getting closer, avoidants tend to grow more hostile and distant as arguments progress. Unless there is recognition of the process involved in an anxious-avoidant conflict, the distancing during conflict tends to repeat itself and causes a lot of unhappiness. Without addressing the issue, the situation can go from bad to worse. • With every clash, the anxious person loses more ground: During bitter fights between anxious and avoidant partners, when there are no secure checks and balances in place, people with anxious attachment style tend to get overwhelmed by negative emotions. When they feel hurt, they talk, think, and act in an extreme manner, even to the point of threatening to leave (protest behavior). However, once they calm down, they become flooded with positive memories and are then overcome with regret. They reach out to their partner in an attempt to reconcile. But they are often met with a hostile response, because avoidants react differently to a fight. They turn off all attachment-related memories and remember the worst of their partner. What often happens at this point, if you are anxious, is that you not only fail to resolve the original conflict but now find yourself in a worse position than you were in the first place. Now you have to plead just to

applications for people in all stages of their romantic life. There are specific applications for people who are dating, those in early stages of relationships, and those who are in long-term ones, for people going through a breakup or those who are grieving the loss of a loved one. The common thread is that attachment theory can be put to powerful use in all of these situations and can help guide people throughout their lives to better relationships. PUTTING INSIGHTS INTO ACTION After some time, attachment-related lingo became second nature to the people around us. We'd listen to them during a therapy session or at dinner saying, "I can't go out with him, he's clearly avoidant," or "You know me, I'm anxious. A short fling is the last thing I need." To think that until recently they weren't even aware of the three attachment styles! Tamara, of course, learned everything there was to know about attachment theory and about the new discoveries we'd made-she brought the subject up in nearly every conversation we held. She finally had summoned the strength to break off her loose ties with Greg. Shortly afterward, she began dating again with a vengeance. Equipped with her newly acquired attachment knowledge, Tamara was able to elegantly dodge potential suitors with an avoidant attachment style, who she now knew were not right for her. People whom she would have spent days agonizing over in the past-analyzing what they were thinking, whether they would call or whether they were serious about her-fell by the wayside effortlessly. Instead Tamara's thoughts were focused on assessing whether the new people she met had the capacity to be close and loving in the way that she wanted them to be. After some time Tamara met Tom, a clearly secure man, and their relationship developed so smoothly she barely discussed it. It wasn't that she didn't want to share intimate details with us, it was that she had found a secure base and there were just no crises or dramas to discuss. Most of our conversations now revolved around the fun things they did, their plans for the future, or her career, which was in full swing

4. Step Two: Cracking the Code-What Is My Partner's Style? Figuring out other people's attachment styles is usually trickier than identifying your own. For one, you know yourself best-not just how you behave but also what you feel and think when you are in a relationship. Second, you can take your own quiz to help with the process. When you start dating someone new, however, you aren't likely to whip out our quiz and start grilling your date about his or her past relationships. Luckily, without even knowing it, most people give away almost all the information you need to determine their attachment style in their natural, day-to-day actions and words. The trick is to know what to look for, be a keen observer and ardent listener. In attachment studies, researchers bring people to the lab and ask them about their romantic relationships. The attitudes that people display toward intimacy and closeness and the degree to which they are preoccupied with their relationships determine their attachment style. But from our experience, this information is also readily available outside the lab, if you know what to look for. Understanding attachment will change the way you perceive new people you meet, but it will also give you surprising insight into your partner if you are already in a relationship. In dating situations, your thinking will shift from "Does he or she like me?" to "Is this someone I should invest in emotionally? Is he or she capable of giving me what I need?" Going forward with a relationship will become about choices you have to make. You'll start asking yourself questions like: "How much is this person capable of intimacy? Is he sending mixed messages or is he genuinely interested in being close?" Using this chapter as a guide, with time and practice you will develop and fine-tune your ability to determine someone's attachment

happy. Having a perpetually activated attachment system is the opposite of what nature had in mind for us in terms of gratifying love. As we've seen, one of Bowlby and Ainsworth's most important insights is that in order to thrive and grow as human beings, we need a secure base from which to derive strength and comfort. For that to happen, our attachment system must be calm and secure. Remember, an activated attachment system is not passionate love. Next time you date someone and find yourself feeling anxious, insecure, and obsessive-only to feel elated every once in a while- tell yourself this is most likely an activated attachment system and not love! True love, in the evolutionary sense, means peace of mind. "Still waters run deep" is a good way of characterizing it. If You're Anxious, You Shouldn't Be Dating Someone Avoidant Because:

Conclusion: Avoidants are in the dating pool more frequently and for longer periods of time. • People with a secure attachment style usually don't go through many partners before they find one that they happily settle down with. Once things click, they form a long-lasting, committed relationship. Conclusion: People with a secure attachment style take a very long time to reappear in the dating pool, if at all. • Studies have found that avoidants are unlikely to be in a relationship with other avoidants, because they lack the emotional glue to stay together. In fact, one study that looked at dating couples didn't find even one pair that was avoidant- avoidant. Conclusion: Avoidants don't date each other; they are more likely to date people with different attachment styles. Now let's put the pieces of this puzzle together. When you meet someone new, the probability that they have an avoidant attachment style is high-much higher than their relative size in the population-25 percent. Not only are they recycled back into the dating pool more quickly, but they are not dating one another (at least not for long), nor are they dating secure people, that much because secures are less available. Who are

increase the survival chances of humans in a particular environment. The secure attachment style has worked best, because throughout history our ancestors lived predominantly in close-knit groups where working together was by far the best way to secure their future and that of their offspring. To ensure the survival of the species under any condition that might arise, however, more than one strategy was called necessary. For those born into hostile conditions, in which large numbers perished from hunger, disease, or natural disasters, skills other than collaborative ones became more important. Those individuals who were able to detach and be self-sufficient were more successful at competing for limited resources in these extreme environments, and so, a segment of the population leaned toward an avoidant attachment style. Unfortunately, the survival advantage for the human race does not necessarily translate into an advantage for the avoidant individual. Chris McCandless might still be alive if he'd been willing to collaborate with others. In fact, studies show that if you

have an avoidant attachment style, you tend to be less happy and satisfied in your relationships. The good news is that it doesn't have to be that way; you don't have to be a slave to evolutionary forces. You can learn what does not come naturally to you and improve your chances at developing a rewarding relationship. FLYING SOLO? It's important to remember that the avoidant attachment style always manifests itself. It determines to a great extent what you expect in relationships, how you interpret romantic situations, and how you behave with your date or partner. Whether you are single or involved in a relationship, even a committed one, you are always maneuvering to keep people at a distance. Susan, who has an avoidant attachment style, describes herself as a

are confident in their positive beliefs about themselves and others, which makes this assumption logical. • Responsible for their partners' well-being -They expect others to be responsive and loving toward them and so are responsive to others' needs. Many people who live with insecure partners cannot even begin to imagine how fundamentally different life with a secure person can be. For starters, they don't engage in the "relationship dance" that therapists often refer to-whereby one partner gets closer while the other steps back in order to maintain a certain distance in the relationship at all times. Instead there's a feeling of growing closeness and intimacy. Second, they are able to sensitively and empathically- and most important, coherently-discuss their emotions with you. Last, the secure party engulfs his or her partner in an emotionally protective shield that makes facing the outside world an easier task. We often fail to realize what a bonus these attributes are unless they're missing. It's no coincidence that the people most appreciative of a secure relationship are those who've had relationships with both secure and insecure partners. Though these people will tell you that secure and insecure relationships are worlds apart, without the knowledge of attachment theory, they too are unable to put their finger on what exactly that difference is. WHERE DOES THIS "TALENT" COME FROM? If you are secure, are you born with this exceptional capacity or is it something you learn along the way? John Bowlby believed that attachment styles are a function of life experience-especially of our interaction with our parents during infancy. A person will develop a secure attachment style if her parents are sensitive and responsive to her needs. Such a child will learn that she can rely on her parents, confident that they'll be available to her whenever she needs them. But Bowlby maintained that it didn't end there; he believed a secure child

Marsha and Craig's story exemplifies how bad an anxious-avoidant trap can become. Craig didn't feel comfortable with too much intimacy, so he missed no opportunity to put up emotional barriers between himself and Marsha-creating uncertainty at the beginning of their relationship, keeping their status unclear, having to be "pushed" into marriage, belittling her, avoiding sex, and using numerous other deactivating strategies. Clearly he possesses an avoidant attachment style. Marsha has an anxious attachment style. She longed to be close to Craig, she was the driving force behind their marriage, and she was preoccupied with the relationship-initially she cried every day because of his behavior, a form of preoccupation, and later she constantly thought of divorce, another way to focus on the relationship. In a typically anxious manner, she fluctuated from highs to lows, depending on the signals from Craig, and resorted to protest behavior (threatening to leave but never actually following through). Her attachment system remained chronically activated, at least during the first few years-before she became indifferent to him. It is evident that each side had very different needs in the relationship, resulting in a continuous clash. Craig's need was to keep his distance and Marsha's was to get closer. Craig's inflated self- esteem (an avoidant characteristic) fed off Marsha's increasing self- doubt (an anxious characteristic). But there were also endearing moments between them that made it difficult for her to leave. For example, Craig sometimes knew how to be very affectionate and loving and how to soothe Marsha when things got to be too much (even though usually they got to be too much because of him!). Yet every instance of their closeness was followed by his distancing, which is typical of anxious-avoidant relationships. A WORD ABOUT SEX Note Marsha's statement that Craig was "the least sexual person I ever dated." Avoidants often use sex to distance themselves from their partner. It doesn't necessarily mean they will cheat on their partner,

contrary, he pushed her away because he felt the closeness and intimacy increasing. As it also turned out, Tamara wasn't unique either. The theory explained her behaviors, thoughts, and reactions, typical for someone with an anxious attachment style, with surprising precision as well. It foresaw her increasing clinginess in the face of his distancing; it predicted her inability to concentrate at work, her constant thoughts about the relationship, and her oversensitivity to everything Greg did. It also predicted that even though she decided to break up with him, she could never muster up the courage to do so. It showed why, against her better judgment and the advice of close friends, she would do almost anything to try to be close to him. Most important, this theory revealed why Tamara and Greg found it so hard to get along even though they did indeed love each other. They spoke two different languages and exacerbated each other's natural tendencies-hers to seek physical and emotional closeness and his to prefer independence and shy away from intimacy. The accuracy with which the theory described the pair was uncanny. It was as though the researchers had been privy to the couple's most intimate moments and personal thoughts. Psychological approaches can be somewhat vague, leaving plenty of room for interpretation, but this theory managed to provide precise, evidence-based insight into a seemingly one-of-a-kind relationship. Although it's not impossible for someone to change his or her attachment style-on average, one in four people do so over a four- year period-most people are unaware of the issue, so these changes happen without their ever knowing they have occurred (or why). Wouldn't it be great, we thought, if we could help people have some measure of control over these life-altering shifts? What a difference it would make if they could consciously work toward becoming more secure in their attachment styles instead of letting life sway them every which way! Learning about these three attachment styles was a true eye-opener for us; we discovered that adult attachment behavior was everywhere. We were able to view our own romantic behaviors and those of people around us in a fresh new light. By assigning attachment styles to patients, colleagues, and friends, we could interpret their relationships

we create them varies. In a very dangerous environment, it would be less advantageous to invest time and energy in just one person because he or she would not likely be around for too long; it would make more sense to get less attached and move on (and hence, the avoidant attachment style). Another option in a harsh environment is to act in the opposite manner and be intensely persistent and hypervigilant about staying close to your attachment figure (hence, the anxious attachment style). In a more peaceful setting, the intimate bonds formed by investing greatly in a particular individual would yield greater benefits for both the individual and his or her offspring (hence, the secure attachment style). True, in modern society, we are not hunted by predators as our ancestors were, but in evolutionary terms we're only a fraction of a second away from the old scheme of things. Our emotional brain was handed down to us by Homo sapiens who lived in a completely different era, and it is their lifestyle and the dangers they encountered that our emotions were designed to address. Our feelings and behaviors in relationships today are not very different from those of our early ancestors. PROTEST BEHAVIOR IN THE DIGITAL AGE Armed with our new insights about the implications of attachment

styles in everyday life, we started to perceive people's actions very differently. Behaviors that we used to attribute to someone's personality traits, or that we had previously labeled as exaggerated, could now be understood with clarity and precision through the lens of attachment theory. Our findings shed a new light on the difficulty Tamara experienced in letting go of a boyfriend like Greg who made her miserable. It did not necessarily come from weakness. It originated, instead, from a basic instinct to maintain contact with an attachment figure at all costs and was amplified greatly by an anxious attachment style. For Tamara, the need to remain with Greg was triggered by the very slightest feeling of danger-danger that her lover was out of reach, unresponsive, or in trouble. Letting go in these situations would be insane in evolutionary terms. Using protest behavior, such as calling several times or trying to make him feel jealous, made perfect sense when

seen in this light. What we really liked about attachment theory was that it was formulated on the basis of the population at large. Unlike many other psychological frameworks that were created based on couples who come to therapy, this one drew its lessons from everyone—those who have happy relationships and those who don't, those who never get treatment and those who actively seek it. It allowed us to learn not only what goes “wrong” in relationships but also what goes “right,” and it allowed us to find and highlight a whole group of people who are barely mentioned in most relationship books. What's more, the theory does not label behaviors as healthy or unhealthy. None of the attachment styles is in itself seen as “pathological.” On the contrary, romantic behaviors that had previously been seen as odd or misguided now seemed understandable, predictable, even expected. You stay with someone although he's not sure he loves you? Understandable. You say you want to leave and a few minutes later change your mind and decide that you desperately want to stay? Understandable too. But are such behaviors effective or worthwhile? That's a different story. People with a secure attachment style know how to communicate their own expectations and respond to their partner's needs effectively without having to resort to protest behavior. For the

that he took off all his gear and started walking away. Finally, he mustered the courage to take the challenge after all. Because of that particular hesitation they lost their lead. Attachment theory teaches us that Karen's basic assumption, that she can and should control her emotional needs and soothe herself in the face of stress, is simply wrong. She assumed that the problem was that she is too needy. But research findings support the exact opposite. Getting attached means that our brain becomes wired to seek the support of our partner by ensuring their psychological and physical proximity. If our partner fails to reassure us, we are programmed to continue our attempts to achieve closeness until they do. If Karen and Tim understood this, she would not feel ashamed of needing to hold his hand during the stress of a nationally televised race. For his part, Tim would have known that the simple gesture of holding Karen's hand could give them the extra edge they needed to win. Indeed, if he knew that by responding to her need early on, he would have had to devote less time to “putting out fires” caused by her compounded distress later—he might have been inclined to hold her hand when he noticed that she was starting to get anxious, instead of waiting until she demanded it. What's more, if Tim was able to accept Karen's support more readily, he would probably have bungee jumped sooner. Attachment principles teach us that most people are only as needy as their unmet needs. When their emotional needs are met, and the earlier the better, they usually turn their attention outward. This is sometimes referred to in attachment literature as the “dependency paradox”: The more effectively dependent people are on one another, the more independent and daring they become. Karen and Tim were unaware of how to best use their emotional bond to their advantage in the race. WE'VE COME A LONG WAY (BUT NOT FAR ENOUGH)

How Attachment Works - Amir Levine - Transcript.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 5. Palabras extraidas: 2.671. Texto curado integrado aqui: 281 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Fundamentos del apego adulto' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

Is solitude important in intimacy? Yes - when you have a secure base and know the other person is attuned and there for you, you'll naturally be alone a lot: “I want to read this book, listen to this podcast, exercise.” You don't think about the relationship much. Sometimes you invite the other person; some couples do everything together, and that's fine if it's effective. The baseline is that both people feel heard and understood. Final advice One piece of advice: the biggest takeaway from the book is to really appreciate the secure people in your life, give them more attention, and foster those relationships. Turn up the volume on secure relationships - those small interactions with secure people can be truly transformative to our brain. On trusting your feelings: it is and it isn't. My next book aims to give a blueprint for which feelings to trust and which not to. It takes time to attach, but when we meet someone we're into romantically, there's a big initial spark - and you need to know whether that spark will lead to a good match. Some things you can trust; others you need to test before you trust them. Feelings run amok can ruin a connection. What people don't understand is our function in a relationship: to regulate the other person's emotions, and vice versa - I'm this other person's Xanax. When a relationship is full of difficult, hurtful feelings, something is off. Secure relationships are mostly smooth sailing, with difficult moments here and there - not constant difficult emotions. If that happens, the bond's regulating function is misaligned and needs to be realigned.

Infants Ainsworth-Patterns-of-Attachment.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 148. Palabras extraidas: 67.022. Texto curado integrado aqui: 12.114 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Fundamentos del apego adulto' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

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xiv Preface (2015) beginning 2-3 years after a book or article appears and then declines as a field moves on and interest in a particular work wanes. In marked contrast, interest in Patterns of Attachment has been constant, even increasing, across the three decades since it was first published (see Figure P.1). This too sets Patterns of Attachment apart from most observational and experimental research in developmental psychology. Of course the field has grown since 1978 and there are more attachment researchers and more journals publishing attachment-related research. However, these reflect, as much as account for, the enduring interest in and impact of this

psychology and mark . Patterns of Influence It is also useful to examine how Patterns of Attachment has influenced and supported enduring and emerging themes in attachment study. One approach is to look for themes among the books and articles that have cited Patterns of Attachment. This could be done at different levels of detail and with different degrees of formal analysis. However, even an informal content analysis of titles citing Patterns of Attachment reveals that it has had broad impact and served as a catalyst for explorations in new directions . It also shows that attachment study has kept pace with new directions in psychology . Having identified all the books and articles that cited Patterns of Attachment between 1978 and 2013, we identified those that had been cited at least 100 times. We then used titles and abstracts to sort these 375 high impact items into categories. The twenty categories with the most members are listed alphabetically in Table P.1 .

FIGURE P.1 Articles citing Patterns of Attachment 1978-2013 (Web of Science). 20101985 1990 1995 2000 2005 Year 1980 280 240 200 140 100 60 20 The Impact of Mary Ainsworth's Work Reflected in Web of Science Citations to Patterns of Attachment 1978-2013

PATTERNS OF ATTACHMENT Patterns of Attachment reports the methods and key results of Mary D. Salter Ainsworth's landmark Baltimore Longitudinal Study. Following upon her naturalistic home observations in Uganda, the Baltimore project yielded a wealth of enduring, benchmark results on the nature of the child's tie to its primary caregiver and the importance of early experience. It also addressed a wide range of conceptual and methodological issues common to many developmental and longitudinal projects, especially issues of age appropriateness, measurement, quantifying behavior, and comprehending individual differences. Ainsworth and her students also broke new ground by clarifying key attachment concepts and demonstrating the value of ethnological methods and insights about behavior. Today, as we enter the fourth generation of attachment study, we have a rich and growing catalogue of behavioral and narrative approaches to measuring attachment from infancy to adulthood. Each of these has roots in the Strange Situation and the secure base concept presented in Patterns of Attachment . Its inclusion in the Psychology Press Classic Editions series reflects Patterns of Attachment's continuing significance and ensures its availability to new generations of students, researchers, and clinicians. Mary D. Salter Ainsworth, Ph.D., was Professor Emerita in the Department of Psychology at the University of Virginia. Mary C. Blehar, Ph.D., is affiliated with the National Institutes of Health. Everett Waters, Ph.D., is Professor of Psychology at the State University of New York at Stony Brook. Sally N. Wall, Ph.D., is Professor of Psychology at Notre Dame of Maryland University.

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PREFACE (2015) Everett Waters, Inge Bretherton, and Brian E. Vaughn A preface generally recounts how the idea for a book evolved or how a project developed to the point of requiring a book length presentation. The story behind Patterns of Attachment is exceptionally well documented (e.g., Ainsworth & Bowlby, 1991; Bretherton, 2013, 1991; Karen, 1998; van Dijken, van der Veer, van IJzendoorn, & Kuipers, 1998). Nonetheless, it is worth retelling for new readers. This preface is written with several important goals in mind. The first is to emphasize that Patterns of Attachment remains a core resource in attachment study and deserves a close reading. The second is to make the book, and the findings of developmental attachment theory, more accessible by clarifying and updating points of theory and method that have been the seeds of misunderstanding and, at times, controversy. In addition, we have added new appendices that include the full text of the measures for secure base behavior at home and the four maternal sensitivity constructs used in

the Baltimore longitudinal study. For economy, these important measures were only presented in outline in the original print and in subsequent journal articles. However, after circulating for decades as mimeographed artifacts from Mary Ainsworth's laboratory, it is high time they appear in full and in their appropriate context. A Modern Classic It is rarely clear from the outset that a scientific study will become a landmark. Moreover, it is never clear exactly where its greatest impact will fall. Patterns of Attachment appeared at a critical moment in the development of attachment study. Only the first volumes of Attachment and Loss (Bowlby, 1969, 1973) had

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1 THEORETICAL BACKGROUND Introduction Attachment theory was given its first preliminary statement in John Bowlby's 1958 paper entitled "The Nature of a Child's Tie to His Mother." It was fully launched by the first volume of his trilogy on Attachment and Loss in 1969, which was followed by a second volume in 1973. The first two reports of research inspired by Bowlby's early formulation were by Ainsworth (1963, 1964) and Schaffer and Emerson (1964). Since then there has been an increasing volume of research relevant to infant-mother attachment, including research into mother-infant interaction and into early social development. There is no doubt that the further formulation of attachment theory, as represented in Bowlby's major works (1969, 1973) was influenced by this research. In the meantime other statements of attachment theory have emerged, some of which (e.g., Ainsworth, 1969, 1972; Sroufe & Waters, 1977) dovetailed closely with Bowlby's evolutionary-ethological approach. In contrast, others (e.g., Cairns, 1972; Gewirtz, 1972a, 1972b; Maccoby & Masters, 1970) have attempted to assimilate attachment theory to other earlier paradigms. Attachment Theory as a New Paradigm Bowlby's attachment theory stemmed from a convergence of several important trends in the biological and social sciences. An initial psychoanalytic orientation was integrated with the biological discipline of ethology and its insistence on viewing behavior in an evolutionary context; with psychology and its focus on neurophysiology, endocrine, and receptor processes that interact with environmental stimuli to activate and terminate the activity of behavior.

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28 Theoretical Background of self and of attachment figures, the kinds of interactions between a child and his attachment figures undergo much change. And as we have also previously implied, the forms of behavior through which the attachment system is mediated become much more varied, although they still feature, under certain circumstances, overt proximity/contact seeking. Despite the increasing sophistication of the processes mediating a child's attachment to his mother and others, and despite the fact that developmental changes continue, Bowlby did not conceive of such changes as involving processes different enough from those operating in Phase 4 to specify further phases of development. On the contrary, the processes implicit in Phase 4 were conceived as characteristic of mature attachments. Although Bowlby (1969, 1973) was specifically concerned with the attachment of a child to his mother figure, he conceived of attachment to other figures as approximating the same model-and he clearly stated that attachments continue throughout the entire life span. Attachment to parent figures may become attenuated as adulthood approaches and may become supplemented and to some extent supplanted by other attachments; but few if any adults cease to be influenced by their early attachments, or indeed cease at some level of awareness to be attached to their early attachment figures.

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may be distorted in regard to one or two aspects, although it is accurate in other important aspects. She may be prompt and appropriate in response to his communications at times and in most respects, but either inappropriately or slow at other times and in other respects. On the whole, however, she is more frequently sensitive than insensitive. What is striking is that a mother who can be as sensitive as she is on so many occasions can be so insensitive on other occasions. 3. Insensitive. This mother frequently fails to respond to B's communications appropriately and/or promptly, although she may on some occasions show capacity for sensitivity in her responses to and interactions with B. Her insensitivity seems linked to inability to see things from B's point of view. She may be too frequently preoccupied with other things and therefore incapable to his signals and communications, or she may misperceive his signals and interpret them inaccurately because of her own wishes or defenses. Or, she may know well enough what B is communicating but be disinclined to give him what he wants-because it is inconvenient or she not in the mood for it, or because she is determined not to "spoil" him. She may delay an otherwise appropriate response to such an extent that it is no longer contingent upon his

the mother can talk about him, discuss her plans for him, or her policies in managing him. She may give information about him, but often this is meagre because she has not observed his behavior or closely enough to give much detail. It is as though her concept of the infant is more real than the infant as he actually exists. The second major type of mother who is frequently imperceptive and unaware has dynamics that seem less pernicious than those of the first, because the mother is not rendered quite so impervious to the infant's signals and communications. This mother creates a barrier against the infant's demands, but, since she does not back this up by a distortion or

perception of his signals, he can, if he signals intensely enough or persistently enough, break through. These mothers tend to be somewhat compulsive. They get preoccupied with their own activities, whether work or conversations, or they ruminate, lost in their own thoughts and worries. While they are thus preoccupied, the infant may go unnoticed. Such women are one-track minded, and find it difficult to switch from one set of activities to another-from house keeping to mothering, for example. Sometimes they bolster up their need to be unintruded by arranging the physical environment so that the infant will not impinge upon

perhaps because she is able to empathize with the infant, does not interpret instances of disruptive, annoying behavior as an indication of a potential character defect in the infant which must be "nipped in the bud." Although some times the infant may seem clearly angry at her, she interprets neither such episodes, nor episodes of more diffusely uncooperative or annoying behavior, as adequate reason for her to feel hurt or to institute retaliatory measures. She may feel a brief surge of annoyance, but she does not consider the infant himself as a suitable target on which to focus her anger. She may acknowledge his anger. She may openly express her own exasperations. She may discourage the behavior in question. She may deal with her own momentarily irritated by some means which gives her a chance to "cool off" before resuming her interaction with the infant. But she does not harbor resentment or hurt, and because she does not "take it out" on the infant, he is unlikely to feel rejected, especially if momentarily irritated or behavior directed disapproval is embedded in general warm acceptance. Some outwardly accepting mothers are more rejecting than those, described above, who can give brief, healthy, situation-specific vent to annoyance. The pseudo-accepting mothers comply with the infant's

rejection under these circumstances. If, however, the infant is in another room-as, for example, when he is crying when put down for a nap or waking from a nap-the mother's failure to respond will be considered ignoring. It is emphasized that this is only a rule of thumb. Ignoring in the sense of being oblivious to the infant and failing to perceive his signals may be a special case of rejection, and may have similar motivation, although the implication is that the negative component is more completely repressed than in rejection. Indeed some mothers may be both rejecting and ignoring, alternating more or less overt rejection with the covert rejection implicit in ignoring. It never the less seems worth while to distinguish these two variables because it seems likely that babies respond differently to the two patterns of behavior, and that certain patterns of infant behavior may be associated with relatively overt rejection in which the angry component can be more clearly sensed, than with the covert rejection implicit in ignoring. Furthermore, the positive ends of the two scales-accessibility and acceptance-may be distinguished. Some mothers are accessible in the sense of being clearly aware of the infant and yet behave in a rejecting way. Other mothers may be on balance positive in their feelings, and

manage. Even though she may refrain from verbalizing her rejection of B, she may manifest it by a constant opposition to his wishes, by a generally pervasive atmosphere of irritation and scolding, by jerking him about with ill concealed anger, and by joining battle with him whenever he seems to challenge her power. There may be positive aspects in her relationship with B which suggest that she can enjoy B, but these are rare and isolated in their manifestations. Note: Difficulties have been encountered in rating highly defended mothers who seem bland or emotionally detached, and who give evidence neither of positive acceptance as defined by scale points "9" and "7" nor of the hostile components of feelings or behavior as specified by the other scale points. It seems best to rate such women "5," despite the fact that they do not show the expressions of negative feeling specified in the definition of that scale point. It is understood that the intermediate points "4" or "6" may also be used, depending upon the tendency for either negative or positive feelings to break through the generally emotionless facade. It is further understood that there may be enough veiled rejection in a seemingly "matter of fact," emotionless mother to justify a rating of "3" as the rating point is presently defined.

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socially to his attempts to initiate social interaction, playfully to his attempts to initiate play. She picks him up when he seems to wish it, and puts him down when he wants to explore. When he is distressed, she knows what kind and degree of soothing he requires to comfort him-and she knows that some times a few words or a distraction will be all that is needed. When he is hungry she sees that he soon gets something to eat, perhaps giving him a snack if she does not want to give him his regular meal right away. On the other hand, the mother who responds inappropriately, tries to socialize with the infant when he is hungry, play with him when he is tired, or feed him when he is trying to initiate social interaction. In play and social interaction, the mother who responds appropriately to her child does not overstimulate him by interacting in too intense, too vigorous, too prolonged, or too exciting a manner. She can perceive and accurately interpret the signs of over excitement, undue tension, or incipient distress and shifts the tempo or intensity before things have gone too far. Similarly, she is unlikely to understimulate the child, because she picks up and responds to the signals he gives when he is bored or when he wants more interaction than has heretofore been forthcoming. In the second year of life, and some times also toward the end of the first year,

more subtle behaviors than the highly sensitive mother. Or, perhaps because she is less skillful in dividing her attention between B and competing demands, she may some times "miss her cues." B's clear and definite signals are, however, neither missed nor misinterpreted. This mother empathizes with B and sees things from his point of view; her perceptions of his behavior are not distorted. Perhaps because her perception is less sensitive than that of mothers with higher ratings, her responses are not as consistently prompt or as finely appropriate. But although there may be occasionally little "mismatches," M (mother's) interactions and interactions are never seriously out of tune with B's tempo, state, and communications. 5. Inconsistently sensitive. Although this mother can be quite sensitive on occasion, there are some periods in which she is insensitive to B's communications. M's inconsistent sensitivity may occur for any one of several reasons, but the outcome is that she seems to have lacunae in regard to her sensitive dealings with B-being sensitive at some times or in respect to some aspects of his experience, but not in others. Her awareness of B may be intermittent-often fairly keen, but some times imperious. Or, her perception of B's behavior

cooperation is required if the intervention is to be effective—for example, in feeding, in play, and (although this usually comes later) in toilet training. Other mothers, whose interference does not so conspicuously emphasize physical force, nevertheless must be considered highly interfering because they are “at” the infant most of the time—instructing, training, eliciting, directing, controlling. In either case it is clear that the highly interfering mother has no respect for her infant as a separate, active, and autonomous person, whose wishes and activities have a validity of their own. The underlying dynamics of such an attitude are various; some examples follow. An obsessive-compulsive woman, for example, tends to require a tight control over other people in order to control her own anxieties; such a mother may become anxious and angry when the infant does not do exactly what she wants him to do, when she wants him to do it, and in the way she wants him to do it. Another kind of dynamic behind interference is shown by the woman whose infant continues to be a narcissistic extension of herself; such a woman tends to treat him as her possession, her creature, hers. When she is in a mood to play, she may find the infant charming, provided that he cooperates and plays; when she tires of him she puts him aside;

communicate intentions and signals.) This present scale, although not entirely orthogonal to scales of ignoring and rejecting, is certainly not in one-to-one relationship with them. Some interfering mothers alternate interfering in transitions with periods of ignoring the infant; others are clearly aware of the infant at all times and are by no means inaccurate. The Cooperation vs. Interference Scale 9. Conspicuously cooperative. This mother views her infant as a separate, active, autonomous person, whose wishes and activities have validity of their own. Since she respects his autonomy, she avoids situations in which she might have to impose her will on his, and shows foresight in planning ahead by arranging the physical environment of the house or by her timing her own household routines in such a way as to minimize the need for interference and for direct control. She avoids interrupting an activity the infant has in progress. When it is desirable to intervene for a routine or to “shift” his activity, she truly engages his cooperation, by mood setting, by inviting him, by diverting him, and by engaging him in reciprocal activity of some sort, often through vocalization or play. In activity shifting and indeed also in play, she capitalizes on spontaneity,

picking up cues from the infant to help her present what she wants him to do as something that is also congenial to him. Even a conspicuously cooperative mother inevitably will instruct her infant to some extent or attempt to elicit particular behaviors, but these mildly controlling interactions both constitute a small proportion of their total interaction and are themselves appropriate enough to the infant's mood and activity in progress to be considered coordinated. Except in rare emergency situations this mother never interferes with the infant abruptly and with physical force. Verbal commands and prohibitions across distance are an inevitable corollary of giving the infant freedom to explore and to learn, but the “conspicuously cooperative” mother manages to structure the freedom to explore situation so that she needs to command but rarely. In other words, to be cooperative in doing does not imply either overpermissiveness or a “laissez faire” attitude. 7. Cooperative. This mother does not have as conspicuous a respect for her infant's autonomy and ongoing activity as do mothers with higher ratings, but on the whole she is cooperative and noninterfering. She shows less foresight than mothers with higher ratings do in arranging the physical environment and her own routine so as to avoid the need for interference

or, as discussed, (b) her freedom from distortion, and (c) her empathy. An infantive, “ignoring” mother is, of course, often unable to interpret correctly the infant's signals when they break through her obliviousness, for she has been unaware of the prodromal signs and of the temporal context of the behavior. But even a mother who is highly aware and accessible may misinterpret signals because her perception is distorted by projection, denial, or other marked defensive operations. Mothers who have distorted perceptions tend to bias their “reading” of their babies according to their own wishes, moods, and fantasies. For example, a mother not wishing to attend to her infant might interpret his fussy bids for attention as fatigue and, therefore, put him to bed or, if she is in a hurry, might perceive any slowing down in the rate of feeding as a sign of satiation. Similarly, a mother who is somewhat rejecting of her infant might perceive him as rejecting and aggressive toward herself. Mothers who least distort their perceptions of their babies have some insight as to their own wishes and moods, and thus can more realistically judge the infant's behavior. Furthermore, they are usually aware of how their own behavior and moods affect their infant's behavior.

The mother must be able to empathize with her infant's feelings and wishes before she can respond with sensitivity. That is, a mother might be quite aware of and understand accurately the infant's behavior and the circumstances leading to her infant's distress or demands, but because she is unable to empathize with him—unable to see things from the infant's point of view—she may tease him back into good humor, mock him, laugh at him, or just ignore him. The mother's egocentricity and lack of empathy may also lead to detached, intellectual responses to the infant rather than to warm, sensitive interactions with the infant. A high threshold of awareness and inaccurate perceptions certainly leads to insensitive responses. Nevertheless, the mother may be highly aware and accurate in her interpretation and still be insensitive. Therefore, in the last analysis, the appropriateness and promptness of the mother's response to communications are the hallmarks of sensitivity. The quality of the mother's interaction with her infant is probably the most important index of her sensitivity. It is essential that the mother's responses be appropriate to the situation and to the infant's communications. Often enough, at least in the first year of life, the sensitive mother gives the infant what his communications suggest he wants. She responds

it is maximally appropriate for the mother to respond to the infant's signals not so much in accordance with what he ostensibly wants as in terms of a compromise between this and what will make him feel most secure, competent, comfortable, etc., in the long run. This is a tricky judgment to make for so much that is done “for the infant's own good” is done both contrary to his wishes and according to the mother's convenience, whim, or preconceived standards. Nevertheless there are situations in which limit setting, even in the first year, clears the air even though it is initially contrary to the infant's wishes. Similarly there are situations in which the infant's signals might lead the mother to increase the tempo of interaction to the point of discomfort for him, and in which it is appropriate gradually to diminish intensity. Therefore, there is a fine point of balance at which the mother can begin to show the infant that she is not an instrument of his will, but a cooperative partner whose participation must be elicited appropriately. In such instances the mother will slightly frustrate the infant's imperious demands but warmly encourage (and reward) behaviors which are inviting or requesting rather than demanding. Nevertheless, in such interactions the sensitive mother acknowledged

ges the infant's wishes even though she does not unconditionally accede to them. The chief point is that a sensitive, appropriate response does not invariably imply complete compliance to the infant's wish—although very frequently compliance may be the most appropriate response. The final feature of appropriate interaction is that it is well resolved or well rounded and completed. For example, when the infant seeks contact the sensitive mother holds him long enough to satisfy him, so that when he is put down he does not immediately seek to be picked up again. When he needs soothing, she soothes him thoroughly, so he is quite recovered and cheerful. When he seeks social interaction she enters into a more or less prolonged exchange with him, after which, often enough, he is content to enter into himself. In contrast, the responses of some mothers with low sensitivity seem to be fragmented and incomplete. These mothers may try a series of interventions as though searching for the best method or solution. Highly sensitive mothers have completed, easily and well resolved, interactions. Finally, there is the issue of the promptness of the mother's response to the infant's communication. A response, however appropriate, which is so delayed that it cannot be perceived by the infant as continuing

current state. In summary, the most sensitive mothers are usually accessible to their infants and are aware even of their more subtle communications, signals, wishes, and moods. In addition, these mothers accurately interpret their perceptions and show empathy with their infants. The sensitive mother, armed with this understanding and empathy, can time her interactions well and deal with her infant so that her interactions seem appropriate—appropriate in kind as well as in quality—and prompt. In contrast, mothers with low sensitivity are not aware of much of their infant's behavior, either because they ignore the infant or they fail to perceive in his activity the more subtle and hard-to-detect communications. Furthermore, insensitive mothers often do not understand those aspects of their infant's behavior of which they are aware or else they distort it. A mother may have some what accurate perceptions of her infant's activity and moods but may be unable to empathize with him. Through either lack of understanding or empathy, mothers with low sensitivity improperly time their responses, either in terms of scheduling or in terms of promptness to the infant's communications. Further, mothers with low sensitivity often have inappropriate responses in kind as well as quantity (i.e.,

interactions that are fragmented and poorly resolved). The Sensitivity vs. Insensitivity Scale 9. Highly sensitive. This mother is exquisitely attuned to B (baby)'s signals; and responds to them promptly and appropriately. She is able to see things from B's point of view; her perceptions of his signals and communications are not distorted by her own needs and defenses. She "reads" B's signals and communications skillfully, and knows what the meaning is of even his subtle, minimal, and understated cues. She nearly always gives B what he indicates that he wants, although perhaps not invariably so. When she feels that it is best not to comply with his demands—for example, when he is too excited, overimpressed, or wants something he should not have—she is tactful in acknowledging his communication and in offering an acceptable alternative. She has "well rounded" interactions with B, so that the transaction is smoothly completed and both she and B feel satisfied. Finally, she makes her responses temporally contingent upon B's signals and communications. 7. Sensitive. This mother also interacts with B's communications accurately, and responds to them promptly and appropriately but with less sensitivity than mothers with higher ratings. She may be less attuned to B's

in either case it does not seem to occur to her to attribute any validity to how the infant feels. A third kind of dynamic behind interference is an emphasis on training. The mother feels that she can shape the infant to fit her own concept of a good infant, whether through a determined attempt to elicit behavior she considers desirable or by punishing behavior that she considers undesirable. These three examples do not exhaust the possibilities, but it is hoped that they serve to illustrate the essentials of the underlying attitude—which is that the interfering mother feels that the infant is hers and that she has a perfect right to impose her will on him. She tends to treat him almost as an inanimate possession that she can move about as she wishes—or perhaps, as a more appropriate analogy, as a small child treats a pet kitten, to be handled, petted, fed, teased, carried, and put aside with complete lack of regard for the kitten's needs and wishes. Mothers at the other end of this continuum seem to guide rather than to control the infant's activity. Such a mother integrates her wishes, moods, and household responsibilities with the infant's wishes, moods, and ongoing activity. Their interactions and shifts of activity seem coordinated. Rather than interrupting an activity that the infant has in

restraint it will not be so considered. In between the two extremes come the milder interferences of verbal commands and prohibitions. Thus, for example, the mother who slaps or holds the infant's hands to prevent him from touching food would be considered interfering; the mother who scolds and warns without physical intervention would be considered interfering to a milder degree. The mother who gives no finger foods would not be considered interfering, unless she slaps, holds, scolds, or verbally prohibits. The mother who tussles or slaps an active child while changing him would be considered interfering. The mother who gives him something to manipulate or who holds his attention by talking to him playfully and thus does not need to interfere physically would be considered noninterfering. The mother who interrupts an active or excited or unsleepy infant and puts him to bed abruptly would be considered interfering. But the mother who plays gentle games, or holds and rocks, and who generally gets the infant into a nap accepting mood will be considered cooperative. The timing of routines per se, will not, however, be taken into account in rating this variable. (Timing will be reflected in the scale dealing with the mother's sensitivity to the infant's

has a perfect right to do with him what she wishes, imposing her will on his, or shaping him to her standards, or merely following her own whims without regard to his moods, wishes, or activities. There is an arbitrariness about the interference that is striking. Much (although not all) of it is "for no apparent reason." Some highly interfering mothers are conspicuous for the direct, physical, forcefulness of their interruptions or restraints. Others are conspicuous for the extreme frequency of interruption of the infant's activity in progress, so that they seem "at" the infant most of the time—instructing, training, eliciting, directing, controlling. But the "1" mother tends to combine both types of interference, even though she may emphasize one type more than the other. Regardless of the balance between physical handling and milder interruptions, these mothers have in common an extreme lack of respect for the infant's autonomy, and an obtuseness which permits them to break into what the infant is doing without any need to explain to others, or even to justify to themselves, the reason for the interruption. Scale 3: Physical and Psychological Accessibility vs. Ignoring and Neglecting The central issue of this scale is the mother's accessibility to the infant, with

emphasis upon her responsiveness to him. Although the essential component of psychological accessibility is that the mother be aware of the infant, she is not truly accessible unless she also actively acknowledges and responds to him. A highly accessible mother has her infant in her field of perceptual awareness at all times so that he is within reach, at least, through distance reception. She can divide her attention between the infant and other persons, things, and activities without losing awareness of the infant. She is never too preoccupied with her own thoughts and feelings or with her other activities and interactions to have him in the background of her awareness and to sense where he is and what he is doing. When he is in another room she is quick to perceive any sounds he may make, and she takes precautions not to have him so far away or so closed off that she cannot hear a sound as loud as a cry. The highly accessible mother not only is aware of her infant's activity and signals, but she responds to him readily. She can switch her attention to him easily if he needs her supervision or protection or if he approaches or tries to catch her attention. To be accessible, the mother does not necessarily understand and interpret the infant's behavior nor does she necessarily respond appropriately to the infant's signals—nevertheless, the accessible mother is

and objective; in their failure to acknowledge the infant they must seem as inaccessible to the infant as if they did not perceive him. Throughout this discussion emphasis has been placed upon the mother's failure to perceive and/or to be responsive to the infant's signals. Inaccessibility is most obvious when the infant is, in fact, signaling, and the mother does not respond. There are, however, babies who make few demands—perhaps because they have become accustomed to being ignored. The relative lack of frequency, intensity, or persistence of signal ing behavior on the part of the infant may make it all the easier for his mother to ignore him, but the rater should not be misled into overrating the mother's accessibility on this account. If she can go for long periods without seeming to notice the infant or to acknowledge him she is a candidate for a low rating regardless of whether or not the infant is making obvious demands. In summary, an accessible mother is aware of her infant and of his behavior most of the time and usually acknowledges his presence, his signals and his communications. A mother is judged to be inaccessible if she frequently or perhaps for prolonged periods does not acknowledge the infant or respond to him—whether she is aware of his behavior or not, and, indeed, whether she is

in the same room or not. This scale does not take into account the quality of care that the mother gives the infant or the quality of her interaction with him. Some mothers are constantly aware of the infant and responsive to his signals, and yet they respond inappropriately or even sadistically. It is the bare fact of the mother's acknowledgment of his real presence that is important on this scale—not the quality of her response to him. Note: This variable is similar to Scale MC 1 of the first quarter rating scale—mother's accessibility to the infant. The previous scale was, however, concerned with the issue of the limited availability of the part-time mother. This present scale is concerned only with the mother's accessibility when she is at home. The working mother will, therefore, be rated only on the basis of her behavior when she returns home from work. The Accessibility vs. Ignoring and Neglecting Scale 9. Highly accessible. M arranges things so that she can be accessible to B and B to her. She keeps him close enough so that she can be aware of his states, signals, and activities. She is very alert to his whereabouts and doings. Even when he is napping in his room she has a selective filter tuned in to any sounds he might make. She is capable of distributing her attention between B and other people and things, and is rarely so preoccupied that she

2. Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activacion

Este capitulo explica como la activacion transforma una necesidad legitima en protesta, persecucion, lectura ansiosa o defensa. La solucion no es negar la necesidad, sino expresarla desde seguridad. Fuentes integradas en este capitulo: 13.

Estructura interna del capitulo

- Definicion completa del fenomeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicologico, relacional o corporal segun las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Senales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y limites.
- Herramientas practicas, criterios de aplicacion y conexiones con otros capitulos.

Books/Secure Love Introduccion .pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 33. Palabras extraidas: 15.178. Texto curado integrado aqui: 1.163 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activacion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

Introduction i see you i hear you i'm safe i'm on your team i see you i hear you What does a healthy relationship look like? Many of us have wondered this. But now I want you to forget this question forever. Instead, ask yourself: "What does a securely attached relationship feel like?" If you don't know what a securely attached relationship is, much less what it feels like, that's okay. That's why we're here. By the end of this book, you will know about secure attachment, and more important, what it feels like to be in a relationship that is truly fulfilling. You will no longer have to wonder whether or not your relationship is working, because you will find the answers within yourself. If it's not working, you will learn what needs to change and how to go about Copyrighted Material

viii CONTENTS 12. When You Aren't Seeing Results 230 13. Instead of This, Do This 247 Conclusion: Going Forward in the World with Secure Love 275 Appendix 285 Acknowledgments 297 Notes 301 Index 303 Disclaimer: Secure Love was written to help struggling couples heal. However, the material in this book is not appropriate or safe for those in abusive relationships. A relationship is considered abusive and unsafe when one partner tries to exert power and control over the other partner with physical violence, emotional manipulation, extreme verbal abuse, sexual coercion, financial control, isolation, and/or intimidation. If you are in an abusive relationship, suspect you may be, or would like to know more about how to define abuse, it is highly recommended that you seek professional guidance. If you want help determining if you're in an abusive relationship or to get guidance as to what to do next, help is immediately available all hours of the day at the National Domestic Violence Hotline: 1-800-799-7233. Copyrighted Material

xviii INTRODUCTION covering topics like "are you emotionally available?" "responding to your partner's reaches for connection," and "when I'm sorry might not be enough." I've included similar graphics and easy-to-use scripts in this book to help you digest this advice readily. If my social media posts are quick hits into these topics, this book is the deep dive, but just as simple to put into action. By the end of this book, you will not know you're in a better relationship; rather, you will have learned to find, recognize, and re-create moments of connection, safety, and security. You will have learned how to make this experience the undercurrent in your relationship, so that it exists whether the two of you are on a romantic vacation together, working through a difficult problem, or even when you're simply going about daily life not thinking about the relationship at all. You will also have grown within yourself, so you feel safe and comfortable in your own skin, and you can bring that comfort into all your relationships. This is the root of true connection. This is secure love. PART ONE Understanding Your Needs Copyrighted Material

"Love is a constant process of tuning in, connecting, reading and misreading cues, disconnecting, repairing, and finding deeper connection. It's a dance of meeting and parting and finding each other again. Minute to minute and day to day." Sue Johnson Contents Introduction xi PART ONE Understanding Your Needs 1. The Problem Beneath the Problem 1 2. Understanding Attachment Theory 13 3. Identifying Your Attachment Style 35 PART TWO Understanding How You Conflict and How to Repair 4. What Is Your Negative Cycle? 73 5. Interrupting the Negative Cycle 93 6. Preventing the Negative Cycle: The Attachment-Friendly Environment 119 7. Reaching and Responding 150 8. Repairing After a Negative Cycle 170 9. Attachment Injuries and Repair 186 PART THREE Real-World Considerations 10. Workable Intruders: When You or Your Partner Struggles with Depression, Trauma, or Addictions 201 11. The Sex Factor 213 Copyrighted Material

CHAPTER 1 The Problem Beneath the Problem I feel so alone. My protests are my way of trying to make things change. I'm desperate to get through to you. You don't even care about my feelings! You're emotionally unavailable! I feel like such a disappointment and I don't know what I'm doing wrong. Using logic and reason is how I try to reach you. You're being irrational! You just want to /f_ight! "The problem is not the problem." Hi, I'm glad you're home," Jen says to her husband, Andrew, as he walks in the door and puts his keys on the table to greet her. "But you put your keys on the table again. I've asked you a hundred times to put them on the hook. That's why we call it the 'key hook.'" "Really?" Andrew responds. "I just walked in the door. I almost always put them on the hook. You really need to bring this up the second I get home?" "Almost always? Hardly. More like 'never,'" Jen says. "It might be a Copyrighted Material

For my husband, Mario, and my children: John, Clare, Kate, Meg, Sophie, and Lizzie CORNERSTONE PRESS UK | USA | Canada | Ireland | Australia India | New Zealand | South Africa Cornerstone Press is part of the Penguin Random House group of companies whose addresses can be found at global.penguinrandomhouse.com Penguin Random House UK, One Embassy Gardens, 8 Viaduct Gardens, London SW11 7BW penguin.co.uk First published in the US by Simon & Schuster 2024 First published in the UK by Cornerstone Press 2024 001 Copyright © Julie Menanno, 2024 The moral right of the author has been asserted Penguin Random House values and supports copyright. Copyright fuels creativity, encourages diverse voices, promotes freedom of expression and supports a vibrant culture. Thank you for purchasing an authorised edition of this book and for respecting intellectual property laws by not reproducing, scanning or distributing any part of it by any means without permission. You are supporting authors and enabling Penguin Random House to continue to publish books for everyone. No part of this book may be used or reproduced in any manner for the purpose of training artificial intelligence technologies or systems. In accordance with Article 4(3) of the DSM Directive 2019/790, Penguin Random House expressly reserves this work from the text and data mining exception. Interior design by Joy O'Meara Art by NataliaMalikova@Dreamstime.com Printed and bound in Great Britain by Clays Ltd, Elcograf S.p.A. The authorised representative in the EEA is Penguin Random House Ireland, Morrison Chambers, 32 Nassau Street, Dublin D02 YH68 A CIP catalogue record for this book is available from the British Library ISBN: 978-1-529-90296-9 Penguin Random House is committed to a sustainable future for our business, our readers and our planet. This book is made from Forest Stewardship Council® certified paper. Copyrighted Material

How to NOT get emotionally invested too quickly - nathalie - Transcript espanol-ingles.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 4. Palabras extraidas: 2.242. Texto curado integrado aqui: 353 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activación' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

my standards. Also maybe date multiple guys at the same time, maybe two guys. You need to create a crystal clear vision of what you want. You need to sit down and ask yourself: where am I at in life and what am I looking for in a man? What's important, what do I bring, what do I want? Make dating into a conscious experience. Really understand that choosing a partner is the most important thing, because it will impact your life so much, so having a very clear vision will anchor you to your reality. We don't take things off the list and then never check the list again. No, no, no. We continue to check the list: do I feel seen, do I feel loved with this man, did I recognise these things that I'm looking for in a man? Other thing is that I want you to prioritise. I want you to have an honest look at the other areas of your life and ask yourself: is this fulfilling? Is there an area in my life that I want to work on? That could be friends, could be hobbies, could be educating myself. Have a good look at your life. If your life sucks and is unfulfilling, it's no wonder you jump at the first sign of attention and validation and connection. The more you create a life you actually love, the easier it is for you to stay grounded. Then the next step: we are going to create a pattern interrupt. The moment you notice you do the thing, you are going to go: okay, this is what I'm doing, I know why I'm doing it, I also know where that leads me. Let's connect to myself, let's validate that of course I want to have that need met, and this way of getting it met is going to lead me to a place I don't want to go. So let's reflect on the things I could do instead right now. You want to create solid boundaries with yourself.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch1 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 15.562. Texto curado integrado aqui: 7.118 palabras.

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Um, see if you can find that in the book. I don't remember exactly what chapter it's in, Katrina. See if you can find that. I think it's either chapter four or five. Okay. Um, I'll take a couple more here. Um, as someone who had an anxious attachment, learning about self-abandonment was a gamechanger and catapulted my healing. Amazing. So glad to hear that. I mean that really is the defining factor for an anxious attachment heal. I mean for both healing, but um you know it's that um usually there's a there's a different flavor between self-abandoning for avoidant and um anxious.

And I don't want to ignore that because it's important. Um, so I'll probably maybe just spend the bulk of my time on the chapter and then a few questions that are kind of outside that content. Um, so since I'm just going in order here, um, someone asks, "Is there a connection between anxious styles and a lack of empathy?" Yes, because anxiety blocks empathy in a given moment. So, usually those with anxious attachment, generally speaking, are more in tune with other people's emotions, uh, because they're usually heavily in tune with their own.

Um, anyone with an insecure attachment, anyone in any interaction, even if you generally have a secure attachment that is really triggered and not managing that trigger in a healthy way, is going to lose empathy because the focus goes into getting my own pain relieved and getting my own need met. Um, okay. So, a lot of you are saying thank you and you're happy to be here and appreciate those comments. It energizes me. Um and yes the sessions will be recorded so you can go back you can watch them you can watch them later um there will be times when I can't come to our weekly meeting because I'll be you know vacation or traveling or whatever and in which case we'll just pick back up on the next chapter um when I get back and again if you need to miss then you have that recording.

So you know yes we're talking about finances. Yes there is a lot on the line when it comes to finances. We all need to feel secure financially and if we're not feeling secure financially then we are going to feel angst about that. Um, but it's not a relationship problem yet until the couple is trying to resolve their differences and work together on finances and they go in a negative cycle. So, if you're going into a negative cycle when you try to talk about the financial stress, you're you're two things are going to happen.

Julie Menanno, MA, LMFT, LCPC. Terapeuta de pareja licenciada, formada en Terapia Focalizada en las Emociones (EFT). Autora del bestseller Secure Love y creadora de @thesequilibrerelationship (~1,3 M de seguidores en Instagram). Combinación sólida de credenciales clínicas y gran audiencia.

Um, I did finish up with Bethany and Brian that's season two. Now we're just trying to do the editing and stuff with that to get that out. Um, and this is what I'm trying to walk couples through self-help wise in the book. So, um, to go from insecure attachment to secure attachment, first I've just got to get these negative cycles stabilized where couples are, you know, attacking each other, shutting down on each other, um, whatever they're they're doing that isn't working and is creating more disconnection between the two of them.

Um, part of that is that those with anxious attachment are in the role, and I don't want to say this in a negative way, and I hope you don't take offense to this because I know a lot of you have an anxious attachment, but there's more of a role of being a victim, of stuck in a victim role. And it's um you were, if you can relate to that, you were victimized. you truly were victimized and you have an awareness of the victimization. You have an awareness that you're not being shown up for.

And then those with avoidant attachment, they don't have the same awareness that their emotional needs aren't being met because they have disconnected from those emotional needs. They are every bit as much victimized by their upbringing or by, you know, the people that they have needed to rely on for emotional health. they just don't have themselves in that box because they're not their lens isn't so much I've been a victim. Um, and so because that layer isn't there, it's easier to get them to figure out the way I'm self-abandoning is I'm just leaving my emotions.

Primera sesión del club de lectura del libro Secure Love. Menanno explica el enfoque EFT: bajo cada discusión de superficie (dinero, las llaves en la encimera) hay necesidades de apego no cubiertas y dolor no resuelto. Cuando la pareja intenta resolver sus diferencias y entra en un "ciclo negativo", ni resuelve el problema concreto ni protege el vínculo: erosiona la seguridad emocional y genera más desconexión, enfado y vergüenza. El caso de Andrew y Jen ilustra que no discuten por las llaves, sino por necesidades de apego (sentirse vista, escuchada, atendida).

You know, I want something to look forward to. And so, that's I guess I hope you uh get what I'm asking. Yeah, I think I do. So, are you saying that you were in like this kind of typical anxious avoidant relationship and then then it shifted and now your wife is the one that is pulling away and you're trying to now bridge that gap? Yeah, she was the one that uh as for the separation. um to I give too much detail you

know uh I trilater trust you know twice marriage to big events um our communication styles uh you know I'm if you know the uh behavioral like assessments like uh I'm very analytical she's very dominant you know uh I'm more reserved I I used to stonewall a lot she's very much a communicator so um with the violation of trust my defensiveness my uh not being able to meet eye to eye also not really uh seeing her love language and meeting her like love language and her needs emotionally um eventually just led to you know her then you know what I'm not happy and uh I want this separation and then things happened after that on her end you know she did and obviously it hurts me and so yes yeah okay so yes this is not uncommon at all um usually we're going to call it a burnout pursuer meaning that the anxious ious partner really tries and tries and tries and that doesn't nec really mean they're the only one trying.

Lo que la pareja ve en la superficie: una persona culpa, critica y protesta, enmarcando sus preocupaciones de un modo que difícilmente abre al otro. Esas palabras dejan al otro sintiéndose incomprendido, no cuidado o como si sus necesidades no importaran, muy influido por sus experiencias pasadas sensibles. Y como no sabe hablar de eso ni ayudarse, la forma que aprendió de aliviarlo es ponerse a la defensiva: "estás equivocada y aquí está por qué", con la idea de que si logra que el otro vea que se equivoca, no tendrá que sentir ese dolor. Pero la primera persona intenta expresar su dolor, así que se siente invalidada porque el otro no puede estar ahí para su dolor. ¿Y cómo va a estarlo si no sabe ayudar al suyo? Y encima la primera tampoco le comunica bien su dolor. Eso crea más invalidación y sensación de soledad, que alimenta más protesta, y así hasta que probablemente alguien se cierra.

The more you heal as a person, the more you will show up in your with your partner in a new way that will start to heal your negative cycle, which will then contribute to your own selfhealing. And then as we do that, we're now we're starting to create these positive cycles with these topics like finances or whatever. And that just increases connection. And then all of that contributes to secure attachment with it which is just an overall felt sense of closeness and emotional safety in the relationship.

How are you trying to manage your emotions? How are you doing it then? And what we're going to figure out is those with avoidant attachment are suppressing, stuffing, um just trying to people plea. I'm sorry. Usually with avoidant, it's not so much peoplepleasing, but appeasing. Um the difference is is with anxious attachment and peoplepleasing, it's more like I want to make you happy so you'll be happy with me so you'll come toward me. With avoidant attachment, it's I want to tell you what you want to hear so you will stop coming at me.

One is you're going to not really get to a solution about finances most likely, and that topic is just going to keep popping up over and over again until it gets some resolution. And two, you're going to harm your your emotional bond with each other and you're going to harm your safety in the relationship. And you might even harm each other's and your own views of self and and create more shame. Um, and so in EFT, we're going in and we're dealing with that stuff underneath the surface and we're trying to get secure attachment on board, get safety on board, get closeness on board.

But sometimes as adults, we have to learn that ourselves. So again, that's it sounds so easy when I just spit it out because I do it 50,000 times a day. Um, but I do have, you know, the shame workshop that's on my course walks through it in the context of shame. Um, and then this course I'm developing for inse for anxious attachment really extensively walks people through it. But that's basically the formula. If you want to write it down, go back and watch this.

Most couples are never going to fully escape negative cycles. It's just not a realistic goal. But when you do have them, they're fewer and farther between. They don't get as ugly and you can repair much faster and you can get back to your felt sense of safety. I like to kind of talk about it as climate versus weather. Um, a securely attached relationship has an overall climate of closeness and safety, but we have periods of bad weather that knocks us off, but we're able to get back through to the overall good climate.

It, you know, disregulated isn't just disregulated. It's something in your body that's disregulated. You got to be able to sit with that. Okay, this is that place where you know I'm hurting inside and what are the feelings around this hurt? Is it a fear that I feel usually disregulated? It always disregulated is going to be a lot of fear and get really specific with that fear. What am I afraid of right here and now? What's the fear? And when you can really listen to that fear, then yeah, you got to start to help yourself get more clear about what that fear is afraid of and what that fear needs to regain a sense of safety.

And the anxious is typically self-abandoning for the sake of other and for the sake of relationship. And um there's just so much healing um in that ability to start showing up for self. Um oh, great question. What is the equivalent for someone with an avoidant attachment? Um what thing usually makes the penny drop for them? Well, I'm going to be honest with you. In the work that I do with couples, I actually have more success getting the avoidant to stop abandoning their own feelings faster.

And he comes in and throws the keys on the counter. And you know, if it's just about the keys, then Jen would just pick the keys up and put them away herself. But it's not about the keys. It's about the fact that she's asked him over and over and over to put the keys away. And so now she's feeling unheard, unseen, unresponded to, unimportant because the keys for her represent emotional safety around her needed for order, right? And um so he's not in her mind, he's not really caring about her need and her emotion and her needs to feel responded to in the relationship.

Sometimes we need to change something in our environment to help that emotion. Sometimes we need to change the way we're thinking about something to help that emotion, but we can't ever know the answer without listening to it. And that's where therapy sometimes has to come in, right? Because sometimes it's just you need someone to hold your hand and who is trained to do that, but not always. Um, and then then it's a matter of figuring out what do I really need here and doing it instead of going into that place where you do something with it that's not good for you.

So let's go into chapter 1 and I'm just going to go through the sections and you know the the kind of idea of the work that I do which is EFT. Someone just asked that means emotionally focused therapy for couples. Um it's working with the underlying unmet attachment needs and unmet unresolved painful feelings that each partner has brought to the relationship and that each partner has created in the relationship or the relationship issues have created pain and we're not dealing with that pain in a healthy way.

It looks like they're arguing about the keys. really they're arguing about attachment needs. Um, some of which are fueled by the stuff between them and some of which are fueled by stuff they brought to the relationship on their own. Um, and so, you know, we got to get them communicating outside of these negative cycles because the negative cycles just don't get them anywhere and they just don't know how to talk about this deeper stuff because nobody ever taught them.

Okay. So, it's it's more um I I guess I'm wondering like the the whole concept of self-abandonment is is foreign to me. Okay. So, that's I'm glad that you're saying that because that is, you know, a lot of people have that experience. If you grew up in a home where, you know, and some people pick this up later in life, but most people with an insecure attachment, they grow up in homes where their emotions are not tended to. So they are their emotions are abandoned, right?

I'm doing a whole I haven't I don't have it out yet, but I'm doing a whole anxious attachment self-work course that's going to be like several hours long and it is walking people through the whole process of not self-abandoning. First we we do exercises to just get awareness of the emotion where it sits in your body, naming it. Then we move into validating it. Then we move into listening to it. Then we move into

communicating it or helping it and slash helping it.

Whereas those with insecure attachment, it's more defined by bad weather. The bad weather sort of chokes out the the good weather. So again to summarize um fewer negative cycles, less intense negative cycles and faster repair. So just to and I'm not going to keep you. So just to make sure I understand and I'm trying to compare it to the book, the rupture will happen. We the rupture will happen. It's just does the rupture turn into like a bigger tear if I'm thinking about it correctly or can we keep the r the rupture as small as possible before it grows?

So then of course that creates more invalidation and feelings of being alone which then fuels more protest which then fuels more of this and then on and on they go until probably this person ends up just shutting it down. Okay, any questions about that? Hey, I am curious. Can you hear me? I can. I'm just trying to find your box. Bright yellow somewhere. There you go. Okay. Gotcha. So, I am curious how it is possible in a cycle to slow it down because I feel like I understand it right now cuz I'm not triggered.

They actually had been separated for a year when we started and he was they he's kind of the anxious slash disorganized and was very very burnt. There were two, you know, big betrayals for him and she's the one now that's really trying to re-engage and fight for the relationship and they made it. I mean, you know, they they they got we got them there. So, I know there's hope, right? Um it just again it depends on and he was like he was he was done.

We don't see eye to eye about wanting a family. We don't see eye to eye about how to be in a relationship. You can't possibly know if it's incompatibility without doing the work to get out of negative cycles because the negative cycles are going to cloud it all, right? They're going to make it all convoluted. You won't be able to see clearly what the problem is. And so if you can start talking about, you know, family planning or parenting or how to raise kids or whatever, um, how to deal with in-laws, if you can start talking about that outside of negative cycles with vulnerability and healthy assertion, which is the opposite of negative cycles, then you can start to figure out, all right, we're talking about this in a safe way.

La ansiedad bloquea la empatía en el momento. En general, las personas con apego ansioso sintonizan más con las emociones ajenas porque sintonizan mucho con las propias: reconocen su propio dolor, y eso facilita reconocer el de los demás. Pero cuando se activan y la ansiedad toma el control (modo buscar seguridad, modo proteger), les resulta mucho más difícil quedarse conectadas y empáticas con la pareja en el presente. Cualquiera con apego inseguro, e incluso alguien con apego seguro muy activado y sin manejar bien el disparador, pierde empatía, porque el foco va a aliviar el propio dolor y cubrir la propia necesidad. La empatía suele ser un término relacional (hacia otro), pero también hay partes de uno mismo que necesitan empatía de uno.

Hello everybody. Um, welcome to the book club for Secure Love, my book. I'm so super super excited to be here doing this. It's something I've really wanted to do for a long time. Um, and so we're finally here, able to put it together. So, what we're going to do is, um, you know, this is the first time I've done this, so we're all going to be kind of learning as as we go. Um, so what I'm going to do is is do, you know, probably one chapter or or less per week.

Um, all right. So, let's dive in to chapter 1. Um, before though, I do want to just look through the um the comments and see if there is any related to the structure of the program to just clarify. Um um so someone says I'm partially through the book and they want to know if we if I discuss what happens when one partner is moving toward secure self-healing showing up in newer ways but the other partner doesn't want to work on themselves. Um, I do address that in the book at the end.

And that job of that caregiving role is to lean into the other's pain, really hear them, really validate them, be able to hold your own stuff until later when then we can now work on your stuff. it it never need, you know, one-sided relationships don't work where only one person is ever getting their validation and their needs met. Um, but we can't do it all at the same time. When couples try to do it all at the same time and they're both their needs are both crying at the same time, which is what happens in negative cycles, then they just bounce back and forth and nothing really gets fully addressed or healed.

Um, okay, we're going to go do the second um slide. Okay, I think if most of you are familiar with the book material, you'll this won't be new information to you, but I'm going to go ahead and show it anyway. Um, so you know, this is the the negative cycle. You know what couples are seeing on the surface here is they're seeing one partner is being kind of blaming and critical and protesty and you know really kind of framing their concerns in a way that is not likely to help their partner be open to them.

Um that doesn't mean it doesn't exist. And um the second part of that is um sometimes the incompatibility is how much do we actually want to work on this relationship to get out of these negative cycles. And if one person isn't really willing to do that work over the course of time and they're not showing a lot of hope they're ever going to be, that is also an incompatibility um because that person isn't willing to help with the negative cycles. And then another incompatibility is we've put all this work in and we can't get out of negative cycles.

EFT significa terapia focalizada en las emociones para parejas. Trabaja con las necesidades de apego no cubiertas y con los sentimientos dolorosos no resueltos que cada miembro trae a la relación, o que la propia relación ha creado, cuando no se manejan de forma sana. Si ese dolor no se atiende bien, la pareja entra en ciclos de comunicación negativos que erosionan la seguridad del apego, crean más desconexión, enfado y malos sentimientos, y se retroalimentan. La EFT va por debajo de lo que se ve en la superficie.

Um so I do like having you know the opportunity to answer kind of specifically because usually every couple's dealing with the same kind of themes or patterns. So it's really helpful for everyone. Um sometimes there's questions I just can't answer. they're too specific and I would need to really know a lot more information about that couple to really be able to give a a solid answer. And so if that happens, I'm just going to say, "Hey, listen. Listen, this is not, you know, a question I can really comfortably answer because I just don't have enough information in this environment.

No, growing up, neither of them grew up in an environment where they really had the opportunity to learn more about what their real feelings are and to communicate those feelings in a healthy way and to manage their own triggers in a healthy way and to reach for each other for help in a healthy way. And so what that means is that each of them self-abandon their own emotions and by going into these negative cycles and each of them are abandoning each other's emotions.

Um so excuse me. Yes. When you say abandoning do you mean like not recognizing? I mean not Yes. not recognizing is one um way to abandon, right? And you're not none of abandonment isn't deliberate, right? It it happens very subconsciously. One is not recognizing. Two is not responding to and helping. Instead, it's going into protecting from having to go there as opposed to diving in recognizing, oh, this is one of those moments where I'm starting to feel kind of alone and, you know, that's a bad place for me, and then communicating about that in instead of just staying up in the anger and the protest or the frustration and shutdown.

If when I was a child and I was sitting in my room feeling this feeling, what did I need from my parents to help me with this? and how can I give that to myself? Now, there's so many different ways to help a painful emotion, you know, you can you can validate it, you can sit with it, you can cry it out, you can journal about it, you can go exercise, you can communicate it, you can seek help for it. I mean, there's so many different ways painful emotions need different things.

A child gets ill or aging parents have to move in or and and they get blindsided and they don't know how to cope. And we can expect that that's going to take a toll on the relationship and then we have to kind of learn how to navigate that. But because we've already gotten these skills of navigating it, it just becomes easier and easier. And then we also, you know, I should add this to the end of this answer. When we learn to do these repairs very well, we're actually creating positive cycles.

And then that contributed to fewer negative cycles to begin with. Thank you so much, Julie, for that explanation. You're welcome. You're very welcome. Um, okay, it looks like I have something from Katrina here. Um, is it possible that we have more negative cycles when we start the work? Yes, anything's possible. Absolutely. And sometimes just the fact that we're recognizing there are negative cycles and communicating in a new way and more and not really yet having the skills to do that in a healing way can absolutely and in that case, you know, I recognize that with any couple that I see experiencing that as actual growth because for some couples just starting to talk about things is their movement toward health.

So, we need to take a break here. We need to take a break. Our nervous systems are in a place where we're just not able to be open to each other. And we need to go kind of settle ourselves and get ourselves in a place, do a little selfwork that we can get to a more open place so we can be more open with each other and take turns. You know, a huge and sounds so simple, but a huge part of this work is just being able to take turns with each other. Right now, one partner is in the attachment need role and the other partner is in the caregiving role.

So, um, that break needs to happen to get ourselves back into a place where we can kind of take turns with each other and give each other the time and space that everybody's needing. Um, when you are disregulated, how do you know what you really need? Well, that is a tough can be a tough question to to answer um if you haven't had a lot of help, you know, getting those figuring out what you need and it's just a process of learning. You know, you have to start with the disregulated feeling.

when you get triggered by traffic, when you get triggered by your mother or something that doesn't have as much emotional power over you, our triggers tend to be the most powerful where the emotional stakes are the highest and that's going to be in our romantic partnerships and also in our um parent child relationships. The stakes are usually going to be pretty high. But for most adults, it's most powerful in their romantic relationships. And so if you're having a really hard time there, um that's like trying, you know, can be for some people like trying to um you know, do calculus before they've learned to do algebra or basic arithmetic.

Um I hope that analogy kind of helps. Um, another way to know, am I doing all the work is are you putting your needs to the side? Are you showing up for their needs and just disavowing your own? Thinking, well, if I can just get them happy with their, you know, keep them happy, then they will show up with to me in a way that I don't have to hurt, right? Then you're not really showing up and advocating for your own needs in the relationship. That would be a sign that it's out of balance.

El título del capítulo 1 es "el problema bajo el problema". Sí, se habla de finanzas, y hay mucho en juego con el dinero: todos necesitamos sentirnos seguros económicamente. Pero no es un problema de relación todavía, hasta que la pareja intenta resolver sus diferencias y entra en un ciclo negativo. Si entráis en ciclo negativo al hablar del estrés económico, pasan dos cosas: (1) probablemente no llegáis a una solución y el tema vuelve una y otra vez hasta resolverse, y (2) dañáis el vínculo emocional y la seguridad de la relación, e incluso la imagen que cada uno tiene de sí mismo, creando más vergüenza. En EFT se atiende lo de debajo para poner en marcha el apego seguro, la seguridad y la cercanía; desde ahí, los síntomas de superficie (las peleas por el dinero) empiezan a resolverse solos.

Parecen pelear por dónde deja él las llaves. Jen mantiene un hogar ordenado como forma de cuidarse, y le ha pedido muchas veces que guarde las llaves; él entra y las tira en la encimera. Si fuera solo por las llaves, Jen las guardaría ella. No es por las llaves: es que se lo ha pedido una y otra vez, y se siente no escuchada, no vista, no atendida, no importante, porque las llaves representan para ella seguridad emocional en torno a su necesidad de orden. En su mente, él no atiende su necesidad ni su emoción.

Él también tiene un buen motivo para activarse: siente que se desvive por ayudarla y de pronto queda definido por este momento en que no es visto, así que entra en su movimiento del ciclo negativo: defenderse. Resultado: ambos discuten necesidades de apego, parece que discuten por las llaves. Algunas de esas necesidades vienen de lo que pasa entre ellos y otras de lo que cada uno trajo de su pasado. Hay que sacarlos de los ciclos negativos, porque ahí no llegan a ningún sitio, y porque no saben hablar de lo profundo: nadie se lo enseñó.

Una parte enorme del trabajo, aunque suene simple, es poder tomar turnos. En un momento, un miembro está en el rol de necesidad de apego y el otro en el rol de cuidador. El trabajo del cuidador es inclinarse hacia el dolor del otro, escucharlo de verdad, validarlo y contener lo suyo para luego, cuando se pueda atender. Las relaciones unilaterales no funcionan, donde solo uno recibe siempre validación, pero no se puede hacer todo a la vez. Cuando ambos intentan hacerlo a la vez y sus dos necesidades lloran al mismo tiempo -lo que pasa en los ciclos negativos- rebotan y nada se atiende ni se repara del todo. Por eso a veces hay que parar para volver a un estado en que se pueda tomar turnos y darse tiempo.

Metáfora del clima y el tiempo: una relación con apego seguro tiene un clima general de cercanía y seguridad, con periodos de mal tiempo que la sacuden pero de los que se vuelve al buen clima. Con apego inseguro, predomina el mal tiempo, que ahoga al bueno. La ruptura ocurrirá igual: lo que cambia es que aprendes a reparar de verdad en vez de barrerla bajo la alfombra para que reaparezca.

Um and so that's really what the trigger is about. And so then he goes into, you know, um he's got a good reason to to be triggered also. And his reason is is he's over here scrambling around trying to help her get her needs met, but then bam, you know, he gets defined by this moment where it's not being met and where he's not being seen. And so then he goes into his move in the negative cycle, which is to defend himself. And so what happens is is they're both arguing about attachment needs.

And when you see her talking to this little girl, the s the metaphor is the little girl is her. She's talking to her own little girl. Um, okay. So, let's see if I can pull this up relatively quickly. Okay. So, I watched that about a thousand times and just cried and cried. So, I hope that that, you know, hits some of you in your heart and and you can see where this can go. This is very very possible to stop self-abandoning. And as soon as someone teaches you how and again when both partners stop this self-abandoning uh they stop showing up in negative cycles, they stop staying in these protective places and they stop abandoning each other emotionally, which is what negative cycles do.

We could give specific names to the pain, grief, shame, fear. Um, so really where it always starts is in the body, right? First of all, you got to get a triggering moment. You you have to get your body to have a reaction to to to be able to focus on that reaction. So, whatever it was that you know triggers this feeling, you need to think about it to get there. Or sometimes it just comes up on its own. And you have to be able to say to yourself, "Okay, I'm uncomfortable right now."

Um because these kinds of words are are just going to end up leaving this partner feeling misunderstood and uncared for or maybe like their needs don't matter or whatever it is for them which is going to be probably heavily impacted by their past experiences in relationships that they're sensitive to. Um and then they're not going to know how to talk about that or deal with that or even recognize that or help themselves with that. And so the way that they've learned to try to get this helped and relieved is to just get defensive and, you know, try to tell her, "Well, you're wrong and here's why you're wrong."

And so the first answer I'll say is sometimes people just need extra help. Sometimes people just won't be able to do this work on their own um because whatever reason. So there's always the option of getting professional help and saying to the therapist, "Look, here's what I'm trying to do. I'm trying to slow this down and I need some help learning how. Um, the second thing, the self-help version of the answer is you can practice slowing it down in lower stakes moments in life.

Another sign is if you're just feeling depleted and emotionally exhausted, then that's a good indicator that you're doing too much emotional labor uh to the detriment of yourself and the relationship. Um if you have a sense that you're doing that, there's probably truth in that. If you have a sense, that's probably your body saying, "Hey, maybe that's happening." Um and you need to kind of look at, am I am I getting my needs met here? Am I overwork?

is this person kind of always in a distressed place and I'm always having to be the supportive role and there's no boundaries around that. You know, we're not meant to be emotional vending machines. And if someone is stuck in emotional pain all the time that they're not there something needs to change on their end to help them not have to be hurting all the time. Got you. Yeah. We can't spend our whole day in the kitchen cooking, you know. I I think that's also I think as a woman uh someone that represents as a woman I think also as a young you were taught as a young girl you're always having to take care of something or someone.

I'm not I'm not feeling them ever. I'm not recognizing them. I don't know how. I I don't even know that I have emotions. The first step is sometimes saying, "Wow, I'm really starting to be aware that I have emotions to begin with." Some people are that detached going into it. Um, and then it's a matter of, okay, so if you're not managing your emotions by accessing them, naming them, understanding them, hearing them, feeling them, communicate them.

Uh, so all right. Well, um, so what we'll do is I will kind of go over, you know, the the basics of of each chapter starting with chapter one and um then, you know, give you guys an opportunity to to give feedback or ask questions. Um, and you know, I I do take personal questions. Absolutely. because that a lot of times puts everything into context and sometimes it's easier for me to answer personal questions um because I get again more more context with what's actually happening.

Okay. Um, all right. And then I I also would like um I also would like uh to have, you know, give you guys the opportunity to ask me questions on camera, too. It just I think I personally feel more engaged with the group when that happens. And um so obviously we're we're time limited, but that that is something that I want to make sure that we do, too. Um all right, so we have a good question. Um, is there Okay, so this is a place where I'm going to have to kind of figure out how how I manage the the room and manage the the content because I'm going to get qu we're here to go through the book chapter by chapter, but I'm also going to get questions that aren't about the chapter that are more related specifically to your situations.

Um, and that's part of the work that I do is help people, you know, get out of these negative cycles that are kind of defined by a lack of empathy. um and you know be able to access you know empathy not just for each other but compassion for self or empathy for parts of self. It's you know I I recognize that empathy is usually a relational term meaning it's about someone else but we also have parts of our self that need empathy from us too. So yes the answer is yes.

And yes, that absolutely does happen. You know, there's no way you can make your partner change and want to grow. Um, you can do things on your own to exponentially increase the odds that you can make a safer relationship just by doing your own work. And that safer environment and relationship can certainly inspire your partner's nervous system to settle, which helps us be more open to growth. Um, so yes, there are plenty of things that you can do on your end.

And we can assume from there that the symptoms of the root problem which is the fights over money etc etc will start to resolve themselves. And yes sometimes you know once we get that closeness back on board we do need in the therapy to work on hey let's talk about money right now and let me just kind of sit here and help you through that. Um but usually I don't need to do that. Usually once I'm finished with the couple, they're already doing that on their own.

you're you're going to have a consequ you're going to have there's going to be an impact of that. And so because you never learned to show up for your emotions from another person who was responsible for helping you do that, you have to learn to abandon your own emotions, not show up for them, and then do all of these things in life to protect yourself from going there as opposed to going there and being with it. So think of it like this. We all need to eat to survive, right?

That doesn't mean we're eating all day long. It means that when we get hungry, we know how to say, "Oh, this is my hunger, you know, doesn't have to be obviously like a a conscious conversation, but we recognize the signals. Okay, we're hungry. It's time to go get some food to relieve this hunger. We just don't know how to do that with emotional pain." We don't really sometimes have words for it being there. It's not organized. And then what we do is we do all these things to try to relieve it that don't work ultimately don't work.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch2 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 13.434. Texto curado integrado aqui: 6.173 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activacion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

Now does that mean that adults don't have insecure attachment? Absolutely they do. And there are situations where an adult can come out of childhood with a very secure attachment and then get into a relationship where they develop an insecure attachment. It does happen. What I see in my practice over and over again is that those people that end up in insecurely attached adult relationships got some had some of that going into the relationship. They had some difficulty being with their own emotions and regulating their own emotions and comforting and supporting and processing their own emotions to begin with.

Okay? Because these feelings are kind of like normal to all humans in some situations. Like everybody feels rejected sometimes. You don't have to have an insecure attachment to feel rejected or feel like you're failing, right? But it doesn't end there with people who have a hard time with their own emotions there. It goes from that to shame and fear that it won't ever end, that you can't ever get yourself out of it. And so that's where that that extra layer of fear can really come in and create a lot of problems.

Um, the people that I work with that have avoidant attachment over and over again, um, what I hear is messages that it's not okay to feel, it's not okay to show emotions, it's not okay to express emotions, it's just not something we do, right? Um, and so they kind of take that on as a way of dealing with their own emotions. uh disorganized attachment. You know, sometimes it's going to be as simple as someone who just kind of does a mix of all of it. Um I think everybody, whether they're anxious or avoidant, sometimes avoids and sometimes handles their emotions anxiously.

Got it. Thank you. You're welcome. Um and Julie, there's a couple questions that I've sent you, too. Okay. Do you find that women with anxious attachment tend to mother their partners? Any tips for comforting your partner without stepping in and helping problem solving? You know what I find is that yes, anxious attachment can be mothering, but I also find that avoidant attachment can be fathering. You know, with men. Um, so it's like, you know, with anxious attachment, you know, it's like caretaking.

Um relationships help us safe relationships help us feel safe and secure in the world. And when we don't feel safe and secure and when we feel alone with all this pain and when we don't know how to manage it, our body is stressed and that starts showing up a and ways we behave which are in line a lot of times with some personality disorders. Um personality disorders are behaviors that are ways of regulating painful emotions that are typically relationship rooted um early relationship rooted. Um and then we also can create so much stress in our bodies with all this unprocessed emotion that it can then do more kind of stuff in our brain that leads to you know depression or anxiety and all these things.

Um that's one thing that I I really, you know, want to help um people with is is even knowing what appropriate expectations are from a partner. Um and you know, some people develop secure attachment in childhood. That's just how they were raised. And some people get it in as as an adult, which is probably what a lot of you are doing now in your life is you're trying to get to a better place of security within and with in with your partner. Um and that's called an earned secure attachment. And you know there's no expiration date on developing a secure attachment.

Um, and so attachment theory, we use four broad categories to explain how people react to their attachment distress and the emotional pain that comes from that. Um, and we what we have found is that most people will fall into one of these four broad categories. Um, that are that is anxious, avoidant, disorganized, and secure. And there are many people that have come along and have brought um you know more nuance to those to those categories and I'm totally supportive of that. You know I um definitely get much more nuance in my work but I do think that there's truth to the fact that these broad categories are um have a lot of um usefulness when until they don't.

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It's just that for avoidance, the strategy is going to weigh heavily toward avoiding. And with the anxious, it's going to weigh heavily toward acting out. Um, and then with disorganized, you're just going to see more of all of it. And then you usually have some trauma layers on top of that where it's not just being anxious or avoidant. It's actually, you know, getting really big, really overwhelmed, big, bigger periods of dysregulation, bigger behaviors, sometimes dissociation. Um and then you're definitely going to get with disorganized attachment just higher levels of mistrust just difficult time trusting that people actually you know really can be there for you.

Everybody's looked through the lens of how are they abandoning me and this is happens even without evidence to support the mistrust and that is because in their experience growing up they really did get damaged by other people. Um and then with secure attachment, you know, someone with a secure attachment, they certainly have painful things happen in life. They don't like feeling pain. It's uncomfortable and sometimes it's extremely painful. Um but they have this trust within I can I can manage it.

It truly hurts. It's not in your mind. It's not you taking things too personally. You know, there might be some truth to that because of your own issues, but at the end of the day, the hurt is very real when we don't feel accepted by others, especially our partner. And you know, it's it's more than just sadness. It's it's a feeling of defeat for some people or a feeling of loneliness or rejection or failure. And then on top of that, now we have this insecure really, you know, people who have this insecure attachment with self.

And so, is some of this coming from my block or is this, you know, kind of their block? And it sounds like maybe it is. And in that case, it might not be a good idea if that person isn't willing to work on it with you. Now, with that said, um there just a lot of insecurely attached people out there. So, the fact that you're finding them necessarily mean you're going toward them. It just means that there there are just many people and mean anxious too. You know, it's really there's just a lot of people out there.

Right. Um and so this is not part of this. Okay. So anxious attachment is um you know someone with an anxious attachment their way of regulating their pain that they're not really able to fully access and sit with because they don't know how. So their way of regulating is well I got to control everything outside of me. That's how I'm going to stay emotionally safe. Um, that could be on a personal level being an over cleaner or you know having some OCD or or being perfectionistic about the way they look or being super successful or being a people pleaser, right?

And the kind of you know core message that those with anxious attachment got growing up in a variety of ways not spoken maybe spoken is your emotional self is too much. You're too much. You're asking for too much. Your emotions are too big for me to be able to deal with and this part of you is either broken or bad or not deserving of care. Um, and then we have avoidant attachment and that's when we're going to um, you know, someone with avoidant attachment, they have the same bad feelings stuck in there somewhere.

It can create a lot of arguments that are dysregulated and negative cycles because we're not just dealing with the issue at hand. Now we're dealing with the pain that we're talking about and now we're dealing with the fear around the pain and that blocks everybody from being able to hear and understand each other. Um those with anxious attachment, you know what they're going to do with their pain. again, move toward their partner. That's not a bad thing, right? It's a good thing. We need people to move toward their partner.

Um we might not some people sadly don't know how to verbalize that before they go into the relationship because they might not even know they need emotional support or what that even means or they're not able to give it to themselves. Um, but you know, if you're, in my opinion, if you are dedicating your life to someone, you're going to live with them day in and day out, you're going to give them all of you, then absolutely you have a healthy right to expect emotional support. Um, and if that person isn't able to provide you with emotional support or you're not able to, you know, fun have an emotionally supportive relationship on both sides, um, then I do believe there's some responsibility and and try um expectation of responsibility to try to figure out how to do that.

You have to actually learn how. I mean, nobody isn't emotionally supportive typically willfully. Usually, it's because they just don't know how to do it. And sometimes what looks like stubbornness and is stubbornness is actually stemming from the fact that they just don't know how to do it differently. Um, now you you ex you know, we deserve when I say emotional support, we deserve being seen and validated and held in our painful emotions. you know, being comforted, you know, being able to say, "Hey, I get really anxious about this."

But he does. Otherwise, he wouldn't protest to you. So, or question it. So, we need to say to him like, "Hey, I want to meet your needs, too. I love this part about you. It's so great that you can help me with life, but I'm also needing this, you know, kind of emotional support so I can let that in. I want to be able to let you in because doesn't it feel good for you when I say, "Wow, thank you for that." I think that's the part I was missing. Just it will help me let your advice in. Yes, absolutely.

And is there I don't know if there is an answer to this question. Is there a way to when if you're an anxious attachment to to not keep attracting avoidance who aren't there? Start showing up for your own emotions. Start learning how to show up for yourself and how to comfort yourself. So you know what you need from others. Once you know what you need from others, it's easy because you know if you're

getting it or not. If you know I am there. Um, I seem to get the same and I was so proud of how I was holding it and dealing with it and then had the same exper that and it triggers, you know, so much in in me.

it it's hard for them to step back and go, okay, I'm I know this is uncomfortable for me, but like how can I try to manage, you know, my own pain and the situation that's kind of triggering this pain with health and they don't do that. Instead, they get panicky and they go back to this is never going to end because in their experience, you know, bad things didn't end or good things were followed by bad things. Um you know how how this where this stems from with anxious attachment is going to be chronic emotional abandonment from childhood and then later reinforced in these adult relationships.

And so really what I'm doing with the couples I work with is I'm helping them maximize this in their conversations, in their interactions with each other, even physical interactions. It doesn't just have to be words. Um, so when I maximize this, we're building up positive emotions, which is then building up secure attachment in the broader sense of the relationship. Um, and then when these attachment needs are unmet, right, when we're not feeling these things, again, we're we're going to hurt. It hurts.

Not your individual attachment needs with self, but your relationship attachment needs to feel safe like we can talk about things and I'm not going to feel shamed and you know put down or I'm going to feel like you can hear me and respect me and see me and appreciate me and understand me. Um, and emotionally close which is what the happens when we feel seen and understood. You know, one is that the negative creates the emotional unsafety and the positive creates the emotional connection. And so, you know, both partners take responsibility for their own role in creating unsafety in the relationship or getting the way in the way of closeness.

You know, it's it's healthy to support your partner and cook for them and do these things for them that, you know, we we all feel good doing for our partners, especially when that's being reciprocated and, you know, equally in whatever way that looks for a couple. Um, but you know, it crosses a line when it's I'm afraid. I'm acting out of fear. I'm I'm doing all this stuff not just because it I like it and it fills me up, but it crosses this line where I'm doing it because I'm kind of anxiously trying to keep you okay so you don't fall apart and that will then affect us and and have a bad impact on me or I'll have to see you in pain and that will hurt me to see you in pain or if I don't take good care of you, you're going to distance from me.

That one I'm still trying to work on. The one I have I have two online right now. One is the kind of overview of attachment theory and then the next one is shame. And that's I think that's really super super helpful that shame one. So but I'm still working on that anxious one. Will you do a class on shame kind of like this? Have you thought about that? I did. I did a whole um Yes, I did one um a two-hour one and actually that that is the course the courseing of that class. Yeah. Okay. Okay, perfect.

All right. So then we move into attachment needs. Okay. So these are what needs to happen between partners for them to feel emotionally safe and close to each other. These attachment needs need to be met. They're pretty much universal. Different cultures have different ways of meeting the needs. They have different meanings around the way they live and operate life. But if you, you know, you dig through all of that, it's the same basic attachment needs to feel seen, to be feel heard, to feel validated and appreciated and understood and shown up for and comforted and helped and trusted and trusting.

[Music] Um, all right. Well, welcome back to the book club. We're we're working through um Secure Love by me, Julie Manado. This is my um book that kind of walks couples through the process that I use in my private practice, which is emotionally focused therapy for couples, which uses um attachment theory as the framework to help couples heal. And you probably already know that if you're here. So, last week we started with chapter 1 and it was pretty chaotic. Katrina and I did some problem solving with that, you know.

So again, there's that outer control, but it's got more of an inner control flavor to it because it's there's a lot of like I'm just going to put my feelings away. I'm going to make sure that I don't go there so I don't have to behave badly and be seen as failing. Um, and then again, it's still emotional self-abandonment. It's all emotional self-abandonment. not knowing how to be there with your own emotions in a way that not only helps you regulate, but helps you know what you're needing from others to help you with these painful emotions.

It's just sometimes in some situations, they're not moving toward their partner in a way that works. Um, and they're coming at it with high pressure, right? The high pressure. I've got to do this in a way so I don't have to feel rejected and abandoned. Um, and then those with avoidant attachment, they're kind of doing the opposite. They're reacting to their pain with more distance and more deflection. And sometimes there's value in that. Sometimes we need distance, right? It's not distance isn't bad in and of itself.

It's bad when it is going too far, when it's creating actual disconnection. It's not meant as a way to keep the relationship safe and protect the relationship from this dysregulated state we're both in right now that isn't going to go anywhere. And it's really set up to avoid painful feelings. And with avoidant, it's going to typically be somewhere something around failure and shame. Um, at the end of the day, then shame too with, you know, it's tricky because at the end of the day, they both don't want to be abandoned.

They both don't want to face failure and they both don't want to face shame. It's just it shows up with these different flavors. Um, and then with disorganized attachment, you're just not going to see consistent reactions. it's just going to be kind of all over the place and a lot of times bigger and batter. Um, and when I say batter, I mean more destructive. Let's let's say that, not batter. Um, and then those with secure attachment, the way they go about managing their emotional pain is with for one, they're able to be with themselves and kind of figure out what am I needing in this place?

It might not. I don't know. Something about that might kind of be too preachy. I don't know. Maybe. Yeah. You know, I know that's nuanced. I hate I hate that because I'm kind of I hate to give people mixed messages, but in this situation, I would lead with trying to meet some of his needs before because he's got a block, right? And is that ideal that you have to meet his needs when you have needs of your own? Maybe not. Maybe it's not fair. But the goal is is to get your needs met, right? And so we're gonna kind of He doesn't know that he has this emotional need to feel seen for his his way of doing it, right?

So, I'm kind of going, okay, if it's triggering you, that means that you're not getting the need met. Oh, totally. Probably it could be some selfwork, too. If you're not getting the need met, that's a really good sign that the person doesn't know how to help you. So, one option is they are willing to learn how for you guys to have a healthy relationship. That's okay. Hey, I get it. There's some blocks here. Let's learn how to do this better for each other. And then the other option is, well, this isn't going to work for me because I do have a reasonable expectation of emotional support and I'm already not feeling it.

Um and that doesn't mean that their the relationship doesn't can create further damage or even create the damage to begin with. Um but what happens is is you know it's it's really a a basic concept that if you don't grow up in a home that is emotionally supportive enough. It doesn't mean perfect. It just means enough emotional support that you learn how to kind of do your own emotions in a way that's healthy instead of unhealthy. Um, if you didn't get that growing up, it's hard to know how to do it as an adult.

If you didn't get the practice, if you didn't at least have someone there acknowledging and comforting your emotions, and if you didn't at least have people modeling how to do their own emotions with health, um, it's hard to just have, you know, come out of that knowing what to do. And so, when people don't have healthy strategies, what do they do? They try to get their emotional needs met through any way they

can. And a lot of times those end up being in ways that aren't so healthy for them or their relationship or their partner.

I'll get by. It's not going to, you know, kill me and there's I can reach for support. I can somehow manage this in healthy ways. Um there's not that layer of panic over the on top of the pain. Um, and when you have that ability to be there for your own emotions with regulation, you are going to be more capable of not only emotionally supporting or getting emotional support from, I'm sorry, emotionally supporting your partner, but knowing what you need from them, knowing what are appropriate expectations.

Um, and so, um, when these needs are met, even just in a moment, okay, you're in this conversation with your partner and you're not feeling seen, you're not feeling heard, you're not feeling like they're going to help you with what you're struggling with, you are going to experience emotional pain. The emotional pain will stem from the unmet need. And then in other moments when you're talking with your partner about something and for whatever reason they're they're more regulated and open to you and you're feeling appreciated and understood, you're going to get a positive emotional experience.

It's not just all me. I'm willing to take responsibility for my role now too. Um, and yeah, so I hope that helps answer the question. Um, you know, it's going to be more helpful for me to write that out really more explicitly. And in fact, I have in this course I'm doing for anxious attachment selfwork. So, um, there's probably some pieces I'm missing to that, but I am getting more clear in my own mind about how to express that. Um, all right. Any Katrina? Yes, Zanna. Hi, Zanna. Just to double check, we're talking about chapter 2.

Yes, because you know absolutely because some of this stuff is, you know, biologically rooted there. It's brain issues. I mean, we live in a world that, you know, there's a lot of stuff that can go on that can affect the structure of our brain that can make it more likely that we're going to struggle with things. Um but I do believe that most of these issues you know addictions, OCD, personality disorders, anxiety disorders are absolutely relationship rooted. You know we learn to manage emotions via relationships.

It um safe relationships help people not have to act out in all these ways to that they're crying to get their emotional needs met. When you're getting your emotional needs met, you're no longer having to cry to get them met. Um or you're no longer having to stuff them so far out of awareness that you're not even, you know, you're just a shell of a human. Um, okay. Let's go to to Sah. Sahira. I hope I'm saying that right. Hi. Yeah, it's Sahira. Hi. I like you have such a beautiful smile. Thanks for bringing that to the group.

And I would never want someone to indefinitely stay in something toxic where they're not getting their needs met. And by stay that means stay physically or even stay emotionally. Some people need to stay physically, but they have to, you know, detach emotionally for whatever good reasons they have. They don't want to split the kids up or whatever. It's not that bad that, you know, so it's kind of like that balancing act where you got to give it space, but you also got to recognize your own limitations.

Thanks for being here. Um, all right. So, um, I'll go ahead and and hop off right now, but thank you guys for coming. Um, felt a little calmer to me today. That's good. I hope you guys picked that up. And so, tomorrow I'll just do I mean, next week I'll just do kind of the same structure. And we didn't get to the feedback, but next time I'll have more time and we'll do that then. So, thank you everybody for coming. And um again that course you mentioned the course. The course I have online right now isn't the anxious self-help one.

En algunos casos, y paradójicamente, la forma de satisfacer la necesidad de seguridad de apego es dejar la relación. Si el cuerpo dice que esta relación no se siente segura y no hay esperanza real de que cambie, la respuesta del sistema puede ser iniciar el duelo por esa relación. Cuando las personas se desvinculan de una relación, atraviesan un periodo doloroso porque el apego es físico: el cuerpo tiene que ir desprendiéndose de la vinculación hasta que el impulso de buscar cercanía con esa persona desaparece.

Oh, thank you. You're welcome. My question is um on the on the on reasonable expectations. Is it a reasonable expectation that an avoidant partner um has a responsibility for raising their unmet needs, their issues, their challenges, you know, um without, you know, it being all on the uh other partner to to ask, you know, or not actually be told. Um and yeah and and so is it something different when an avoidant partner doesn't say anything and abruptly leaves and discards an established relationship with no explanation, nothing.

Don't not recognizing there's any issue. Two is starting to kind of be like, yeah, maybe there is something here. Maybe I have kind of been stuffing my emotions. maybe some of these ways that I'm behaving or some of the problems in our relationship might kind of be rooted in me not having a lot of emotional health. And then the third is like, okay, I recognize this is a problem and I want to do something about it, but that wanting to do something about it kind of waivers and I'm not really sure what to do and you know, I want to do it because it's the right thing, but I don't necessarily want to do it.

Um, it's our body's way of saying you need to reestablish safety. Now, from there, it becomes a question of what's what are we needing to do to get to the safety. The answer to that question is really going to be based on what's the pain you're dealing with. Are you feeling is it a rejection? Is it a fear that I can't trust you to stay close to me? Is it a fear that you're cheating on me and I'm being abandoned? you know, your body is saying something and then that's the self-work is diving in and trying to figure out what the the pain is trying to communicate to you.

You know, when your body is hungry, your body might be communicating, I need protein or I need carbs, right? And so it we just kind of intuitively know what to go for based on what we're craving, but we've lost that connection to our own emotions. So, we know the pain is there, but we just go to the convenience store and, you know, start look like taking everything off the shelf. we can that might not really be what we need or good for us. And so with the emotional work, it's a matter of diving in and starting to really learn about what is my unmet need here?

What is the pain around that unmet need? You know, sometimes the answer in getting attachment safety met very paradoxically is to leave the relationship. That sounds so counterintuitive, but your body is saying this doesn't feel safe and it doesn't have a lot of hope that that's ever going to change. Now I need to go through the grieving process. You know, of course, my work is to avoid that and to help people get healthy with each other. But just to kind of let you know where it goes if that need is it's not possible to get that pain feel filled.

Ambas personas de la pareja son responsables de su propio papel en crear inseguridad o en obstaculizar la cercanía. También son responsables de su propio papel en satisfacer las necesidades de apego del otro.

Mejorar las relaciones no cura necesariamente todos esos trastornos, pero puede contribuir de forma significativa. Las relaciones seguras reducen el estrés del sistema nervioso y hacen que la persona no tenga que actuar de formas poco saludables para intentar cubrir sus necesidades emocionales. Cuando las necesidades emocionales se cubren, desaparece la necesidad de buscarlas de formas destructivas o de suprimirlas tan profundamente que la persona se desconecta de sí misma.

But some days I will have free space after the club so I can hang around a little bit more. Um, if I get a question and I feel like we're kind of going off track, I'm just going to bookmark you and try to pull you back in on track just because the whole, you know, the whole group is here to really talk about chapter 2. So, we need to stick with that. Um, and then I'd like to get, you know, just um, a couple people and maybe just, you know, not too elaborate, but kind of like, hey, this is how I've been using this information in my own relationship, and here's how this has really helped me.

And the way that I have found the most useful way, and that doesn't mean it's the only useful way. I bring in lots of different ways of looking at relationships and attachment theory. Um, but I use predominantly attachment theory because for me, it's the most clear and understandable way to make sense of relationships and has the most truth to it. Um, it's not a perfect theory. Um, not everybody is going to relate to all of the, you know, theories of it and and categorizations, but I think it's a very much a good enough theory and it really helps me help people.

Um, and what I really like is the better you can explain and the more clear you can explain how relationships work, the better the road map is to healing. So, um, all right. So, basically, one sec. I want to pull up my little narrative here. Um, I'm gonna kind of read my notes here as we go. Um, so shoot. Where did the Hold on. Sorry everybody. I'm going to get better at this. I promise. Um, okay. Forget that. Okay. So basically the the broad overview of attachment theory is that children who aren't adequately emotionally supported are going to struggle supporting their own emotions.

It's all about kind of controlling the external to feel okay inside. And in relationships, that's going to turn into an overfocus on the partner's state. If only if my partner's okay and they're okay with me and everything's okay and I feel safe, can I really feel okay inside? Now, it's tricky because we all need for our we all want our partner to be okay and be in a good place with us, but it crosses this line where it's like the end of the world if you know that what's outside of them isn't going well.

That's not a good ex expectation. That's not a healthy expectation. It is healthy to expect a healthy division of labor and reasonable expectations of you know how we keep our home. But when it crosses the line into this like this is how I'm regulating, some people think, well, my partner really needs to agree with me on how to live life um in every way. That's not a reasonable expectation. Um you know, it's it's reasonable to expect that your partner is able to um do their part in the relationship to help your attachment needs be met.

That's how he does it. It's like figure out what to do differently. Problem solve, fix it. That's probably worked very well for him in many parts of life. And it's probably one of the things you love about him is there's something safe about his ability to kind of regulate his feelings and go into let's just kind of take charge here. Um and so but that has had to come at the expense of the other piece which is really being able to access and feel his emotions for instance the fear around not being able to fix the situation or the pain that is leading him to need to fix the situation to begin with.

Um, you know, but yes, if someone's not willing to do the work or talk or tell you. Yeah. And Yeah. And I mean, I hate to say this because nobody wants to hear this, but it does sometimes take time and sometimes it's a twostep or two step back. like they kind of get open to the idea that there's something going on, but then they go back and close down, you know, because that's their safe place. People don't leave their safe place very easily. And so sometimes it just it does the change process really needs to, you know, give be given some space and time.

Aunque la teoría se desarrolló inicialmente en el contexto infancia-cuidador, en adultos el marco se aplica principalmente a las relaciones de pareja romántica. En civilización occidental, la pareja romántica y la relación padre-hijo son los contextos donde se espera que se cubran la mayor parte de las necesidades de apego.

La persona con apego ansioso no puede acceder plenamente a su malestar interior ni permanecer con él. Su estrategia para regularse es controlar todo lo que está fuera de ella. A nivel personal, esto puede manifestarse como perfeccionismo, limpieza excesiva, tendencia a complacer a los demás o búsqueda de éxito. En la relación, se convierte en un foco excesivo en el estado de la pareja: solo cuando la pareja está bien y la relación parece estable, la persona con apego ansioso se siente emocionalmente segura.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch3 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 26.114. Texto curado integrado aqui: 11.856 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activación' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

And then many many people have an earned secure attachment meaning they learn to become more secure within their own body and to help their relationship become secure or find a partner that is already secure. I really I don't love the idea of seeking if you're single seeking out someone with a secure attachment and that's all you'll that's you know the only thing you're looking for because I don't know how realistic that is in today's world and most people aren't super secure just culturally we're not so secure.

And um all right. And so what happens is is in this anxious attachment these patterns of trying to get needs met go on into the adults relationships. And often times those with anxious attachment will find themselves in relationships with those with avoidant attachment. I won't go into why unless you want to ask me that, but that's typically what happens. Most most distressed relationships are anxious avoidant. Um that doesn't mean they're doomed. That's what I do every day, many hours a day, is help these couples heal, help them become secure um out of their anxious avoidant um dynamic.

There's some equal equal weight on both. Um and then you know look in these anxious avoidant dynamics with the partnership that the partner is almost always s somehow a significant contributor to their partner's anxious attachment right. Um actually I'm sorry that's meant to say anxious right there. um sorry about that but yes their partner is all almost always contributing and reinforcing that to one degree or another but almost always they didn't create it right there they have a role in maintaining it but they didn't create it and so there is plenty of selfwork that needs to be done with the anxious partner and there's plenty of relationship work that needs to be done and if there is an avoidant partner there's plenty of selfwork that they need to be going.

Um, and then I have people that 90% of the people I work with do somewhere in there carry shame. Um, okay. So now, oh, secure. Um, all right. So, if you have a secure attachment and you developed it in childhood, that means you grew up in a home that was good enough in its emotional supportiveness. It was good enough to help you feel secure, to help you know about your emotions, to help you know that most of the time you're going to get help with your emotions. Maybe not always. life is or hopefully not always actually because we also as children need to learn to take care of our own emotions at times because we don't always have someone there to help us and so you need to have you know 75% of the time I have someone to go to but 25% of the time I got to learn to regulate myself I got to learn to be there for myself that's that's resilience people who get their needs met every second every moment of the pain every time sometimes they go into the world without a lot of resilience.

And not everybody's going to fit perfectly into one category. And that's okay because if you have an insecure attachment, you just have to know that somehow you're managing your feelings in a way that isn't so healthy. And you need to shift that. And sometimes instead of looking at what category I am, you just need to look at what symptoms do I have of my insecure attachment and what do I need to do to minimize those symptoms and become secure within myself and within my relationship. The goal is always the same, which is that an earned secure attachment with yourself and your own feelings and with your partner.

Um, yes. So, um, I did just say that. I'll go back. So, if you look here, it says some people become insecure in adult relationships. Yes. You know, again, most people who find themselves in insecure relationships probably found themselves there because they have some stuff from childhood that kind of led them to that point, but not always. There are lots of different ways that people can take twists and turns in life. And yes, some people do start off with a relatively secure attachment and they get in a somehow find themselves in a toxic relationship and that makes their relationship with self all wonky and then they become very insecure.

um difference between avoidant and emotionally abusive. Um well, anybody who's emotionally abusive is going to have insecure attachment because that emotional abuse is a symptom of insecure attachment. Nobody ever emotionally abuses that has a secure attachment. It just doesn't happen. They don't need to get their needs met in that way. So, you know, the emotional abuse is the behavior. The avoidant attachment is the way that that that person stuffs their feelings in a way. They're not managing their feelings in a way that they're communicating them with health.

Um h why are anxiously attached and avoidantly attached people attracted to each other? Well, because they balance each other out. You know, too anxious is going to have so much energy that it's not going to be sustainable and one of two things is going to happen. Either one partner is going to start leaning toward avoid toward avoidance and probably the lesser anxious of the two. um or they're going to break up, okay? And they're going to end up in some level of an anxious avoidant relationship.

Um, there are some exceptions to that. Um now there is a very good chance that insecure attachment from childhood can be worsened during adulthood. The patterns are still there but the relationship is toxic to the degree that it just you know exaggerates everything. Um and certainly you know relationships where both partners have an insecure attachment they will reinforce each other's insecure attachment. Um, you know, most people develop these kind of unhealthy ways to cope with their unmet relationship needs and the pain that results from that.

There's good arguments that people will make for using the other term. So, whatever term works for you, but yes, just know that if I say disorganized, it means also um fearful avoidant. Um, okay. So, now we have avoidant um attachment. Hold on one second. I'm going to stay anxious. Okay. So, anxious attachment. Um, all right. So, first of all, in the chapter, you know, we talk about what creates the anxious attachment, the childhood environment. And I'd love some questions about that if you have them.

But there's all kinds of nuances. So different cultures just have different ways of getting into the universal experience of pain. Um all right. So avoidant. Oh, actually here. um you know when you're mu moving from insecure to secure and I don't know if this person means in the relationship but I'll go ahead and answer in the relationship fewer negative cycles increased feelings of closeness um when you do have negative cycles and we'll talk more about those in subsequent chapters and next chapter we're going to dive into what is this negative cycle um and so it's basically conflict for now just know negative cycles are fights or just extreme feelings of disconnection.

Um, sometimes maybe the acting out isn't so extreme but the pain is still high. Um, and you're going to just see a lot of a lot of inner conflict. And then we move into, you know, the anxious spectrum and the avoidant spectrum is down here. And you're just going to see more extreme behaviors. Someone with a high anxious attachment is going to feel anxious more of the time. They're going to act in bigger ways. They're going to have a harder time seeing their own part. Um, someone with a higher avoidant attachment, they're going to be more shut down.

And if it is getting help, they're they're not in enough distress to feel like they have to do all these other things. But, you know, a baby that becomes anxious might and listen, there's a lot of reasons babies cry. Um, so I don't want to say that this is a sign of anxious attachment, but babies can learn early on that if they're not getting their needs met and they have to cry louder and get really really upset to get responsiveness because either, you know, for whatever reason, then that is the early stages of a anxious attachment.

Maybe if you just picked, you know, two random people from the crowd, one person who is avoidant might be more emotionally abusive than this person that we picked out that is anxious. But overall, as a whole, um, all of this attachment, insecurity contributes to some level of emotional quote unquote abuse, which is emotional dysfunction. um how to dis to know the difference between disorganized attachment and being flexible. One is very dysfunctional, one is healthy. Um if you're, you know, able to regulate and have different ways of regulating your body and you can communicate with your partner in a healthy way, um and you're getting results from that and your negative cycles are stabilizing, that means that we're moving towards secure.

So I always feel kind of angsty and bad. And there's just usually or always with anxious attachment, there's a strong flavor of emotional validation. It's less than just ignoring your emotions and more of your emotions are irrational. Your emotions aren't welcome here. Your emotions are bad. Your emotions are selfish. Your emotions threaten me to the degree that I get disregulated as a parent. um your emotions are going to be punished or your emotions are just too much, right? And all of that is emotional abandonment.

And so what you're trying to do is well, let's just make their emotions go away, too. And or ignore them. And obviously that is going to be very triggering to an anxious partner because that's not what they're needing. Okay? And then they get all big and big and loud and protesty or whatever criticizing and then that doesn't feel good for the avoidant partner and then they react in a way that's not so healthy and then on and on the cycle is going. Um there are blaming avoidant partners. I, you know, and it's never black or white.

They talked to them about it. They maybe even if they didn't talk to them about their kids' emotions, they just somehow supported them implicitly. like they just knew I have some emotional support here and from that they learned it's okay to have emotions it's okay to support them and it's okay to ask for help. Um all right so again you know most people are going to develop secure attachment in childhood and end up in those as adults. Um there are exceptions because sometimes people get in relationships that cause them to feel more insecure.

Attachment theory means that we have four categories of one's attachment style meaning how they the nature of the fears they feel in their relationship and how they behave and what they do and how they attempt to regulate their fears in the relationship. So we have secure, anxious, avoidant and disorganized. And this all exists on a spectrum. And you know these labels aren't meant to they're meant to create insight. They're not meant to box anyone in. And when I say insight, I mean as a template to know what to work on, right?

Now, are there exceptions? Absolutely. Some people for whatever reason they find themselves in relationships with other people who are are so toxic that it actually starts impacting their relationship with themself to the degree that they lose the ability to manage their emotions with a health and then they become insecure. Um so that does happen but most of the time that's not what I see. All right. So, we've got anxious attachment. Um, let me Oh, someone says, um, is disorganized attachment the same as fearful avoidant?

And so they they labeled it that anxious or actually they they labeled it anxious, preoccupied, dismissive, avoidant. Then as the field progressed it kind of the attachment research kind of divided and we had the you know the people who were clinicians and kind of following that early researcher line that stuck with the original terms and then we had more people who were like more related to social psychology and educational psychology and they decided to come up with different terms that made more sense to them which was I know fearful avoidant is on.

If it's if that flexibility is not really flexibility but dysregulation and chaos and that that is disorganized attachment. All right. So back to the anxious attachment. Um so those with anxious attachment as children what they learn is to cope with their pain. the pain of emotional abandonment, the pain of, you know, just not having their needs met. They cope with their pain by moving in, getting big, getting externalizing behaviors, right? Emotional acting out, anger, anxiety, anything they can do to be seen and responded to.

In when someone has an avoidant attachment and they're in a relationship, it's almost a guarantee that their partner is also contributing to their avoidant attachment style and reinforcing that. But again, they probably didn't create it. They they have a role, but usually this stuff is present to some degree. Yeah. So, someone says, can you repeat the core fears of each attachment style? Yeah. So, with anxious attachment, the core fear is emotional or physical abandonment. Um, fear of emotional abandonment is enough.

I'm giving her space. I'm not contacting her or whatever. Um, I will say uh on your book, I've read 32 books on this kind of stuff and yours has been the most helpful. Well, good. Thank you. So, thank you. It it really a lot of books, too. Good for you. It just puts it in a perspective. But looking at my own attachment style, I'm an anxious avoidant. I had a childhood with uh uh three sisters, no brothers. I had an emotionally unavailable father. Uh my mother obviously was stretched too thin. So I I I identify with all the characteristics of an anxious avoidant.

Um, yeah, I think in the book where I go through the different emotions that we'll get to in the later chapters definitely talk about why these emotions are good and keep us safe. So, yeah, absolutely. Um, okay. So, let's do Tristan and then we'll try to get to more here. Um, okay, Tristan. And then I think who else? Hi. Hi. Um, my How are you doing? Hi. Good. Um, I just started reading your book. Okay. Um, but I guess my main question is uh trying to figure out for sure which style of insecure attachment I fall into because um I definitely have some symptoms from uh the disorganized attachment on the more anxious side.

Um, their ability to cope and regulate is usually lower. it it always is, I should say, um lower than those who are more in, you know, towards this end of the secure spectrum. You're going to see less predictability. You're going to see more exaggerated behaviors. Um you know, some of some anxious, some avoidant, some dysregulated. You're going to see a lot or a lot of dysregulated and some dissociated is what I meant to say. Um, sometimes people will just be super flat because they one way they deal with their intense feelings is just flat and then other times they're just dealing with their intense feelings by not being able to deal with them and so they just get super dysregulated and act out in really big ways.

And then we go over here to mild where you know it it still shows up but it's not so intense, it's not so damaging. We can come back faster. Sometimes in this place you're going to say bouncing around from anxious to avoidance strategies because we can do both now. Um and then you're going to move into secure where you're just you're in these places very seldomly. You know how to get out. You you generally feel good with your in within your own body and your relationship. You generally feel safe and connected to your partner the vast majority of the time.

Um, I didn't go too deeply into it with this slideshow, but ultimately, we're going to have a child that has unmet emotional needs. Period. They they don't feel heard. They don't feel understood for their emotions. They don't feel validated for their emotions. And what happens is is that creates insecurity. And the insecurity is I don't know if anybody's really going to be here to help me with my emotions or not. And now I feel really insecure. And I haven't learned to help myself with my emotions because nobody else is there modeling it to me or even teaching it to me.

Emotional abandonment means not leaning in and helping someone with their emotions. And when that person is a child, it's really important that most of the time a parent is doing that. And as the child grows, they learn to increase their capacity to do that for themselves. But those with anxious attachment, they don't really get the opportunity to develop the capacity to do it for themselves because nobody has been there helping them do it from early on. Um, all right. Someone says, um, can you develop insecure attachment styles as an adult?

Okay. Uh I've noticed in the later years of my uh 18 years with my husband, I kind of am avoidant now. Okay. And I don't know. I mean, it seems like you kind of need to know what your attachment style is in order to start working on uh repairing it. Let me let me address that. You don't really um what you do need to know is that you have an insecure attachment and what the symptoms are. Really, that's what you need to know. The symptoms can be categorized, but you don't need it can be helpful to know because you can kind of go, all right, I'm going to this hits, this hits, this hits.

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Yes. So, let me explain that. So the very original the first attachment um style research was done in the late 70s early 80s and from that research these researchers named Mary Einworth and Mary Maine and John Bulby contributed heavily to the theory and so they started researching and they developed from attachment theory these four categories. They they observed how these children reacted to a stressful situation with their caregiver. And they found that a portion of the children acted reacted with anxious behaviors, a portion of the children reacted with avoidant behaviors, a portion reacted with secure behaviors, and another portion acted with these disorganized behaviors.

Okay, that's very different from handling depression in a way that is like uh getting defensive. You shouldn't be upset about it. you should be more you should be more tolerant or even shame spiraling. I don't deserve help from you. I'm somehow failing to have this depression. Um I'm or just not communicating at all. Not getting help. That's a way of reacting to the depression in a way that's more indicative of that insecure attachment. Usually there's tons of overlap. you a lot of times, you know, when I see people, they aren't they don't just have this insecure attachment with themselves and with each other.

Instead, they're communicating them with emotional abuse. And so, there could be other factors. Why is this person, you know, choosing to be emotionally abusive with their feelings instead of communicating in the healthy way? what's going on with them as a person and what's going on in a negative cycle that both partners are contributing to that is creating a symptom of emotional abuse. And there's no no um there's no truth to the fact that someone with an avoidant attachment is more emotionally abusive than someone with an anxious attachment.

Um, you know, different there's different nuances of environments that might reward different behaviors. Um, and yeah, so it's just it's just fueled by, you know, you usually can see once you have a trained eye, it's pretty easy to see an anxiously attached kid because they're, you know, the behaviors are real noticeable. Um and you know um the the behaviors as in childhood typically of anxious partners is they're they're making their parents matter. Again, if there's the peoplepleasing, you know, subset of this, then it's probably not making the parents matter.

um a fear of making the parents matter and having to really tow the line to not um and it it tend their behaviors tend to push their parents further away because their parents don't know how to cope with it because of what they've created really. And so what happens is is the further the parents go away or the angrier the parents get the more anxious they get and now they're in a cycle with their parents. Um the difference between a parent child relationship and a romantic partner relationship is the parents are usually they're responsible for better or

worse for behaving in a way that contributed to the development of their child's attachment style and they're also the ones that are responsible for doing something to reverse it.

And if we call environments that create um anxious and avoidant attachment emotionally insensitive, we call disorganized attachment environments emotionally dangerous. Okay, these are more like dangerous environments. Like you're going to really suffer if you rock the boat. You're going to get really big messages coming at you of shame and punishment. You're going to get physically hurt. You might get sexually hurt sadly. Um it's just you're there's just less safety. Okay. And what this does is it creates enormous conflict in a child because here you are you're a child and you're supposed to be able, you know, to rely on your parents for love and support because you can't survive in the world on your own.

And if not, you know, it's going to create just a lot of a lot of emotional dysregulation and overwhelm. Do you have a resource that talks about the function of emotions? Oh, yeah. Do I ever? Um, my shame workshop. Um, the the anxious self-workshop I'm working on is just a deep dive into the function. Every exercise involves honoring the function of the emotion. Um, the podcast does a function of emotion. I mean, I never I never really work without addressing function of emotion. I'm sure it's in the book.

I just need for people to really understand that there's so much value for doing this work on you and learning to deal with your own emotional self in a new way, even when our partner isn't coming along with us. It's like there's an impact of an insecure attachment in all these behaviors on you and there's an impact on the relationship. And sometimes people get stuck with well if it's not going to positively impact the relationship and shift that what's the point and I need to be like no there's an impact on you personally of these behaviors and that really needs to be the driving force behind the change.

I know that it's possible because the vast majority of the couples that I work with get there. Okay, so I know it's possible. Um, and you know what? A lot of times with anxious attachment, there's this emotional void that they never learned to fill with self-work. And so then they put a lot of pressure on the relationship to do all the work, not just be the partner who's emotionally supportive, but also helping them do all the work, do all the emotional work, which some of it is selfwork. Um, and that what that does is they're pulling for too much and often their partner doesn't not know how to give anything at all.

You know, there are plenty of people out there that are in a partnership and they have an anxious attachment and they just know my partner's not going to leave me. They'll never leave me, right? But they are always emotionally abandoning me. They're always leaving me feeling invalidated and unheard and misunderstood and not comforted. And that is very painful. And then there are also those who are anxiously attached that not only are being emotionally abandoned but they also have a threat of physical abandonment or they've been physically abandoned and that's even worse, right?

Okay disorganized attachment is deeply rooted and I can't imagine a situation where it doesn't come from childhood unless there's some kind of major major major event. Um, but with that said, once that person with a disorganized attachment gets in a relationship there, you know, the partner can certainly do things that don't help them grow. Okay. And then we have secure attachment. Let me see if we have any questions. Um, is shame always a part of avoidant attachment? Um, most of the time, yes. Sometimes you can have people who have a more mild avoidant attachment and they will go to I failed and I hate failing and I don't want to go near failure without crossing that line into I failed because I am a failure.

And they need to give you space before they go, "All right, fine. I hear you. But but but but but that but but but doesn't doesn't work in relationships ever. Okay. So you got to lean in. Get give every everybody needs space. Okay. If you can't give that space because you get anxious and your nervous system goes into somehow leaving them, you got to figure out why you're leaving them. Um and put words to that. There's a good reason for it. The reason is is because you don't want to stay feeling unsafe.

I need to help them with their, you know, need to to relax sometimes. Um, another thing that you could be contributing to is, um, are you are you giving a lot of messages that they're not successful and not a lot of messages that they are? Are we are we balancing the good out with the bad? Um, and yeah, those are the two things I can I can think of. or are you delivering your messages as you know demands or protests or criticisms that's going to potentially get in the way and create negative cycles around these conversations and if I had your partner here I would be asking them the same question like you know I want to look at you know maybe what your partner is doing that's contributing to your shame spirals and how can you ask them for help and I also need to know are you contributing to this in any way that you might need to work on.

You you you generally you you do confront yourself and confront some of your behaviors um and you're willing to work on yourself. Absolutely. But you're not like mired in shame. um your failures in life don't turn into I'm a failure or I'm just unlovable because this person can't love me. Um so you generally has have a positive sense of selfworth. Um and then self insecure attachment on the other side of the coin means you have difficulty accessing your deeper emotions. you you tend to get stuck in your pain turns into anger and anxiety and you tend to get stuck in anger, anxiety and either you just have no idea what's underneath that to begin with or you can't regulate it enough.

The the way to deal with your emotions is just shut them off or somehow avoid them. Now, when we get over here, the person's becoming a little more engaged, willing to share more, open up more, better able to access their feelings. Um, up here, sometimes someone with an anxious attachment who was previously here. um they they start to be a little more avoidant sometimes because they have now this other tool to manage their feelings which is sometimes putting them away and sometimes we need to balance that out and find that middle ground.

And the way that we do that is how we're navigating communication, how we're navigating cycles to create positive cycles instead of negative cycles. Um, you know, one of the things is is that people with who have a secure attachment in childhood, they just naturally know to seek that in adulthood. They don't have to really think about it. They just know what the felt sense of security and emotional responsiveness from a partner feels like. And they also know how to be a healthy, supportive partner.

They just get feel desperate. Um, sometimes that's people pleasing, right? Hey, that's an externalizing behavior. Try to try to kind of control others happiness with me so I can feel seen and feel loved and feel valuable. Um even at the ex to to the detriment of my own self-growth. Um um this is can happen on a on a spectrum. Some children are going to do these in a bigger way than others. Um, some people are, some kids who are anxious are going to tend lean more towards people pleasing and some are going to lean more towards demands and protest.

Um so there is such thing as you know needing our children to deal with emotional adversity on their own sometimes. Um uh and yeah so so they just they have an they have the ability to put their emotions to words. They have the ability to comfort their own emotions and they have the ability to reach for help with their emotions. Um, and they got this ability not from thin air, not because they were born with the ability, but because they had caregivers there, wiser, stronger others there in their life that helped them deal with their emotions, helped them learn how they made space for their emotions.

And anybody can get there with with work. All right. So what is the attachment security with self? Okay. So that means your your attachment your relationship to yourself is how you respond to your own self. Can you access your emotions? Can you self support your emotions? Can you self-regulate? Are you in touch with them? And we can't communicate our emotions effectively with others if we don't have access to them or ability to regulate them to begin with. And another, you know, aspect of self-secure attachment is positive self-beliefs and health, right?

um with the understanding that sometimes there are ruptures. You know, most relationships, the vast majority, 99. 9% of relationships will have ruptures from time to time, even if it's a super secure attachment. It's just they can get back to their baseline security faster. Okay, Katrina, any questions for me? Not yet. You can continue on. Okay. Okay. So, attachment styles are almost always rooted in childhood in some way, right? Um, most of the time they don't just appear out of thin air in adulthood or even appear in hard relationships in adulthood.

They have other stuff going on. They have personal issues going on. And those personal issues need to be dealt with and we need to be dealt with how those personal issues are showing up in the relationship. Um so yes, Asperers would be a situation where that person is probably going to have more challenges will will definitely have more challenges um knowing about their emotions, communicating their emotions, and responding to the emotions of others. That doesn't mean they can't do it. It just means they have to get some special help probably to learn how to do that because they have a more of a challenge than someone who is, you know, not neurode divergent.

And it's because they don't know how. They don't they even if they intellectually know how to do it different, they don't know how to help their own body to get to the point that they can actually do it differently. Um, usually those with anxious attachment have high other blame. Um, that doesn't mean that they don't recognize they have a role, but they skew heavily toward my partner really needs the one to be the one to change here. And if they can really just change, then I wouldn't have to get so upset at the expense of maybe I need to figure out how to help myself not get so upset, you know, in addition to wanting them to be better.

Just don't go to sadness. Don't go to frustration or rejection or whatever feeling it is that's not okay in their system or that's not going to be supported in their system. There's no healthy way to cope. So, the only other option is put it over here. Um, it's very subconscious. Nobody chooses to do this. Um, I think some people are are more temperamentally prone to handling their emotions with avoidance and some are more temperamentally prone to handling their painful emotions anxiously. Um, but however you get there, you know, that's what avoidant attachment looks like.

you're you're going to, you know, there's always exceptions to the rule, but very rarely are you going to find someone who has these symptoms in their life of being perfectionistic or whatever else they're acting out on that doesn't have an insecure attachment. It all it goes hand inand because that's how they're trying to regulate their emotions. And we typically reg want our partner to help us regulate our own emotions in the way we do it. So if the way she regulates her anxiety is to be perfectionistic, she's wanting you to help her in the same way.

Um, that's one side of it. And then it really becomes traumatic when there's more like you're getting shamed for your emotions. Um you're getting punished if you show emotions. the the responses are just far more just more damaging than you know we have invalidation over here and you know that that's not invalidation can be very very damaging especially chronically but we have some invalidation over here and that's emotional damage and it's emotionally insensitive but we move into trauma when uh we're put in situations that are extremely emotionally overwhelming that as a child like you just don't know how to deal deal with um sexual abuse, physical abuse, all create emotional trauma, um serious abandonments of by a parent, um even not intentionally and not having the right kind of help with those emotions.

El abuso emocional siempre coexiste con apego inseguro: nadie que tenga apego seguro necesita satisfacer sus necesidades a través del abuso emocional. El abuso es el comportamiento; la inseguridad de apego es el mecanismo subyacente. Tanto el apego ansioso como el evitativo pueden manifestarse en formas de comportamiento que resultan emocionalmente abusivas. No hay evidencia de que el apego evitativo genere más abuso emocional que el ansioso.

So you can have someone with you know some sort like depression for example who they are depressed it's very clear and they aren't able to emotionally engage because they are depressed. However um you can be depressed and communicate about your depression in a way that is indicative indicative of a secure attachment. Right? That's going to sound like this isn't about you. something in my body just feels cut off. It's horrible. I'm in a lot of pain. Um, and I understand that this is very difficult for you and this is, you know, like really hard for both of us.

Um, a lot of times those with avoidant attachment, especially as children, will either find things that are constantly distracting them like video games or toys or whatever, and just kind of keeps them quiet or highly successful um academic, sports, career, hobbies. You're you're usually not going to see someone with avoidant attachment getting in a ton of trouble and drawing a lot of attention to themselves um at least consistently. And the and then these patterns go into adult relationships because if you are used to having to emotionally disengage in order to stay safe um with yourself, then you're going to deal with your partner's emotions in the same way you deal with your own.

And it's going to be really confusing to you why your partner isn't okay with that because you your MO is emotional disconnection. And on top of that, one of the things your partner may have been attracted to about you is your emotional stability. So now you go into the relationship and all of the sudden this, you know, you start disagreeing about things and your partner's upset and you just don't know what to do. Um because you're used to just making their emotions go away. And so you're trying, I mean, your own emotions go away.

Um and so the core fear what they're going to notice more is emotional abandonment. And as they become healthier, they start to get more in touch with other fears, right? But it's more balanced fears instead of all of it just be being around preventing abandonment. Um and then with avoidant attachment, the core fear is of failing and not just a failing. It's of seeing self as a failure or being seen by others as a failure. And that is going to bring up feelings of fear and rejection and all kinds of painful stuff.

They could sometimes just completely numb out and dissociate. Sometimes they get like super dysregulated. um it's just, you know, it there's there's such a variety of ways to react to a disorganized attachment. Whereas with anxious and avoidant, you're just going to see more consistency and more predictability of responsiveness. Um and you know, when someone has a disorganized attachment, their relationships are going to be more impacted by that. You're going to see more higher conflict, more dysregulation, probably more chaotic, probably more unpredictable.

And when I tried to bring up my needs to my dismissive, I'm sorry, my fearful avoidant or disorganized avoidant partner. Um obviously it felt like she was never paying attention to it. But my question specifically is I guess I found two wounds that I had as a child. Not only did I didn't feel like there was a place I could go for emotional support, but I had a father. It's like, you know, it was never good enough kind of thing. And I kind of felt that in this relationship with her because I went above and beyond to do everything I could for her.

And I was wondering, is that related to anxious attachment? Is that a different kind of wound? Is that a different kind of issue? So I guess that's No, absolutely. Because what what's happening with that is you there's a lot of ways to explain it. One way it's coming to mind is that your father is dealing with his own anxiety, right? Something about you being good enough or some level of perfection that he's expecting is more important than the relationship. If he's giving you messages it's not good enough and that's not being balanced out by what you are

getting right.

Um we worked on the assumption for a long time. I mean I'm I'm definitely avoidant and the assumption that my partner was anxious. She definitely has a lot of anxiety and I think just recently realized that actually she is probably more of disorganized had you know had quite a lot of trauma in childhood and growing up and um I guess I think we're really trying to contemplate how we proceed from here obviously the work in your book but I think partly you know we've had lots of ruptures and there's over the course of our relationship and there's a lot of kind built up um I think mistrust from both sides.

And then now, not only are you not getting the help, but now you're having to deal with his shame spiral. And so, what can you do with that? Well, one is you can communicate your needs, feelings, and needs to him, which is in a safe way, right? Which is, hey, we got to talk about this because I want to honor your need for not having to feel like a failure. And I want to know how I can help you better not to feel like a failure, but at the same time, I do need to help, right? and it's really hard on me if I'm not able to reach and ask for help because you know then you go into your stuff then that leaves me feeling alone with it and that doesn't work either.

So yes, it absolutely can happen. But again, I don't see that happen a lot. I see typically people go into relationships with some of this stuff that gets either worsened or just reinforced by other insecure partners. Um, so someone says, "How do you know if a partner is reacting a certain way to their attachment style or a different reason is aspergers or another psychological concern?" Well, you know, it's really attachment is really more about how one is handling their own emotions and how one is communicating their emotions, right?

That doesn't mean people parents are bad who have a child with an insecure attachment. It just means they they probably have one themselves and they just haven't had the tools to not do that. And you know, my belief is that most parents tend to do the best they can with what they have. I mean, there's some parents out there that have done some really, really, really awful things, and I don't want to get them off the hook, but most of the time, most parents do the best they can with what they have.

So, they're they're afraid of their own body and they're afraid of other people and they're afraid that everybody out there in some way or another has the capacity to really quickly trigger what's going to come up in my own body. Everybody out there has the capacity to hate me and reject me and abandon me. and because that has been my experience over and over again in life and especially growing up. Um, how can parents help their children avoid or reverse insecure attachment? Well, it's pretty simple and it's pretty possible.

And if they're both avoidant um probably it's just not enough trying to fill the void by either partner. So, typically what's going to happen is they're just going to drift apart and end up just kind of being roommates or they're going to split up and find someone who helps them feel alive or one partner is going to take on more of the anxious role as a way of trying to balance out the system. Okay. So disorganized attachment. Um you know the the probably the most common factor of a disorganized attachment is the source of love is the source of danger.

It's the I am a failure that's the shame. And so theoretically, yeah, some people don't go there, right? Um, but most people do, but not everybody. And most of the time when I hear someone say they don't have shame, um, they do have shame. They just haven't learned how to find it. And that's more common than someone actually not having shame. But there are situations I have worked with people who they just either don't have a ton of shame. They don't have shame or they just don't have a ton of it.

And so that's your work is to just go in and make sure you've answered those questions. Um, because you're going to need to know some of that in order to go forward into chapter 4, which is going to be learning about negative cycles and eventually learning how to map out your negative cycle. And you can't know about your negative cycle without knowing about what's going on with you underneath the surface of your behaviors. And you can't know about your partner without really knowing yourself first because we rec we can recognize in others what ultimately what we can recognize in ourselves.

I am anxious and I am so very grateful that you have taken on this research and putting out these resources because when couples are looking to heal, you are there and all of your resources. I was first introduced to your Facebook page and um both my partner and I follow your page. Love, love, love all the insight and it has generated many conversations and we are healing. Oh, I'm so happy to hear that we have a long way to go. I love I love that you are helping people identify, make connections, and you give us the resources to heal.

Okay, good. All right. Um so yes, I I just want to echo what everyone else has said. It's like just so wonderful and and really applicable. Um and you know for my own situation I just um we're going through a rough season of our marriage and you know historically have been the anxious avoidant um couple and you know probably got worse over time um before we really learned this information you know like um y and We've had some attachment ruptures since then, which you kind of have heard about. Um, and I just really feel like we're coming to a reckoning.

Does that make sense? Yes. Yeah. And I feel like that was somewhat played out in the relationship because she was very much a perfectionist. She excelled in school. She excelled at everything and that was part of her own attachment because yeah, she just had to run away from she she had a chaotic home as a child. uh and her parents were unavailable to her because they had a special needs uh sibling or she had a special needs sibling. So, um and so I felt like, you know, it was never good enough. But anyhow, I just didn't know if it was something different or if it was all related to my absolutely related.

And on top of that, if your partner is getting space to engage and talk about their feelings, that is emotional closeness. That is um having a safe conversation that's not like you're just withholding from me. It's it's the way if you can do that in a way that is healthy. That's the safety. That's the emotional engagement that you're needing. And so you're using the trigger. You're using the unmet needs as a means to the connection instead of they're trying to share their feelings with you in a blaming way and you're pushing away their feelings because you're not hearing about it.

So can we work together here to try to figure out a way that you can feel successful and I can get the help I'm needing. All right, so there's the first thing. Now the second thing is what is your role here? Do you have a role? if you're delivering things in the most perfect way possible and you're really trying to hear and understand where they're coming from um and this is really truly just appropriate teamwork needs um then the block is 100% on them however a lot of times we do have a role and we need to look at that role okay so one possible role uh do you have standards that aren't the same as his and there's really nothing wrong with his standards they're just not quite quite as perfectionistic as yours and you're needing for him to meet you in your perfectionistic standards because that's how you regulate your own emotions.

They're going to be more disengaged from their own feelings. they're going to be more defensive and all of these things. And then again, we go into moderate where now, you know, we're starting to see distress at periods of time, especially when it's really difficult topics, but also times when things are okay and, you know, it's not black or white, right? Um, they're they're moving toward secure. They're becoming more flexible, less rigid about the way they they regulate. In the past over here, there's a lot of rigidity.

Probably not. They're pro that person in the system is probably expressing the emotions for all the other people who aren't expressing emotions. Um, and it's just not it's just not something we do. It's just not something we will learn to do. And not only that, we're actually

rewarded for pushing our emotions down or hiding them and not talking about them. Um, we're we're rewarded by not rocking the boat, not threatening, not getting messages of shame or or punishment or whatever. Um, and then there's this other thing that can really contribute heavily to avoiding attachment, and that's when parents are too emotionally inished.

You know, plenty of avoidant partners do go to a place of blame, especially in the midst of conflict. However, avoidant people are more likely at the end of the day to circle back to it's really just all my fault. It's all on me because they have such a sense of responsibility of and um independence, emotional independence and self-reliance. So that self-reliance is going to keep them circling back to it's really me. When there is some value in recognizing this is a cycle that we're both contributing to.

Um, and you know, I I would like to believe that that isn't enough to create someone who's just kind of broken forever. It it might though contribute to some more challenging need more challenging more challenges to their ability to self-regulate their own nervous system. Yeah, I think for me I'm definitely avoidant. Like I learned to just not have needs, not be emotional. Like my mom said, I only ever had one temper tantrum when I was two and it's because they drove for 10 hours on vacation and otherwise we're such a good baby, but really I suppressed everything.

We haven't really moved into how to do the work. We're laying the found the intellectual foundation here. Um, but if you have a really specific question about just how to how to do this, which most of you are asking about, and then after this question, we'll move into maybe some like 15 minutes of broader questions. Um, someone says, "How on average, how long does it take people to heal from their insecure attachment?" Um, honestly the the not so great answer that nobody wants to hear is it's kind of a lifelong journey of growth really.

I mean, I've been doing these intensives now where I'm working with people just marathon of, you know, seven days of two hours a day and that's getting them there really quickly. I mean, but then of course once they're done with that piece of work, then they have to work to maintain it. Um, if someone is starting off with a really bad disorganized attachment and to move fully to secure, I mean, it might take them, you know, 10 years of self-work or or lots of forward and backward or make take them five years, you know, really it just depends on so many factors.

When you get in these moments where the guilt starts to overwhelm you, you do really need to keep repeating to yourself, there was wisdom in my choice, and here's why. And I did the best I could with what I had, and you know, what would it have looked like if I stayed in that? Um, emotional trauma is first of all emotional abandonment. Consistent experiences of not getting validation, heard, understood, seen, having your emotions be held and comforted and had space for. Um, learning to, you know, have someone help you learn to do do your emotions with health.

I I really need some validation that where I'm coming from about why why we do need to do this together. Um sometimes if things are really bad, then it takes healthy assertion, which is I'm just not okay with what we're doing. I'm I'm just not okay with it. And if we can't get out of this, like here here are the consequences. Here's what you know, I don't know if it has to go to I won't be able to stay in this relationship. That's really a personal issue depending on your circumstances, but it might be like I'm going to ha I I might end up just emotionally disengaging because it's too painful to keep going doing the same thing over and over.

Um then that's the moment where you might really need to like ask yourself what what you should do going forward. Yeah. Uh yeah. And in terms of whether we get to that place separately or together, do you have any feeling about what you've seen whether you've you know whether it's actually helpful when when it has been helpful or you know my my fear is that if we do if we do you know do that work on ourselves which we both acknowledge we need to do because we're both struggling with those first two questions you know the communication and then the behaviors you So my my fear would be that as soon as we do that we will just the easy option will just be to kind of drift further apart and not do the work.

But you have to at least go there and try it. [Music] Um my partner is avoidant. Any slight negative comment if I remind him to do a task as he might not done he feels a failure. How do I communicate that if I don't feel he is a failure or think bad of him? if a mistake is made. Well, first of all, I'm gonna start with, you know, communicating to him. That that's frustrating. Okay. Um, it's really frustrating when you need help and you can't ask for help because it's not safe to ask for help because he's going to go into a shame spiral.

A menudo la estabilidad emocional aparente de la persona evitativa fue algo que atrajo a su pareja al inicio de la relación. Cuando surgen los conflictos y la pareja expresa emociones, la persona evitativa intenta que esas emociones desaparezcan igual que lo hace con las propias. Eso activa a la pareja ansiosa, que responde con protestas o críticas, lo que a su vez resulta incómodo para la persona evitativa, que reacciona de forma poco sana, y así el ciclo continúa.

and they have a hard time tolerating um just even isolated moments where their partner might need some space or might be in kind of a grumpy mood. Um that can feel like the end of the world to them or very permanent and that causes distress and then with that distress they move in close the diff distance get desperate get demanding sometimes controlling. Um, this doesn't mean they're bad. It just means they're reacting to their own feelings and they're reacting to, you know, real and real problems in the relationship that their partner is contributing to, but they're not reacting to that in a way that was really going to help them get their needs met.

You don't survive as a human without having those emotional pain signals to inform how you navigate through life. It's just like if you don't you have to feel physical pain to know how to stay alive physically. People there are people who don't feel physical pain that they're very rare but they don't live very long because they don't know how to keep their body safe. They get infections. They have tons of broken bones. Same with emotions. We have to have emotional experience to keep us safe in the world.

Um so you have that fewer less often fewer and farther between um you you they're not as bad when they happen. You're not like going to the ugliest places more more consistently. Sometimes pe couples backtrack and they might do be doing great and then have this terribly ugly fight. That doesn't necessarily mean they're they're not growing in the big picture. Um but but in the big picture, we're we're less intense. We're getting less distressed and we're able to repair faster because we're able to really recognize what actually happened and bring our our new emerging communication skills into the repair process and um just general feelings of of more closeness and safety in the relationship.

But a real tangible way to assess it is how are we doing with our negative cycles? Okay. And so with an avoidant attachment, you're going to typically I'm going to see two really consistent styles of of uh consistent home environments during childhood. One is going to be high levels of disengagement um where nobody in the family really does emotions. We just kind of operate by stuffing them down. Nobody really ever talks about emotions. Maybe we have that one sister who's always sort of disregulated or that one brother who's always getting in trouble at school and has serious ADD, but that's just them, you know, that's just how they were born.

And if they learn that, you know, my mom starts panicking when I'm upset, then it might be better just to to not cry. that that's the early roots of an avoidant attachment. So, with that said, yes, I mean, I would like to believe that, you know, just a few days of of this trauma is not enough if it's offset by a lot of good caretaking later. However, I do know nervous systems are very sensitive at that period of time and it can set up patterns and the pattern might look like, you know, the baby is more agitated, more distressed, get has less time to start learning

how to regulate their nervous system and that creates, you know, a fussier baby and then the fussier baby overwhelms the mom who's already compromised by their own health issues and that can sort of set up a bad pattern if that makes sense.

And that's really sad. That is going to get you out of guilt. If you're if you're doing the other thing and you're saying, "Well, I'm a failure. I failed. I shouldn't have left them. I'm bad for doing it. And what does that mean about me as a person? And I should have tried harder." And you're making sense of it in that way, then you are going to feel guilt. And in that case, you need to unpack that. you need to figure out like what's getting in the way of you making peace with the situation. Um, is it because you grew up with messages that you're kind of responsible for everything or if you can't make everything work, you're a failure and maybe there's some healing that you need to do around that.

Um, you you need to figure out like what's the what's the guilt trying to do? How's guilt is any bad bad emotion or I'm sorry not bad painful emotion is trying to keep us safe in some way. There's a function to it and sometimes even though it's not working we need to kind of figure out the function of that guilt and kind of try to honor the function of it before we try to get rid of it. Um you know there's just a a lot of layers to it. But, you know, at the end of the day, you do have to kind of keep repeating to yourself.

I'm hearing you like I get it. You're you're scared. You don't want things to get worse and I appreciate that. I appreciate the fact that you know you're trying to protect the relationship and just leave it for a while and then come in let that simmer because that is relationship work. That doesn't mean you like their decision and that mean doesn't mean you're okay with sticking to that or agree. But later then you come in after they've felt kind of heard and validated and say, you know, I know you've got these good reasons, but I need for you to hear my good reasons, too.

El apego desorganizado recibe diferentes nombres según la tradición de investigación. Los términos originales de la investigación clínica son "ansioso", "preocupado", "dismissivo-evitativo" y "desorganizado". La psicología social y la educativa adoptaron términos distintos; en ese marco, "fearful-avoidant" equivale a "desorganizado". Ambos términos refieren al mismo patrón.

Una persona que parte de un apego desorganizado severo puede necesitar muchos años para alcanzar una seguridad relativa. Alguien con inseguridad más leve puede construir la base en semanas con trabajo intensivo.

You can't regulate the anxiety enough in a moment to get down to the deeper stuff. Um, which leaves us with difficulty self-supporting and poor communication because we often just don't know what we're supposed to be communicating. And then a lot of negative self-beliefs and shame that accompany accompany the negative self-beliefs. Again, it's not, oh, I failed. Oh, I messed up. Oh, I wish I could change this. It's I failed and I messed up and I can't change because I'm just fundamentally flawed.

Nobody asks for this stuff. Um, but I mean it's the most painful and it's probably going to be the most dysfunctional in a relationship. Um, but really more importantly, it's the most painful. People with disorganized attachment are just simply in a lot of pain a lot more of the time. Um, usually there's just a lot of mistrust for others that, you know, is there even in many different contexts. Even if there's not a ton of evidence to not trust a person, even before they know a person, they go into things with mistrust because they have been so harmed by relationships.

Um, most people develop these po coping mechanisms somewhere in childhood. Um, and you know, again, adult relationships can make them better or worse. And to to put this out there, there is a lot of truth to the fact that healthy relationships can make them better. And the goal for my work with everybody is to bolster the relationship to a point where it actually heavily impacts and reinforces both partners security. And each partner can do that with each other. Each partner can contribute to that and has their own role in that.

So just know that it doesn't matter what culture you're in, you have emotions. Okay. Now, how do you get to the pain? That's where we have these cultural differences. Different cultures make different meanings of different behaviors and different things and have different sort of expectations and different surface level things that keep them feeling emotionally safe. Okay. And so the culture is going to determine how they get to the emotions. And sometimes there's overlap. You know, usually if if someone's screaming in your face, it doesn't matter what culture you're in, that's going to hurt.

So those with avoidant attachment are typically trying to stay one step ahead of failure and the shame that is in embedded into failure for them. Um and then with disorganized attachment the core fear is usually just like you know with the disorganized attachment there's never one complete answer but if I had to give one complete answer I would say um two things I would I wouldn't give one complete answer I would give two complete answers. It's one, their own body is a not safe place. They never know when these intense things are going to come up in them.

And good. Um, maybe not in a in a great way. I'm just Oh, I see. Yeah. I, you know, like I don't know. It's hard because I think that my husband, you know, has with like being avoidant just really is kind of feeling this incompatibility because he can't get it right or if he doesn't get the answer right 100% of the time that like he just feels like so bad about himself, you know, or just like he feels he feels good with everything else, but like, you know, he just feels like he he can't get it right.

Oh yeah. No, I mean listen, some people are going to be able to do that on their own, right? And just with self-help. I'm sorry. And some people don't even need to know the term negative cycle. They just learn some better relationship skills that just naturally get them out of them um and lower the conflict. And then some people are going to respond really well to self-help like what we're doing here. And some people are just their nervous systems are going to hijack them either for personal reasons or because their relationship has just been so hard and their level of mistrust and distress is so high that they just can't overcome the nervous system dysregulation to settle in and really hear each other, right?

Some people are going to be too scared to do the work. Some people are um not going to get the right kind of help sadly. Um, some people are, you know, going to be up against a relationship that's so painful that it's really hard for them. So, but I see time and time and time and time again people learning to regulate themselves and you know when they start improving their relationship it starts to create co-regulation and that in of itself helps everybody regulate but in order to contribute in your part of relationship change you have to be able to also regulate.

one disorganized attachment, one avoidant attachment, lots of escalation at the beginning of the work in the sessions. And you know what? I don't know how many sessions in. We maybe did 20, I don't know, 22, Katrina, 23. And they're they're going to do they're doing it. They're back. They're they're not completely back together, but 20 sessions for a couple like that is like not very much. They're going to need more, but they're able to spend weekends together. They're able to stay out of negative cycles.

So the way that he regulates his anxiety is is somehow with these perfectionistic standards and like a lot of negative feedback. And so now he is expecting you as a child to help you regulate his anxiety by being perfectionistic also. So he doesn't have to worry and fear that you're not going to make it in the world or you're not helping him out enough or whatever it is. He's needing you to be more than is health a healthy expectation of what ch a children child should be because of his own anxiety.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch4 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 20.510. Texto curado integrado aqui: 9.381 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activación' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

And if they're using the anxious partner's regulation to get off the hook, oh, look, I don't have to do any work now, that needs to be named, right? that somehow the anxious partner needs to be able to show up and with some healthy assertion and say look you know I'm doing my work over here and I'm really just on a personal level it's been so helpful and I know it's taken a lot of pressure off but at the same time you know we're in a relationship and I do deserve an appropriate amount of co-regulation and emotional support you know I've dedicated my life to you and that is a part of a healthy relationship that's part of what can help me feel will help me feel safe and close and I need to know that sure I can take care of myself and help you out by not putting all this pressure on you but at the same time I need to know if you can kind of lean into me also and balance this out a bit because it's really not feeling balanced and that is the start of the conversation right I don't know you know it's going to take multiple rounds and multiple you know that's the start later it's like what we want to know because first of all this person isn't doing that on purpose.

It's like the abandonment hasn't ended. Okay. Well, okay. There's two pieces to this. One is if your protest and blame is working for you, just keep doing it, right? But the odds are high that the protest and blame aren't working. So, you got to figure out like, am I going to be committed to this because I can make sense of why I go into protest or blame. You go into protest or blame for a very good reason. You're saying to me, I've got these unhealed wounds. I felt abandoned. I felt horrible. there's nothing that we're doing that's really healing some of that stuff.

It's still this unhealed lingering wound. And so, of course, my body goes into protest or blame. That's my way of trying to get this pain to go away. The problem is is even if that makes all the sense in the world, the protest or blame is not going to help you. You got to figure out how am I going to deal with these emotions without going into protest or blame. One is to start showing up for that that in yourself so you don't keep going into protest or blame that really gets you nowhere, make things worse, make you feel worse.

Um, you stated that two anxious styles will not work because they have too much of the same energy. I don't know if not work that that sounds kind of extreme, but because I first of all, I don't know what somebody's saying to me too anxious styles. I don't really know what that means to them 100%. Um, and people find ways to make things work all the time, but generally speaking, two people aren't going to stay at the same level of anxiety together. Um, does that hold true if you both are doing the work to become secure?

Um, okay. So a common thing with anxious attachment in these cycles, right, is those with anxious attachment, their primary focus in the cycle is somehow protect myself from the pain of loss and the pain of abandonment and the pain of facing these beliefs that I'm just unlovable and the despair in those places. Um, not being able to reach. So they're that's what their main wounds are around because of their his history and other relationships. They're really sensitive to loss, abandonment, feeling like they're unlovable.

Um, there's so many different strategies. I think the best strategy, honestly, for regulation is to dive into your feelings and really sit with them and try to listen to them and get a little bit more clear about what your feelings actually are. Um, so you can go back into the repair conversation knowing more about what was really happening for you and what you're needing. That's where that anxious workshop, I mean, anxious attachment course I'm doing really comes in is to help people do this emotional work before they show up in the relationship.

Co-eregulation is wonderful. It has to happen in a relationship for that relationship to be safe and close. But it can't. There's an over reliance for anxious partners and that ends up putting an immense amount of pressure on their partner um who is got their own stuff to deal with. Um, anxious attachment ultimately is blaming. It's ultimately very other focused. Um, even if they intellectually understand, I've got a part here, um, they're still going to have a real hard time really internalizing what that part is.

And it's not just random protection of sense of self because I'm so egotistical. It's protection of self-hatred, the despair in the self-hatred, and being rejected by others, including being rejected by my partner. If I lose my sense of self, not only am I going to hate myself, but how could they possibly even want me or love me? I'll just be just some slimy little loser. Okay, so the protection always has a relationship component to it. Um, negative cycle strategies for those with avoidant attachment is always going to be keep things from getting worse, keep things from getting worse.

They they don't even they are not even meant to help people. They're just meant to um make money off the name of the book. Um, if they did have useful information in them, I would say go buy it. Whatever helps. But they don't. Um, they're completely fraudulent. Um, they make it look like I wrote it and I did not. So, really don't buy those. It's an absolute complete waste of money. [Music] Um, can you give a short example for two anxious partners in a relationship? Yes. I mean, 99% of the time if two anxious partners are in a relationship, there's going to be just a lot of escalation, a lot of fighting, and it's really one person.

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[Music] Hi Julie again. So I did do my test. I am an anxious avoidant. Can you hear me? Okay. Yep. Okay. Can you So I currently I'm not in a relationship and I think my avoidant attachment style is coming up with every reason not to be in a relationship. Right. I understand when you're in it some things that you can do. I guess I'm struggling with knowing that this is my attachment style. How do I push myself to be in a healthy relationship without being full of fear and anxiety? If that makes any sense.

Um, and then the as the cycles get going between the two of them, they create more wounds of each other. And then now they have the relationship wounds on top of the individual wounds. So that just creates even more pain. And the more pain and the more we don't know how to manage pain, the more like we are likely we are to have more cycles. And um when you go up here to partners bringing this you know insecure attachment with themselves and self-abandonment strategies um what they're doing is not only are they having poor communication with their partner but they also might be doing a lot of acting out relationship um I'm sorry acting out behaviors in their own life because they don't know how to do their emotions.

So they might be substance abusing or having an affair or any number of things that harm them and harm the relationship that are rooted in their own self stuff. But then of course we bring that into the relationship and now that causes the relationship to have all this pain and everything just really gets worse. Okay. Some um someone says, "Do securely attached couples have negative cycles?" Um yeah, they do because I I don't really believe anyone ever fully fully fully heals? I mean, and even if we do fully heal, we still get triggered.

And so they're less likely to go into negative cycles, although they do. Um, and they're much more likely to have them be less intense. They're not going to get so bad and ugly. They're not going to wound each other on the level that insecurely attached couples are in the

cycles. And then they're going to be able to repair, catch themselves faster, interrupt it faster, and repair faster. So really, that's what I'm looking to do with my couples is I'm not saying, "Hey, I'm going to eliminate your cycles altogether."

There's there's no way to avoid that. Um two avoidance in a negative cycle are going to be very disengaged. They're less likely to go into negative cycles. They're going to get really heady and intellectual. Um there's not going to be a lot of emotional escalation. If there is, it's going to be very logical and um they're going to have, you know, no nobody's there fighting for the emotional distance. So, either the relationship is just going to be very stale and kind of fizzle out or um they, you know, well, it is it's just going to be stale or one partner is going to start feeling the pain of the staleness and want more and start becoming more of the anxious role.

M maybe what you're needing to do to to help that fear is you're needing to figure out better ways to have healthy assertion around your time or know that you need to be with someone who is respectful of you know reciprocating time and that can tolerate the fact that you also need to maintain a strong sense of self sense of independency within the relationship interdependence. Yeah. like where you're not, you know, you need for to feel safe and close, you need to not be in a relationship where you just feel gobbled up and taken over.

Take action. Protest, blame, reach, right? anything to get his attention, bring attention to the problem. So, he says to me, "Oh my gosh, you're right. I'm so sorry. I know how important it is to you to have everything orderly and that's how you feel settled here. Let me help you out with that." Okay. However, that's probably not going to work because what happens is now we're going to switch over to Mark. Mark, the triggering event for him is Cassy's protest, right? He doesn't like that. Doesn't feel good for him.

If if you have two anxious partners in a fight, the fight is just never going to end. Nobody's going to nobody's going to move away from it. So, someone in that cycle is going to take on the avoidant role to shut it down. So, it's going to look like a lot more escalation, a lot more drama, a lot more um long extensive conversations um that go nowhere, a lot of talking over. Um, but it's so unsustainable that they're either going to just not work and it's just going to something really bad is going to happen and they're going to end up breaking up or one person's going to move into more of an avoidant role because someone has got to balance that out.

Relationship energy finds a way to find balance. It just does. And that is a lot of what the anxious avoidant dynamic is doing is trying to create some balance. Um, what happens is when two people come to the table who are imbalanced in their ability to deal with their emotions, one person's getting flooded and acting out all the time, the other one is getting flooded and shoving it down all the time. Um, then they they balance each other out, right? I need for two people to come already balanced out.

No, not at all. If you're both doing the work to become more secure, um, then then no. I I think just keep going with that. Um, for sure. you know, if if it's working and you're seeing improvement and you're seeing movement and both partners are committed, you ab there's so much hope um that you can get out of that [Music] um after a negative cycle. What is a healthy time frame to reconnect and repair? When both people's nervous systems are able to be open to each other. When you're able to be open, openness means you can hear your partner's perspective.

And have I ever felt like that before in life? Yeah, I did. I felt like this growing up and it was terrible. And so then we want to say, well, the way that you're trying to regulate that fear is just avoid the trigger. just avoid the um you know the the relationship that could trigger that. Yeah. Right. So, but what's the downside of that? Well, the downside of that might be just being lonely and you know this other thing that you fear. Um so now we got to figure out how do we help you with that fear and those emotions that might come from the fear um without having it to go to avoiding a relationship.

So, now partner one's in this place. Okay. Now we're going to go into two. Partner two, I mean, I'm sorry. Now, partner one, once they get that ouch, this is the ouch, right? Then their body mobilizes into a protective emotion, which is usually going to be like anger or anxiety. And any physical urge, the protective emotion is a physical urge to do something, defend myself, protest, retreat, anything to make this ouch go away. Okay, so this protective emotion is designed to motivate some sort of action to regulate this terrible pain.

And what's going to happen if you start experiencing your feelings is you're going to start expressing them more. And sometimes before they learn how to kind of do that with finesse that can um come out in more of that anxious way or um they're starting to tap into their own relationship anxiety or they're starting to tap into anger and they don't know what to do with the anger. They haven't felt the anger in their life and so now it's kind of coming out all over the place because they don't know how to rein it in and contain it and talk about it in a healthy way.

Um, unless again it's helping. I mean it look if it's helping you feel better then who am I to say not to do it anymore? My experience is that most people aren't going to really get where they need to be if they stay there. Um, and then we have to figure out how to heal these wounds first of all. One, how to heal the wounds. two, how to heal the current negative cycles that are creating all this junk that is leading to protest and blame. Um, and so the first thing we have to do is we've got to help you talk about these abandonment wounds in a healing way which is outside of a negative cycle.

And maybe they need to be like, "Yeah, I know you were going through a lot, but still that didn't feel good for me." And then I need you to lean into that. Go, you know what? That makes sense. I get that that was terrifying for you, or I get that that didn't actually impact you in the greatest way possible. Um, okay. So, let's go back to uh someone says, "Does the Secure Love workbook exist?" No, not really. There are these people that take books on Amazon and they make workbooks and they're just absolutely horrible.

So, you know, we need to do something here because I want to show I I know you need to be appreciated for the fact that you're moving, but I'm also really needing some emotional connection. So, how can we get there? How did to and some people honestly like just need more help than the book or the workshops can provide. Sometimes people can keep chipping away at it and keep trying to deepen their conversations. But there's also the reality that sometimes people need more more guidance in real time from a professional.

Whether it's when you need to bring up a concern or when you need to do a repair, anytime that you really need to be in an emotionally grounded place, you know, you really do need to be able to tap in and sit with your feelings. It's just so many people don't know how to do that. And that's what happens when people, you know, don't get therapy that helps them really sit with themselves. That's the many many times the missing link. And that's why I love the somatic work um and even EFT because it's really designed to get you into your body, get you into your your feelings so you can understand them better, communicate them better, and help them better.

We're really going to figure out how can we shift the patterns underneath all of those topics and create new patterns of communication that will on their own help you figure out on your own all of those topics. So I don't have to spend all my time with couples, you know, going over each and every little area where they have a disagreement or fight. I'm teaching them how to shift the patterns so that they can start to better do that stuff on their own. Um, and it really is I mean I you cannot you you simply cannot have a healthy relationship that is um emotionally close and can resolve problems together without stabilizing negative cycles.

Um, each partner is bringing in their own difficult relationship with their own feelings that they don't quite know how to manage and some communication difficulties and then some old wounds that get triggered more easily. And then what happens is is they're fine at the beginning. it's all fine because they haven't had any time to have conflict that causes negative cycles. Well, then bam, they have their first

conflict. And most couples can remember that first conflict because that's going to be if they don't, you know, because of their own stuff, they don't know how to manage the conflict and the conflict goes into a negative cycle, then they're going to start eroding the trust.

Those negative cycles erode the trust. Then when the trust erodes, it makes the next negative cycle more likely. And then on and on it goes and it can get really out of hand. Some couples have mild negative cycles. They're generally healthier. Um, and it doesn't they're not enough to really hugely disrupt the attachment safety. Some couples, they just get stuck in negative cycles all the time. they can't they're very rarely are they not either having one or afraid of having one. Um and yeah so basically what it is is they come to the relationship with wounds and then they create wounds in the relationship of each other and then things just start to you know to create um positive reinforcement loops.

Well, the other person might not be delivering that concern in the healthiest way because they are afraid of not being heard. If I say it in a soft way, I won't be heard and then I'm going to feel rejected and unheard and powerless and I don't want to feel all those things. So, the way I'm going to deal with not having to go there is my nervous system mobilizes and I'm just going to try to get louder to get you to hear me. We're not seeing all of this pain under the surface. I'm too lost in my own fears and pain that I just can't even hear a word you're saying.

Okay. Now, with that, partner one is going to do a behavior in response to that anger or anxiety or whatever that protective urge is. This is real specific. It's words or actions that they do in the cycle. Protest, get desperate, get demanding, get controlling, get accusatory, get um anything that'll make the pain go away. Stuff the emotions down. Okay. So here now first ouch second protective pain do something urge third behavior. Okay now partner two now now partner one is behaving in a way that's going to trigger partner two.

I mean, no matter how healed a person is, if their partner snaps at them, there there's probably going to be a little bit of hurt there. Um, securely attached couples have far more capacity to regulate their own emotions and show up in a healthier way when they communicate their distress to their partner. And their partner has, you know, the other side of that is they also have more capacity to lean in and understand and hold their partner when their partner brings up distress. And sometimes that doesn't happen, but they're able to catch that much more quickly.

Um, but that's very rare. Usually, you know that what I have seen over and over again is that when we start stabilizing these cycles and we start bringing emotional safety in, which creates emotional connection, people do start to re um figure these things out. The symptoms start to disappear. It's much easier to resolve a problem when we feel safe with each other and we're coming at it from the perspective of we want to help each other out instead of we need to protect ourselves from this person or I need to get my way because of blah blah blah.

Um during the during the healing process, is it common to shift into the opposite attachment strategy? Yes, absolutely. Um you know, as long as is this person is growing and the couple's growing and they're not they're not just staying stuck in a disorganized attachment. Um what happens is is people start to get more flexible. Right? that that's it. I mean, anxious attachment and avoidant attachment are they're rigid ways of responding. Um, and so when someone starts to heal, they start to experience their feelings and avoidance starts to experience their feelings.

or an anxious partner, they start learning, oh, I can kind of take care of myself. I don't really have to have them come to me or call me all the time or say a certain thing or do a certain thing in an exact way so I can feel better. And they start sort of retreating. They kind of start liking that. I like that I can do this on my own. I don't need them, right? And then sometimes their growth is going to that place and learning about that place and then over time starting to reconnect with loneliness.

And we're also trying to repair more often because in the past we used to be very happy when we were finally not disregulated anymore and then we would just leave it at that and that doesn't work. So now now we're repairing or trying. Um, but the thing is that when we try to repair, when we're no longer disregulated, my partner um, hardly ever remembers what was going on inside of him, but also he doesn't really remember the things he said, uh, or did or the things I said or did. Um, so we are kind of stuck um as to when to repair because if we wait until we're both settled down um we don't really get anywhere.

Um, mine's very similar to what Anna was talking about, like if the anxious partner, you know, starts to learn to not be so heavily um, reliant on co-regulation and starts to learn how to, you know, what's going on inside of her or inside of me. Um then the avoidant partner doesn't really see the alarms going off or the problem and and it's kind of like okay then there's no reason to visit that little small because she's regulated you know like so I don't know what do you do about that? Well, the avoidant partner has has responsibility to become engaged with self, right?

You need someone who um, you know, can uh be also healthy, have healthy expectations of emotional closeness. It's not like accommodating the avoidance. It's finding health if that makes sense. And then you need to be with, you know, you need to be able to your own work is to use healthy assertion in that relationship instead of just bailing or instead of just shutting down when you don't want to do something. It's hey, I love you. I love hanging out with you, you know, but I also, you know, I also enjoy my downtime.

That helps me feel filled up so I can back in. Um, and if you learn how to communicate that and navigate that with someone, you don't have to fear relationships anymore. Thank you so much. You're welcome. Gives me hope. Thank you. Okay. Good. Yeah. It's just I mean, really, if I distill that, it's a matter of exploring the fears and figuring out better ways to deal with the fears than just avoiding whatever you're Yeah. Thank you. You're very welcome. All right. So, we're going to talk about chapter four, which is diving into the negative cycle.

Um, so what is a negative cycle? Well, it's repetitive patterns of communication. If I look at couples and I have them tell me, you know, give me an example of five of their last fights or arguments, I'm going to see a very consistent pattern in every single one of those arguments. It's going to go from someone says something that creates an unmet need that creates a painful feeling that creates anger or fear or anxiety that creates a behavior. The other partner gets triggered by that behavior and then it just they go into the same scaffold of events and then it just keeps spinning back and forth.

Um, so what you see on the surface in a negative cycle, and I'll go ahead and look to see if I have any questions before I move on. Okay. So what you see on the surface, right, you see protest, you see demands, you see blame, you see high anxiety, you see yelling or these back and forth intellectual discourses that are really just trying to convince the other person to see it differently. Um, I don't mean healthy intellectual discourses. I mean, the unhealthy kind where nobody's really hearing anyone and we're just trying to make the other person think differently or agree with us.

We need to pull out. We need to figure out how you guys can communicate about this in a better way." And if that doesn't get them to the place where they can come to an agreement, then maybe they need to decide, hey, how are we going to navigate the fact that we just don't see eye to eye? Um, but at least they're going to figure out what to do from a place of clarity and safety. Um, is being stuck in a continuous negative cycle essentially the same as experiencing the four horsemen patterns? Um, yeah.

What's what's blocking them? Why is their nervous system so threatened and activated that they can't kind of step back and go, "Okay, we need to do something different here. We need to join each other." I wouldn't try to have that conversation in the negative cycle. I know that's tricky because what do you do to you know um in the meantime and I'll talk about that in a minute but later when things are settled when

we're not when our nervous systems are more open I would go in and I would say look you know I'm trying so hard to help us not have to go back to this awful place where we get stuck in these cycles and we just can't hear each other.

They don't know how to go in and go, "Okay, what's really happening for me right now? how can I kind of give myself some help right now? They they don't do that and oftentimes they have no idea that they're not doing that. Nobody does this stuff on purpose. It's really not anyone's fault to be honest and we come by this stuff honestly. We are responsible for seeking out new information um to help us. But um and so those with anxious attachment, they rely too heavily on co-regulation from their partner.

Um, sometimes I I say, you know, a common thing with anxious attachment is watering the plant with gasoline. They are putting in the energy and the effort, but in ways that aren't working. And they don't know it because no one's ever actually taught them how to do the work in the way that actually helps them, which is really hard and sad. You know, there's a lot of therapies out there that are great at building insight, but not so great at actually helping them heal. Um, and then common with avoidant attachment, um, the focus is going to be on protecting their sense of self, right?

and the self-abandonment of emotions that causes them to rely too heavily on emotional disconnection from self as a way to stay safe from pain. Right? And then what happens with this emotional disconnection from self is they're not able to deal with their own emotions head on and they're also not able to show up for their partner's emotions because they don't know how to show up for their own. Um, at the end of the day, avoidant attachment is ultimately going to blame self. Even if there is some knowledge that the other partner is in the wrong, it's always going to be, well, why am I not doing enough to help them change?

Um, it ultimately it circles back to me. Okay. And so, what can you do with all this? Well, you know, we're going to talk more about what we can do with all this later. That's, you know, the book is designed to lead with um information to ground us so we have a better ability to do the work later. But you know, if we just look at this part, you know, we got to really get that anxious partner um believing in their own lovability and not having to question that so much. Um we got to get them doing new strategies with these feelings.

It could be some IFS work. Um and of course my work as the couple's therapist is to stabilize the relationship so we have that relationship piece not um creating more trauma or activating the trauma so often. Um, but both partners, even the traumatized partner, have to be able to do that relationship work to stabilize the relationship. And you know, ultimately trauma or no trauma, we are all responsible for how our behavior is impacting the the safety of the relationship. And you know partners can trauma can responds very very positively to partner co-regulation.

Um and again that would be my my role would be to help the partner of the traumatized person co-regulate. But it doesn't it can't be one-sided where one person's trauma is kind of taking up all the air. We also have to help that person get through a traumatic situation and get through their own feelings so they can also co-regulate their partner. Um, how does a serious attachment rupture like going through a major health crisis affect the negative cycle? I understand my reactions can sometimes be protest or blame, but for me it feels like a momentary trigger and more like a long-standing alarm.

They know how to emotionally engaged. They know how to regulate. They know how to communicate. They know how to get their needs met. They're balanced as individuals. And that's where the relationship balance is coming from. Um, so how do you bring up topics about the relationship that need to be addressed that could possibly be triggering to your partner? Well, um, one thing to do is to lead into it with some validation of their of their trigger, which would be, hey, you know, first of all, you might want to understand the good reasons that they would be triggered by the conversation.

Paso 4 - El comportamiento. La persona hace o dice algo para regular ese dolor: protesta, exige, controla, acusa, se retira, se desconecta, cambia de tema, da al otro lo que quiere para que no se enoje, etc.

El sistema nervioso de Cassie la dirige a protestar, culpar, llamar la atención sobre el problema. Su objetivo subconsciente es conseguir que Mark diga "tienes razón, lo siento, sé que esto es importante para ti". Eso regularía el dolor.

La protesta de Cassie es el evento disparador de Mark. Mark llega a casa después de un día de esfuerzo. Los mensajes que recibe son de fracaso. Su dolor es: "no me ven, no soy comprendido, soy el malo de la historia a pesar de todo lo que hago". Su sistema nervioso se moviliza. Su comportamiento es desconectarse, ignorar, intentar que ella vea que lo está viendo mal, o simplemente retirarse.

Yeah. Well, the first thing you need to do is figure out what the fear actually is, right? Sometimes the best way to get to the fear is maybe like imagining a scenario that that part of you that says I don't want to be in a relationship would fear like what spec you know not wanting to be in a relationship is kind of vague and global right narrow that down to something specific. I don't want to have to do things on an evening that I don't want to do. I don't want to, you know, whatever it is. you're going to have to really dive into what is so bad about that, what's scary about that?

Um, a lot of this is just still kind of staying in that educational place or as we move forward, we're going to learn a lot more practical skills, but I do have um some homework here that you can start learning how to map out this cycle. Um, I will be having a negative cycle workshop in a couple weeks. I don't remember the exact date. Katrina can put that in the um chat or it's basically I'm gonna it's an hour long and I'm going to help couples or individuals map out their negative cycle so they can get more grounded and like what's actually the problem here and then later at some point after that I'll take that to a next step with another workshop that's um goes you know continues to go deeper and deeper into the negative cycle to help people stabilize it.

And I apologize, but I spelled negative wrong up there. Um, all right. So, what creates these negative cycles? Well, um, uh, oh, I duplicated a slide. Sorry about that. Um, no matter how many times I go through this, I find something that I did wrong. I'm so sorry. I'm terrible with that. Um, all right. So, what creates these negative cycles? Well, each partner brings baggage to the relationship, right? I've never met a negative cycle that just, you know, completely materialized out of thin air.

It's there's a historical context to these cycles. Um, and so but in a moment usually one person is going to be the one to start that round. Um, and you know, sometimes, let's let's say in a situation, one partner, well, never mind, I won't go there. Let's just say that most of the time, we're going to see a very clear beginning. Um, something's going on in one person and it's a very specific moment. That's what we need to understand about negative cycles. It's not, you know, people come to me and they want to talk about their relationship in this very global way.

They want to say, "Oh, well, I just, you know, I never feel heard." And a lot of times when he comes home, he's this and and a and you know, she's just kind of always seeing me as this. And her relationship with her dad was blah blah blah. And there's nothing wrong with that. I the context can be important, but I've got to eventually narrow them down to, okay, you're telling me in this relationship that, you know, you're seeing these signs of her relationship with her dad showing up. I need to know a moment when that came to life.

I got to work with a moment where she said or did something that your nervous system says, bam, here we are. This is about you. You make sense of it as this is about her relationship with her dad. What does she say or do there? Right? So, I need to get this condensed into

a moment because I got to see how the negative cycle is playing out around this topic. And so, what's going to happen is there's going to be a trigger. Uh, the partner is going to say or do something and then here's where it starts.

That's not really possible. Life is constantly bringing us new things to be stressed about, new experiences that we don't know how to navigate. resources get low, resilience gets low, we get hungry, we get tired, we revert back to our old ways, whatever. However, my goal is to get you to the point where they're fewer and farther between, they repair faster and they're less intense. And then as couples start to get more exp Oh, and also they're able to turn the negative cycles into positive cycles, we're able to talk about these negative cycles in a way that it's exposing our vulnerabilities and that's actually helping us bond.

Um, and the more they can do this, the more confidence they they build and the more trust in each other they build and then that just keeps contributing to more healing. How does the dual nature of the conflict play out in practice? The surface level issue still needs to be addressed as well, right? Um do you do that later immediately after addressing repairing the cycle? Yeah, you still need to deal with the issue. You know, all all issues are dealt with in different ways. Some issues take a really long time to repeated conversations.

the the four horsemen patterns which is like contempt or um defensiveness, stonewalling. Those are behaviors and experiences that are part of negative cycles. Um I don't know the I know the Gottmans do the four horsemen. Um historically they have not organized those into a negative cycle. I think they may have brought some of that in now. Um, but they, so let's say there's stonewalling. Okay, so stonewalling doesn't work in a relationship. That is a four horsemen. Um, and so I'm going to plug that in here.

Um, you might, if it's really bad and you just can't, you know, it's just not safe to keep going, you might then have to say, "Hey, listen. We're in that cycle. This feels bad. I have to protect us right now. I can't I'm going to have to go and take a break. You know, I'm going to have to we can't do this." Um, if the second partner is uninterested in doing this work, then probably, you know, that both partners really need to be on board for working on the relationship. Um, one partner can absolutely do the work on their own for a while and do that in order to establish safety in the relationship.

They're not facing problems. So, we got to get them in um su get them experiencing success with actually facing problems so that they don't just keep trying to avoid things and then waiting for it to blow up. Um, again, I got to get that that avoidant partner dis or I'm sorry, connecting with self. They got to start feeling. They got to start sitting with those emotions. They got to start, you know, naming those emotions and exploring them a little bit more. So they start connecting to self in a way that helps them not to have to behave poorly in the relationship and in a way that they can now connect to the humanity in their partner that they have learned to see in themself and sometimes in this place it's a matter of healthy assertion and also over here um okay so now I'm going to take some questions and then we'll talk about the Anatomy of a trigger.

And if there's a stuckness there, then there's going to need to be some more work to get back in, you know, moving back in toward the middle. Um, okay. So, the anatomy of a trigger. All right. So, I'm going to go over here for a second and we're going to look at the negative cycle. And we have this partner's stuff, okay? Their their lower feelings, unmet needs, and then their protective emotions, and then the way that they act, and that's going to trigger this partner stuff. Maybe one day this partner stuff was over here starting it.

Right now, he's not there for me when I need him. And I'm having a hard time trusting that he'll be there for me when I'm needing him. None of this is conscious. Cassie is not thinking this in her mind. This is in her nervous system. And that feels pain. She she's saying, "I don't know if my needs matter to him." Okay. And now that takes her into pain. Nobody doesn't feel if you're attached to someone. You're going to feel pain if you don't know they'll be there for you when you need them. If you don't feel pain, you're probably not attached to them.

I know that trauma is in the body and can hijack the nervous system. How to deal with this particularly many people are not aware of this? Um, well, the first thing is is I need to know how that trauma is showing up in the relationship. Is it showing up as that person is having a hard time regulating in in a way that keeps them doing their own part of the negative cycle by showing up vulnerably, showing up with healthy assertion, being able to lean into their partner's experiences and hold that? Um, if that's not the case, I need to figure out what's blocking it.

So, what happens is is you have this wound. It keeps causing problems. you need to heal it, but every time you try to talk about it and heal it, you go into a negative cycle. Now, now I need to understand what that why you're going into a negative cycle. What are you really trying to say to each other? Um, and I'm going to get down to the helping them communicate the deeper issues around that. And some of that might be you being able to share, you know, look, I had this horrible health issue. It was traumatic for me.

Um, but your partner also might need to go get some professional help being able to engage more emotionally. Yeah, he we are both getting professional help separately, but we are working through your book together. Okay. Um but if I try to search for any emotions that he might have, the answer I get is almost always I don't know or I don't remember. Okay. And you might say if you might use your own empathy and brain to kind of understand what he might be feeling like maybe he's I don't know the context but like nobody goes into negative cycles without feeling something right.

El ciclo se compone de una secuencia: algo que dice o hace una persona genera una necesidad de apego no satisfecha, esa necesidad produce un sentimiento doloroso, ese dolor produce una emoción protectora (enojo o ansiedad), esa emoción produce un comportamiento, y ese comportamiento dispara el mismo proceso en la otra persona. Desde ahí, el ciclo se retroalimenta en rondas sucesivas.

Sometimes some couples will have, you know, one to three different iterations of a cycle, but even those different iterations are going to be going to re involve some sort of consistent pattern. And the great thing about this is if we can figure out the pattern, we don't have to just keep looking at the different topics. Oh, we got to help you talk more better, you know, we have to help you make a decision about finances. We help to help you make a decision about parenting. We have to help you make a decision about um getting married.

We're going to start with partner one. Partner one now feels unheard or betrayed or like getting messages of failure or less than. It doesn't matter what the topic is. It really doesn't. All that matters is this. Okay, this starts the trigger. And so if you see here, we have the trigger. Whatever the partner does or says and bam, partner one is feels emotionally dropped, alone, afraid, unloved, unlovable. In this place, we have a lot of emotional pain. We have a lot of unmet attachment needs um that are not being consciously seen or have words put to them.

Okay. So now partner two in a very typical cycle is going to get messages from partner one. Now I'm be I'm failing. Uh now I feel ashamed. Again, there's not a lot of words to this. I don't feel like an equal. I feel misunderstood. I feel unseen. Anything that's painful and vulnerable and an unmet attachment need. And so that partner one's behavior now dips down into partner two's ouch. So now partner two has an ouch and partner one have an has an ouch. and nobody's really talking about the ouch or helping each other or themselves with the ouch.

And nobody's being heard. Nobody Nobody's being misunderstood. They know they're here. That's not It's easy to see this. You can't deny this. They have limited experience of this and almost no conscious awareness of this. My job as a therapist is to go down into here and start shifting this so we can shift this so they don't have to keep going back into the same place over and over and over again. Um all right. So why does this happen? Again, you know, each partner is bringing this stuff to the relationship that makes them likely to get stuck in these cycles.

And then you want to take action. And that's when you go into contempt, contemptuous behavior. So yeah, we're just organizing all of the horsemen into cycles. Um, and um, what can one partner do when they recognize the negative cycle starting and they try to stop it, but the other partner doesn't notice it yet and may be even feel controlled or resistant to the attempt, no matter how well-intentioned or gentle it is. Okay. So, I would need to know what's blocking that partner, that second partner from being able to pause and kind of pull out of that.

That can open the other partner up to being interested, they can see some value and they can, you know, when one partner is showing up at their as their best self, it does kind of sometimes put the other partner in a position to see what they're not doing to do their fair share because now there's less to blame. Um, again, it can create emotional safety where they feel safer and that makes them want to do the work. But ultimately, if one partner is simply uninterested in working on the relationship, that is going to be a big problem that you'll then have to say to yourself, hey, we can't get better if they're not kind of meeting me where we need to be, and now what do I need to do with that?

We got to get them really not self-abandoning their own emotions. Um, and being able to show up for self more so that they don't have to go into these same strategies for safety. Um, and we really got to get them to own their their part and and really see. It's not just about owning. It's about really being able to see. And then once you can see, it's pretty easy to own. Um, and then over here, we got to get this avoidant attachment. We got to get some of this shame stabilized. Um, we got to get, you know, when you're when you're trying not to keep when you're trying to keep things from getting worse, what you're doing is not facing problems.

Um, so then Cassie now because of this, this takes her to a place of despair. It takes her a place of feeling betrayed. These are big words, I know, but this is what happens in cycles. Cassie has felt this pain in her life before. She grew up in an environment. She had other partners who truly didn't really care about her needs or not enough of the time. She felt betrayed. She felt abandoned a lot in her life. This is a painful place for her. She re Mark's name. She relies on Mark to help her out with her feelings.

Are you feeling like they're not really seeing you? Are you feeling like they just don't care? You know, there's some attachment need there that is not being met that's causing your trigger. So, I want you to start just getting grounded in the fact that there's unmet needs going on. And then I want you to know when this need goes unmet, what is that emotional experience for you? Does it does it take you to um you know a sad place? Does it take you to a lonely place? And I want you to kind of try to focus on the deeper emotions, right?

And then if you have advanced negative cycle, I'm going to have um on the recording of this, I'm going to have a worksheet attached where you can complete the anatomy of a trigger worksheet for each partner. I'm going to have like a fill-in- thelank so each of you or you can fill it out for you and you can even try to fill it out for your partner if they aren't to understand them better. And then you're going to transfer that into the negative cycle map to just start to get a better idea of how this is all playing out with each other in the cycles.

Right? If you're, you know, feeling so unsafe in your own body that you can't actually help your own emotions enough to show up for your partner in the right way, then I need to figure out how you might need some extra work with self-regulation or whatever. And then I need to work on your partner's side. like what are you doing in the relationship partner that is contributing to your partner who has traumas um inability to show up for you? What are you doing that's that's kind of perpetuating the unsafety?

you know, I have my own ideas about what that healing would look like, but um if someone is just gen genuinely saying, "Look, I cannot feel safe enough in my body to show up as my best self in the relationship," um then I would say, "Look, that's that's a problem, right? If you so we we need to figure out what you need to go do to be able to show up in in your best way." Um and how can we get your trauma to not hijack your nervous system? That could be somatic work. It could be any kind EFT individual work.

So if someone a couple comes to me and they say, "Hey, we keep going into these cycles. Part of the reason we go into the cycles is because we all have all this unhealed wounds that you know I'm carrying around all this resentment and it's getting in my way of showing up as my best self. Then I'm going to say the first thing I'm going to say is what happens when you try to talk about the wound. Well, when we try to talk about the wound, I start feeling invalidated and he he starts feeling attacked and I we both start feeling misunderstood and we both start feeling like it's unfair and we just end up it goes nowhere and we either get in a fight and so we we just learn to try not to talk about it, but it keeps showing up and I'm going to say, "All right, well, let's talk about that then."

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch5 Parte 1 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 20.014. Texto curado integrado aqui: 9.085 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activacion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

And then to not feel anxious, insecure, and angry, I have to defend myself. But then I'm now in that protective place trying to take care of my own needs. I've now left your needs and now I can't hear you. And then they show up in a way that now, you know, leaves partner A feeling like, well, I had something important to say and now I feel completely dropped and neglected and invalidated. And that causes more insecure, anxious, angry, and/or angry. And then they go back into their move and on and on it goes.

And so we don't want to um work on just kind of resolving every single topic in the right way. Um, when we're doing relationship work, we want to work on stabilizing these patterns first because the pattern has to be stabilized before a couples can ever expect to find solutions to their problems together. Whether those part problems be related to, you know, logistical things in life or their emotional relationship or sexual relationship. Okay. And so then just to really quickly recap because I know most of you already know this information from the last chapter, but you know we have this protest and accuse and then that from partner A over here and that causes partner B to feel all these bad things and then they get angry or anxious or have some urge to take action and then they do you know any number of these ex moves with their feelings, stuff it down, get quiet, try to fix it, get mad back.

Um, again, because I'm anxious and angry, and what I want to do to not feel alone, afraid, disconnected, and all this stuff, I want to protest to get you to see what you're getting wrong. That's the goal, right? The the protective urge follows the protective and reactive feelings. I'm trying to offset all of this. If I can just protest and get say the right words and get loud enough or get rationable rational and intellectual enough and put the right evidence out there enough and I can just get you to see what you're getting wrong.

So, it is important to take a break. I know this is very hard because a lot of times the more anxious partner, you know, the the more I'm sorry, the more avoidant partner is is taking they're they're more comfortable with that break because that's where their way of escaping. Um whereas, you know, and then that kind of leaves the anxious partner feeling abandoned. So, we have to do it in a way that's safe. So, the goal isn't to escape. The goal is to put a pause on it that we're going to come back to.

But most of the time if we're in a cycle, it's not working. Um, but if you'll just change what you're doing, then I'll get to feel safe and secure. That's the need. I'm needing safety and security. I'll feel better. I won't feel alone. I won't feel afraid. I won't feel disconnected. I won't feel unseen. I won't feel dropped or misunderstood or betrayed. I'll feel safe in secure. Um, however, when I'm doing this, all I'm really doing is

sending you the message that you're failing or you're misunderstood or you're being invalidated or you're being unseen.

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Um and again it's not that any of these feelings are wrong. It's not wrong to feel irritated or angry. It's not wrong to feel disconnected or anxious. It's wrong if you're not talking about it in the right way that doesn't go into a negative cycle. That's when it becomes I don't know if wrong's the right word, but but not productive, bad for the relationship. So again, none of these things are wrong. It's how are we going to go forward and communicate when all this stuff wells up. Um if you have an urge to start launching in and fighting back and protesting or or defending, um that's a problem.

Well, that doesn't land well on this partner who was already triggered and trying to be heard. So, they get more upset and then on and on it goes. And another example of more specific information is, you know, partner A somehow sends a message of failure to partner B. You're failing. You got it wrong. You did this wrong. um either they're, you know, del uh not deliberately, but either they're um obviously sending a message of failure or partner B picks it up as a message of failure. Either way, partner B now I feel misunderstood and unseen that makes me anxious, insecure, and maybe angry.

And that's the relationship work. But so again, we can't go change the past of the childhood, but we can kind of grieve through some of that. Um, we can learn to show up for self now. Part of showing up for self now is dealing with your own emotions in healthy ways and meeting your own needs and learning how to behave in new ways when those needs and all that pain gets activated. And then the relationship work um I'm almost done with the um anxious attachment which is also appropriate for disorganized attachment course that I keep talking about.

If the goal is to escape, that's really just another iteration of the negative cycle. I'm just trying to escape. Um, and then the anxious partner has to, you know, be willing their their work is to be willing to trust we can take this break and will be able to circle back to it. And I need to be able to kind of hold my own emotions right now um in the service of taking this break instead of going into that fear place where we have to resolve it right here and now. But it's not just about taking a break.

How's that getting in my partner's way? How's that getting in the way of our relationship safety and closeness? Um, okay. So, um, what if you do set up the structure and are willing to put your trigger aside to hear your partner out, but you still feel anxious and fearful in your body because your partner hears you out later, says the words that you need to hear, but never follows through on the actions or resolution, and now your nervous system is wrecked. That's the conversation. The conversation now is to um confront the fact that the words aren't being followed through with actions.

Tomemos como ejemplo el movimiento de protestar. El objetivo de protestar es que la pareja entienda lo que está haciendo mal, lo corrija, y así la persona deje de sentirse sola, asustada o desconectada. La lógica interna es: si digo lo suficiente, en el tono correcto, con los argumentos correctos, mi pareja lo entenderá y cambiará.

We're not wait hold on, we're not really enemies right now. There's this cycle going on between us and let's just, you know, see it for that right now." Take a step back. Um, you know, if you are going to name the cycle, it it needs to be done with safety instead of you're in the cycle or see, when you do this, that means we go into a cycle or, you know, it's your fault we're in the cycle and and just kind of go back into, hey, let's not let this cycle win, right? It's not you hating me. It's not me hating you.

Um, again, a big one is if I'm going to hear about the bad, I also need to hear about the good when I'm what I am doing that's working for you. Because your partner, you have a right to be able to express your concerns and disappointments. And your partner has a right to also get plenty of messages of where they are being successful in the relationship. How long is a break? And for the anxious partner, what if the avoidant uses it as an opportunity to let it blow over or has fear of bringing it up and not coming back to it?

So that's really recognizing what the impact of, you know, you have good reasons to do this and here's all the good reasons, not working reasons, but still, you know, it makes sense if you don't have any other way in your life to get your needs met that you would try to go here. Um, however, we also do need to recognize the impact on our partner. So then we repeat for them in in our mind like when they get the message that they're failing then they probably feel bad and then they get all worked up and then they try to blah blah blah to get me to change so they can feel safe and secure but then I get the message and then we just keep going back and forth.

Okay, we can't go to the past. We can't change anything about your childhood. Those needs were unmet. However, now you can learn to show up for yourself and start meeting your own attachment needs. And you can learn how in your relationship to create an environment that's going to increase the odds that you can start getting those relationship attachment needs met. Um, and of course, you know, that is also going to rely on your partner's ability to learn how to help you meet learn how to meet your relationship attachment needs and get theirs met.

That's going to help that place feel less alone. And then now let's take it to a relationship level. What am I needing in my relationship to offset this pain? How do I what's a better way to go about getting those needs met in my relationship than just kind of launching into these negative cycle moves? What do we need to do together to get to get there? So that's it. I mean, it's just, you know, again, you got to slow down with it. You got to find it in your body. You got to organize it, name it, make sense of it.

Um, but the the way that you would, you know, confront that, some some ideas of how to do that would be, you know, um, just putting really clear words to that outside of a cycle when things are safe, which is, hey, you know, listen, you know, we're in this relationship together and we're both going to, you know, part of being in a relationship is working to, you know, meet each other's attachment needs so both of us feel safe and close in the relationship and we are going to let each other down. That's just part of being in a relationship is sometimes we're going to let each other down and there are things that we're going to need to talk about that aren't working.

If we're, if the avoidant is using it to avoid, that's that's part of a cycle, right? That's just another way to be in the cycle. Um, and so I would need to know like what's getting in the way of that partner using the break to also tap into their own stuff. Um, and the fear of bringing it back up um, needs to be talked about. What's so scary about bringing it back up and what might happen if we don't come back to this? What what are you trying to avoid here? Because whatever it is, it makes a lot of sense and I want to know more about that.

Um, okay. First of all, let me Katrina chat me if we have anybody who wants to come on. We don't right now. Okay. Okay. So, Okay. So, Angie says, "Thank you for all you share. Your book and podcast have made a huge difference for my husband and I. I'm so happy to hear that. It's so so good to know it's making a difference and I'm really just very happy that you're feeling better." Um, I relate to the anxious and my husband relates to the avoidant. When we are in a cycle, he will try to validate what I'm feeling with a single sentence said in a very flat tone.

Then there will be a lot of silence as I'm still feeling hot and he'll repeat the same sentence in the same flat tone. Any suggestions of what to do at that point and keep the process going to deescalate and repair? Yeah. So, the first question I'm going to ask as the therapist is what is getting in the way from him emotionally engaging from his word? I mean, emotionally engaging along with the words, right? Um, so

probably that means that he's not emotionally engaging with himself. And when he doesn't know how to emotionally engage with himself, he's going to have a hard time understanding what's going on with you because he doesn't understand his own inner world.

Okay. So given that you understand this concept um now we need to figure out well what do we do with this right okay it's one thing to know we have these negative cycles um so there are kind of three steps to managing negative cycles one is just preventing them to begin with learning to create this attachment friendly environment in your relationship so you go there less often to begin with um two is to repair them when you do have them like, "Oh, yep. We messed up. Let's figure out what happened and make a repair so we can learn from each this experience and learn more about each other and what we can do better going forward."

I need I need to know we're a team. I need to know you can see me and understand me. And then you know those aren't met at the bottom of the barrel here. And then that brings up painful feelings, despair and sadness. I feel betrayed. I feel defeated. I feel really alone. I feel sad. I feel disconnected. And then you know you're going to go into these fear and powerlessness and fear of the future. Fear this will never end. And then that's when your body is going to want to take action. Right? That take action says, "Ouch, this stuff hurts."

Um, I need for, you know, before I'm going to go forward with a couple into the deeper layers of the work. Um, I really need for them to each be able to verbalize. When I hear this from you, this attachment need goes unmet and then my body goes into this vulnerable place and then I get scared and that's when I try to just tell you what you're doing wrong or that's when I just pull away and disconnect because I'm trying to make just escape from the pain of all this. Um, and when they can really see clearly how this negative cycle is playing out and what's going on within each of them individually in the cycle, then they're ready to, you know, start moving into the deeper stages of the work.

Okay. So, here's what it might sound like. So when I get the message and here's the unmet attachment need that I don't matter to you whatever it is that I'm not being understood or seen by you. I feel and then we have the vulnerable part of the anat anatomy of a trigger. I feel alone. I feel afraid. I feel disconnected. That's a painful place for me. And then my body responds to that by getting anxious and angry. And that's my body trying to um you know do take action, do something. It's my body telling me take some action here to make this to to get away from this pain.

Um and this is one way to get yourself into that headsp space. Um what can I do differently as someone with unmet attachment needs? Well, you you know what you're going to have to do differently is a figure out what those attachment needs are um that aren't met um from your past and figure out how am I going to get those needs needs met now, right? As an adult, now I'm walking around. I didn't get these attachment needs met in my childhood. Um I don't know how to meet them myself and I'm not getting them met in my rel present relationship.

You know, it there's so many different ways to show up for needs. Um the first thing we have to do is feel the pain and figure out like listen to it. Um you might need to do body work to to help yourself. You might need to um do better self just physical self-care in the world. You might need more support in your life. You might need more um spiritual work. you might need um to learn how to, you know, do breathing exercises to calm your nervous system. Um but it always is going to start with feeling the pain, making sense of the pain, and figuring out what this pain is trying to communicate to you.

That is the opposite of just having it be there in this vague way and acting out on it in all these ways that aren't working in your life. Um, how can I interrupt a negative cycle and regulate myself when I dis feel dismissed or triggered? If the dismissal keeps happening with every emotional need, what's the way forward? Okay. So, you know, all negative cycles are going to involve feelings of dismissed or triggered. That that's why they're negative cycle. You wouldn't have a negative cycle if you're not feeling dismissed or triggered.

Is the partner sending messages of not being successful that you know maybe need to b be balanced out with if we're going to talk about the negative, we also need to talk about the positive. How can I help the partner deliver this information that is going to be the most productive? And then you know what is it about if if your partner is kind of letting you down or messing up or showing up in the negative cycle in ways that aren't working. What is happening for them that it doesn't end with oh my partner's expressing a need and I you know my work in the relationship is to kind of figure out how I can work on my end to help them get that need met.

And let's say you start and you help your partner express what it is about sex that helps them feel safe and close, right? The way that you might be talking about it is in this cycle way, which might sound like, well, I just need sex. I'm a man or whatever. That's how I feel. Or doesn't have to be a man, but um I that's just how you know um I feel good in the relationship is to have sex and you never want to have sex. And if you'd have more sex than this, and then you start going, well, I need emotional closeness and I don't want to feel open to sex if I don't feel emotionally close.

You know, hurtful words. If you're finding yourself there, you're in a cycle. Sometimes there's just tension in the air. Sometimes the cycle isn't so much in an active state, but there's tension in the air that you're acting out on. You're distancing from each other. You're being passive aggressive to each other. You're avoiding each other. You know, that's more of an avoid avoid cycle that will probably turn into an a more escalated cycle later because the tension is eventually going to reach a point where it gets addressed.

Defeatedness is is needing a feeling of of being empowered over your own, you know, your own well-being. um and or or being heard or whatever it is that that feels defeated. And then you have to kind of, you know, get get more clear about what that's needing. And once you're you have a little more clarity and you're able to listen to it and figure out what it's needing, then it's like, well, how can I show up for that need? How can I show up for my feeling of of being alone? Right? Maybe I need to just sit with myself and not abandon myself in this place.

It's a painful place. Let me just sit with that for a minute and be there with that and and not just rush over that feeling. Let me just feel some of that in my body. Give it some space. There's some sadness there I need to sit with. I need to give that some space. Now, I need to figure out what what needs to happen in my relationship so that I don't have to keep circling back to this dismissed feeling. What's going on? How are we communicating with each other? that that keeps circling back to this.

What is my partner doing or saying that takes me there? What am I doing or saying that takes my partner to the place that they they then go into their place that leaves me feeling like this? What are we both doing in this cycle that's ending up in me feeling dismissed and them feeling XYZ? Okay. So if you're doing that work right and you're still, you know, circling back to dismiss, that means you guys aren't able to get out of those negative cycles. And so you got to keep, you know, doing the work, figuring, you know, communi coming back to each other and continuing to say, you know, we're we get stuck in these cycles and I'm still going to this place where I'm needing to be heard and understood by you.

Um, and that is the opposite of a negative cycle. Okay? A negative cycle is you saying, "Look, here we go again. And every time I bring up a concern, you know, you just kind of shame spiral, um, do you see the different ways that I'm dialoguing around that? It's like, here's what's going on for me. You know, I have this I when I feel unheard, that's a bad place, and we need to be able to reach each other. Um, and then that piece about taking turns is is huge. taking turns will get people out of negative cycles and we'll talk about that more as we go deeper

into the book and learning the skills.

There's, you know, there's a lot of opportunity there to help him emotionally engage with himself. just by saying, "Hey, listen. I really appreciate that you're actually willing to um put these words out here, right? Can you help me understand like why why are you using these words? Why are you using these words of validation?" Well, because I want us to not fight. Okay, that's really helpful. What about fighting doesn't feel good for you? and then see if we can open that up to it feels disconnecting and you know then maybe saying okay I don't you don't like to feel disconnected sounds like that's a painful place now he's emotionally engaging right or you might say you know have you ever felt invalidated in your life you know what was have you ever felt misunderstood try to get him kind of into that place of not feeling heard and understood on his own anything that's emotionally engaging for him is going to help him see you more emotionally.

I wouldn't try to prove anything. I would just trust yourself and be really clear. This isn't okay for me. It has to end because it is not possible for me to feel safe and close in a relationship where there's dishonesty. Um, and so we need to figure this out. First of all, we got to get him owning the behavior. If he's not willing to own that he's lying, there's no way to get around that. Okay. So, we have to somehow figure out a way to say, "Look, I need to go forward here. I need to know that you're with me in this and that you're willing that we can work on this together.

It's going into a relationship with this information is great because you're not having to do all this cleaning up stuff later. Um I if I had my way, every every couple out there that you know um has decided to be in a committed relationship together, I would have them do a few couples therapy sessions just to understand or read the book, whatever it is, just to understand their negative cycle. just to understand here's what our cycle is. If you've been together for any length of time, it's already taken on some energy.

El problema es que la protesta le llega a la pareja como un mensaje de fracaso, de invalidación, de incomprensión. Eso activa a la otra persona, que entonces también entra en su propia secuencia interna: siente que está fallando, se pone a la defensiva, y sus conductas resultantes le llegan a la primera persona como abandono o invalidación. Y el ciclo continúa.

Um, and then the third thing is learning how to interrupt them when they do happen. Um, and I start in the book with interrupting them because my assumption is is that all couples are going to have cycles, um, negative cycles. We don't, you know, we don't really ever, most couples are never going to fully escape them for lots of good reasons. You know, life is a work in progress and um sometimes we're tired, our resources are low or we have triggers in our relationship that are over, you know, we haven't dealt with before and our our capacities for coping get overwhelmed and we don't show up as our best self.

And if whatever it is going on with you has to do with the relationship and the message that you're currently getting from your partner, really good sign you're in a cycle or heading for one. Um, if you have like an irritated feeling or an angry feeling, any kind of painful feeling that is kind of about the relationship but not getting directly addressed um is probably getting acted out in the kind of words and behaviors that define a negative cycle um or can go there relatively quickly. Um, if you're feeling like you're communicating and and you feel kind of disconnected or an urge to disconnect, um, for some people it can feel like kind of a drained feeling or a tired feeling.

This is what's really happening in these cycles. All you're all couples are seeing when they're not consciously aware of this these patterns um both between them and inside of them is they're just seeing this part. Okay? And if you're just seeing this part when you're interacting with someone anyone, you're not it's not going to go well. Okay? And so we really need to get more awareness that oh something else is happening. we need maybe if we stop trying to just do this and we start trying to address and communicate about this we can get somewhere here.

We're both triggered. Something important's happening. We both have something important to say. Let's not let this negative cycle beat us right now. And then the other, you know, kind of basic interruption is to take a break from it, right? Because here's the thing. If your nervous systems are escalated, probably, you know, unless you're a couple that gets is really good at co-regulation, which is going to come kind of later in the book. If you're a couple that doesn't quite know how to do that so well, um, and you're just learning this stuff, it's probably better to take a break than to go into these cycles that can, you know, you're you're risking creating more trouble and damage in the relationship if you go down that road.

So you can have the feeling in your body, learn how to slow down, okay? Because if you're not slowing down with those feelings, you're just going to act out on them. So you're going to sit there with them and then you're going to, you know, figure out, listen to those feelings. Okay, I I do feel kind of defeated right now. And when I feel defeated, that's a real sad place for me. I can feel it in my body. And what is that defeat needing? What is that loneliness needing? Well, we can assume that loneliness is a needing a feeling of connection.

That's where I would want to know what happens. Let's, you know, later when you're not in the situation, you might want to go in and say, "Hey, listen. You know, I know we go into these cycles. you know, we go into these cycles and we got to figure out a way to interrupt them because wouldn't it be nice if we didn't have to keep doing this over and over. You know, one of the ways I know that's, you know, I'm trying is to kind of name it so we can do something different. But something important comes up for you, I can tell because when I name it, you know, that doesn't seem to land well with you.

So, now we have to figure out what is that dismissed or triggered needing. What is dismissed needing? It's needing to feel heard and understood. Right? That's the opposite of dismissed. dismissed as unheard, misunderstood and not responded to that feels bad. So just first of all getting clear about what that isn't is what unmet need is in dismissed, what pain is in dismissed right now. You got to be able to kind of show up for yourself there. Wow, this dismissal feeling really hurts in my life. I've felt dismissed a lot.

You can try medications. You can try avoiding certain foods, you can try all of these things, right? And that doesn't necessarily mean all of these things are any of these things are going to work. We can increase the odds by trying different strategies, but ultimately if the things we're trying aren't working, we need to figure out a plan B and keep figuring out what we need to do. Sometimes that's accepting and learning to live with things not being perfect. Sometimes, you know, when it comes to the relationship, that might look like maybe we need to break up.

Um I guess I struggle and the last part is I guess I struggle with addressing my own concerns and disappointment because it sends my partner into shutdown. Yeah, see that that is a problem. You need to be able to have space to in a healthy way express your concerns and disappointment without them going into shutdown. So again, taking turns communicating about how that's impacting you and also giving them the space to talk about, you know, why they're what they're needing to not have to shut down, what they're needing more of in order to be more open to your concerns and disappointments.

So what do we have to do to get there is he needs to be more emotionally engaged with self meaning he needs to be able to kind of tap in recognize what happens to him when he gets messages. You know what what happens in his body. We got to get him into that body place. Um, if you've watched the podcast or listened to the podcast, that would be kind of what I did with Drew is just help him learn to emotionally engage with himself so that it's not just putting out the words there. Um, however, I would make sure on your end that you are at least um responding to the fact that he's trying right there.

And then of course, you know, the flip side of that is for you to be able to, you know, give that again, if we're going to talk about what they're getting wrong, we need to talk about what they're getting right. Kind of give that, hey, I see the growth just in the fact that you're willing to move out of your old cycle moves and at least give me those words of validation. And there's something really helpful in that. Um, you know, at the same time, you know, I know that we need some more emotional connection.

Okay, I'm just going to do a couple more here. [Music] Um any suggestions for an avoidant avoidant cycle and the break? we both often don't want to come back to it. Okay. Well, if you don't come back to it, it will come back to you, right? Um unresolved issues will maybe they'll go under the rug for a while, but they will continue to flare either in the same topic or the pattern in a different topic. They will cry to be met, to be taken care of. Um so just know that. So maybe the conversation with each other is look, we can either choose to address this topic with intention.

if they're saying the words, they probably do, but something gets in their way that they don't have words for. How can we help them get words to whatever it is that they're block? So, we have to know, they need to know how you're impacted. Um, we need to um have make space for understanding what's getting in their way and how are we going to work together or how what work do they need to do to overcome that block? Because the consequence of the block I it makes sense to me. I get it. You're scared.

- Necesidades de apego no satisfechas: ante ese evento, se activan necesidades del vínculo que no se están cumpliendo. Por ejemplo: necesito saber que estás ahí cuando te necesito, necesito sentir que somos un equipo, necesito sentirme visto y comprendido.

Las necesidades de apego que no se satisficieron en la infancia no pueden modificarse retroactivamente. Pero en la adultez es posible aprender a estar presente para uno mismo y a construir condiciones en la relación que aumenten las probabilidades de que esas necesidades se satisfagan ahora.

you know, the two ways ultimately everything kind of circles back to getting out of it, um, meaning either interrupting it or preventing it is just making more space in your relationship for vulnerability and healthy assertion. And as we go through the book, we're going to talk more about that. But just keep those two words in mind because that's really everything that we're doing here is getting better at expressing and holding vulnerability and expressing and holding and responded to responding to healthy assertion which some people might say you know the word boundaries or being very clear about needs very clear communication.

All right. So again, you know, we talked about this last time, the negative cycle or these patterns of communication that couples get stuck in where, you know, someone gets triggered. These triggers usually aren't just out of thin air and isolated. They're not just about the moment at hand, but they're also about relationship history and even history from, you know, your past um the partner's past. And then so they get triggered and then they act on the trigger, not with vulnerability or healthy assertion.

Um, that's their body kind of collapsing because all of a sudden I'm not feeling safe anymore and I'm feeling overwhelmed. And instead of their body going into activation and do something, their body does the opposite and goes into just kind of collapse and escape inside. Um, now what why is that a negative cycle? Because if that's you or your partner and you go into that place, now you're sending the other partner a message. I'm not here. I'm gone. I'm I'm out. I'm checked out. And that's going to trigger them.

So we have we have this triggering event. You know the your partner's late again or your partner is not sticking to the budget or your partner is putting their um you know extended family you perceive they're putting their extended family above you or they're you know not parenting in the way that you feel comfortable with. And so you know you get triggered or they get triggered and then we have these unmet attachment needs. Okay. So that's I need to know you're going to be there for me when I need you.

And it becomes much easier to interrupt what you can actually see to begin with. Okay, I'm going to answer your question, Angie, but I'm going to wait here um because I want to I want to stick with the slide and then we'll move into kind of more more specific or more general questions. Um, okay. So, one way to interrupt it, just kind of a basic way when you're really just learning this stuff is is just to name the cycle, right? Just to say, "Oh gosh, this is it. This is our cycle." That starts to externalize the problem from, "Wait a minute.

If you just would do this differently we'll be okay and they're not really able to see clearly what's really happening in these communication cycles. um you know they they do tend to go into this protective where we're we're enemies of each other place. And so the way out of that is the reframe that this is everything I'm teaching you is the reframe. No, that's not actually what's happening. What's actually happening is this negative cycle that is fueled by all these unmet needs and pain that we're not able to communicate about in a healthy way and reach each other over.

I'm really getting really getting close to getting this done. And that's going to deal with that middle part of showing up for self, which a lot of people that grew up in homes where they did not get their needs met have no idea how to show up for themselves. And that really is you cannot separate that ability to show up from with self from the relationship work. Relationship work requires that you can first show up for self. Um, I'm going to see if any of these have Okay, so I'm going to go ahead and finish this out, which I think it's finished.

It just becomes natural to them and in a you know, they they might not consciously go through all these steps. Sometimes as adults when we're learning things as adults, we have to clean it up and make it more organized. So because it's not just wrote um what if you are getting better at interrupting a negative cycle and you make a pass but your partner does not get it and continues in the same vein to escalate. Okay. And sometimes I do this as well. So now once we understand this negative cycle is happening and we understand some moves to interrupt it.

Um, is it something to do with the way they're interpreting their delivery? Is it something to do with the fact that something is triggering them about the fact that you say, "Hey, this is a cycle. It doesn't take them to a place of safety. Instead, it makes them feel unsafe and then they keep going." What is it about that that's unsafe? again, is it your delivery or is it the fact that when they hear, you know, your delivery is as perfect as possible, but when they hear we're in a cycle, they hear we're in a cycle and you're to blame or whatever, something about those words aren't safe for them.

So, help me understand what happens there, right? Do I need can I say it in a new way? Can we learn new ways to kind of try to reach each other in ways that feel better? Um, or is there some meaning around the negative cycle that doesn't help you feel safe that we need to talk about here? So, again, you know, if you don't have a professional helping you work through whatever these blocks are, um, then you got to learn to how how to have those conversations with yourself, with each other, I'm sorry, to work through those blocks.

They will be um really helping the partner that isn't allin be understood and feel safe and kind of exploring around what's going on with not allin. You have some good reasons to not be all in here. Help me understand helping them because ultimately that's their anatomy of a trigger. allin is the behavior. I'm I'm kind of staying distanced from this because I've have stuff coming up in me that it doesn't feel safe to be allin. So that's what the third party is there to do is to process not allin which is the exception to the negative cycle.

Um um so yeah, so I I'm going to keep answering the question self needs um in the same way. It's showing up for yourself. It's a big concept. Um, and it's being able to access your feeling in your body, being able to talk to yourself in a new way, being able to put words to

your feelings, being able to sit with them instead of just trying to escape them. Figuring out what these feelings are needing to be healed, figuring out ways that you can start approaching your painful needs in your own personal existence to help them be met.

How can we make that happen? you're still going to this place where you're needing to be heard and understood by me. How can we continue to work to make that happen? Now, that a lot of that work is going forward in the book. So, I'm not going to put a lot of that information out here now because we're just in this part where we're learning how to kind of triage and interrupt it. Um, but you know, the the skills going forward in the book are how couples can get out of these cycles so you don't keep feeling dismissed.

The two aren't mutually exclusive. We can want to feel successful and still be behaving in ways that aren't going to get us there. So, first thing is what is this partner doing that is not successful, right? How are they contributing to the fact that they're not being successful? What do they need to do differently to send messages that, you know, show up in the way that helps you feel safe? Okay. So, I need to look at their role and then I need to look at the partner's role in them not feeling successful.

Why does it go to oh no I'm an abject failure? Okay. So, I would want to know more about that. Why does normal appropriate relationship concerns take them into a shame spiral if that's happening? Um, so again, I'm working with both sides of the equation. But the idea that I don't want to feel unsuccessful does not mean that they're not behaving in ways in the relationship that aren't working. Um, so the second part of your question is how do I confront that in a way that allows you to feel how to confront that in a way that allows you to feel and honor your disappointment but doesn't make them shut down and respond with I can just never do anything right for you.

Okay, great question. You know um again what is what if that is theirs that no matter how perfectly you deliver the information they are going to shame spiral that is their stuff that you know could come from their past of you know negative messages growing up that you you get something wrong. It's not it doesn't just end with you did you messed up let's fix this. It it goes to you are wrong you messed up because you're a loser. You messed up because you're bad. whatever it is. Um, so we would I would want to work with what's going on on their end.

And then we're going to later we're going to do that with me. I need for you to kind of be open to me expressing what's going on with me. And that's when you have the opportunity to say, you know, I I need to be able to reach you with disappointments that we're going to it's a normal part of relationships. Um, and when you kind of, you know, go off into your I'll never get it right spirals, then I feel abandoned. Okay. So, it's, you know, kind of what I'm saying here is naming the problem. Um, figuring out as a team how we're going to go forward with fixing this so we can reach each other with concerns.

Breaks, I think anywhere from 20 minutes to a day is appropriate. Um, depending on the unique circumstances. There's no right or wrong answer. Sometimes things might need longer. I like the 20 minute as a minimum because that's how long you you know and I don't know for every situation but that's the minimum amount of time it takes your nervous system to kind of settle in. Um you need that 20 minutes to kind of tap into yourself and be like okay what's really going on with me? you know, organize the experience with the scaffold I gave you, which is when this happens, then I feel let down and that takes me to a painful place.

please help me understand, you know, why it's safe for you to just kind of move away from it and really be there and be open to hearing about what their resistance is. Really validate that, really show up for that. But then we got to switch over to here's what it's like for me when we have these concerns that never really get addressed. Um it, you know, that that leaves me feeling really alone with it and that's not working for me either. Um, so we need to figure out a way to do this with each other where you know we're we're I'm honoring what you whatever you need to be able to come back to it and you're honoring whatever you know my it's actually both of our needs to come back to it.

And since I don't want to go into these negative cycle behaviors anymore, I just kind of have to go off and be sad. And I don't like that. It's disconnected. can we work on that? That's very different than you need to you have trauma responses and you need to work on them. Um so that's one thing and then the other thing is I would you know move away from telling them that this is trauma responses and m lean into kind of trying to understand what happens what's going on with them. What um I mean if we want to stick with the word trauma response, maybe you could say what does it mean to you when I say those words.

Is there a guarantee? No. There's never a guarantee. And any of any no relationship advice ever out there in the history of all relationship advice has guarantees to work. We can only increase the odds. And leaning in is one way to increase the odds. So, I would just give it some time. Um, and you know, of course, if you're leaning into them, you that needs to be balanced out with eventually them being able to lean into you, right? But if your partner is the one not reading the books and unfortunately they have some sort of block to it, the only thing you can do now is to work on your side for a while.

It probably is part of his avoidance pattern. So, I do get kind of where he's coming from, but I don't know how to deal with it. Can you comment on that? Well, yeah, that's not okay behavior, and if it's ongoing, um there's just no way that you're going to be able to feel safe and close in the relationship with a partner who is chronically lying. So we have to know the first the first goal is that the lying has to stop. Um and that needs to be communicated in a really clear direct way. And I wouldn't rely on proof.

What's getting in the way of that? I don't know what it is because, you know, there's different things for different people, but that's the first the question is what is getting in the way? Why is it so hard for me to tolerate and be open to what they're saying? What, you know, what's going on with that? Then I would go into that anatomy of the trigger and try to organize yourself and kind of try to figure that out. Um, and then that might be the thing that you need to be held around. That might be need to be the conversation of let me just tell you what happens for me.

Um, there's no mandate that you have to, but if you don't, you know, then you risk kind of getting stuck in the same cycles over and over. So, um, again, that's not so much for now. That's more for later. And I know that's hard because to interrupt a cycle, you do have to have better words. But um right now I'm trying to in this phase of the book sort of again triage it just kind of let's just not let it go get so bad. Let's do some damage control here and then later we're going to fill in that damage control with diving deeper into the healthy strategies.

So, what do I need to do to get myself in a place where I can be vulnerable and take that step? I can take that risk. You know, there's a saying in my line of work, no risk it, no biscuit. Meaning, if you don't risk, you don't get the good results from the risk. For you and your partner, the risk is leaning into the conversation even with your scare, even when you're scared. understanding more about that fear, putting words to that fear, and then really recognizing how is this fear, how is how I'm trying to regulate this fear by avoiding how's that getting in my way?

you you get, you know, overwhelmed. You forget whatever it is. It makes sense to me, but at the same time, you know, it does it's not working. We got to figure something out here. Um, and I want, you know, to help you with that, but we got to figure something else out because, you know, it's it's getting in the way of the safety and closeness in our relationship. Okay, I think we're going to go ahead and stop there. Um, and thank you Forest for that. That's really sweet. Um, I do wish you the best of luck in your next relationship and it absolutely this information will help you be successful in that.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch5 Parte 2 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 13.698. Texto curado integrado aqui: 6.284 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activación' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Nothing changes until we can do that. Clearly, your partner is needing to do some work around their ability to either re-engage emotionally or stay engaged emotionally. And so, what you're describing is you're staying in a disconnected state much longer because you are able to disconnect. And that's kind of when I say sometimes people as they grow, sometimes the anxious partner can start to avoid more as a way to kind of, you know, offset the anxiousness. And sometimes it can take a while to find that balance between completely disconnecting and kind of finding this middle zone where you're not in the anxious state, but you're able to stay in there a bit.

I've moved to a more secure place in my previously anxious response, and I now self soothe, calm down, and try to communicate from the self. But with some triggers, it takes me a long time to get myself calm, and we stay in a disconnected state much longer. My avoidant partner keeps their distance still. Any thoughts, suggestions for how to help this? Yeah, that's a great question. First of all, congratulations that you are able to get more secure in yourself. That's amazing. That is absolutely the first step here.

There's a course on my website about the anxious avoidant dynamic that might actually be a little more useful. And if not, something about the negative cycle in the Wednesday night group. And Katrina can dig around and find out what that is. Because the first thing that we want him to know about is this is a cycle. This isn't him trying to fail or do something wrong. It's this cycle that's come up between the two of you that you know you both are contributing to and there's a really good reason he needs to go into avoidance because that's somehow a safe place.

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So my interpretation is if I go talk to someone about that like in this case needing to feel valued then I won't have the problem anymore and he won't have to help me with it. So that's kind of my question is what is that about when he's you know go go over there and work on that and then come back when you're done. What do you think that's about from his anxious point of view? What it is is he is completely out of tune. I mean out of I don't know if out of tune is the right way. It has sounds like and you can correct me if I'm wrong like very little awareness of the value of emotional needs being met and probably has very is very disconnected from his own emotional needs and his own emotions.

And you can tell him, look, I want to hear you. I want to lean into you, but I also to feel safe doing that consistently, I'm going to know I'm going to need to be able to be heard, too. So, we got to we got to really work together here on this. How do you deal with the relationship maintenance fatigue when you're the recovering anxious partner that is married to a recovering avoidant? I would need to know more about what that relationship fatigue is all about. Why is it feeling like such hard work?

If there is a resentment, is there is still a relationship? My spouse has resentment toward me and it's hard to accept. Ye. Yes. And maybe I should I should qualify that. So, usually resentment in an ongoing relationship means that there is an investment. Now, I'm going to pick I'm going to pick apart resentment versus anger. Reactive anger is typically crying for help. Reactive anger is yelling and whatever, protesting or calling names. You know that those strategies are trying to get your partner's attention, try to bring attention to the problem, trying to show your hurt because there's no other way to get the hurt through.

And so sometimes, a lot of the time when avoidants don't know how to show up there, their comfort zone is just to stay to stay out of it. I don't want to go there and feel unsuccessful or like I don't know what to do and so they stay disconnected. So the first thing is that we need to get your avoidant partner emotionally engaged. And that needs to be, you know, really clear to them that, hey, look, I'm doing my work over here. I'm working on, you know, calming my own self, soothing my own self, and that's great for me as a person, but at the same time, I need some connection in our relationship.

Okay. All right. Let's go to next, which would be Angie. Hi, Angie. Hi, Julie. Hi, Julie. Thank you. You're welcome. So, I had a question about something that comes up during a negative cycle. I'm more the anxious and my husband's more the avoidant. So, I've been mainly raising our kids for the past 25 years. And recently, I was gone for a week. And I asked him that while I'm gone, can you notice how I contribute and let me know when I come back. Basically, I was asking him to appreciate me while my I'm gone and verbally tell me.

I've seen from your post that as an anxious person, I need to feel valued. We've been doing some of the work together. So, I was able to kind of share that word with him. But when I came back, he didn't say anything. Okay. And then he said like, "Oh, I'm glad you're home." And then about a week later, I brought it up. He's like, "Oh, I forgot." And I feel like that's common. Like I'll have asked for something specific. And he forgets. Okay. So my question is then as we're talking, he says, "Oh, I think you need to go talk to someone about that."

you're saying, "Look, I'm really struggling staying with him because this this pain gets so big." So you you're going to need to figure out what is that pain about. You know, that's when you're going to go into that anatomy of a trigger chart, which is when I'm having to stay with him, like what message am I getting? What does that bring up in me physically? Is there a fear there? Is it a fear I'm never gonna be heard? If I stay with him, I'm just never gonna be heard. If that's the case, what we know that fear needs is it needs experiences of you being heard, too.

It's super hard. I don't I definitely don't protest and scream or act out or anything, you know, like like I used to. I don't get like that triggered or reactive. However, even when I I think we've been in a negative cycle for so long that even when I approach him very calmly with something that's like in a positive way, not a criticism, he hears it as criticism regardless. Okay. Um low fuse, whatever. And then more recently, he booked a trip, a family trip to go see his family back home. And the dates had to get switched because of his exwife schedule.

So, just two options there. Wish I wish there was a third. I wish the third option was somehow we can connect in this space. So, it doesn't have to be awkward, but that's what we're, you know, you're working toward and you're just not there yet. Okay. Okay. That's helpful. You're welcome. Okay. So, let's go to Douglas. Yeah. Thanks, Julie. And I got to drop off here in a second. Okay. For a work meeting, but so I can come back to this and I just want to make sure this was an appropriate question to ask at this time, but so I'm an anxious avoidant and my exartner is a I'm writing.

A few days is just way too long for a relationship to be safe and healthy. we need to get you guys some help where we're figuring out why he's needing to go away for a few days and what why is that his safe place? What's going on that's motivating those days? What it's a it's a function of a negative cycle. So, someone's going to have to help you understand that because the way he's dealing with his pain is just going away. There's not, unfortunately, there's just nothing I can say that's going to help you feel safe and close in the relationship if you know that at any given moment he's going to go away for a few days.

It's like what? Okay, option A is that we don't have to do this, but we don't know how to not do it any right now because we haven't learned. And then so option B is how can I care for myself as a human, as an individual and not have to, you know, of course I'm going to be sad that my partner can't show up for me, but how can I not just kind of let it like completely ruin my life? Like how can I kind of stay engaged in my life? Some of that is going to be feeling your feelings, feeling the feelings around, you know, the despair and sadness around him being gone instead of kind of staying in an anxious energy if that's what you're doing.

I'm not saying that's abnormal. It might just be a part of your growth. But to get through that fatigue, we need to figure out what is the fatigue. Is it fatigue because you're constantly having to manage your own triggers and not go into a negative cycle and it takes a lot of emotional pushing down? Fatigue that you know, I don't know. Usually when I hear fatigue, it's just the emotional fatigue of the work. What is so hard about it? What needs to happen to make it feel easier. It's hard. It's hard to answer that.

So talk to journal, talk to a friend. Anything you can do to get out of that stuck anxious anger down into the vulnerability below it. Feel some of those painful feelings. Support yourself in whatever way feels good for you. There's so many different ways to support our emotional pain. I mean, you can call and talk to someone. You can journal about it. You can just sit with it. You can exercise. You can take a bath. You can go get a massage. You can again I think probably the most effective co-regulation strategy really is connecting with other people.

El enfado reactivo es una señal activa de que el apego sigue presente. Quien grita, protesta, llama la atención sobre el problema con intensidad emocional, todavía está intentando alcanzar al otro. El enojo en ese contexto es un intento de recuperar la conexión, aunque tenga formas destructivas. Es un indicador de inversión.

So, okay, I hope that was helpful. Let me go to our little chart we're making because I want to add some stuff from what Douglas said, which is and I'll send this I'll put this on the website by the way, which is why aren't we okay? Healing is repeated experiences of something new. Build up interactions with met attachment needs. That's what that is so important. You know, the more you can make those those interactions positive cycles instead of negative cycles by meeting each other's needs, even though it's hard, we got to we got to figure out how to deal with those triggers that block that, the more trust we'll build and the more healing will happen.

And then maybe we can say, well, that was an emotional need. Like you have those needs. See, you're we're learning that you have these needs, too. And then that's kind of opening it up. And then eventually we want to take that to you know I understand I want to I want to help lean into what happens for you when I send these messages you're failing but I also want you to recognize that you know one of the ways I feel filled up and supported is knowing I'm valuable and it's going to take patience because we can't have him go to you know a to g which is being disconnected from his own stuff and then remembering to show up for you.

That's healthy assertion. When in early dating with someone, first date time frame, and you arrange a call and they don't call. The next day, they said they fell asleep, but no apology. Do I raise this or let it go as we barely know each other and see it as information? Now, I don't want to end up with him thinking he can do this, but I don't want to appear too anxious or unreasonable so early on. I just wanted an apology for the disrespect on my time. Yeah, I would I would use that as really important information.

Cuando el miembro ansioso de la pareja trabaja en sí mismo y aprende a autorregularse, puede empezar a crear más distancia como estrategia para no recaer en la ansiedad. Es un ajuste comprensible, pero puede desequilibrar la dinámica: la persona que antes protestaba ahora desaparece más, y el miembro evitativo se queda sin la señal de alarma que antes lo activaba (aunque sea de forma reactiva).

And I don't know if you're if you're able to do that yet or not, but regardless, what you're finding is your avoidant partner isn't coming forward in that disconnection and trying to help you out with filling up that distance. So, we do need for your partner to be able to do that. That that's part of their work of bridging the gap in that in the relationship work. you know, your partner might be I'm I'm going to trust that your partner isn't purposefully keeping their distance just to randomly leave you abandoned or not, you know, not do the work, but they haven't done the work on themselves to really know how to emotionally engage, know how to fill that distance.

So, so the way I was answering that question that I just finished answering is that when I said, "Hey, you know, I'm doing my work over here and it's really helping me and but I'm going to need you to do whatever you need to do to step into that space." That's healthy assertion. Okay? That is the healthy assertion piece. It's not saying I'm doing all the work. You don't do anything. You're not addressing your trauma. There's truth to all that, right? But that is other focus. It's just focused on telling them what they're doing wrong as opposed to really standing up for your own needs and saying, "I need for this to happen.

Because right, I I'm pretty good at that. But what I'm uncomfortable with is when I'm in the same space with him or Okay. So, what I like to say to people sometimes is like, how would you be with anyone if you didn't feel super safe and close? You just kind of light and polite, not expecting a lot of emotional connection because your body's going to be blocked to that because you don't feel safe with them. You know, I don't know where he's at, but think you it's just what I call light and polite.

It makes a lot of sense to me and just fully lean in, that's what makes it heal." And of course, we have to change the behavior or whatever relationship shifts need to happen, negative cycles stabilized and stuff so the resentment doesn't keep building. But sometimes that's a piece that people miss is that there's so much value in the vulnerability, but there's not space for the vulnerability consistently if we don't dissolve that layer of anger and resentment. And the only way we do that is just anger needs to be validated.

And so then the question becomes, well, how do we get there? And you know, there's there's there's a lot to be said for that. You know, how does how does anybody develop emotional awareness? Well, first he's got to have the motivation to do it, right? And a lot of times people don't have the motivation because not because they're trying to be obstinate or they're not, but because they don't see the value in it. They it's so far out of his playbook. He's always stayed safe by staying in his head and probably, I don't know, working, hobbies, this the stuff avoidance do to feel successful in the world.

And are is that something that you're wanting, too? Are we are we on the same page here? Are we in alignment here? because if we're not, you know, I I don't know if this is going to work out. You really need to honor your own need to have health, right? And that doesn't mean that you just drop him. It means you talk to him about it. See if he's willing to see that. See if he's willing to own some of that and see if he's willing to most importantly work on it. If he is willing to work on it, the possibilities are endless.

This is a hard place for me. I don't like it. I've felt here like this before. I've felt dropped and alone before and it's a terrible place." And kind of feel some of that sadness around it. Sometimes when we just make space for that sadness and cry it out or whatever, it starts to relieve. It's better than staying stuck in useless anger and anxiety in a moment that's not going to really help you get your needs met. At the same time, that anger does need to be processed. But the problem is you can't process it in the relationship because he's not there for you right now.

And so the only way you're going to know is leaning into it and seeing if by leaning into it, it starts to resolve a bit. You also we also have to work on what's causing this resentment. Doesn't necessarily mean you have to stop doing X, Y, and Z. I don't I don't know. But I do know somehow some shifts need to be made either around your behavior that's causing resentment or their unrealistic expectations of your

behavior. Something needs to shift so we're not building up more of it. And then we need to heal it that you heal it by validating leading into it with the understanding that if you have resentment, you also need to have space for that to be held and heard too.

Una vez que esa pequeña apertura ocurre, se puede cerrar el círculo: "¿Notaste que cuando yo me incliné hacia ti en ese momento te sentiste diferente? Eso fue una necesidad emocional siendo atendida. Tú también tienes esas necesidades." La progresión es: apertura al propio estado, reconocimiento de que ese estado necesita algo, y transferencia: el otro también tiene necesidades similares.

[Music] Hello everybody. I said last time that what we're going to do is do it do part two of the negative cycle chapter, which I believe was chapter five. Pardon me if I'm getting that wrong. Sometimes I get confused about the chapters, but it was the introduction to the negative cycle chapter. And so I thought instead of doing another presentation since I already laid the information out there, we could just sort of talk about the homework, which was to assemble your, you know, anatomy of a trigger for yourself and for your partner or have your partner do it there on their own and then kind of lay it out and map it out to see how this negative cycle plays itself out between the two of you.

And I'm really seeing that that's going to require for you to do some work to re-engage emotionally, and we got to work on this together. What is how's that going to look? What's that going to look like? Because as I make more distance to to help us, I need for you to help us too by stepping toward me in that place. And then how do we do that? Well, we do that by, you know, doing the work I've laid out in the book, which is working on your understanding his trigger. So he and assuming it's a he, your partner, working on their trigger to understand more about what to talk about to fill that distance.

Let me put that in our in our notes here. Okay. So, this is going to be one note both for health as an individual. Okay. So, this is just an important note here. Some of you might already know this, but you know this there's two p pieces to this work and and three pieces actually, which is you got to do your own work to show up for yourself. Just like the person who asked this question was describing, I'm doing it. I'm doing it right. And that's great and there's so much value in doing that. Just forget about the relationship value for yourself as an individual, but for the relationship health to be on board, both partners eventually need to be able to do this.

Feeling very sort of betrayed again because I keep having these repeat attachment injuries. They're happening like every week like like multiple times a week. But this one was a really big one because are sorry Colleen let me just interrupt you here. I want to make sure that we're not getting into territory that I can't contain in this environment. So well my question yeah I just have a question then. So my question is we're in this place right now and I don't want to go back to the negative cycle.

So, and then I I just you're going to have to really lower the expectations of any kind of emotional support. And what is left over surface level conversation? And what is left over beyond that is I don't want to go into that. That's awkward. That doesn't feel comfortable. I don't want to have to go to a dinner where there's no emotional connection. And so the other alternative is to not go to the dinner. But the the worst thing to do is to go into it and expect to get some emotional connection that you're not going to get.

I don't like the trigger. I don't like the trigger. The trigger is I we're it's awkward. The trigger is we feel disconnected and I'm just going to keep giving you the same two options because there aren't anymore. Keep working on it if if you feel like that's getting you somewhere. fun, try to take care of yourself and the environment, light and polite. If you have to be around him, don't just get rid of the emotional expectations because he can't show up for you right now. And then two, or move yourself out of the situation until you guys get to a better place.

He doesn't have success with vulnerability. So why bother going there? So now we need to kind of get him to buy in to the fact that hey there's some usefulness here. And we can either do that by telling him there's value and hoping that lands or we can you know another way to do it is by giving him experiences of feeling emotionally held. So that that puts the work on you. I do understand this and you're not a therapist, but as partners, we we are, you know, responsible to some degree to helping each other with our emotions.

I mean do I think do you think give him some of that? What I would do is I would be curious about why he wants you to go talk to someone. That's his emotions. I would be like, "Well, what feels important about that?" Because what he's saying is, "I don't know how to help you. I don't know how. I love you. I want you to get help." And oh, here's a great solution. Go talk to someone else. Right? Or I don't know how to help you. And I don't want to stand here continuing to feel like a failure because that feels bad.

And, you know, whatever it is. And then later, because you need space, too, later, a day later, later that day, so it doesn't feel fit for tat, go in and say, you know, listen, I'm really working here. I'm leaning into you. I want you to have that. I want you to feel heard and understood, you know, but I I got some things to say, too, and sometime I don't want to end up feeling alone with that either. So, would you be willing to kind of hear me out? That's that's the way to do it. And if you're saying, "I don't bring up his behaviors because they aren't as much of an issue."

I mean, I I think too there's there's space to say just to stand up for that. And I mean, we can't guarantee that he's going to go, "Okay, I won't do that anymore." But standing up to that in a healthy way is, "Hey, that's this isn't this isn't okay." Like, I I this is really not going to work for me. Like, I can't feel safe in a close to you if I if I never know when you're just going to go away because we get, you know, stuck in this place. So, we're going to have to get some help here. We're going to have to figure out a way that we don't keep going back to this cycle because it's just not working for me.

I wouldn't try to push past that. We don't know where he is. We don't know where he's cap what he's, you know, his capabilities are as far as being able to to respond to that request for an apology. I don't know if you asked for one, but we don't know yet. You're just getting to know him. And you you're you say, "Okay, like is this an isolated event or is this part of a bigger pattern?" And if it is part of a bigger pattern, then another conversation, which is probably not I mean, unless he's willing to like see these things and you've given it some time and you say, "Hey, look, there's so many things I really like about you, but you know, it's really important to me to be in a healthy, authentic, open communication relationship and about things that aren't working for us, including what's not working for you."

So any one that else you have in your life to give you that support. And then the biggest piece here is doing the work on the relationship to figure out why we keep going back to this block. What's this block about? How can we get it to the point where I don't have to self soothe so much because we do have more space for this affection in our relationship. All right, I'm going to do four more minutes here. In the book, there's an example of a trigger around feeling your partner distant themselves.

Like, I would not like that either. So, I apologize for my role in this. And then, you know, later you're going to need to come back and say, you know, we got to figure figure this out. I want to be able to lean in and hear you, but you know, I need to talk about what comes up for me, too. Because, you know, if you're not distancing, we're still in a place of disconnection, and it still feels really bad. So, we still need to work on how to bridge that gap in these moments. What are you needing in there?

And so you and the hurt ends up coming out in anger. That is usually a a sign that a strong sign that there's still investment. I'm still trying to reach you. The anger is still trying to solve the problem. When people stop caring and they stop they lose their attachment. They stop being angry. They either do that in the relationship because they get to the point where there's no point and they just kind of check out or they the relationship ends and they have to go through a period of anger later until they get through that and then eventually people get to a place where they're not so mad anymore.

And the only way you'll ever know is to validate it. That we have to trust that there is a very good reason that your partner resents you. I don't know what that reason is. I don't know how much of that reason resentment is related to stuff from their past. I have to assume that there is resentment around the negative cycle stuff that you both contributed to. I have to because very rarely do I see a couple where the resented partner doesn't have a role in being resented. Okay. However, you probably have your resentment too and that also needs space.

La afirmación saludable es plantear la propia necesidad en primera persona: "Necesito que esto ocurra. Para sentirme seguro y cercano en esta relación, esto tiene que pasar." No ataca, no acusa, no pide que el otro cambie porque está equivocado, sino porque hay una necesidad real que no está siendo atendida.

El miembro evitativo que no reconoce el valor de las necesidades emocionales no es indiferente por elección consciente. Suele estar muy desconectado de sus propias emociones y necesidades. Alguien que no puede identificar sus propios estados emocionales tiene dificultades estructurales para reconocerlos en el otro.

La confianza no se construye con declaraciones de intención ni con compromisos verbales solos. Se construye mediante la repetición de experiencias concretas. Cada interacción en que una necesidad de apego es atendida -donde uno se siente escuchado, visto, validado, comprendido, o que el otro se inclina hacia él- es un dato que el sistema nervioso registra.

Cada vez que dos personas logran tener un intercambio en que las necesidades de apego de al menos una de ellas son atendidas, se produce una experiencia que contrasta con el patrón negativo habitual. Esas experiencias son el material real del cambio.

Ceder en necesidades legítimas desde el inicio para no parecer "demasiado" produce el resultado opuesto al buscado: instala una dinámica en que esas necesidades nunca tienen lugar, y la experiencia emocional que sigue es exactamente la que se quería evitar.

And you know, I have also the podcast where I take the avoidant partner through that process of re-engaging so he can understand how to re-engage emotionally and fill that distance. There's other resources out there that meant to help people become more emotionally engaged. So anyway, I'm just reading this and I'm reading, hey, I'm doing the work on my end and it really actually is helping. So I think the next step is just that avoidant re-engagement piece. One second. Okay. Okay. Any follow-up questions on that?

Our situation is, I guess to just put it like quickly, like we're having blended family problems. My stepson does not accept me and my husband's way of dealing with it has been basically to exclude me completely from his life. He lives in our house and every time they do anything together I'm completely excluded. Did we talk have I talked to you about this before? Briefly, but not I mean a birthday party. I think I had a question. So anyway, we haven't really made much progress. We are still working through our negative cycle stuff and it's really compounded because although I feel like I've made a lot of change, I'm still triggered at times when, you know, like I'm literally excluded in my own home.

I think we're doing much much better and I don't want to do that and at the same time how do I show up in this relationship for the next 3 weeks before this trip and then after the trip knowing it's coming feeling hurt. Do I just pretend it's not happening because I there's no point in talking about it anymore. Like I tried to ask Jamie but our session was over and kind of couldn't get to that. She said obviously, you know, we're not talking about big heavy things until we have our next session.

Okay. Says he's frozen. She said he's frozen and he's blocked and she can't get there. Another good reason he can't be there for you emotionally. So when someone can't be there for us emotionally and we are reasonably sure we don't want to get vulnerable with that, there's no point in it. Hopefully as you continue to work with Jamie, she can help keep opening up space for vulnerability so you guys can get there. But, you know, you're giving you're you're listening to me a lot of really good reasons why um you're not going to be able to get support from him.

I don't know how to navigate that. Maybe it's better that we don't go to dinner." You can choose to go to dinner and keep it kind of surface level. I mean, I'll tell you the two things you don't want to do in dinner is try to get super vulnerable and expect him to be able to lean into that and validate you and hear you and give you emotional comfort. I would definitely avoid that. you you have really good reason to believe you'll just end up getting dropped. I don't know. I'm assuming that he's not going to open up to you because he's frozen.

And then really giving space to taking turns, you know, especially if there's past stuff that needs to be addressed. Another really important thing that sometimes gets missed is is leaning into each other's resentments and angers, not staying stuck in there, making sure that we're dealing with the stuff below it. But if we if we aren't talking about those resentments and anger, then they're just going to they're never going to go away. And so we really need to be able to, you know, sounds like you're kind of more deeper into the work right now, further along than she is.

So you might just have to say, "Hey, you know, I know we both we both got some resentment." Understandably, resentment shows investment. If you don't have resentment, that means that the attachment is severed. So I would say just I want to be here for you. I want to hear about that. Let's make some space for it. Because if we don't talk about it, it's just that energy is just going to keep being there. And usually when you can lean in and really say, "Hey, I get that resentment. I get that anger."

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch6 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 17.232. Texto curado integrado aqui: 7.864 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activación' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Their needs don't matter, unheard, invalidated, which is going to cause a yucky feeling in their nervous system. Those with anxious and disorganized attachment are typically very overwhelmed by that yucky feeling in their nervous system. They know it's there. They feel it all the time. They're used to it. Those with avoidant attachment have it, but they're numbed out of it. They're disconnected from it. They don't have access to it. They don't have words for it. And then those with secure attachment, they know it's there.

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So, even I do that with my kids. If my kids come and they're complaining about, you know, school, I'm going to listen and validate that and sit with them. But then I always say, look, if we're going to talk about the negatives, we're going to have to also talk about the positives because we want to avoid just getting stuck in that negative energy. And so sometimes people, you know, especially people with an anxious attachment, they have a tendency to be very very aware of when their partner fails them because they have been failed by relationships over and over and over in their life growing up, adult relationships, maybe the current relationship.

But at the same time, you know, we both are in a relationship together and we are going to have concerns and I really need to be able to bring those up without that toxic shame that you carry kind of taking over, right? So, how can we do that? because I don't want to tie into

your childhood stuff because that's not good for you, but I also don't want to give up my own needs because that's not good for us or the relationship either. So, there's a way to kind of heal shame by frontloading and say, you know, giving them the opposite of shame, which is acceptance of who they are.

And then the third thing is, shoot, I forgot the third thing. What was the third thing? I just had it in my mind. I lost my train of thought. The third thing is getting really clear. helping him get really clear about what the shame is. Okay? Because shame is a very global word. Shame is always going to be rooted in negative self-beliefs. Okay? So, we need to get really clear about what those negative self-beliefs are. So, if you bring up a concern to your partner and they shame spiral and you know they're shame spiraling because of their behavior when they shame spiral, they're defending themselves or they're over apologizing or they're just trying to tell you what you want to hear.

Maybe they are, you know, really trying to hurt you. Maybe they are, you know, not caring about you. But the odds are high that there's a lot more going on with it than that. There the odds are exponentially high that there is also a lot of in attachment intention happening. Some people are just extremely narcissistic or sociopathic and they truly don't care. That is not what's happening with most people. And so when we can really keep repeating to ourselves, protest is fighting for change. They're fighting for closeness in this protest.

And I'm willing to kind of give you the mic here. Just know that we're going to have to come back to my stuff later because otherwise I'm not going to feel like I was heard. So, the person in the attachment needing role, they're needing their attachment needs met. They're needing to feel heard. They're needing to feel understood. They're needing to feel some kind of responsiveness. And the other person, their role is meeting those needs. Doesn't mean doing what they want you to do, but it does mean hearing them, validating them, empathizing with them, trying to understand where they're coming from.

But please don't feel bad about leaving a situation that was really not working for you. I am an anxious style person and my spouse of 32 years, wow, is an avoidant one and we are recovering from a long betrayal where his avoidance apparently where his AP apparently by AP do you mean a fair partner? Yeah. Okay. Was a little I get confused because of all these attachment initials or whatever. So a fair partner apparently was a good listener. I am having a lot of difficulties accepting that and every change I or we need to make seems to remind me that this recovery is going to be long and who who knows if successful journey.

However, if what you're saying is one of the things that they weren't getting enough of in the relationship is feeling heard, then it only stands to reason that maybe we can build that up in the relationship so they don't feel the need to cope with that pain by having an affair. And so what do you need to do to become a better listener? But what do they need to do? Because I'm certain that they were doing their own things in the relationship that contributed to you not being a good listener. And you were doing your own things in the relationship that contributed to whatever was happening for them that contributed to you not being a good listener.

[Music] All right. Well, let's go ahead and get started. So, we're going to go into chapter six of our Secure Love book club. Does anybody have any questions for me before we get started about the content or anything from last week? turn my phone off. All right, let's go ahead and jump in then. All right. So, this one is chapter six, which is preventing the negative cycle. So, I'm just going to give some insights into that. And the way that you're going to prevent a negative cycle is you're going to create an attachment friendly environment.

And sometimes that means prioritizing their needs over your own, obviously. But there is a healthy version of fawning, right? And that's collaborating. It's it is the willingness to maybe let's put my needs to the side temporarily or some of my needs to the side so that I can join you and some of your needs. And then we have this unhealthy freeze response which is just, you know, freezing up and not doing anything. And that can be hard because most people aren't doing any of these consciously. Their bodies are just habitually go into it because that's what they're you're used to.

If you know that you're just someone who freezes up, instead of freezing up, you might need the break. Be assertive about taking a break. That's not freezing. Being assertive and saying, "I need a break," is not freezing. It's communicating. If you're someone who has a tendency to go into flight, your work is I'm going to really be intentional about trying to keep myself regulated and stay engaged. Moving away from that just habitual get out of here, shut it down place. All right. So we're going to start with you know what's what's in this chapter is this system called evicting shame right so when we are communicating with each other in a way that minimizes shame shame is kind of the root of all the problems right if we're minimizing shame because shame leads to you know loss and abandonment loss of the relationship loss of sense of self Right?

you know, it doesn't necess just because one person has a need to feel heard and understood and validated doesn't mean the other necessarily does. But if what you're saying is is that person is waiting weeks or months because they don't want to deal with their emotions, they don't want to deal with it or they don't know how to deal with it, that that's problematic because we're not addressing a problem. And so that's going to those emotions are going to show up in some other way, right? Emotions will show up.

Can we start to make more space for flexibility just by putting some of those fears into words? Can you define what emotional safety is? Just to clarify, yes, emotional safety is feeling first of all, it starts with a nervous system feeling of calm, relative calm. Sometimes it's not completely calm, but just relative calm. It at ease, safe, not in a state of yucky fear and all angsty and agitated. That is not emotional safety. That means your body is in some sort of fear state. It's it it's an open feeling.

If I can look through it as what attachment needs is my partner trying to express to me right now that we need to get better at meeting either through the work from our relationship or their own selfwork, whatever it is or a combination, how can we actually get those attachment needs met? That's a much easier thing to accomplish when you know how. Okay, so here's where I was right here. And so I'll go ahead and go forward. And we kind of already talked about this, but again, we're we're talking about, you know, viewing your relationship through the attachment lens as a means to create attachment friendly environments.

Yeah. Like you, you know, want your partner to be more validating to you, right? You you want more emotional validation from them. And a controlling approach is kind of like in an inner interaction and you're expressing something to them and they're not emotionally validating you. And so right then and there, your control need gets activated and you start saying, "No, I need you to stop what you're doing. You're supposed to be emotionally validating me right now. This isn't going well. Here's what I need you to say."

And what's going to be the impact on your relationship? And even better, have your partner do this exercise or if you're here as a couple, both of you do it. And because it because this needs to be do be done on both sides of the street. However, if only you're doing it right now, that's okay. Your partner might not be here doing that this work. Eventually, yes, they need to be doing the work, too. But as I've said over and over, a lot of times when we start doing this on our own, the relationship just starts to become safer and healthier and our partner will start growing with us, too.

All right, that's that. Let's go ahead and talk about questions that you guys might have. I have some in my Q&A. Fearful avoidant spouse and I'm in AA. Can timing also and I am AA. Oh, I see what you're saying. You're not in AA. You are avoidant. Can timing also be by weeks or months? I think as an FA he struggles with dealing em with emotions. I mean, I think it really depends on what it is. Sure. Yeah. I mean, I think if if one person doesn't have an urgent need to kind of express themselves around an issue, then maybe we wait for that need to come

up.

Well, if it keeps happening, right? And every time it happens, you feel really awful and it causes you pain. And if you've done selfwork around it and you recognize, okay, what if what if the trigger around this is kind of more related to my issues than in my own some of the stuff I came to the relationship with and it's not as related to them. Like when you've done that selfwork, which by the way, the I did finish my part of the anxious attachment healing course, which is also appropriate for disorganized attachment.

It can come from sex can be emotional. Can create emotional safety because it's communicating. I'm wanted. My needs matter. I'm being cared for. I'm being invited in. I'm being trusted. Nonverbals can communicate in a way that creates emotional safety. Affectionate touch can be communicated in a way that creates emotional safety. And then all of those things I just listed can all verbal, sexual, affectionate, touch, non-verbals can also communicate in ways that leave a person feeling, you know, devalued.

and do doing that by meeting each other's attachment needs in those interactions, which is going to create more positive emotions, less negative emotions. So, when we're creating an attachment friendly environment, just remember we're doing that in interactions. All right? And so what attachment friendly environments do, and we'll talk about logistically what that is in a minute, but they prevent disconnection. They enhance bonding. They meet attachment needs. They resolve surface problems or make it much more likely that those surface problems will be resolved either in that interaction or in future interactions that sometimes some problems need a little more space and time and conversation.

They assist in healing shame and they assist in healing past wounds. All of that material prevents negative cycles. So, one of the things is, you know, when you what I love about attachment theory and the reason that I use attachment theory in my professional and personal life is because I believe that it is the attachment theory is the closest science has come to really explaining relationships, what makes them work, what makes them successful, and what makes them unsuccessful. And so when you can kind of stay grounded in that mindset that every single thing you're doing or saying to your partner and every single thing they're doing and saying to you, it has some attachment meaning or need embedded in it.

So we we do need to move out of them. But when we can view them through the lens of attachment, it's so much easier to see why those behaviors are happening. And when we can see why they're really happening, it's so much easier to figure out what needs what what are these the needs embedded here? What needs to happen differently for us to be able to shift out of that so we can get those attachment needs met in a different way. If you're dealing with how do I get this partner of mine to stop being a bad person and a jerk, that's a tall order.

I can see my partner's in pain. Let me kind of ground myself in that before I go forward here. And it doesn't mean you have to leave your own emotional experience. It just means that you're able to kind of hold both. All right? I don't like feeling misunderstood. That hurts. But I can also lean into their feelings here too. That is emotional maturity. And emotional maturity I think probably starts with empathy to be honest. Empathy is very regulating also. It gets you out of your own fear and you know dysregulation and gets you into you know someone else's stuff which can be very regulating can turn down the heat.

And they need to understand that. And you at least need to have the space to have that conversation to, you know, I insist that we we have have a much bigger conversation about this and come up with a plan. And then if it needs to go into demand and it's a deal-breaking situation in the relationship, I mean, that, you know, who knows what the consequence of demanding is. But if you're, you know, in a relationship that is sometimes demand, the consequence is, hey, this has to end. I can't live I can't live like this.

whatever it is to avoid their own shame. Now, we need to figure out what is the self-belief that's being activated by your concern. A common one is a partner who has concerns at all. I I there's no space for concerns. Growing up, I had to maintain the status quo. If I didn't maintain the status quo, I wasn't a good family member. I I didn't fit in. I was bad. I was broken. There was just something fundamentally flawed about me. And so now in this relationship when I get messages I'm getting I'm failing because we all fail in relationships sometimes.

This fear of vulnerability is is here for a good reason, but it is actually getting in your way. We need to help her understand the impact on herself. There is a massive impact to self when we're not able to be vulnerable. There is a massive impact to our partner when they're left out. And there's a massive impact to the relationship. So, there is some value here in learning how to be vulnerable. And people are typically more able to take in and understand that value when they're not being shamed for their fear and their resistance.

And that sounds like a big job, but if you think about a relationship is not just this big global thing. It's actually a series of repeated interactions. That's what a relationship is, right? That's why relationships can, you know, get healthier or get unhealthier because we we want to know what the quality of each of those repeated interactions are. So, if you really look at this intentionally and say, you know, I'm going to really work here to not worry about the big picture, but just worry about the next interaction, doing the best I can and working with my partner so that they're doing the best that they can to maximize the health of that interaction.

And but there is a healthy version of fight which is being assertive. It's it's not giving up your needs. It's just communicating those needs from a place of assertion and clarity instead of fighting. Unhealthy fawn. That would be like you know the unhealthy version of people pleasing which is really just trying to get someone to be happy with you so that you can feel safe. That's the the goal. You kind of willing to put maybe your needs to the side. you're even willing to put their needs to the side just so they'll be happy with you and you'll feel safe.

That is the root of the problem. So we we need to have our communication be in a way that is helping shame not develop and even sometimes healing the shame in the interaction. Right? And so I have the little system called evict shame. And so that's going to be empathy, validation, influence over control, curiosity, and tolerance. So empathy, you know, just some things about empathy. If if you can just when you're going into some sort of triggering event with your partner or you're in the triggering event, being able to kind of first step back and access some empathy.

Sometimes the anger part of an interaction. If someone is the type of person to just stuff their anger and never talk about it, it can be very vulnerable for them to start putting words to that in a healthy way. I say sad words and I say fear words and shame words because it's not just I'm sad. It's, you know, I just feel kind of hopeless and I I'm feeling a lot of kind of despair right now or I feel in these moments I just I get to a point where I feel really helpless and I don't know what to do and that takes me to a fear and then I I get scared that if I don't answer your questions in exactly the right way, then you're going to be disappointed and more mad and that's a scary place for me.

I think that there could there is probably going to be a period of time if you this is new to you and your relationship with your child. I think there need does probably need to be a period of time where you are kind of exclusively showing up for them and if especially if there's kind of some wounds around that and just kind of creating safety, right? adult children are adults, but there's a there's a little bit of a, you know, it's not so black and white because they're still your child and they were historically were your child and, you know, there maybe was some stuff built up.

So, I would say give give some space to create safety, but then yes, eventually, you know, the idea is that you grow into more of an adult adult relationship where your needs start to matter, too, and you're able to say, "Hey, listen. and I love you and I know you know this is it can be really hard for you but like it here's how I'm impacted when you you know are you you know giving me the silent treatment or whatever

they're doing that is not meeting your needs and if there's in this process when you're trying to create more safety with them if there are serious boundary issues right like they're screaming at you and you know really being out of line then that's a situation where there's an argument to be made for saying, "Hey, I'm here for you."

Both parents were conflict avoidant and the oldest sibling is a narcissist. Defensiveness, justification, and minimizing of emotional concerns was the norm. Everyone had to maintain the status quo. He is now very aware, courtesy of your book, Glad. Thank you. that his family dynamic was unhealthy. How can I make sure that I am not creating a situation where I'm adding to his toxic shame? He is truly a nice person. Okay. So, the way that you can make sure that you're not creating toxic shame is by not communicating in a way that is shaming to him and on top of that communicating in a way that is deshaming.

It's a comfortable feeling in your body. And how do you get there? Well, humans get to that place of emotional safety by feeling heard, feeling like their needs matter, not having to worry about feeling, you know, overtly attacked, feeling like they're valued by the other person, feeling emotionally validated. Those are all ways to be communicated with that leave your nervous system feeling safe. You don't have to get there verbally. Emotional safety doesn't have to come from verbal interactions.

Their retreat is not about trying to retreat from me. It's about trying to avoid the pain and shame they feel around disconnection. Getting loud isn't them just trying to not care about my needs and overpower me randomly. It's just fighting to be heard because being heard is part of feeling safe and close with me. Their defensiveness is fighting to be seen in a more positive light. Their hurtful words are fighting to communicate their pain to me. If they can get me to hurt in the same way they're hurting, then I'll know what's going on and I'll understand their hurt and I'll be able to show up and help them with that.

And so, we really have to get into that mindset that I don't have control over my partner. And the reason for that is sometimes we need to grieve. We need to grieve a situation where our control is actually limited and recognize as much as I want my partner to change, I can't control that. But what I can do is do my best to create an environment that's influential and try to influence them. When we get control out of the picture, a lot of times it just opens up a lot of safety. It removes a lot of pressure.

They've they have truly experienced feelings and moments of emotional abandonment. And what happens when we've experienced that kind of pain over and over is we start to be on the lookout for it. And it's not bad to be on the lookout for it. It's bad if being on the lookout for it is taking up all the space in your relationship and causing you to filter everything they filter for the negative and just kind of define them by their mistakes. The idea being if I can catch your mistakes, then I can tell you what you're doing wrong right then and there and you'll change and then I won't have to keep going back to that painful place that my body knows or I won't have to start going in this relationship back into that painful place that my body knows.

It's just are they going to show up in a healthy way or a not so healthy way. So I would encourage your partner to have to kind of figure out a way to start doing this and with health and not waiting weeks or months to to face these things. I'm a parent adult child. I'm a parent adult child relationship. Okay. Would it ever be appropriate for the child to hear the parents needs or is it always the responsibility of the parent to empathize, validate, be curious about the child's needs? Yeah, the good good question.

I'm conflicted with feelings of guilt for giving up on it, but was so empty from not getting my needs met. Okay. I first of all, if you were miserable, that's that's an and especially if you know it was just a couple months. Oh, 18 month sorry. You don't have to have you don't have to have any you don't have to feel guilty in my opinion for giving up on a relationship that was absolutely miserable that you were suffering and that you had tried hard. You you deserve more than that. I know there are some situations where maybe there's other factors like you've been you have a family together and there's way more layers but of of the relationship.

Yeah. So if what you're saying is one of the things first of all many many relationships have partners that aren't good listeners and the partner who isn't feeling heard choose doesn't choose to deal with that with an affair. Okay? So your partner and I think you probably know this but just to put this out there your partner chose to have an affair. the bad relationship could not the worst relationship in the world can't force to someone someone to cope with that by having an affair. It is not your fault that your partner had an affair.

It was a co-creation of some sort. So, we need to figure out what was what's blocking feeling heard in this relationship and how can we not do more of that. Okay, so that's one is to change the behavior that heavily contributed to the pain that caused your partner to make this decision to have an affair. And two is you've got wound healing to do. And that needs to be, you know, a wound healing conversation, which is chapter, I think it's chapter 8. Let me double check. I'm pretty sure it's chapter No, it's not chapter eight.

It's chapter nine is healing. Let me just double check that. Yeah, chapter nine in a couple weeks from now, three weeks is going to be attachment injuries and repairs. And that's going to walk you through the process that will need to be repeated over time. These these healing interactions, right, that need to be repeated over time that will lead to you guys being able to heal some of these wounds. And that of course has to be in combination with ending the behaviors that led to this stress to begin with and replacing those behaviors with new healthier behaviors that increase bonding.

And I'm am very sorry that you're going through that also. That is not a very very painful place to be. So I'm sorry that you're in that. Okay. So Q& A personal backstory, major generational trauma, abuse, and other family issues, black sheep, trust issues. That sounds pretty awful. That's a lot. First of all, just going into a relationship with all that. As a single person doing this work, how do I know when I need to state a boundary versus adapting to tolerating? Am I being taken ad? Well, let me answer that first.

I did finish my part of that, which was I think it's it's going to be a few hours long. So now we're just in the process of putting it all together as a full-on, you know, package. And so when I say you've done your selfwork, that course will really help you understand what I mean by that selfwork to begin with. And so you've done your selfwork and you you have yourself grounded in the bal a balanced perspective of your partner, then you really do need to address ongoing issues, right? Because if you're not addressing them then and you're continuing to find yourself, you know, over and over again repetitively feeling pain and then acting out on that pain in ways that aren't working for your partner, then that's a really good sign that, hey, we do need to set some boundaries around this or express yourself with healthy assertion.

In my experience with many many couples, it's probably a combination of all three. So, it's a matter of sort of picking through and going, okay, you know, what if this trigger that I'm feeling is am I maybe have an oversensitivity to because some of the past stuff I've gone through? What if this trigger is genuinely coming from my partner because of their stuff, right? And what if this trigger is a function of this negative cycle that we found ourselves in? Okay. My husband grew up in a complex home environment.

I'm failing. That takes me to that horrible painful place of I'm a failure. Okay. So now we have words. We have more words for the shame. It's not just shame. It's if I mess up, if I'm not perfect, that just takes me to I'm just a failure and a loser. And so now that we have more words to that, we can say, well, let me give you some reassurance here. Okay. I I expect that you're going to fail me from time to time in the this relationship. That's just what life is like. We're going to fail each other.

If I fail you, does that mean you see me as a big failure? No. And that's the same with with me. I need to bring up these concerns. That doesn't mean I see you as a failure. We just need to work through, you know, whatever it is in these ways that sometimes we slip up and fail

each other. And that is again addressing the shame in a more clear direct way. And that does take work on their part to kind of get more clear about that. My wife and I have been in marriage counseling for five years with six different therapists.

Hi, Genesis. Hello, Julie. How are you doing? Question. I'm good. I have a question regarding when you talked about control and I had a question if you can expand more on how control can imply the need for grieving for one of the people in the relationship and okay if you can also share about at what stage of the therapeutic relationship would you begin to explore more of that grief process with the client would that be before or after identifying the focus of the goal of the couple going to counseling.

And as we do that, we're now helping them experience safer ways to be with their emotions. Okay? And that grief is such a big one that we want them to have a lot of safety around their emotions in general to be able to go there. And then when we get them to go there, you know, hopefully they will be sort of trained to deal with emotions in a healthy way. So it's not just like, oh my god, overwhelming. They're flooded with it all at once, right? Also, they've built up safety with the therapist and they built up safety with their partner being able to be there for them in their pain without, you know, going into their own stuff.

El trabajo concreto dentro de cada interacción consiste en satisfacer las necesidades de apego del otro y en recibir satisfacción de las propias. Cuando eso ocurre de forma repetida, se generan más emociones positivas, menos negativas, y la relación se vuelve progresivamente más segura.

La teoría del apego ofrece un marco para dar sentido a los comportamientos difíciles. La premisa central es que casi todo lo que hace o dice una pareja tiene una intención de apego incorporada, incluso cuando la conducta es dañina o parece hostil.

Aplicar esta lente significa que, ante una conducta problemática de la pareja, en lugar de interpretarla como prueba de que no le importas, te odia o solo quiere hacerte daño, se busca la necesidad de apego que esa conducta está intentando comunicar o satisfacer de forma disfuncional.

- Ponerse muy intenso o subir el volumen no es ignorar las necesidades del otro. Es pelear por ser escuchado, porque sentirse escuchado forma parte de la seguridad y la cercanía.

Entender el porqué de un comportamiento no lo convierte en aceptable. Esas conductas dañinas deben modificarse porque siguen deteriorando la relación. Pero la comprensión cambia la pregunta. En lugar de preguntarse cómo conseguir que la pareja deje de ser mala persona, se pregunta qué necesidades de apego está intentando expresar y cómo satisfacerlas de otra manera. Esa segunda pregunta tiene respuesta. La primera, generalmente no.

Lo que ocurre sin buena gestión del tiempo: las parejas entran en conversaciones cuando están distraídas, cansadas o sin capacidad de dar atención plena. Una vez dentro, las necesidades de apego compiten entre sí: uno expresa una preocupación, el otro se siente incomprendido o eso le activa sus propias preocupaciones, las trae al presente, el primero se siente invalidado, sube la intensidad, y ninguno de los dos es escuchado. Todos están en el rol de pedir, nadie en el de dar.

Un solo miembro de la pareja a la vez está en el rol de quien necesita tener sus necesidades satisfechas. El otro está en el rol de satisfacer esas necesidades, lo que no significa hacer lo que la persona pide, sino escuchar, validar, empatizar y tratar de comprender. Luego cambian de rol.

Cómo se genera: los seres humanos llegan a ese estado de seguridad emocional cuando se sienten escuchados, cuando perciben que sus necesidades importan, cuando no tienen que anticipar ataques, cuando se sienten valorados y emocionalmente validados por la otra persona.

Todos esos mismos canales también pueden comunicar lo contrario y producir inseguridad emocional: desvalorización, que las necesidades no importan, que no se está siendo escuchado o validado. Eso activa una sensación de malestar en el sistema nervioso.

Invalidation is fighting to get your own needs met. If I can just invalidate your experience, then my experience will become more valid and then I'll get to feel safe and close. And then we have the positive ones which caring behaviors are also have massive attachment intentions. They're striving for love and closeness. Now, does that mean these behaviors are okay? Absolutely not. They're not okay. Continuing to do these behaviors, even if we understand the very good reason for them, will continue to damage your relationship.

When people feel validated, they truly are more capable of challenging their own perceptions. And then our I or I'm sorry, there's two V's here. The second V is vulnerability. Okay. So, we can't there's no way a relationship can be healthy unless part both partners are doing vulnerability, right? And here's why. Vulnerability is always part of a problem. It's always part of a surface level problem. It's always part of a communication problem. So, if we're skipping that piece, right, it's not the only thing we need to talk about in a problem, but if we're if you're skipping the vulnerability, we're not fully addressing the issue.

We're we're missing a lot of pieces. Not only are we not fully addressing the issue, we're not really getting to see all of each other. We're not having an opportunity to empathize. We're not having an opportunity to validate. So partners have got to learn to do vulnerability. I go into, you know, lots of examples of that in the book, but for the purpose of this discussion, then we can talk more about this later when I'm finished with the presentation. Vulnerability is speaking to the sad part of a of a interaction, the fear part of an interaction, the shame part of the interaction.

A lot of times people go into their relationships with their partner with that mindset, which is, you know, if they're doing something I don't like, I've got to take control, make sure they don't do it anymore. And that that approach just doesn't work at all well in adult relationships. You truly cannot force or coers your partner into changing even the worst behavior and the worst consequence that you could do. they're they're still an adult and they're still, you know, going to make their own decision.

A lot of times both partners are trying to control each other in similar or different ways. You also really need to if if you find that you're someone who's more controlling than you are trying to be influential, you might want to really step back and go, you know, what are the consequences here of staying stuck in this place of control? Well, first of all, what the biggest consequence is your own constant disappointment? Because people who try to control are constantly over and over going to be met with situations that they can't control and that's they're not going to know how to deal with that.

And so then we need to kind of ask ourselves, all right, where does my control end over this situation? Because sometimes we do have control over certain things. I don't want to go too far here, but we need to recognize the limitations of our control and when that control is not healthy. And then we need to move over into what do I have the ability to influence here? And that is an empowering place. Being controlling is a very disempowering place. Angie, great question. Would you provide an example of influence instead of control?

Influence is willing to let things sink in and simmer. Control gives away your power. Influence is empowering and recognizes its own limitations. Influence is confident. Control is scared. That's a good that's a good gauge is are you coming from fear or are you coming from a healthy place of assertion and intention. Influence is about self-expression and cooperation. Control is draining and fear-based. Influence puts the immediate goal of behavior change to the side in order to focus on connection.

Let's say your partner has a hard time opening up about their feelings, leaving you feel feeling shut out. A controlling approach is, "Why can't you just tell me how you feel? It's not fair for you to just shut me out right now if you're not willing to work on your avoidant attachment and start talking about your feelings. I don't even know if I want to be in this relationship." And in this situation, you're trying to control your partner and demanding they change right now. Influence would sound like, "I feel shut out, but I don't think that's your intention."

Timing, timing, timing. That means that what happens is couples who don't have good timing, first of all, they they set themselves up for failure by trying to have hard conversations and moments where maybe they're distracted or tired or, you know, they're they're not going to be able to give it their full attention. That doesn't mean that timing always has to be perfect, but we want to set the interaction up for success as much as we can. And but the biggest thing that happens is once they do start talking, they're just it it becomes competing attachment needs.

There's the impact on yourself, there's the impact on your partner, and there's the impact on your relationship. So the impact of not being curious is that ultimately you're going to end up feeling badly about yourself because you know now that this is the healthier way to be, right? So you're going to feel badly about yourself. On top of that, that energy that you put out is going to come back to you from your partner probably anyway. So it is going to impact you poorly. Your partner's going to feel unheard.

That's not going to feel good for them. And you love them. You don't want them to feel unheard. And then you're going to have to say, well, look, it's also keeping my relationship stuck in these cycles. So, three levels of impact. And then I want you to imagine a future situation that is going to be triggering where you're going to feel pulled into talking over them instead of being curious. Right? And then I want you to imagine what would be a better thing to do. Well, loving listening is what I have written here, which is curiosity.

First you if if something is just first of all you can tolerate your partner in the big picture as a whole person and recognize on the whole my part I feel loved and cared for in this relationship right on the whole my partner will show up for me and in that case for the most part this relationship is worth holding on to. If the answer is no to that question that in the whole most of the time I'm not feeling good here, I'm not feeling loved, I'm not feeling cared for, I'm not feeling heard, I'm not feeling understood, that's a different conversation, that means this relationship really isn't working on a much broader level, right?

I like this, and I do talk about this in the course. I like this idea of I don't know if I'm going to say it in the right exact way, but suggest, ask, insist, demand. Okay, so first, you know, we need to just kind of bring awareness. Hey, this is kind of not working for me. Is this something we can be aware of? Right? And then ask is, hey, you know, I mentioned this and now I really need to, you know, we really need to work to dive into this more deeply because this keeps happening. So would you be willing to sit down and have some conversations about this or would you be willing to stop doing that thing?

Okay. So now you've you've you've brought it up. There's no surprises. You've mentioned it and you've asked for help. And now if they keep doing it, we don't have to just surprise. I'm mad about this. Now it's, hey, this is a big problem for me. And I do I'm insisting we have to work on this, right? What are you going to do if they don't? I don't know. It's so different for every situation. But the one thing they do know, need to know, is you're not happy with it. And the consequences of this not getting addressed is going to be an impact on them, an impact on you, and an impact on the relationship.

and not communicating in a way that is shaming is about using, you know, speaking from yourself, not saying, "Hey, you're just a a bad partner, you know, and you need to, you know, look at how much you let me down." It's more like, "Hey, you know, when this happens, I end up feeling kind of left out or pushed out or not invited in, and then that leaves me feeling kind of alone, right?" Right? And you know, someone who's carrying a lot of toxic shame, they might because of their own stuff still feel shame over that, right?

My wife says she does not feel safe in many situations. She avoids being vulnerable in many cases. She rarely gives me compliments or says thank you. something I take as a lack of feeling safe to do. So, what suggestions can you offer? All right. I need to know what her fears are around this. If I'm her therapist, I'm going to be really getting trying to get really familiar with the good reason that she doesn't feel safe. Right? We nobody feels safe randomly. There's a good reason she feels safe.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch7 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 18.449. Texto curado integrado aqui: 8.384 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activacion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

Julie Menanno, MA, LMFT, LCPC. Terapeuta de pareja licenciada, formada en Terapia Focalizada en las Emociones (EFT). Autora del bestseller Secure Love y creadora de @thesecurerelationship en Instagram.

Awesome. What's it And so what's it called? It's on your website. Um I I don't even know what's it all I created it. Is it called anxious? It's called the anxious self-work course. Yeah. Yeah. So anyway, that that is really meant to help people understand these personal blocks to their own work on their work on the side of the relationship, not at the expense of their partner's work, but um yeah. So no, totally. I love it. Thank you. Okay. You're very welcome. All right, let's go to Irene. Hi, Irene.

He hasn't in the past. I have a lot of evidence to believe that no matter how much I fight him, no matter how much I protest, he is not going to all of the sudden go, "Oh my gosh, you're right. I'm sorry. I'm going to, you know, and and do this five minute repair that you're looking for. It I don't think that your any amount of protest you do, it's going to get him to change his response just because it's so you're you're still not giving me the clarity of option number two. I've already done the grieving.

you know, my partner just ends up, you know, turning my issue into their issue and then the next thing you know, my needs aren't being met and I'm not meeting their needs because they're leaving my needs. And so that is a block that we need to name and that's the conversation with your partner, which is, hey, look at what we're doing. I come to you with a need, then that turns into your need, and that's not working for us, right? So, we got to figure something out. We need to structure. We need more structure here.

All right. So we we'll just go over some things to think about when you are initiating engagement slashreaching to your partner for some sort of interaction, connection, problem solving. So one of the things that happens especially with someone with an anxious attachment is they're really afraid of not being heard. And that is because they have had repeated experiences in their life of not being heard. either, you know, in that relationship, in their past relationships, in their childhood, and often all three.

Do I feel my emotions? Do I put words to my emotions? Do I understand how my emotions are attached to my behaviors? Do I understand the origin of some of my emotions? And and so anyway, that really truly has to has to has to happen if the relationship is going to be healthy and you're going to be okay, right? And feel safe and close. Um will it happen because of therapy right now that he's getting or will it happen because of years of you know reading and growing gradually? Will it happen because right now he's not in the right it's not the right timing.

So Oh, you don't even have my picture, right? So I can I can calm down. Yeah, I can put my phone down. All right. Okay. So, um I'm not sure what my question is. U maybe if I can reflect to you um you can give some feedback. So, um my husband is a pretty extreme dismissive avoidant. Okay. And I've just discovered that I am not an anxious, I am a fearful avoidant. Okay. And some of the things that I thought were good qualities like you know really intent upon communication is actually like potentially dysfunctional.

So some trigger comes along and then you overshare and it happens so fast you don't even think about it. So we need to figure out what happens in that space. Some people overshare because they feel like well if they I'm going to give them all the information because they're probably going to reject me anyway and if they have all the information then maybe I don't have to wait for them to reject me. We'll just get it all out right then and there. Something like that. That's No, that's exactly I and like one of my things that I say is I'd rather be rejected than my time wasted.

So, and it's not it's not fair to you as a whole person, right? So, that's why we need to have like we need to let relationships build safety and build getting to know each other and knowing the good parts of each other before we start, you know, um throwing it all out there. Absolutely. Because then it will prevent me from thinking every relationship is going to be the same. So, I got you. Thank you so much, Julie. You're welcome. And just to circle back, any any relationship work you're doing with your dad, like with your co-orker, it's all going to be beneficial to being in a relationship with a future partner.

I need to, you know, connect with you about something that happened with work. I need some physical connection. I need just to engage with you. I need some emotional help. Whatever that is. Um, what sexual in contact, sexual sex, let's just leave it at that. Um, affection, physical affection. um words and behavior that are seeking to resolve some sort of issue, right? Um and or words or behavior that are seeking some sort of repair of something that went wrong in the past, recent or or distant past.

Um, I think it's really helpful for people that are especially new to relationship work and not really kind of understanding how relationships work and those, you know, people who have had, you know, not a lot of success in relationships or grew up in environments with that the relationships in their family weren't super successful, um, you know, yet want to work on it. um they they need to be more intentional um at especially at the beginning of their work. And so one of those ways of being more intentional because the stuff isn't so intuitive if you haven't done it before or didn't grow up with it is to be really clear.

Um, and obviously that doesn't work for you because it's not regulating for either of you, right? And so we need to find someone capable of doing that work. And I personally um would rather a couple do the work together um because I I'm doing that work, right? doing is 50% of what I do is individual work. I just weave it at the end back into the relationship. I I figure out how are these individual issues showing up as relationship symptoms. Work on that and then I work on um to process like what did you bring to the table here before your you know partner you even met your partner and then I work on um how can we you know stabilize the relationship to where we're not continuing to reinforce all these things that were there to begin with.

Like how can you kind of see the difference in that? Well, some of the differences you're going to find in in a feeling of fear or anxiety. Um that's always a good sign. If you're if you're going into a situation with a lot of fear and anxiety, there's a really good chance that you know that's going to go south. And I don't mean some fear and anxiety. I mean, if you're like um feeling kind of angsty, that that's a good indication that you might be needing some you might be rigidly needing some certain response for them in order to feel safe as opposed to kind of dealing with some of that fear on your own, figuring out what's going on with that before initiating the conversation and then going to it with more openness.

These things are going well. And maybe there's some compelling reasons to stay in it, even though, you know, I'm not getting all of my needs met. But the reality is that I'm with someone who isn't willing to learn how to meet me emotionally and might not ever be able to learn that. And that's really sad and there's grieving around that. And in a moment, what does it look like? In a moment when he isn't able to show up for you, you have you have a couple of options. One is you can get amped up and protest and try to get him to hear you and try to repeat the same thing that you've been doing over and over that's not really getting you that result you're looking for, which does take a toll on your nervous system and going into fight mode.

Can we still have some things that we enjoy? Can I go wheel him around the park when we can't walk together, but is it worth staying or no, I can't do this. I I need to be in a relationship with someone who can finish out life with me in a way that feels more fulfilling. I mean, it what I do know is that there's no amount of yelling and protesting that's going to make them get out of the wheelchair and walk. I get that. Okay, I got it. and we may not be able to have this conversation go any further.

All right, so we'll go ahead and stop there. And it looks like I think I saw someone had a raised hand. All right. Well, there we go. Hi. Hi. How are you? Um not well, but I'm happy to be here. Okay, good. I'm sorry you're not well, though. But I'm glad you're happy to be here. Thank you. Um I missed this chapter this week, so I'm a little But um I was wondering whether it's a question for this or maybe for a future week depending on which chapter it kind of goes with. Okay. I'm more the anxious attachment style.

Um, and we got to now find someone who's capable of helping him work through those blocks, right? We need to understand one how are these blocks showing up in the cycle? How's the the shutdown showing up in the cycle? Um what's the impact of it? What are the very good reasons that whatever these cycle behaviors are are helping him regulate the emotions that he's not in touch with. So he's trying to regulate you in the way he regulates him. Yeah. Right. which is just shut it all down and then confused as to why that's not getting him the result with you that he can temporarily escape his own feelings.

So that's neither here nor there. But well, it is here because I you you said does this mean um individual work? So it could it it doesn't have to though. You you can find someone especially I you know I'm biased towards the type of work that I do which is called emotionally focused therapy for couples and someone who does that work that's they they know going into it like we're we're not doing the work if we're not helping the avoidant partner engage. Yeah. And then I'm also gonna you know that that person is going to need to be able to understand how are you contributing to his problem right and how is he contributing to your problem right in the cycle.

Okay. And um like I'm 51 and I never got apologies as a kid. So, it's really important to me and it's like my partner needs like a day or so to get over the negative cycle and I'm usually over it within 5 minutes and want to start the apology process. Okay. And so you so usually I bring up you know the next day, hey, this is a need and it still spins out and doesn't go well. Like we have two negative cycles out of the one. Okay. What is um what does that apology mean to you? It means they're taking responsibility for their 50%.

I mean that actually that course I have t been talking about is is it out Katrina? Sorry plugging my computer in. Yes, it is. It just so there's an anxious attachment self-work course. It's out. It's hours long. How many hours is it do you think Katrina all said and done? I mean I people are probably I think video content wise it's like three hours but people are going have a lot of reflecting to do and it could Okay. So it it basically tries to really walk you through these triggers. And so you know I I kind of start it with like okay I want you to you're going to have to come up with a trigger for each of these exercises.

It's hopeless leave. But you're saying that's option three. So I don't know what option two actually looks like as a fearful avoidant. Maybe that when I can't address something that occurred really simply, straightforwardly. I don't even think it's going to be a big deal. Don't do that. Well, you can, but I don't know it's going to get you anywhere. It's forget option one. Let's just let's just forget option one. Let's leave that off. We're talking only about option two here. Okay. And as a fearful avoidant, to me, option two, I go straight to well, that means I have I have to leave.

La primera opción es seguir protestando y buscando del otro lo que no puede dar. Eso tiene un costo: el sistema nervioso del que espera y no recibe queda en un estado de activación constante. La historia se repite: expectativa, caída, expectativa, caída.

La segunda opción es un trabajo de aceptación y duelo. Aceptar no significa que todo esté bien ni que no duela. Significa reconocer que el otro, por ahora, no puede o no está dispuesto a aprender a dar lo que se necesita, y que ningún nivel de protesta va a cambiarlo en ese momento. Desde ahí, el trabajo no es con el otro sino con uno mismo: el diario, el trabajo terapéutico, nombrar lo que duele, tener presente la pérdida que implica estar en una relación donde esa dimensión no está disponible.

That, you know, agreement isn't a necessary part of a healthy response. Sometimes it's it's great when our partners agree with us, right? But that's not always going to happen. It's not possible. the healthiest relationship. Partners are going to not always see eye to eye about certain things. Um, sometimes, you know, it's not so much that partners are so far away from each other on how they see something. Sometimes negative cycles can actually create kind of fake disagreement, which is not being able to be open to the other person's, you know, point of view, a lack of flexibility, sort of doubling down on your own, you know, your own perspective, which are all not so much about what you really believe if you really started to kind of come together and explore yourself, but they're due to just actual unmet relationship needs that you're fighting for when you think you're fighting for your opinion.

And partners can just sometimes say, "Hey, look, it's raining outside." And the other partner, you know, might not might be in their own head and not exactly say something. But we do need to be really intentional because a lot of times a partner is reaching and we need to recognize that and be open to giving them some sort of response. Um, and so you need to be make sure that you're especially like if this is something significant, right? Like they're wanting a connection from you or they're wanting to resolve a problem.

And again, couples who are who are really into stress and new to relationship work are going to need to be really more clear about this. Um, you really need to heavily lean into your partner's feelings and make a concerted effort to find the truth in what they're saying or kernels of truth instead of just immediately going into how am I going to refute this? Lean into what's the truth in what they're saying here. Um because there's almost always some truth to someone's concern. Um repeat back to them what they're saying to you and ask for clarity.

Okay. And why are they resistant to the apology? Uh I think because uh they're saying like I really need to like it's they're taking it takes them a long time to come down from the heightened you know like often this comes about from a negative cycle that's intense. Like these aren't our little snippy things. This is like you know everybody gets amped up. I mean, there's three of us with a seven-year-old all have ADHD and we can all get, you know, amped and um so usually she needs a long time to kind of either process it internally and so she's an internal processor, I'm an external processor.

Obviously, their role is way more destructive than your role, but you both, you know, just kind of like thematically are doing something that's not healthy. And so, I would, you know, there's there's so many layers here. I I the first thing I would want to know because I do think apologies are healthy. I think we can't, and you probably read this in the book, like they don't work as an isolated way to address something in isolation. We need to have other things going on with the apologies because for some people it's like, I'm sorry, they're not really addressing any of the other emotional support, validation, getting to the root of the problem.

And then the exercises progress and go deeper, deeper, deeper. And a trigger for you could be, I can't, I have a really hard time getting into curiosity. Right? And so then the the exercises are designed to help you kind of pinpoint all the feelings that are underneath that resistance, that inability, the fears. You know, when I try to pick pick them apart. Okay, right now we're going to just work on the fear part. right now we're going to just work on the shame part or whatever. And so that's going to help you like get a little more clear about what's so scary about leaning because that's what it is.

But I can tell you that in the past when I was ready to leave, I said, "You need to read this book and it's about conflict repair. And at least you need to read the book because if you're not even willing to read the book, it's completely and utterly hopeless. We can't do it. Yeah. So it took him like eight months to read the book. Okay. And his experience of the book is I can't retain anything. Um it just kind of goes in and goes out. It's just not my like he's Mr. Spreadsheet, you know? He can he can do spreadsheets and he can do science and math but he can't do human relation information very easily.

I don't have another option for giving him the response that you're hoping for. And I know beyond that, you have to decide what you're going to do. One, you can either accept the situation for what it is and stop fighting or two, you can keep fighting. I have I have no idea. Another option is to leave the relationship. I I think Okay. Oh, you that's a third option. Okay. So, in that second option, see, I really don't understand. Maybe because I am this fearful avoidant that I think option two is the one where you're saying it's over.

As an avoidant, and I got to stop here in about two minutes, everyone. As an avoidant, a place I often get stuck is the difference between my partner's experience of something, how it impacts her, and what my actual intent was. At times, I know I am thinking of her, and her experience is that I wasn't because the thing didn't land as I intended. Negative cycles happen. Is there a time for my intent to be heard? Yes, there is a time for your intent to be heard. Um, you do not have to bury it. It's not really healthy to bury it.

El lenguaje de apego reencuadra el reaching: "no te traigo esto para culparte ni para que te sientas mal, te traigo esto porque quiero sentirme cerca de ti y quiero que tú también puedas sentirte cerca de mí". Ese es el motor del apego: seguridad y cercanía. Cuando el reaching se formula desde ahí, es más probable que el otro pueda recibirlo.

And so when people are afraid of not being heard and they're not super clear about what they're needing to begin with, what happens is they don't send clear reaches. And sometimes that looks like instead of being really clear about hm here's what's going on and here's what I'm needing, it comes out as just sort of telling your partner what they're doing wrong or criticizing them or just telling them what they need to do differently or just trying to convince them how they think how they should think or feel.

You're not doing anything wrong, but you know, it would feel good for me to have a little smile that would, you know, help me feel more connected to you throughout the day. Would you be willing to for us to try that? Um, so focusing on yourself is is not just ignoring anything that they're doing quote unquote wrong because many times partners are doing things that aren't so helpful. It probably isn't so helpful to not smile at your partner before you leave for the day. Um, but it means going into it from a place of here's what I'm needing and feeling instead of just your focus being exclusively on them and what they're getting wrong and what they're thinking, what they're feeling.

Right? So it's like hey here's what happens for me. Are you hearing me? Are you able to kind of take this in? And then when that's established, then then we go into and here's what would be helpful for you to do. And again, you know, relationships have different levels of of health. And some people in healthier relationships, this happens just super intuitively. This is just what they do. And some people who

are really learning to do this work, they need a little more structure around these interactions.

And these are all blocks and are going to create, you know, make it more difficult from partner A who's doing the reach to do that in a healthy way. So what happens? What happens then if there are these blocks? Well, we got to figure out the root of the block, right? We can't know what the block is without understanding what it is. I'm afraid I'm not going to be heard. We need to discover that block. We need to name it and we need to work through it. So if you say, you know, look, Julie, I want to do my best to reach my partner in the healthiest way possible, but what I've experienced over and over and over again is that when I come at it that way, I don't really end up feeling hurt.

We need to, you know, if one of us is coming to the other with a concern, we need, we're both responsible for delivering it in the healthy way possible, but we need to be able to really sit with and lean into each other's concerns before just kind of taking the mic and going into our own stuff. So, again, there's different blocks around, you know, this the ability to show up as your best self. You got to figure out what they are and then partners really have to come together and talk about that. And a good therapist, their job is to figure out what the blocks are to health, healthier communication.

All right. Another way to bring up a concern or reach to your partner is using attachment language. Right? And that means how are we framing? How are we kind of viewing the problem, right? Are we how are we framing our partner? How are we framing the reason that we're coming to them? If they're getting messages that you're coming to them just because you randomly want to make them wrong or you want to make them bad or you want to let them know how much they're letting you down or you're just trying to control them or you don't care about your needs, they're not they're going to have a very difficult time opening up and being responsive to that in a healthy way that feels good.

Um, well, if you grew up in a home where your concerns were just chronically dealt with in critical and shaming ways, you might have no idea that reaching to someone is a way to actually feel safe and close with them. Um, I need for these things to change so I can feel safe and close or I need for us to be able to talk about this so I can feel safe and close. If you don't have that reference point, that's a good place to start. And then of course we have chronic these chronic negative cycles between partners which does start to make it look like we're enemies.

And it never is about only one partner's needs matter. It's just about we're going to take turns. That's part of structuring your communication in healthy ways. Especially, you know, some partners, they just already do that. They don't, for whatever reason, they've worked on their relationship. they just have a healthier relationship in general. Some partners who are really new to this work, they really need to intentionally be structuring. All right. So, if you're the partner who is in the listening role, what and you're needing to respond to your partner's reach, what is your work here?

Okay? Okay. And what was the reach and what was the second partner's response to the reach? And then when you figure that out in the, you know, service of avoiding negative cycles in the future, see how you might both re improve that. How might have brought that up? How might I have initiated that conversation in a new way that maybe made it less likely to go into a negative cycle? And how might the responding partner improve their response? um in a way that lessened it, lessened the odds that it would go into a negative cycle.

And if he doesn't see the value and he's resisting doing that work, then there, you know, we we we need to understand why. What's the very good reason he's resisting it? But but he also needs to understand like, okay, you have some good reasons here for not wanting to really actively participate in this. But you do need to understand the consequences. And the consequences are um loss of the relationship, possibly um an unhappy partner. he stays unhappy and then just like getting stuck continuously in negative cycles, right?

So, we got my job when I'm working with a couple is to give really compelling reasons to do the work. Um, so then you know what what is the work? Well, now we have to figure out what what is the actual what are the actual blocks to his ability to show up? Like people have different blocks. I mean, with an avoidant attachment, he's going to have blocks that are pretty common for all people with avoidant attachment, but they'll have their own unique flavors. And some blocks are more similar for some avoidance than others or more common and avoidant, but there's usually a big umbrella, which you've read in the book.

So um let's say that's not possible then another option would be for him to see a therapist who does help him get emotionally engaged with himself. Um, and that could be, you know, the type of work I do, emotionally focused therapy, they have an individual model or just talking to different therapists and see who has a lot of experience in helping people emotionally engage with self and but that word engagement is kind of vague. Emotional engagement with self is how do I engage with my emotional self?

I'm connecting with people. Okay. But I think I hesitate of jumping into anything because I truly believe I have some work to do on my own before I can really show up for a partner. I know how I've done it in the past and I don't want to repeat that cycle. Okay. And a lot of it is just like I I know like a lot of our example it does again this is a lot of you know you're a couple's therapist this is your specialty thing but I think I I think I sometimes um having a difficult time sometimes with taking this information in but it's like how do I do this while not being in an actual like relationship and I also don't want to like deter myself where I'm like oh everything I do I have so much to work on.

there's always something I'm gonna have to work on. And even like you mentioned too in these slides about self-focus and even a lot of it's like oh do I have to work on something or do I you know and I think I I I tend to gravitate towards doing that because I'm like okay I'm doing all this work but yeah the real uh the real test is when you're you know doing that with any relationship you're in and I do I think I'm taking a lot of your uh your tips and like how to navigate in all my relationships.

It what is what needs to be clear is the intention, the hope, how sa how how safe it is for the given situation. your dad doesn't sound like a super unreasonable person. So even if he can't fully understand what you're saying, I think it's healthy for you to start that conversation because at least you're planting seeds of something new. And um you know, when you say, "I overshare," well that really needs to be looked at. I mean, first of all, does that oversharing have a downside? If it doesn't have a downside, don't bother.

And uh I just like I'm someone like here's my full story. If any of this bothers you, tell me now so I we can avoid doing that work we eventually have to do regardless. There you go. So you need to figure out like what's the fear and first of all like I know that there are there there's truth to the fact that we don't want to waste our time but there's also truth to the fact that we have to risk wasting our time because it's the only real way to get to know someone. And if you present this kind of bad information about yourself out of context when they haven't gotten to know all the wonderful things about you then all of a sudden you're throwing this stuff at them that's out of context that's overwhelming.

It's a fear on my needs are not going to matter. And then I just get really like okay you're scared this you're scared what if how are you going to feel? How are you going to feel? And really be able to kind of sit with the deeper there's there's stuff in there. There's unexpressed grief. There's, you know, there's all sorts of stuff in there that needs some help that once it gets some help, it's going to be much easier for you to not have it sort of driving the car and creating these blocks to really being curious and hearing.

We're going to stay on the subject. We're not going to shift the way you always do in the past. We're not doing that. I'm not doing that." And I'm walking away. Let me know when you're able to talk. Whole 24 hours went by. We talked again the next morning. I guess, you know, I

think it's important to repair something. I think it's important to just and I and I conveyed to him. I said, 'Look, all I need is a five seconds of you matter to me. It appears that I did something hurtful. It was unintentional, but I'm sorry because you matter to me.

So the book was read and that answers your question. I guess he understands either that he doesn't do repair or maybe I need to read this book or else she'll leave me. I don't really know. All right. Well, let me ask you this. Are you are you miserable in the relationship when he's Mr. Perfect? It's very sweet. It's very lovely. It's very nice. I recognize the limitations to intimacy and I've accepted that. And it's it's lovely. I only take offense when I feel like he's behaving rudely, disrespectfully, disapprovingly, being some kind of, you know, mean.

I understand that because you have a call that you're dealing with. I'll just say that I don't understand what option two looks like. So we can leave it at that. And you can look in the book in chapter I don't know when when I say what is it what if it's not working that will explain very clearly option one option two and option three and option just think of option two is how I would respond if they physically were couldn't couldn't do something how would I respond it's the same thing he emotionally cannot do it and he emotionally is not willing to get the work to do it apparently I don't I don't know for sure okay um I'm going Let me go over here to Eric.

you know, I it does feel important to me that that you're able to hear my intention and hear, you know, what in that response was my hope in responding to you in a healthy way. And you know, that's kind of a bigger issue because sometimes I don't know if you, you know, I'm feeling so appreciated for my good intentions. And it's not that I don't want to get better and help you, but there there's also this part of me that for me to feel safe and close, I I need to be seen for that just like you need to be seen for your stuff.

So, it's not about burying it. It's about timing. Because if you go in when she brings up this concern and you start going into your intention, it it things get convoluted and it's like whose needs matter most? And you know when partners can stop start doing that um usually that will help just those conversations and that structure will help with the symptoms. So maybe she's not going to being maybe she's not getting triggered so much to begin with um because we're building up safety and connection just in these conversations of really leaning in and hearing it.

Los ciclos negativos crónicos pueden producir desacuerdo falso: no una diferencia real de opiniones, sino rigidez y cierre ante la perspectiva del otro que proviene de necesidades de apego no satisfechas que están "peleando" aunque parezca una discusión de contenido. Cuando las parejas estabilizan sus ciclos y la forma de hablar, con frecuencia descubren que estaban más cerca en sus posiciones de lo que creían.

La norma estándar es mantenerse en esa estructura. No a los cinco minutos derivar la conversación hacia las propias necesidades. Esto no significa que las necesidades del que responde no importen: importan. Significa que se toman turnos. Cuando se ha trabajado el reaching de uno, entonces hay lugar para que el otro traiga lo suyo.

No existe límite de tiempo para abordar rupturas pasadas de apego. Si un evento del pasado sigue activándose, sigue apareciendo en ciclos negativos, sigue generando angustia, necesita algún tipo de trabajo. A veces una pareja estabiliza sus ciclos y la lesión de apego pasada deja de activarse sola porque ya no se sigue reforzando. Pero si sigue apareciendo, necesita una o varias conversaciones de reparación específicas sobre ese evento.

There is a an ask in all of those behaviors and we need to figure out what the ask is instead of you're you know you never um smile at me when you say goodbye, right? That that's not you're getting you're giving them the idea of what you want by telling what they're getting wrong, but first of all, they're going to maybe not take that so well because they're going to feel blamed. It's very different from, hey, you know, I like to have a little connection when we separate in the morning. I know you're busy and you've got a lot on your mind.

Um, and one way to really stay with a self-focus and address a behavior is to share how you're impacted from a vulnerable place. You know, like I just said, you know, when when you leave and I don't get that smile, then I I kind of feel alone or I feel sort of disconnected. And you know, me, I like to go into my day feeling like our connection is there. It helps me feel strong throughout the day. And um so you know when I don't get that doesn't feel so good for me. Um again it's okay to be clear with your partner about what you're needing for them to do differently but it does really need to come after you've delivered the selfwork and they've been able to take that in.

Um but yeah I mean there there there is no cut off point. Now, something can happen to where a couple starts to get healthier and they stop repeating the same theme of whatever that wound was in the past and that starts to just heal it on its own. We know that's happening though. If that trigger, if that memory doesn't just keep coming back over and over again, if it does keep coming back over and over again, it will show up in cycles. It does need some sort of healing. I don't know exactly what that healing is.

Well, people who've not been heard historically are going to have a hard time. They're not or they can assume that they're not going to be heard. Hey, this approach isn't going to help me be heard. Um people who have a history of not being responded to. Um, people who have a history of even when they are coming from a self-focused place, then they're not it's not leading to these any changes that they're needing or any kind of deeper conversation about why the changes aren't happening. Right? And then sometimes we're in a in relationships where the only thing our partner will hear is when we're telling them what they're doing wrong.

Um, and sometimes the blocks are rooted in repeated negative cycles and sometimes the blocks are rooted in someone's own individual stuff. You know, when I was growing up, if somebody came to you with a concern, that meant you were just bad and awful and it was very shaming. And to stay safe, the only thing I knew how to do was just start bringing up their stuff, right? It's like, who's worse? And so that needs to be uncovered so we can figure out how it's blocking, healthy communication, clean, free flow, direct communication.

If you're just trying to make me wrong, then I'm going to react to that by making you wrong. And then it just that starts to become the narrative of the relationship. And we need to get out of that narrative and into this narrative, which is we're just trying to reach each other. and all these behaviors and all these bad words are are desperate attempts to reach safety and closeness with each other. Um, one thing people kind of get stuck in is um, let me check questions here. One thing people kind of get stuck in is trying to control an interaction for getting the immediate response they're looking for.

It's never a good idea to give up. You know, yes, at some point some relationships do need to be given up on, but never right when you start doing new things and you're not getting that instant feedback. Um, so you know, the overriding goal is to be your best self, right? In spite of the immediate response you're getting from your partner. What is your best self? Well, it's a lot of different things. I mean, but that's the overriding goal. And one of the best self things is being really clear and intentional with your own communication.

Um you you know you want to move away from I'm trying to get this new response right here, you know, in this instant moment. Um to I'm trying to improve the relationship health here, right? Maybe it's not going to happen right now, but my real goal is to improve the relationship in the big picture. You know, one of the reasons why the our new moves don't don't land immediately and also this goes for, you know, when your partner reaches to you. I'm always not just speaking from you to them. I'm also speaking of them to you.

One of the reasons why you might not be responsive to your partner's new move or they might not be responsive re responsive to yours is because the nervous systems don't always trust new things, right? and for many different reasons. And sometimes there have been so

much stuff in the relationship or their past that have led them to not really trust that this is real or not really trust the intentions. And so the only way that you know nervous systems really really trust is repeated interactions over the course of time.

So consistency. Um, and you know, then the other side to that, well, look, if a lot of time goes by, um, and you're not seeing any results at all, that's a new conversation. But it still means that you're not in every given interaction just quote unquote saying the right thing to get this um, good response. Okay. Sometimes partners, you know, when they're reaching for their partner, we need to make sure that their responsiveness isn't that they necessarily agree with you or agree with your perspective.

And sometimes that's not true. Sometimes your opinion is your opinion. It's real. You're not able to be flexible. Um, but what I have found over and over again is that when couples start stabilizing their cycles and the way they're talking to each other, a lot of times they do find that they're closer um than they on issues than they think that they were at first. Um, and you know, then of course, you know, we don't need for, you know, we don't want to have the expectation that our partner is going to agree with us over every single little thing.

Um, but we still need to have space to present our argument to them. Um, and so once the emotional safety is established, we're hearing each other, we're open to each other, we we're open to understanding each other, um, then that's that's the point at which okay, we're safe here. So now let's talk about well I want to hear what your argument is and here's what my argument is. Okay. Now sometimes couples really get stuck in details when really the issue transcends the details. It's about a bigger meaning.

And if so, what is my contribution to that and what is theirs? And just by g getting in that frame of mind, um, you're going to be far more likely to reach and respond to each other in a healthy way. All right. So much about reaching and responding is about timing. Timing when you bring things up, right? And timing and structuring the roles of each partner. Okay? So the standard rule is that if one partner is reaching, we stick with that. That partner is in the attachment needing role. They're needing a response.

Um, and this, you know, ideally we're able to stay in this for an hour or more, you know, and then we switch to if the other partner has something to bring up because we want to know. Partners really need to know I can bring something up and I can reach and it's going to be heard. It's going to be held. It's going to be responded to without it going into your stuff or just getting ignored. Um, so timing is about when we bring things up and how we um who who has the mic, who has the floor um in that interaction.

Well, you're responsible for a really recognizing their reach as a reach. You know, sometimes it's easy your partner says something and it's easy to just kind of ignore it, blow it off. it doesn't seem like that big of a deal, whatever. And maybe it is a really big deal to them. And you need to figure out, you know, what why are they what's going on with this? What are they trying to say to me? What are they needing from me? Every single interaction. No, I mean, the goal is to get to the point where this just sort of flows.

I you know what, listen, I've I've taken it in. You have a lot of important things to say. I really feel like I've heard you. Let me just take some time with this. um you know, this is kind of new to us, so let me just take some time to this before I give you a response. And of course, some conversations lend themselves more to needing time to process than others. All right. So, homework for you is to really think about the last time you and your partner were in a negative cycle and try to pinpoint was there some sort of reach where one partner initiated an interaction even if it's hard to see that reach where there was some, you know, we can get to some clarity around what that partner was hoping to get in return.

He's a um I've done a ton of personal work since my teens. um he's turning 45 and really hasn't done any. Okay. We have a very big um conflict in our relationship actively that we're working on in couples therapy. Okay. And it almost feels as though there's no way for me to receive any support from him because he's so shut down. Mhm. I'm wondering when you have someone like that where maybe I I think it's possible that someone just doesn't have the capability to show up cuz they're so shut down.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch8 - Julie Menanno.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 18.898. Texto curado integrado aqui: 8.584 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activacion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

The fear is this is never going to end. Here we are again and I'm just always going to feel rejected and then that those protective feelings kind of amp up into behavior which is now my body's all fired up and I'm mobilized and I'm going to protest. I'm going to tell them they never listen and I'm going to use always and never language. Okay? And then what's going to happen is then your partner the partner is going to react to that and then they're going to get stuck in a negative cycle. And so when they come back to repair, each partner really needs to have a really good idea of what just happened for them because this is the stuff that needs to really be addressed to really fully get to see each other and know each other.

They want to be heard, validated, and comforted, but struggle to recognize their own role in the dynamic or take responsibility. This leads the other person to feel like there's no room for them. That's very common with anxious attachment where their anxious attachment starts to sort of take up all the space, right? So, couple things. One, the selfwork is truly needs to be there. What is the what is their block from taking in validation and being heard and comforted? Probably there's some shame and views of self stuff stuck there that they need to resolve on their own.

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All right. So all of this is in the book. I'm going to, you know, add a little more insight here and there, but the elements of the repair, right? Here's what needs to be sort of happening in this repair process. The first thing is that partners really, really, really need to be able to understand and see all of the attachment needs and unmet needs and emotions underlying just the anxiety and the anger. Most couples who don't have a lot of emotional health in their relationship, every single time they argue or fight or get in negative cycles, all they're seeing is each other's anxiety and anger.

We have to, you know, create emotional safety before we continue to address whatever it is that we're talking about. You know, we need to, if you're having an argument about, let's say, sex, right? someone's needs aren't being met and you get into this negative cycle. You know, part of the repair process is saying, "Hey, we need to establish some emotional safety before we try to go back to this topic. Clearly, this topic, you know, brings up a lot for both of us and there's a lot of needs there and sometimes those needs conflict with each other.

And why? Not because they're doing it on purpose, because they don't really know how to get underneath into the attachment meanings and the emotions, the vulnerable emotions underneath there, or they don't feel safe doing it. And so really to do full repairs and to really help your relationship stop going back to the same negative cycles over and over again, we've got to understand ourselves and our partner through the lens of attachment theory, which is tied up with emotional safety. You know, it has to be some communicating with

vulnerability.

[Music] All right. So, today we're going to do chapter eight, which is repairing after there has been a negative cycle or any type of rupture. So, the difference between healthy couples and unhealthy couples is the ability to repair. All right. So, how do you know if you need to make a repair with your partner? Well, the obvious answer is after a fight or some kind of combative argument, which i. e. negative cycle. Sometimes there is some kind of cycle going that is just more like tension in the air.

What do you do if your partner sees repair as a form of retribution? That's not repair. That's just in the negative cycle. So, we need to understand what is about what is it about this retribution that they're wanting to be heard. That retribution wants to be heard. that retribution wants to see change. I don't know what it is, but you know, that's not that's not a repair. A repair is I genuinely want to get back to closeness to you. Now, that retribution might be their attempt at trying to reestablish closeness, and there's something to be said for that, but it's not actually a repair.

I'm failing. And that block needs to be resolved. We need to figure out how can we help you engage in a conversation about behavior without it have meaning that you have to just kind of shame spiral into this failure place. Or the block could be that when you try to talk about the repair and when you try to go through that you actually go back into another negative cycle where you know all those messages are are just flying around between the two of you. So in that case, the answer is really learning how to stay out of a cycle when you're doing the repair.

And I really do plan to keep working on that behavior. We want to use empathy as a driver for change as to as opposed to fear. You know, I'm always the reason that I do the work I do in the deeper levels of emotional processing and understanding yourselves as emotional beings and emotional hurts instead of just you know the behavior what we see on the surface is because I want to help people empathize with themselves and I want to help them empathize with each other. Actually, I should say I want to help them have compassion for their own experience and understanding of their own experience so that they can have empathy for their partner's experience and understanding their partner's experience because it is much more effective to be motivated by I want to work on my part or I'm sorry, I want to work on my part because I love you and I want to protect you out of love from feeling unseen and unresponded to and I want to protect you and do do what I can, you know, to to the degree that we can as partner a partner to protect you from hurting.

Then and the next thing I would want to know is like okay so you have you know you try to have a repair conversation about some cycle in the present and what happens in that repair that causes you to go off track and end up feeling more disconnected. I I would not want to just understand it in the context of well we need to get better at doing these repairs. I would want to understand it in the context of what happened in this one singular repair that ended up taking you to a more disconnected place because whatever that is, it's the root of the problem.

I don't know if they can really see me. I don't even know if they really want to see me. And that's a bad place. And when all that wells up, that's a lonely place. I feel rejected. I feel kind of betrayed by them. I'm kind of feel some fear. I feel some shame. And then that goes into these protective feelings, which is our body's mobilizing system. Protective feelings say, "Do something. take some sort of action. It could be frustration or a skeptical feeling or indignant or real or even catastrophized fear.

And then you might need to say, look, you know, sometimes I do feel like, you know, your your big emotions, I want to be there to help them, but that sometimes I do feel like it kind of leaves me kind of choked out and not able to kind of show up with my own stuff, and then I'm not getting heard and validated, and then I have a hard time feeling close. So, wouldn't it be nice if we both could get these needs met? and maybe you need need to do some selfwork too, right? So, it is a matter of understanding there is a huge relationship importance to meeting each other's attachment needs, but that can't happen outside of each partner also being able to do their own selfwork.

because, you know, it I think it would be nice if we could both sort of own how we're contributing to this because if if we stick with this narrative that it's just sort of all me, I'm not really sure that's going to get us anywhere. And that must be really disempowering for you to think that all your happiness is kind of dependent on whether or not I start to change. I mean, so I just don't know if that narrative is really going to get us anywhere. I've started the anxious attachment course. Oh, good.

I'm dying to know feedback on this because I haven't had any feedback yet. It's already helping so much. Yay. I'm so glad these parts that are anxious, angry, or sad have never been acknowledged this way before and I'm doing it for myself now. I'm also getting what sit with your feeling actually means and I'm learning how to do that with this course. Thanks. So worth the money. Okay, promise I didn't coersse her into doing that. That makes me so so happy. This is the first feedback I've got on it.

Wounds are bigger events that you know shake up trust to an a much bigger degree than just kind of an everyday attachment rupture. All right. So why repair? Why not just keep moving forward and try not to let that happen again? Well, there's a lot of value in repairing. one, you know, couples who aren't able to repair and they just sort of push things under the rug. It the resentment just builds and builds. And what resentment needs to be relieved is it needs to be heard and understood. So, if we're not taking the time to do that and to talk about some of the other feelings that may have happened in the rupture, then that resentment will just start to build and it can really, you know, take a toll on the relationship, especially over time.

And so it is really hard for me to take in concerns even though that's a normal part of relationships. But again, that's for later because if your partner brings something up, that's the time to lean in. And instead of shame spiraling, a much healthier response is to kind of put that stuff aside and to be able to go, okay, look, I'm going into my own shame. I want to stay with my partner right now because that's how you be in a healthy relationship. And try something like, you know, I see how I let you down and how my words impacted you.

Does it work? No, it does not work. They do need to be able to come back to a repair for the relationship to be healthy. But before we're going to get them there, we need to understand why they keep going back to Stonewall, why Stonewall is safe. I would try to maybe understand that more outside of the situation. go, hey, look, you know, I'm really trying to get this repair thing going for us. I think it's going to be a lot better. You know, when we can kind of get to a place where we don't have the same fight over and over, but I notice when we go into the repair, something in you says back away.

So by the time they're done with me, they have a really good conscious understanding of why they're doing what they're doing that's not working. And it's so much easier for them to shift. And I've also given them tons of experiences of doing something new in the sessions. If you don't have access to that, the work is right here. Also, the course, actually the courses out that I keep talking about, the anxious attachment course. I do want to make an avoidant one at some point. Several hours long. It takes you through that scaffolding over and over and over and over again, going deeper and deeper and deeper with each repetition.

Absolutely, you should feel resentment. It's just what is the resentment about? Does it really belong to your partner? If it doesn't really belong to your partner, where does it belong? The resentment is real. It needs to be listened to. It needs to be heard. Again, this is where I would encourage you to do the course. I do a whole piece on anger. It needs to be heard. It needs to be listened to. You need to figure out what it's all about, what it's needing to heal. We I don't want you living with that resentment.

And then great, when that resentment isn't there, it probably won't keep getting triggered in these moments when that story that you're describing comes to life. When your partner's, you know, doing all these things that triggers this wound. If we heal the wound, the resentment doesn't need to be there anymore. It's getting what it needs. What do you suggest when both partners want to repair but struggle get stuck on what the compromise looks like? Well, first of all, if you're trying to address the compromise and the solution and the problem before you have done the emotional work, people are just you're both going to double down on the compromise because you're trying to resolve the emotional stuff by trying to get your partner to go along with your way.

You're trying to say, "I need to know my needs matter. I need to know this." And I'm not I don't want to devalue the fact that whatever it is you're compromising on is important. It obviously is or you wouldn't be fighting about it, but we need to understand more about why it's important to you. What's the emotional stuff? What's the fear around the compromise? Whatever it is, like I'm I'm afraid that, you know, if we spend too much money on the car, that's going to lead us to being stressed in all these ways.

Ejemplo de narrativa: "Cuando percibí que no me escuchabas, mi cuerpo se tensó. Mis inseguridades se activaron. Me sentí rechazada. Te quiero mucho y me duele pensar que, incluso por un momento, quizás no quisieras conocerme y conectar conmigo. Cuando todo eso sube, me entra miedo de que esto siempre vaya a ser así. Sé que es catastrofizado, pero tengo experiencias en la vida donde algo así ocurrió de verdad. Y entonces me enfado y lo único que ves es el enojo y la protesta, pero debajo hay mucho más."

That's one of the reasons why you see couples doing really well at the beginning of the relationship and, you know, having, you know, no problem whatsoever and not not a lot of negative cycles, but then these little things happen along the way and they build and they're not repairing, not repairing, not repairing. And then the next thing you know, all this resentment's built up and that resentment contributes to less closeness. And then the next thing you know, you know, we're so far apart, we don't know how we got here.

But I do want to hear more about what is that desire to punish me trying to say? What are you needing? What are you need? Are you needing to know that I can hear you? Are you needing to know that I'm willing to kind of shift my part over here? So yeah, I think it's just being able to distinguish negative cycle behavior from actual desire to repair. Okay, so another thing we want to do is let me see. I think there might be a couple more questions here. One more and then we'll go on. What if my partner tends to see my attempt to repair as rehashing the past or rewinding the tape?

Maybe there is some value of trying to kind of do these repairs in a healthier way because I certainly don't want you end up feeling worse. That's not the goal here. So maybe what we can do is instead of just avoiding repairs, we can figure out a way to make repairs actually feel okay. And to do that, you really need to understand the blocks. So if your partner is having a block to even the most perfectly delivered information on your part, it could be that no matter what, no matter how perfectly you bring up a concern, they go into their place of I'm failing.

And all of a sudden, when we can get through that resentment layer, which is not being in a negative cycle, right? A negative cycle around resentment is well I have a lot of resentment for you and the other person going well you that's not fair you shouldn't have resentment for me because xyz that's a negative cycle so a lot of times when we can just get through that resentment layer sorry then the couple is able to get to continue speaking to each other outside of a cycle all of a sudden like this energy just sort of releases.

Most likely they're not letting it go because you guys are trying to communicate it outside of a negative cycle. There is something that your partner is needing to say or be heard and understood about that isn't happening that is causing them to not be able to let it go. So you you can you know we can spend all the time in the world telling our partner to let something go and if they would just let it go then everything would be okay probably not going to be effective. What we need to figure out is what are they needing to let to actually so it will go on its own.

Sometimes the repair needs to happen within you. It's still a repair. You're still showing up for your own painful feelings and acknowledging them and working with them. You're not necessarily just letting those painful feelings go and saying, "Well, I should just get over it, right?" You're actually trying to understand yourself better and in that being able to say, you know, this is really my work. This isn't, you know, something that I need to address with my partner or and it's always a good idea just to talk to them about this work that you do within yourself because that's bonding.

That helps you bring it up in a gentler way. You might determine, yeah, no, this is a problem. this is a pattern of unresponsiveness. It's not just about the milk. This kind of happens a lot and that might need to be addressed with a more direct repair. Or you might again decide you know we don't really need to repair this. I just kind of want to talk about what came up for me in the context of my past and just as you know a way to know each other really. When is it relationship work? Well, if you've done your self work and you really still feel like no this is something that needs to be addressed, right?

And then when all that wells up, I start to feel scared that I'll keep feeling this way. And sure, a part of me knows that's catastrophized, but you know, I have feeling experiences in life where that did kind of happen. And then I get angry and all you see is the anger and protest and that doesn't land well on you obviously, but underneath it is so much more going on. And if both partners can learn to communicate like that, it just it's just going to create much more bonding, much more awareness of each other, much more empathy, and partners are going to start finding new ways to manage these situations when needs aren't going met.

They start having fewer cycles. The higher quality of your repairs, the fewer cycles you will have. And then, you know, do I have two timeies? No. Again, we're taking turns sharing our experiences like this, owning the behavior if owning their part in the cycle and apologizing. Okay. So, we want to expand on apologies in repairs, right? So, we don't want to leave it at, you know, I'm sorry for hurting you. We want to combine that apology with empathic remorse. And especially in situations where it's very clear, you know, look, I didn't like the way you talked to me, but the way I reacted wasn't so great either.

You know, every time I tried to get my mom to understand me, she just told me how bad I was or ignored me or whatever. I do have some resentment to that. It doesn't need mean I need to hate my mom. It doesn't mean I need to see her as the worst mom ever, but that resentment is real. My body felt it every time it happened. And you might you don't need to tell it to your mom. Maybe you do, maybe not. Maybe your mom wouldn't be able to hold that. You just need to acknowledge it to yourself. Yeah, that resentment is real.

And then we got to go in and feel all the other feelings underneath the resentment, the the loneliness you felt, the the rejection you felt, and sit with that and let the sadness around that come up and give that sadness what it needs. Does it need space? Does it need comfort? Do you need to talk to someone about it? It definitely needs space, right? And comfort and just being with it and some grieving, right? And when you can do that and also own the resentment, typically that resentment will start to fade.

And, you know, I that's not going to feel good for us. And there's also this part of me that needs to know that you can see me for that fear and that you're not just going to devalue that fear and say I'm being ridiculous. That you can lean in to say, you know what, I get that. I get that fear, right? I have fears of my own and I want to be seen for those too. So it makes sense to me. Typically when that conversation can happen first before we try to write the, you know, solution, people start to soften and flex up.

been just like waiting and waiting asking Katrina every day. Has anybody finished it? Have you had any feedback? So, thank you so much, Angie, for that. I've read your book, listened to your podcast, and have started your anxious attachment course this week, Julie. You rock. Well, thank you. It's always good to hear. I'm so glad. Please let us know how the course goes for you. All right, I am worn out at this point, so let me go into Okay, that's Katrina. I think I've gotten to everything. All right.

you know, the whatever it is that you're arguing about or having this negative cycle over, whether it be, you know, sometimes partners are just talking about their closeness in their relationship, but sometimes it's over money or parenting or in-laws or any kind of, you know, triggering issue, where we're going to dinner, the refrigerator door. I mean, it can seem like just the smallest things, but if you aren't able to repair the arguments that happen over those things, there's a good chance that whatever those surface problems are aren't ever going to get attention and get the resolution that they're needing.

Otherwise, you're just going to fall right back into anger and anxiety, particularly anger and or or just even fear and shutting down. You know, communicating vulnerably, it's sharing the deeper feelings, the longings, the sadnesses, the fears underneath these behaviors that you're doing in these cycles that just aren't working and are creating the ruptures to begin with. Again, we really need to view your each other through this attachment lens, which is my partner is trying to feel close and safe instead of my partner is trying to hurt me.

The narcissist needs to get help for their narcissism. And you know, even with a narcissist, no, they're not necessarily trying to be close, although in a roundabout way, at the end of the day, that sort of is what they're trying to do. They're trying to manage unmanageable levels of shame so they don't experience rejection. It just is really wonky and doesn't work. But this this information, you know, if someone is truly a narcissist, that there's no amount of emotional work in the relationship that you can do on your end alone that's going to cause their narcissism to go away.

Well, that's when you might want to say something like, "Look, wouldn't it be nice if you know, let me pause that for a second. What you're saying to me is they don't understand the value in the repair, right? They don't they don't understand the value. For them, the repair means this is just going to be another opportunity for me to end up feeling attacked or like a failure or whatever it is for them. they don't have a good experience with repair. And the first thing I would want to do is I would want to lean in and understand more about that.

You don't have to agree. You don't have to take full responsibility for things that maybe, you know, some of their perception, but you do have to try to understand them, reflect what they're saying, and validate their feelings. Okay. What happens when both partners have experienced a lot of unresolved conflict and repair usually means brushing issues under the rug just to meet an immediate need? Both are afraid to bring things up because in the past, honest conversations have only led to more disconnection.

That's a great question and I'm going to talk about that a little bit later. I don't believe every single rupture needs to be addressed and repaired. I do believe that there are situations where it's more appropriate to let it go and I'll talk more about that. At what point does rehashing the past show that we haven't solved anything? Continuing to rehash the past and it's not getting healed means that somehow you're getting stuck in negative cycles every time you try to heal whatever happened in the past.

because you did experience throughout childhood or even in other adult relationships actual betrayals and emotional abandonments. Of course, your nervous system is going to be sensitive to that. That's how your nervous system is trying to stay safe. It learned to do that in an environment where those risks were very real. That doesn't mean that you are in a relationship now where those risks are that real. Okay? And so you can sometimes overreact to your partner's mistakes based on these past experiences of pain.

You know, it's relationship work. If you can say, hey, if I don't res address this, I'm going to end up carrying some resentment around this because that resentment will start to show up in behavior. You can, let's say, you can see the bigger context. You know, you're able to say, look, my partner is great. They have all these strengths in the relationship. At the same time, you know, I keep finding myself going back to not really feeling like I'm these situations where I don't know they're thinking about my needs or, you know, I feel kind of dropped.

And they sort of start to just distance without it looking like a lot of anger. But that distance for an avoidant partner is often indicating that there's some sort of repair that needs to be happening. Okay. And then so what do we do here? Well, this number one, number one, number one is knowing yourself, knowing your partner, knowing the layers of your triggers. To do a real repair work, you've got to really know what's going on with yourself and what's going on with them. and they've got to know what's going on with them and what's going on with you.

And so we can start to shift all of this. Okay. All right. And so then what you can do once you kind of have this all mapped out is you can kind of write it as a narrative. You know, you can go through each each step, right? And you know, when I perceived you weren't listening to me, my body tensed up and then my self insecurities got touched and then I felt rejected by you. And I love you so much. And it hurts to think that even in a moment you might really not want to see me and connect with me.

They need to start showing up for their own self emotionally before they can expect to fully take it in. They could be having an expectation that you're not going to be there to do the relationship work of hearing and validating them. But you're also going to be the doing the relationship work plus their own selfwork. In which case, there's no amount of your hearing and validating that is going to be enough if they're not able to give themself the same heard and validated. They that means they need to believe they deserve it to begin with, right?

And that's probably what's going on there. there's there's some beliefs there that I'm just too much. I don't really deserve it. And that that needs to be addressed. And then, you know, hopefully the idea is is that when they can start showing up for self more fully, then they're able to take in what you're offering. Now, that's giving that my assumption is that you are showing up and you are hearing and you are validating. And you know, I know it's hard because what do you say to someone? you need do need to take do your own self-work.

Tampoco se puede volver al tema en disputa antes de haber trabajado la seguridad emocional. Si se intenta resolver el problema de fondo (la discusión sobre el dinero, el sexo, etc.) antes de que haya seguridad emocional, cada persona va a defender su posición porque está intentando resolver la necesidad emocional a través de que la otra ceda.

But each partner is reacting to that tension and in the reaction to the tension, if they're continuing to trigger each other, that is a negative cycle. It's just a more quiet one. And that's a good sign that something needs to be addressed. When there is some sort of attachment rupture, you know, you feel unheard or unseen or your partner feels invalidated or someone is in a place where they're not sure their needs matter to their partner or someone feels betrayed. And then when there is an attachment wound and we'll talk more about wounds in chapter nine.

Ruptures are an enormous opportunity to learn from, you know, our relationship mistakes and our mistakes with our self and grow. You can't do that if you're not processing what happened that didn't go so well and learning from it. And then repairs are really huge opportunities for bonding. I mean, I don't want any couple that I'm working with to end up only bonding from repairs. There's lots of ways to bond, but you know, when there is some sort of rupture, it's not a rupture if it doesn't kind of hit vulnerability underneath the surface.

So, we need to figure out how to be extra safe with this topic before we go back to it." One really important thing is what I call in the work I do sharing the function of the protection. Okay. So when we think of anger and we think of bad behavior in relationships that people do when they're triggered, we have to understand why they're engaging in those behaviors and why that anger is so important. What's the function of it? Right? We don't need to say I want to know the function so I can tell you why I should keep doing this.

We need to understand the function of anger and poor behavior so we can figure out what it's actually needing to get resolved. What is it trying to communicate and how can we go about getting its needs met in a better way? What kind of new behavior can we bring to the table? You know, one way of sharing the function of the protection is, you know, something like, you know, you see the anger, right? you see that it's really clear, but underneath that there's just a longing in me to know that you're willing to hear me.

It's again negative cycle behavior. So, I would I would want to say, hey, you know, first of all, I don't know how you know that. Are they do they own that or do you assume that from them? if they do own that and they are able to say, "Look, you know, when I, you know, sometimes I want to go back into this repair because really I want to just keep, you know, somehow kind of punishing you for messing up." You know, the the way to lean into that would be, hey, I don't want to be punished. That feels really bad for me.

Okay. So more elements of a repair. So you know, this is where a lot of people do do this really well. Okay, they explain themselves and I really that wasn't my intention and that's not what I was doing. and they can apologize and they can say, "I'm never going to do that again." You know, most people know how to do that, right? And there's nothing wrong with all of that. Those concepts do need to be expressed along with it. But what a lot of people are missing is the other stuff, the emotional work, and they get kind of stuck in just explaining themselves, apologizing, committing to change, and then just moving forward.

So, we just want to make sure we're doing this in a way that's measured and in a way that is balanced with the emotional work of the repair. So, we also want to avoid shame spirals. And that kind of ties into this question I just answered, which is, you know, a lot of partners, they go so quickly to I'm bad, I'm failed, like they can't take in any level of confrontation or concern without it turning into I know, I'm just so awful, I don't even know why you want to be with me. Well, nobody does that, you know, is intentionally trying to take the mic from their partner in that kind of a situation.

and they're genuinely hurting and getting kind of caught up in their own bad feelings and shame. But if that's the response, they just abandoned their partner's stuff. They just abandoned their partner, left their partner alone with the concern and took the mic and turned it into their own pain and bad feelings. And there's room for these, you know, these thoughts and feelings, but it's not when your partner is bringing up the concern. This is something that needs to come later which is and it's going to sound more like you know when I mess up and and I and let you down like it is really hard for me because you know growing up mistakes weren't just mistakes they were like reflections of your value and and you know you were kind of defined in any given moment by whether you were getting it right or getting it wrong.

But we can't do that until we know how to stay out of negative cycles in the present. And some of this work is just having the discipline as a couple to recognize that there's no way that in one day or two days or a week we're going to be able to resolve all of this. This is a process. We have to, you know, take this a step at a time. The very first step is just getting out of the negative cycles that you're in that of day-to-day ones, right? Because if you don't learn how to get out of those, then you're never going to be stabilized enough to go back and heal the past.

And once you can get to that root of the problem, it's going to be it it really will you know what what you'll find is that you don't actually need to keep going back and addressing well now we got to address this, now we got to address that. It will become more like now we have to address this theme and this theme is sort of rooted in this event that happened or these chronic events that happened over the last 10 years or whatever. Does every single rupture need to be addressed and repaired? No.

And sometimes it can truly be as simple as we're going to start with our resentment and we're each going to share, I have a lot of resentment about this thing that happened in the past and I need for you to hear and understand that resentment. you know, I resent that X, Y, and Z. You don't have to agree with why they resent it, but the receiving partner needs to lean in and go, you know what, I get that. I get why it makes sense to me that you're carrying resentment. I can hold that resentment. And then the other partner might need to share their resentment also.

Okay. What if one partner can never seem to reinterpret their stories and forgive? Well, that's a problem and we need to figure out what is getting in the way of their interpretation of stories. Maybe some of that is selfwork. Maybe some of that is relationship work. Maybe they need some validation around their interpretation instead of being chronically told you're reinterpreting, you're reinterpreting, you're wrong, you're seeing it wrong. You know, maybe they are, but we most likely what I have found when that is the narrative is one partner's never really being validated for their interpretation or having their interpretation understood.

Absolutely. It might need to be confronted and challenged. But nobody is really open to conf confrontation and challenge until they've been heard and held. Right? So if that hasn't happened, that's the first step. And usually when people start to feel heard and understood, they do start to open up to being able to forgive. However, if a partner is truly just so stuck in their narrative and so stuck in not forgiveness, I would absolutely need to look at that and go, "Okay, I'm not seeing that this is a relationship issue."

I'm going to go ahead and go finish the presentation and then I'll go back into these questions. Okay, so let's go forward. All right, so this is to kind of circle back to should we let it go? You know, look, you know, we shouldn't let something go if it keeps coming back up over and over. If it's just constantly unresolved, that that is a really good sign something can't be let go. However, in just a given moment when you know you get triggered by your partner, that doesn't mean just because you're triggered does not mean that you necessarily need to dive into a repair with your partner.

Either way though if you even if you do determine that there's selfwork to do with that. You can still talk to them about it. It does just doesn't mean that you need necessarily, you know, for them to apologize or or validate how how you were impacted and, you know, the full full repair thing. And, you know, you might you might end up, you know, when you are able to kind of step back and do some selfwork before you go into the repair, you might just end up viewing their mistake in a gentler context.

That that's a time when, you know, you still kind of feel uneasy about it. That's a time when it might be a good idea to engage in some sort of repair. If you notice that you're starting to have kind of negative feelings and behaviors toward your partner, that is a sign that there's something that needs to be addressed. you start noticing that you're not feeling as close as you'd like. A lot of times that's what happens with those with avoidant attachment is they don't address things and they don't necessarily notice a lot of resentment, but they do notice, you know, they they they can say, "Yeah, I'm not feeling as close."

What I have found over and over again is that these kinds of com when these kinds of conversations start to happen instead of just staying up here in this, which is what negative cycles do, staying in these two zones. When these conversations start to happen, the relationship symptoms really do start to resolve on their own. It just starts to shift our entire felt sense of each other and ourselves and of the

relationship. It softens everything. And then you know we have to remember timing is so important.

Later, we'll deal with trying to maybe understand more about why the appearance of listening wasn't there, what was really going on with that. But this needs to happen first. The listening partner just needs to lean into that and go, "Okay, I get it." like you know even if they don't agree with the fact that they weren't listening we all have experienced moments in life where we thought someone wasn't listening and we can say look I know you know I felt like that before that someone wasn't listening and whether I was right or not it feels it's hurtful you feel invisible you feel bad and then they switch later where the other partner gets to share their part of the cycle and their part of the trigger and again when they can do that the symptoms do start to really decrease.

And I get it. I have needs of extra care in other in in some areas too. And I apologize for not being present or if you felt you were being present. You know, I'm sorry if you felt like you sometimes when we're not present. It's hard to explain why I added this sentence in. If anybody needs clarification, I will give it to you. But or for not being clear about my inability to be present. Sometimes we just need to say to our partner, "This isn't a good time. I can't hear you right now. I'm just too my mind's too, you know, worked up from work.

Let's let's pause this and talk later instead of just saying I'll hear you and then not really being present. And, you know, it's something I'm going to work on. Okay. So, your homework is is the next time you and your partner need to repair or if you just want to go back and find another thing that happened that you want to understand better about a cycle, you're going to fill out the anatomy of a trigger. And you can find this on the the website and use the example I wrote as a template to write your own narrative and then share that narrative with each other and see what happens.

So, can we work together on this? Can you discuss the added blind spot that an individual might encounter when they grew up in an environment that was gender specific roles? There was also a religious moral dynamic. Well, I would I would want to know the first question I have is how are those blind spots or maybe blind spots showing up in the relationship? You know, blind spots aren't a problem until they start showing up in something. Are they saying, "I'll never do dishes because the men in my house didn't do dishes, or I'll never do xyz because that's not what women do."

Would it bring up shame? Would it be bring up failures feelings of failure? Would it bring up feelings of unfairness? Because I'm over here doing all this other work that men do do. Does that necessarily resolve the problem? Not necessarily, but it's it's a start. We just I I just would want to understand more. Instead of saying to someone, you just refused to do dishes because of your gender specific role issues that you grew up in. Most people are not going to respond well to that. I would lean in and just be like, give me a little more information around this.

Back away. I wouldn't even say the word stonewall. I would say you just want something feels safe about backing away. Help me understand that. What's so safe about that for you? And absolutely, you need to say here's how it doesn't work for me, right? if you're backing away and that's just your go-to because you don't want to make things worse, but things keep getting worse. You know, that really doesn't work for both of us, but I want to understand more about why you're needing to back away. So, we can maybe work through that and find something different we can do.

Maybe you need to recognize, you know, I shouldn't it's not appropriate to resent my partner for this or I don't want to say not appropriate. Probably some of that resentment does belong to them honestly if it's there. But let's say it's not. Let's say they have not done anything in this area where you have this resentment. We need to figure out is this old unmet needs that you experienced growing up that you just carry some resentment for and you've never had space for that resentment. It's time to be able to say to yourself, I do resent that.

Try to figure out right at the the last negative cycle where he found himself being demotivated. What happened right before that? Because that's the trigger right before that that his body goes into a spiral and then the way he handles that is I can't do this. My wife and I have gone to therapy for a few years. We have talked about repairs. My wife is still not able to express her part or her mistakes or apologize. I'm guessing she doesn't feel safe to do so and not I'm not sure what I could do differently.

- Una ruptura de apego: una persona se siente no escuchada, no vista, invalidada, o no sabe si sus necesidades importan a su pareja, o siente que hay traición.

En los ciclos negativos, las personas solo ven la ansiedad y el enojo del otro. No llegan a lo que está debajo: los significados de apego, las emociones vulnerables, las necesidades no satisfechas.

Si un tema particular (por ejemplo, la vida sexual, el dinero, los hijos) genera ciclos negativos, no se puede abordar bien ese tema sin primero establecer seguridad emocional. El primer paso es reconocer que el tema activa muchas cosas en ambas personas, que hay necesidades en conflicto, y acordar cómo tratarlo con más cuidado antes de retomarlo.

Si el bloque persiste después de que la pareja genuinamente ha validado, escuchado y contenido, puede ser un asunto de trabajo individual: creencias sobre sí mismo, evitación de vergüenza u otras dinámicas internas que impiden ver la relación desde una perspectiva de seguridad de apego.

Ocurre especialmente con el apego ansioso. Una persona necesita ser escuchada, validada y contenida continuamente pero no reconoce su propia parte ni toma responsabilidad. El otro se siente sin lugar para sus propias necesidades.

I have never met a a negative cycle in all my years and all the couples I've worked with where I could say, you know what, your partner is just really randomly trying to hurt you because they have nothing else better to do. There's always going to be something going on down there that's somehow this is the way that they're trying to feel safe and they're trying to feel close and the way they're going about that might be really really awful and actually causing damage and there there's no, you know, excuse for that.

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch9 - Julie Menanno.docx

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Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Sistema de seguridad, protesta y activación' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Julie Menanno, MA, LMFT, LCPC. Terapeuta de pareja licenciada, formada en Terapia Focalizada en las Emociones (EFT). Autora del bestseller Secure Love y creadora de @thesequirerelationship en Instagram.

Um, so I think what I'm trying to say here is that I don't really believe that every single little I know every single little episode that represents the wound does not have to be addressed, but it enough of them do have to be addressed to, you know, make sure the pattern is is being given enough attention. Um, anxious attachment course comment and chapter nine question. I am getting so much value out of your anxious attachment course. Awesome. Thank you so much. I am on section six and the timing is perfect.

Nobody protected you, right? you you had to just kind of on your own deal with these feelings of being rejected and not seen for what your your efforts and not thanked and you you just had the negative things thrown at you all the time and nobody was there to protect you and children need protection from that. They need people in their life to say, "Hey, listen. Yeah, you're getting this thing wrong, but you're not defined by your failings and let's work on this." And you need to have adults who are protecting you from the feeling of being rejected.

And it is hard when, you know, we don't feel seen for what we're contributing and instead we're just getting a lot of feedback about what we're getting wrong. you know that that's not that's kind of demoralizing for me and I do need to hear more of the positive is seen in me. I do that that's part of what helps me feel seen for my whole self and that I'm not just kind of defined by you know my failings in the relationship. I think anybody needs that and I you know to feel safe and close to you. I do need more of that and I I do need to for us to figure out a way to kind of get more of that going in our relationship um in the you know service of feeling better and you know wouldn't it be nice if I you know the consequence of me feeling better is x y and z or the outcome of me feeling better is x y and z and that that's going to help me soften and that's going to help me feel less anxious and stressed and it's probably going to impact you positively.

He just needed some help finding them. Okay. It looks like we have some um questions. SG, do you have a question? Looks like you have your hand up from my end. It looks like you have your hand up. Okay, you if you're coming on, go ahead and come on. Oh, there you are. I was going to say I'll go to another question while you get ready, but it looks like you're here. Yes, I have a question. Okay. Um, so I'm in an anxious avoidant relationship. We've been in a relationship for a long time. Um, I am the one who is aware of this type of thing, attachment, woundings, and and repair and stuff like that.

Yes. I think he's he seems to be affected by the the avoidant um shame. He doesn't want doesn't want to be he doesn't want to be reminded that he has caused me pain. I'm the one who, you know, I'm the anxious one, right? I want to work through the problems. Totally open to okay, what is my part in this? I don't think there was cuz this was a total lie on his part. Um, all right. Well, try try to just, you know, the the the start starting point is we're going to because you can't help him put the shame to the side without him knowing the process of healing and that the shame.

Oh, I can give you all, you know, you can do all the, you know, new skills possible and there's so so so much value in that, but at some point we have to figure out what's keeping her from emotionally engaging enough in the relationship for it to be okay for you, for for closeness to be established and safety to be established. Okay. So, my biggest concern, I guess, if I were to summarize this is, is she doing the work too? Because it really has to happen. Okay. And her lack of work is showing up right now in the cycle you guys are in right now even though you're not together where you're needing you're over here feeling anxious and nervous and left in the dark and she's over here, you know, not really being clear with you.

One of the ways you're describing is to just kind of sit with it. Um, and in sitting with it, maybe you fear it less. And if you fear it less, it doesn't have to be on alert all the time. Um, but there's also, okay, I typically do not have an anxious attachment with my husband except regarding his toxic family dynamics because there is no emotional safety or closeness. Um, okay. So, I'm not really sure if there's a question in that, but it sounds like your the toxic family dynamics are what creates this yucky feeling in your body.

Um, and then the wounded partner also needs to actively participate in healing conversations. All right. What about making space for the wounding partner? At some point, that needs to happen, too. Just because one person has a wound doesn't mean the other person's needs and feelings just go to the wayside, right? Even the worst wounding partner out there probably has some of their own wounds. Maybe not, but still their feelings need some some space, right? Their wounds need some attention, too. Now, if there's been a really if they've done something really awful or done, you know, have really behaved badly, um, you know, there there's some truth to the fact that might they might need to have that stuff on the back burner for a while while we focus on this bigger energy and we create more safety and trust in the relationship.

I'm thinking that just means he doesn't want to repair it. He doesn't know how. Um or he just likes continuing to lie. I'd like to repair it. Well, first of all, you know, he need is he open to information? If he if he doesn't have the skill to go through a repair, um then the there's no way to repair. So, he's got to be open to learning the skills to have a successful repair. So, the first thing I would want to know is is he willing to access that information and work with you. And if not, I think we Yes, I think we're I'm open to it more.

Um, so if if someone's relationship isn't good at staying out of negative cycles around like events that or or situations or triggers that aren't as emotionally impactful as the wound, then we can assume, reasonably, confidently assume that they need to learn some skills before they try to heal the wound. Because if we can't talk about smaller smaller issues, usually no issue is small. if it's causing a fight. But if we can't talk about those things without going into a negative cycle, we're setting ourselves up for failure if we try to keep talking about this wound.

Um right, because she's got her own unresolved work, you know, because she's she's got to do some work, too, because you've said a few things that Yeah, those mean words are not okay. That's not a good way to try to regulate your feelings. But at the same time, those feelings didn't come from nowhere, right? Those mean words are are trying to get some sort of need met from her and they weren't getting met. And it sounds like you were asking and not getting it met. And so I need to understand what she needs to do different on her side of the environment.

Yeah. I need to understand what her fear and block is cuz she and you know I do want to understand that because she's had lots of um failed relationships um and I you know I I want to believe you know she always says her picker was bad and it's like well I want to believe that but um but I need to understand I can't I can't contribute to it without understanding what her true fear is and her block. So, and and saying her picker was bad, you know, there's probably truth to that, but also there's stuff going on with her that caused her picker to not be so great.

Sometimes that will need to happen. Um but in the context of proper timing, right? Again, it's about timing. It's not about whose needs matter more. It's about when are we going to give the attention to each person's needs. Um so in the context of getting the timing right, the wounding partner does need some space to share about their motivations around it or their feelings of shame, right? Um, we just don't want them to use their partner's share time as an opportunity to take the mic and go into their own stuff.

One of the main issues that I have in trying to repair my relationship is I've been wounded. my partner lied um in a big way and we've tried to have a conversation about it. He is avoidant and seems to want to just dismiss that he has created a very big wound. He would rather not talk about it. I'm trying to understand a healthy way to go about repairing that. Like what is a healthy expectation of regaining trust? I'm thinking transparency. He gets upset and just says, "If you're gonna hold this above my head, I can't be in a relationship with you."

It's like I need to know you. You're going to be there for me in my most vulnerable state when I need you the most, when I'm physically incapacitated. Like, there's so much need and trust around that. Um, so and I'm not saying affairs aren't harmful at all. They are they're equally or if not worse harmful, who knows? But they are just not in my experience as common. Um, so you don't need to address every single little thing separately for it to heal, but you do need to address it as a separate incident.

So you need to the conversation needs to be around one incident, right? the biggest one, the first one that comes to your mind that was so hurtful and harmful for you and you need to be able to say, "Look, this is how it hit me. This is how I was impacted. I know you had your own stuff going on, but still, I was super super super hurt." And it it crushed me and I thought, "Are you ever going to be there for me when I really need you?" And I just need for you to know that and lean into that with me.

And it's just like, well, if I don't if I didn't feel that validation, you know, it's just like cuz we I think we sometimes we do things that we think are appropriate, but if if your partner doesn't perceive it that way, then it wasn't in the form that they needed it. And I and that happened a lot in our relationship. And I just said, I understand you think you're adding things a relationship, but that's not what I need necessarily. So just because it's from your perspective doesn't mean it's from my perspective.

- Permanecer en la protesta, el ataque, la vergüenza proyectada o el reproche como único modo de comunicar el dolor, sin llegar a la vulnerabilidad ni a la afirmación sana.

El ataque, el reproche, la vergüenza proyectada y la protesta como modo de comunicación no pertenecen a ninguna de estas dos categorías. No comunican sentimientos, no promueven escucha, y no abordan el problema real.

It could be all sorts of reasons, but that's one way wounds will show up is that you never get to fully relax or you don't get to fully relax consistently. Maybe sometimes you do, but enough of the time you don't that it's a problem. Okay. So, the first thing that has to happen is we have to accept that there actually has been an injury and we need to name it because you can't heal it if you can't really explicitly name it. And both partners really need to agree that there this wound has happened and they need to be able to see it clearly for what it is and as a wound.

that means that there's some sort of block that healing, you know, um that needs to be uncovered for the healing process to fully work. And that goes, you know, beyond the extent of this chapter because it there could be all kinds of blocks. And sometimes it might take professional help um for a professional to help come in and kind of try to figure out, you know, what these blocks are and how we can work through them. Um, you know, again, there's the problem in, you know, if if the endgame is to heal the wound and we go a step backward from that and we say, well, to heal that wound, we have to have healing conversations and behavior change, then to go a step back from that, we have to not be in negative cycles.

When we have the healing conversations, they're not healing. If we're in negative cycles, right? So if you are going into negative cycles while you try to repair, you are ensuring that the wound will stay unhealed and you're also maybe even making it worse because if if someone is traumatized by an event or a situation and then they're trying to talk about that situation and they're just getting met with invalidation and all these things that can be more that can retraumatize, right, and make make it even worse.

We'll start right now. Let's go. Let's start talking about it. But the second you guys start to go into a negative cycle, I'm going to have to pull us out of that and figure out why we're going into the negative cycle because if we keep trying to push through, we're going to make things worse. And you know, we can't put wounds on the back burner indefinitely. It's just a tourniquet. Um sometimes we need to put a tourniquet on them to be able to learn better skills so we can actually be successful in talking about it.

Getting stuck in it is counterproductive. And if it's stuck, that is going to make it difficult to heal from the wound. And both partners can play a role in anger being stuck. Um staying in protest and blame and shaming and attacks as a way to communicate your feelings um without you know well just that in of itself is not helpful. It's not really going to help anybody hear you and it's not really going to address any problem and it's really not talking about your feelings or being showing up with healthy assertion.

Maybe together, maybe not. But um we do need to take a look at it. And if we do both have contributions, we both need to do to take ownership of that. Um my work is to you know own own my contribution if there is one to change my own behavior that might be contributing to an unhealthy environment to recognize the unhealed self wounds which might be blocking healing. Sometimes there's self wounds here that are layered under the actual relationship wounds that can block healing even for the wounded partner that need to be addressed.

And then you might need to move into healthy assertion, which is, you know, I need for this to change really truly because I can't feel fully safe and close. And then that's going to impact us in all these ways. So, I'm really needing for this change to be made. very different from you this, you that, you person, the the hearing partner in that situation, their role is to lean in and really try to stay with you in that instead of going into their own stuff and then later hours later, not not right away.

I want it to go away. And it it needs to have words to it before it's going to go away. That's where my heart is. So, I just need for you to hear it. your partner might need to to have to express their resentment around something too, right? So, a lot of times resentment is blocking. If you have done that resentment anger work and you've cleared up that layer and not getting stuck in it, but just being, you know, anger and resentment need to be heard. If they don't get heard, they are probably not going to go away.

Um, so if that hasn't happened, that would be my next place to go with that. And yeah, you know, there's so many things to look at before we say, hey, I don't think this is going to get anywhere. Um, but at the end of the day, if if the truth is, I cannot re-engage. I am not willing or able to re-engage emotionally and do this emotional work, then we have to say then the consequence of that is no safety and closeness in the relationship. And that isn't going to be a very fulfilling relationship whatever you do with that.

And if they're able to do that and we relieve the pressure off that event, that's going to help with the whole pattern. Now, there might you might need to say, look, and you know this these other couple things that happened, they're kind of the same thing. And it was really hard those events, right? And I just I need you to not know about this one big one. That was just the big biggest one. that I need you to know that it happened again and again and it it killed me. And so there's a way to kind of roll it all in.

I'm getting reminded of this event. You know, it's probably not big enough that I need to take it to my partner. I'm just going to kind of draw upon the fact that we have healed around this and I can reasonably assume that my partner will be able to show up for me and that can kind of be a enough self soothing then that's great. But if it's not and you go nope this is not going to go away until I get some help emotionally with from my partner around it. I just need a I just need to go back there and get a little validation or whatever just so my nervous system believes that that is real and possible if I reach to them for that.

Right now, I am feeling dropped by two avoidant male relatives and I'm feeling the same type of rejection from both of them. In the past, I've felt the same thing with my husband and dad, too. They are also avoidant males, of course. With this course, I can see how the tender part in me that feels I can never do enough in order to be enough is being triggered by these avoidant males. With the course exercises, I've been able to see this pattern for the first time and how it shows up all over my life.

when you posted on Facebook that emotions take about 90 seconds if you can just sit with them. Can you expand on that? Yes. So, an emotion is not meant to last forever in your body. It's meant to rise up, give you some information, bring your attention to something, and then fizzle away. And that that is not my 92 is not my words. It's a Harvard study that was done when they had a lot of people come in

and observed how their emotions worked, what they found is that it takes an average of 90 seconds for an emotion to peak and dissipate.

Um, so the problem is with that process is when people get in the way of it peaking and they get people get in the way of it all the time. That's what called defending against our feelings is called is when we get in the way of the feeling existing. And we can get in the way by going into our head. We can get in the way by react reacting and just starting to protest or yell at someone. There's all these ways that we can get in the way. It's usually some sort of behavior that is meant to numb the feeling instead of just letting it be.

And it's really good for your nervous system to do that because that energy doesn't get stuck. And then at the end of that, you know, you can allow that to happen. You should have a moment of clarity and feel calmer and and more clear. And then you go back and you go, "All right, what what am I needing to do with this here? I don't want to have to keep having this feeling come haunt me over and over. What am I needing to get healing around this?" And that's where the course comes in is to not just help you have the feeling, but to also start to understand and learn more about what that feeling is needing to actually heal.

And I'll talk more about that. So, what is an attachment injury or wound? Well, it's just a profound betrayal of trust that actually blocks any good moments from landing, right? It's hard to take in the good because you have this kind of lingering mistrust and if it's not healed, your body is sort of always wondering when it's going to come back and happen again. that's the problem is you don't know when it's going to happen again. Um or you have, you know, unresolved feelings that need need space to be processed.

Right? So for example that a toxic environment in the relationship that both partners are contributing to um but one partner chooses to respond to that toxic environment with an affair. Right? The most toxic environment, the worst partner in the world can't make someone have an affair. However, we also have to address the toxic environment. So, even if both partners contribute, the wound is still real and it still needs to heal and it needs to be healed separately from the conversation about the wounded partner's contribution.

I'm getting it. I'm empathizing with you. Because empathy is a better motivator than fear. So, we need empathy. A person is going to be far more motivated not to keep hurting their partner if they can actually feel empathy. So that might sound like, you know, I'm just I'm allowing myself to feel into what you're saying, and I'm never going to know exactly how you felt in that moment, but my body knows how it feels to be hurt, too. I've been hurt in life, and it's a horrible, horrible feeling. And your hurt makes so much sense to me, and I just want to lean into it with you right now.

So sometimes, and nobody likes to hear this, sometimes we have to put the wound on the back burner while we just learn better communication skills. um or we at least need to be ready when we start having the conversation about the wound. We need to be ready to back away from it once we start going into a negative cycle. So people will say to me, "When do we get to talk about this horrible wound when we come to therapy?" And you know what I've learned to say is, "We'll start talking about it right now."

Right? We need two two the the two broad categories of healthy or of um healthy communication are vulnerability and healthy assertion. I'm not okay with that and here's why and I have to stand up for that. That's healthy assertion. This is not this is the opposite of both of those things. Um you know we do need at some point the wounded partner to have to attempt to understand where the wounding partner was coming from. We're not excusing their behavior, but this person does matter too. And we at least need to be able at some point to kind, you know, to step into their world.

Done. If they've done all the background work that it can it can be stabilized that quickly instead of why do you always have to bring this up? Look, we can't avoid this. we can't completely avoid this part of town or the the wounded partner shutting down and not talking because they've gotten to the part of town and all the anger comes back up to find them. That just means there's so much stuff that needs to be get attention and be addressed so it doesn't just keep coming up in these ways that blindsides the couple.

I'm the one who's doing research. He is open to it, but I think he uses that he works too much as like an excuse. He seems to use excuses. Um he we both actually follow your page on Facebook. um he'll share things with me that you post, but when this big wound comes up, it seems to be something he wants to avoid. Okay? So, he needs he needs some buy in for because the reality is this. It's going to take a lot less time to heal the wound and not have to deal with it over and over again than it is to have it keep coming up indefinitely over the years.

So, we need to get somehow we need to get some buy in from from him. So I would start with just really validating that you know he doesn't want to go into this and kind of understanding why because what's the fear there you know is the fear that you'll just talk about it indefinitely that the healing process for him seems like it might just be talking about the wound forever and ever and ever and that of course would want to make anyone not want to go down that road right agree with that but um so I would want to know more about, you know, you said, does he just want to keep lying?

And so it makes sense to me that somehow you're trying to stay safe here by lying to it's not working, but like I'm just trying to kind of validate why you would be resistant to this information. Then when you can kind of get him feeling safe like he's not just being judged or told he's all wrong or whatever, then we need to share. Okay. But there's there's still a consequence, right? There's still a consequence of this wound not being healed. We need to really let if you don't want to heal it, we'll we'll figure something like okay, I don't know what we'll do, but I we need to at least be clear about the consequences.

What's the consequence on you of not healing this? Well, the consequence on you is it's not going to go away. We're just you're going to have to keep dealing with it over and over. The consequence on me is I'm going to not feel close. I'm not going to feel really safe because, you know, I can't as long as this thing is lingering. And then the consequence on the relationship is we're probably just going to keep fighting. You know, it's going to keep showing up. And so, I just really need for you to see that there's a lot of good reasons for not wanting to go down that road, but there's also consequences to not doing so.

I don't know what that might be. But the first thing that is absolutely a a healthy expectation is for him just to lean into into your experience. And if that doesn't happen, it is going to be difficult for your nervous system to feel safe and close. So it's not like, you know, I just have this demand because I'm just randomly want you to wallow in shame and feel bad about yourself. It's I want to feel safe and close to you. But to be able to do that, I need to be able to reach you with these moments when we kind of, you know, fall off and I and I feel hurt.

If there are several past wounds regarding the same issue, partner not showing up fully for my medical and other physical needs, should each wound be addressed in a separate healing conversation or should they be brought up as a pattern of behavior? Well, first of all, this is very, very, very, very common. These medical wounds and hospital wounds and childbirth wounds. Um, to be honest with you, I see more of those kinds of wounds than I see affairs is these health things because there's so much on the line.

It's not like deliberately roll it rolling it all in. It's just coming from this authentic place of this pattern. And here's here's some examples of how that pattern showed up. Now, if you do that, it there's a really good chance that the he the wound around the whole pattern, especially if the behavior changes, will start to resolve, but you might still have little things come up here and there. It's if there's a trigger and it doesn't seem like that trigger is going to go away on your own. You can't soo yourself with it and go, "Okay, I know that's hard."

And so really what I'm going to be addressing if I'm working with you as a therapist is what causes that yucky feeling to exist. What is that yucky feeling needing? It's needing help from you to regulate it. And it might be needing help from your partner. Maybe your partner has some work to do with you and you can work together on the toxic family dynamics and kind of stabilize that part that is creating the trigger that maybe he can do some things different to help you, right? Um but ultimately, you know, we are all responsible whether how however the trigger gets there, we are all responsible for knowing having the selfwork to manage it.

She agreed to read it. You know, we've talked a little bit about that. Um, but uh but I don't I don't know. I'm just like, what do I need to do? Just wait. Um, you know, I've encouraged her to, you know, let's talk about this more since we're having these positive validating conversations. Uh, but I didn't know if you had any suggestions. Okay. What would you like to happen? Um, well, I want her to I mean, I've done a lot of work and I'd like for her to see that I've done a lot of work. Uh I do want to uh I think we can be good for each other if we um validate and you know because during the relationship the hurtful words come from I felt like she didn't appreciate anything I was doing.

Like you you have the right to advocate advocate for some clarity. And maybe that clarity is I just don't know right now. Right? And at least that's her verbalizing, right? And you do you do have, you know, it's healthy to expect communication around where she's at. Yeah. And that's a consistent theme in our relationship and I've tried to respect it because she's a lot of times says, "I don't know. I don't know how I feel about that. You know, she needs to process it or whatever." But a lot of times I, you know, it never never got resolved or she never came back to me.

Now, there's also some other factors there. One is sometimes people have so much trauma around their feelings that when they start to feel, they start to panic because they're starting to feel and the panic now becomes a new emotion and then things can get sort of convoluted. And then we have another situation where feelings are coming rapid fire and it's like you you know your feelings will follow thoughts, right? So if you're sitting there trying to sit through a feeling and you've got all these thoughts spinning around then all these feelings are coming with all the spinning thoughts and you just it starts to become so much emotion that it's too much to manage.

All right. So, we're going to talk about um attachment injury wounds and attachment injuries slashwounds, same thing, different word. Um, and you know, just to put this out there, trying to deal with these old wounds that you have, which we'll talk about what those are, um, in negative cycles is going to make them worse. And, um, when we can start talking about these things in positive cycles consistently and over the course of time, that's how we start to heal. And of course, we have to have behavior change, too.

So, we have to learn new ways to talk about the chronic illness in a way that doesn't doesn't be dismissive of anybody's feelings around it. There does need to be an apology and a commitment to change um around these behaviors, but the healing process doesn't end there. We need more than an apology and commitment to change. All right? So healing conversations, they are safe, they're clear. The wounded partner gives a self-focused delivery. They're not just going into you're so awful. You're a selfish person.

Not just that moment, lots of other moments, but I need for you to know how devastating this was for me, right? And then the response from the wounded wounding partner really needs to be understanding and validating instead of taking the mic and going into their own stuff. So instead of just kind of leaving it at, I'm so sorry I put you through that, which can be an important thing to say, right? We don't want to lead with that. We want to lead with something that is showing, I'm leaning into how you felt.

The goal is to talk about it effectively as many times as needed so you work yourself out of a job so you stop having to talk about it over and over again. And if you keep if the same issue keeps popping up indefinitely for years and years and years or months and months and months, that doesn't mean that you're just going to have to keep talking about it indefinitely. That means that it's not getting talked about in a way that's actually helping it heal. Um, so the idea here is is that if we start to have get momentum on healing conversations, the wound will start to heal.

Um, Douglas asks a good question. Is the attachment wound what you bring to a relationship from your childhood or how is it playing out in an adult relationship now or both? Well, I'm specifically talking about wounds that partners create together, right? But the wounds that they create together are heavily impacted by each partner's childhood experiences. It's going to heavily impact the creation of the wound. It's going to heavily impact the creation of the environment that set the stage for a wound.

And it's going to heavily impact how they repair from the wound. So, we can't ever completely separate the two, but I am specifically talking about wounds that were created between partners. All right. So what is what can the wounded partner what might they be doing in negative cycles that are blocking the healing? Well, getting stuck in anger, right? And expressing anger is super important and it's super important that the wounded partner is being able is able to hold that anger. But the idea is getting through it, not getting stuck in it.

But we also need to recognize there's a consequence here because if our partner showing up in the best way possible and really over there doing the work and we're not taking it in, we're not giving them any success with the new work and they're just going to end up demoralized. And maybe that doesn't mean that they don't have to hang in there for a while and see it take effect. But if it stays like that indefinitely, you know, people stop trying if what they're trying isn't getting them anywhere.

So, this stuff does need space, but we have to do it with the right timing. And if there's been some big wound, this partner gets the floor first. That's what we deal with first. Um, okay. So, we also want to ask what is your work partner? What is our work together? And what is my work? Because there is self-work to healing wounds even if you're the wounded partner. for one being able to communicate your feelings effectively. Um, so your work as the wounded partner um I'm sorry that when you let's say the wounded partner is is speaking here.

And sometimes we need to give it some time because the wounded partner is not ready to show up for the wounding partner yet. And understandably, they've been traumatized. Like we we have to do this, you know, in a safe way. And sometimes we have to give them a lot of time and a lot of new experiences in the relationship before they're going to be ready to show up. But that doesn't mean it's okay for them to never show up. We need for them to be able to show up at some point. Some injuries are truly worse than others, right?

It's not coming up as much. It's not taking up so much energy. Maybe it still is, but it's just it's lessening. Um, and again, this can be a two steps forward, one step back process. Sometimes we have a couple weeks go by where it shows up more than others, but then we notice we're having longer stretches where it's not so big. Um, the conversations around it start to shift into more of a place of connection. we're able to kind of bring it up when it gets triggered and we end up feeling kind of heard and understood and a little more connected than in a worse place because we went into a negative cycle.

And I it it finally just came to the head. So now I have a huge wound of where are you? What are you doing? Um you know, are you keeping more secrets that he will be able to lean into what you just said? Really hear you, not go into his own stuff, really try to understand how that impacted you. He may have not done it intentionally. It doesn't matter. He just needs to be with you and how that impacted you. He really needs to be able to say, "I hear you. I get it. That was really hard for you. You know, I'm sorry for my role in that and I'm really understanding that and you have of course you're upset if that's the experience you had.

We won't have to keep circling back to the same place. Then what happens is when I'm over there doing that, then they start doing the same to me and the next thing you know, I'm pointing the finger and blaming them and they're pointing the finger and blaming me. Okay?

So, first of all, we need to make some timing boundaries around this. One person gets the floor at a time to talk about whatever it is that they're trying to talk about with the blame and fingerpointing. So that's we need structure around when we're going to bring these to each other.

But I just need you to shift the way you're communicating and instead talk more about your vulnerable feelings. You know, this happened and you know when you did this thing, here's how I was impacted by that. It really hurt me. It really starts to make me feel, you know, kind of like, can I really, you know, do you really care about my needs over here? And, you know, are you willing to kind of work with me on this? Are we actually a team? And if I don't feel like we're a team, that's a bad bad place for me.

I don't suggest right away switching because what happens if you do it right away, it just starts to feel like, you know, you're just biting your time until it's your turn. So, we want to sit with one person's perspective for a while, for hours, and then we reverse and kind of go back in and do it with the other person. Um, 40 years of marriage wounding is relational, emotional neglect. Over those years, we are working with an EFT coach, but the trust is just not there for me. My partner has often said he was on the same page about something, but later I realized we were never on the same page, big things and small things.

Okay. So I need to unpack as the therapist I need to unpack the root of that mistrust. Why that mistrust is there, what it's showing up. Again, usually mistrust is showing up as a difficulty or a willingness with vulnerability, a lack of safety around that. We can't make the relationship work if we don't have clear back and forth vulnerability taking place. And so, I need to figure out the root cause of that. Is there something that their partner can do differently to help you build trust?

Not overprotecting you, but at least helping you out when you do feel that way and reasonably trying to protect you from, you know, feeling emotionally unsafe in the world. And you didn't have that. And of course, you're needing that from your husband. And you know, it's not all his work. Some of it is your work to learn to protect yourself like you're learning in the course. But what I would say to to your husband or what I would facilitate in a therapy session, I was like, "Look, nobody protected me."

Um, okay. Usually we talk about a repair from a negative event. I have a wound around the absence of vulnerable verbal appreciation. Do we still use the in order to feel close approach with wanting to move from neutral to positive versus negative to positive? Yes, absolutely. You know, that that's gonna sound like, hey, listen, you know, it's been really hard for me over the years to, you know, kind of not, you know, I don't I don't I'm not saying you need to kind of cheerlead me all all the time, multiple times a day, but, you know, it is nice when our partners recognize what what we're getting right.

Wouldn't it be nice if we can get there? Well, here's what I really need for that to happen. Um, you speak about honoring your nervous system and the feelings in your body. Yes. Um, is it reasonable to have acceptance that your nervous system can respond when it detects danger? And otherwise, I need to have acceptance that I can handle the situation and allow my nervous system to calm down versus remaining on high alert all the time. Yes. I mean, there's you we have to accept reality, right? And reality is that your nervous system is going to respond when it detects danger.

There's no ruptures. There's mutual validation. U and I guess my question is she hasn't ever really, you know, like you answered part of the question in those slides about what she needs to do because I was a wounding partner. She said hurtful things to me too and I understood where they come from from her past and her inability to regulate that. Uh, I guess I know patience is obviously a big thing. I It's like how do I encourage her to I guess show up? I don't know if there's anything I can do. I sent her a copy of your book.

Like is she able to see this in the context of a negative cycle that your mean words are not okay? We do not want to keep going back there, but like what was going on on my end over here? Is she willing to do that? Yeah, she's acknowledged after I sent you the her or I sent her your book and when she first started reading it, she did acknowledge that she had her own work to do, but she didn't explain what work that was. Uh I think it was more around validating because she thought she was validating me.

And that's what I'm wondering like I don't know what necessarily her what she feels her work needs to be. So all right. Well, we do we do know this. We know that she's not re-engaging in the way that you would want. Right. And it doesn't sound like And I'm Yeah, I'm trying to be patient. Yes. Yeah. Yeah. And you are being patient. 3 months is patient, you know, and maybe you need to be more patient and let more, like I said to you last time, I think more positive experiences build up between the two of you to keep building up that trust.

Um um but I don't the biggest question is what's her block? That that's the the million-dollar question is we need to know what her block is to going forward. What's the fear? If I go forward, what bad thing might happen? Right? I don't know what that is. Is it now that you're doing this, she has kind of an avoidant attachment style, now that you're doing all this work, is is something going to be asked of her emotionally that she won't know how to give you? Um, is she afraid this behavior will still keep happening?

3. Evitacion, desorganizacion y miedo a la intimidad

Este capítulo separa distancia protectora, desconexión emocional, miedo a depender y respuestas desorganizadas. La intimidad se trabaja como tolerancia gradual a cercanía real. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 3.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definición completa del fenómeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicológico, relacional o corporal según las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Señales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y límites.
- Herramientas prácticas, criterios de aplicación y conexiones con otros capítulos.

Adam Lane Smith/20 Steps Avoidant Falls in Love - Adam Lane Smith.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Páginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraídas: 9.249. Texto curado integrado aquí: 4.299 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Evitación, desorganización y miedo a la intimidad' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

It's time to pull back the curtain on exactly what happens in an avoidant partner's head and heart. I'm Adam Lane Smith, the attachment specialist, and I have worked with thousands of couples where avoidant attachment style was destroying the connection between them. And I've seen exactly where relationships break down because partners don't understand what's even happening inside the avoidant person's brain. By the end of this video, you're going to understand exactly which step they're on at any part of the process.

Not what should I do? What would you need? Under what circumstances would you get that feeling?" And the avoidant person's brain says, "I don't know." By having that calm conversation about needs, feelings, and expectations, the avoidant person feels received and cared for and not demonized. But they also start trying to figure out how to solve a problem. They begin vasopressin bonding with their partner. For the first time ever, the avoidant person feels received, loved, and connected.

Another way of putting that is this, your nervous system knows you are safe through actions, not just through empty words. Knowing these 20 steps puts you ahead of 90% of people who are trying to navigate avoidant attachment style. You now understand what's happening and why. What you need next is the how. The specific tools for each step, the exact language that works, the strategies that match avoidant neurology instead of fighting against it. That is why I created the video course called how to love an avoidant man.

If you're in a healthy relationship, that is. Avoidantly attached people have never felt less connected to you before. So, the pressure goes up, the dopamine drops through the floor, and the avoidant person feels like they're getting zero benefit from the relationship at all. And in fact, this is where temptation sets in because now everyone else in the world gives them more dopamine than you do. This is where temptation sets in. That girl on Instagram, that girl at the gym, that person who texted them, their ex in their phone, everybody looks more attractive than you because the dopamine cliff makes you the least attractive person in their life.

Now, if an avoidant person takes path A, they get back on the hamster wheel and do it again. If they take path B, even if they blow up the relationship and then take path B, or if they take path B during the relationship, ideally, right? It leads us to step 15, the repair. And this leads into phase four, the rebuild. If the avoidant person has a partner who's actually nurturing and understanding, somebody who is not a doormat and anxiously attached in that way and collapses, but someone who does have expectations, but is patient, kind, and gentle.

You've heard plenty of people say, you know, they're perfect on paper, but I just don't feel anything. That's this step. An avoidant person is intellectually evaluating whether someone in their world matches the criteria, but they're not feeling a connection because feeling requires vulnerability that they're not willing to give yet. This is, I want other people to fit this mold. Most avoidantly attached people will engage in casual sex, plenty by the way, so they're willing to date plenty of people and sleep with plenty of people who don't meet that pattern, but they say, this person doesn't meet my pattern, so they'll never be my person.

Gentle accountability, clear expectations, but reasonable and loving, okay? If the avoidant person therefore has mostly a secure relationship with a mostly secure person, they can actually start rebuilding the trust. The avoidant person might say, "Hey, something is not right here and I don't know what it is. Something doesn't feel right. I'm not feeling what I would hope to feel." And at this point the partner might be able to say, "Okay. Let's talk about that."

You just didn't know which step you were on. Today, I'm going to walk you through the exact secret internal process of how avoidant people process love. The steps that most people never see coming. The steps that explain why everything felt so good at the beginning and then fell completely apart. The steps that avoidant people, by the way, will never ever consciously admit to you. This is the pattern that runs behind the scenes. This is the pattern that runs most often without them even realizing that it's there.

You're going to know why they do what they do, and you're going to stop taking it personally, because it's not about you. It's about neurobiology. Now, I'm mostly going to talk about the ethical avoidant experience here today, not much about the manipulative avoidant style. But, I will say this, if you follow along with me today, you will see the exact point where good intention can slip into manipulative behaviors instead. So, let's get started at the beginning.

They fall in love with the intellectual concept of it because they don't have an experience to track back to. Now, another problem here is that in most avoidantly attached people, their oxytocin receptors are blocked. Cortisol actually closes these receptors and blocks them so that you can't get bonding hormones even if someone does release them in you. Even worse, avoidantly attached people usually prevent any activity that would actually give them oxytocin in the first place.

Usually an avoidant person doesn't do this on the first pass through the cycle. They might do this at 35, 45, 55, 65. I had someone come in recently do this at 78. He had been avoidant his entire life and at 78 years old said, "You know, maybe something's off with me. I wonder if that could be the answer." 78 years old. Imagine 78 years of cycling through these over and over and over and over. Nobody's more frustrated than the person who realizes that at 78, by the way.

So, there's a phase at the beginning called the conceptual phase. And in step one, it's called conceptual love. Avoidant people begin to experience attraction in this phase. Avoidant people don't really fall in love with a person first. They fall in love with the intellectual idea of love. They usually don't realize this is happening, but they're looking for that feeling of a bonding hormone called oxytocin. It's a feeling of coming home, of being safe, of belonging to a group or a person, and feeling an intimate safe connection.

This is because the avoidant person's parents and caregivers probably had expectations this high, and now they project that everybody does. Okay? The third thing they look for is the presence of endless dopamine. I only bond through dopamine. Dopamine is all that gives me pleasure. I don't get oxytocin, and I get very little serotonin because I can't engage in emotional connection with people, only intellectual. So, I need endless dopamine hits. The problem is this will never actually work because novelty dopamine of a new partner wears off at 5 to 7 months.

There's internal, let's just see where this goes system playing out inside of them. Usually by this point in the first five to seven months the novelty dopamine is still there. So they're still feeling good and enjoying experiences with you, but it is beginning to dwindle down. And this is why the avoidant person is usually highly pessimistic here. When avoidants commit, they are excessively pessimistic, but they choose to wave that away in the moment cuz the dopamine still feels so good and they have a little bit of hope.

You know what? I have to settle somewhere, so it may as well be here with you. That's not very romantic by the way, which is why they don't externalize any of their thoughts or feelings to you. But remember, the avoidant person is not oxytocin bonded to you. They prevent that. Their receptors are still blocked by cortisol. And they also aren't vasopressin bonded to you, the hormone responsible when we solve problems together. If you've ever met an avoidant person, when there's a problem, they suddenly go dark, pull away, don't speak to you, and avoid eye contact, go to the garage, and solve the problem alone there, and then come back to you pretending nothing has happened.

We just clicked." Now, when a partner says that, they're usually describing incredibly high oxytocin bonding on their end. Okay? The avoidant partner is giving them high oxytocin. "I love you. You're great. You're fantastic. Here's attention. Here's time. Here's care. Here's low expectations. You're wonderful." You feel better in that moment than you've ever felt in your life. However, the avoidant person is getting dopamine. These are not the same experiences, and dopamine must inevitably fade.

Of course, everything begins to feel worse. Okay? The other person's panicking, hurt, afraid, confused, and the avoidant person doesn't have the bonding chemicals that would make working through this feel good or feel worth it. They don't have a vasopressin or oxytocin bond. Dopamine is gone. They have nothing left. This is where step 13, the decision, comes in. Around month 11 or 12 after the rupture, they make a very firm decision. Avoidant people usually say something that's like this very proudly, "I never go back on decisions once I make them."

This is where they start to feel that feeling of at home that they've always been chasing. By having this conversation with a reasonable, calm partner who doesn't try to perform but tries to co-create, that's when avoidant person who's ready can begin changing their dynamic. This leads us to step 16, the reset. Now, over a period of time, the avoidant person might detect that they're hyper-tuned for stress. This is where if they come in and work with me and my team, we begin recalibrating their nervous system.

They come up with what I call a partner model. The person who would give me the feeling I would want would probably look like X. Now, unfortunately for an avoidantly attached person who hasn't experienced oxytocin bonding properly, that model is based on three key things. First is the reduction of fear. Things that make me uncomfortable, things that make me feel too vulnerable, things that make me feel too open, too many emotions. Reduce my fear. The right partner will reduce my fear and not challenge me in those areas.

We'll just exchange temporary dopamine for a little while. They usually don't realize the other person is bonding to them. It's I'm looking for Mrs. Right, but I'm willing to take Mrs. Right Now while I'm finding her. Now, rarely, something else may happen, but it does happen enough that they come to me for help on this. Sometimes, an avoidant person gets swept up by someone who love bombs them completely. Usually someone with their own severe attachment issues, usually loud disorganized or even crossing over into borderline personality disorder.

This leads us to step eight, human inconvenience. Irritation starts building in the relationship. People are humans. So, the avoidant person is bonding with a human who now has expectations, desires, and needs. Maybe you get sick. Maybe it's your time of the month. Maybe you're grumpy. Maybe you're hungry. Maybe you're scared. Maybe work requires too much of your attention, or maybe you want more of their attention and work's taking them away. Because the person is not biochemically incentivized to stick with the relationship through vasopressin and oxytocin, they start feeling a rise of cortisol against you instead.

They wanted to feel at home with you. They wanted the oxytocin experience, but their receptors were blocked from childhood. And every time they got close to real vulnerability, their nervous system shut it down. They loved the idea of loving you. They feared the reality of loving. Not because of who you are, but because how their system is wired. I also want to say this, if you're the avoidant person who's watching this and you're recognizing this pattern, the same applies to you.

Your nervous system runs so hot and so intense that you're chronically in a sympathetic nervous system activation mode in your vagus nerve. We need to get you to a parasympathetic rest and digest mode, a second mode. For avoidant people, the language they like, especially men, is a you have a war mode, let's give you a peace mode. That's what's been missing for them. Okay? They need to feel and experience things like their own emotions, vulnerabilities, emotional truth, received well by other people.

The intensity feels like connection because it's flooding them not only with dopamine, but for the first time overwhelming them and shoving oxytocin into their receptors. It is such a saturation of it that the avoidant person is blindsided and confused and has no idea what's happening. It's one of the strangest patterns I've ever seen play out and sometimes they come to me deeply confused and unsettled about what's happening and they want more connection, but now they're even more afraid than they were before because that person usually ends up devastating them.

They pick the best prospect, or someone that really tickles their fancy. This person looks right to me, so I'll choose to figure it out. Here's what most partners that have this happening don't know. At this point, the avoidant person is laying down internal conditions. These are secret requirements that the prospect is supposed to meet, that they will never tell you. They won't communicate these clearly to you. Now, this is a shame, because if they actually laid down clear expectations openly, that would usually fix the relationship for most people, but they keep these silent and internal.

Avoidant people fall in love in exactly 20 steps. These are 20 specific stages that happen in a very predictable sequence, from the moment they choose to start seeking out love before you even meet, to the initial attraction of connecting, through the chaos of the middle, all the way to either secure bonding on the other side or a complete shutdown of all emotions and all bonding. Now, here's why this matters to you. If you've ever been with somebody who started out warm and present and interested, then slowly became distant and cold and unreachable, and you couldn't figure out what you did wrong, you didn't do anything wrong.

It is a doomed pathway that will never work. Are you seeing the problem yet? An intellectual model of a perfect partner will never inspire fear or discomfort, will never have expectations or pressure, and is always delivering an endless impossible supply of dopamine. This is why avoidant people are not happy. They're not looking for deep emotional bonding. They don't know what that is. They're looking for someone who feels good without requiring vulnerability, and who would play well into the story they would ideally like to live.

This is not, by the way, because avoidantly attached people are narcissistic monsters who want to mistreat other people and harvest them for good feelings. It's because they don't have a concept of anything beyond this. They say, I will offer these three things, and you will offer them to me, and we can both be happy. They think that's a win. Step three is what I call scoping. Now they start scanning. They're tracking carefully how other people fit their model.

Trial and error. Low commitment, maximum gain, testing the waters. Okay? This is the perfect time for them to start using dating apps, which reward that kind of behavior because you're just playing and getting back on the app again and again and again. A lot of times their earliest experiences do usually involve getting smitten with somebody again, but it goes badly because the avoidant person doesn't know what real love is supposed to feel like. They pull back, they try to please the other person, they just try stay distant, they pull away, and even if they pick a good partner, they will usually sabotage it without realizing it, cause hurt, and drive the other person away.

And that brings us to the commitment phase. The commitment phase is second, and this is where people get confused, because they say, "Adam, why do avoidant people even get married?" It's because they believe through trial and error that nothing better is going to come, and that they're never going to feel the feeling they've wanted, so they may as well try to build a family and see if maybe that's fulfilling. Most of them are not sociopaths who just want to play the field forever and hurt other people.

The pressure is through the roof. They feel like they're getting no benefit. And now, they don't know why they're doing this, and they feel like they have already lost. Now, this is the point right here that I need you to hear. If you've been through this pattern, the passionate beginning, the slow withdrawal, the eventual shutdown, it wasn't your fault. The avoidant person was looking for a feeling their own brain chemistry was preventing them from having.

Thank you for trying. I wish you the best. Goodbye." They make this decision internally without even speaking to you. This is what they're thinking about from 7 to 12 months. Five months of silent internal calculations that you're not allowed to have a part in. Now, ultimately the process here is that they didn't bond properly. Not because the partner was wrong necessarily, because the avoidant person's system never allowed the bond to form. And to be clear, this is not intentional, I choose not to bond with you, it's I want it and don't know how to make it happen and I'm afraid of what would happen if I did these stupid things like talking and being vulnerable, not realizing that's actually what would build the connection.

What would you need?" If the partner's more secure doing their attachment work, they might say, "Tell me what you would need. What do you actually need? Let's build this together." Here's where anxiously attached people get this wrong. The anxiously attached brain inevitably says, "I'm doing something wrong." So then the brain says, "What would I need to do?" And that's what they ask their partner, "What do you need me to do? What do you need me to do?"

What can I do for you?" The anxious person is trying to fawn and please and the avoidant person immediately goes to, "Well, what would give me dopamine?" Well, wear these outfits, right? Do these things. Act this way. Do your makeup different, right? Wear a bikini, stand on one leg in a bucket of potato salad and flap your arms like a flamingo. Anything that might change the dopamine. This is where people start talking about opening the relationship.

Both kind of couples wish it would work. The difference is knowing which step you're on and what that step actually requires from both of you. The couples who transform understand that avoidant bonding doesn't work like regular bonding at the beginning. You can't oxytocin your way into their heart if their receptors are blocked from you. You have to go through vasopressin first. That means problem solving, shared challenges, facing fear and hardship together and overcoming it.

There's a very specific test that avoidant men run in relationships that looks like disinterest, but is actually a very critical opportunity for rebuilding the relationship. Get that one test wrong and you will trigger even more withdrawals. But if you get it right, you'll build the exact kind of trust that opens the door to the deeper steps. That video is right here.

A partir de ahí explica el "acantilado de dopamina", el aumento de expectativas, el retraimiento, la ruptura y la decisión interna y silenciosa de terminar. Luego plantea la bifurcación: apagarse (volver al ciclo) o rendirse hacia la vulnerabilidad. La reconstrucción pasa primero por vínculo de vasopresina (resolver problemas y enfrentar el miedo juntos), que reabre los receptores de oxitocina y permite el apego seguro "rehecho", extensible a amistades, hijos y trabajo. Mensaje al partner: no es culpa tuya, es neurobiología. Cierra con promoción de su curso "How to Love an Avoidant Man" y una oferta de San Valentín.

Now, you're supposed to experience this first with your mother. Most avoidant people didn't. Or if they did, it was yanked away from them when their mother was cold, disconnected, overbearing, overly emotional, and it was severed. So, even before they have memories, the oxytocin was removed from them, and they were never allowed to feel it again. They have an understanding that there's a feeling somewhere, but they don't know how to get it. Their system says, "Love exists, but I'm not sure it exists for me."

Number two, an absence of expectations or pressure. The right partner won't be pushing toward marriage. We would have at least 15 years to consider it before we even put a label on the relationship so that we can really take our time. No pressure, no expectations. The reason for this is not that avoidant people hate expectations. The reason is that they project everyone's expectations to be absolute maximum, and they don't converse about what they are, when really most people's expectations are down here.

If they're doing this in their early teens, they might take whoever's around them and it goes catastrophically badly. Then for the rest of their life they have this sob story about how when I was 16, it went so bad and she cheated on me, now I can never commit again. By the way, now I'm 56. Right? 40 years ago someone hurt me and confirmed my fears, so I can never open up to anyone ever again. I hear that actually quite a lot, okay? But by their 20s, most avoidantly attached people are very ruthlessly strategic.

Just the smallest amount. Usually they'll tell you hope is dangerous, but they have the smallest amount of it. If they're ethical avoidant, they model their own part of the love story. They try to give you that love. I will never give you reason to be afraid. I will never put expectations or pressure on you and I will try to give you endless dopamine. They try to do what they think is a good partner. Usually this means overworking, financially providing and building physical safety.

Now, this is where step 12, the rupture, happens. Some kind of a big disagreement hits. They finally admit this is not what they signed up for. The expected feeling is gone. There's anger, there's panic, there's destabilization on both sides. Everything the avoidant person now is afraid of happening starts happening. The relationship feels like a trap. I don't know. I I'm just not feeling it. I I just am not feeling it. What do you mean? It's been 12 months.

You told me you loved me. You told me you want to get married. We're supposed to be getting married soon. You gave me a ring last week. Yeah, I know. I I just I'm just not feeling it. Maybe we're not meant to be together, which of course, to the avoidant person, sounds like you're proposing a topic to discuss intellectually, but to the other person, especially if they're anxious, sounds like abandonment. "Maybe we're not meant to be together." says, "I am leaving you right now."

That opens the receptors for oxytocin. As the cortisol diminishes, they start to feel oxytocin in love. They're bonding through oxytocin receptors that have been dusty and cobwebby. Actually, they've shifted away from oxytocin. They shift back to receive oxytocin again. It's a fascinating process to watch because the avoidant person becomes addicted to that feeling, which is what they were afraid of, by the way. But it's someone safe and loving, so they keep coming back to it.

So, they have an idea, an intellectual idea of what love could feel like, but they have no concept that they themselves are the one preventing it, that their lifestyle and their brain and neurobiology is preventing the very feeling they're looking for. I'll say it this way. They love the idea of love, but they have very little idea about the actual practice of love. Now, step two is love modeling. This is where it gets really interesting. Avoidant people start by envisioning what love could look like intellectually, what it would act like, and maybe feel like, almost like a math equation.

Adam Lane Smith/Falling Out of Love - Adam Lane Smith.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 8.806. Texto curado integrado aqui: 4.074 palabras.

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It feels terrible. People throw their partner away and say, "I'm just going to go find a new partner to have fun with." That's the moment when people really stop trying. The reality here is that you're not falling out of love, you're running a system that just makes love unsustainable. Now, if you're listening to this right now, if you're recognizing this pattern in your relationship, if you have felt yourself or your partner falling out of love, if falling out of love just felt like a thing, and you've been living in it all this time, I want you to know that is not a reality that has to exist.

So, now they've got cortisol and dopamine. Those are the two chemicals to play with. That's it. This right here is why avoidantly attached people fall out of love at about 7 months no matter who they're with because their system is designed never to properly connect to anyone. It was built that way from childhood and it's still running. Fixable, by the way. We'll talk about that a little bit later. The problem here is that an avoidant partner in a relationship structure like this is not going to feel fulfilled or connected at about 7 months to 1 year.

When the other partner, whether they're anxious, secure, whatever, they are increasing desire for intimacy, marriage, family, bonding, moving in together, everything right at the moment when the avoidant partner has never felt less joy, less pleasure, and less desire. Theirs is dwindling as expectations increase. This right here is a major problem. Sometimes avoidant partners get married anyway and now it's a joyless, passionless struggle to just fulfill obligations.

Now, let's talk about what most people are actually doing because that's a minority of couples running that healthy system. Instead, we have novelty dopamine, the scarcity system. This one chemical is holding things together for most couples. Avoidant partners in particular, usually men but sometimes women, they often mistake this rush of novelty dopamine at the beginning for love. Then they mistake the novelty cliff at 5 to 7 months for falling out of love because their oxytocin receptors are blocked.

That's also linked in the description below. It's 91% off right now, just \$97. You get my complete system for understanding your attachment style and your partner's. And if you want to start by understanding where your patterns are coming from, my free attachment style quiz is also linked in the description below. So, if you suspect you could be avoidant or anxious or disorganized, I'd take that quiz. Costs nothing, and it's very quick. It's under 5 minutes, and you get an instant result.

This right here is what begins the falling out of love problem for some couples. Here's another problem. If you're not bonding correctly inside the relationship, if maybe you're anxiously attached and you're addicted to the oxytocin feel because you don't know how to feel safe yourself, so you need someone else to give you oxytocin to stimulate GABA to then suppress your cortisol, you're looking for external regulation from others more like a child does because you never learn to oxytocin build yourself or to manage your own nervous system, then you are not going to be fulfilled either.

So, which mode are you pushing your wife into? It's that simple. Do not wait to feel good before starting. That's what I'm going to tell men. Don't wait for her to make you feel good before you provide emotional safety. The feeling is what comes after you start. Especially for avoidant men, you won't feel at home with anyone because your system is blocked in a number of ways. You have to begin this process first. Remember, her biology will not allow her to respond to any of this until she knows that she is safe and that what you're doing is true and real.

You build outside accountability. It's not just you and her trying to make a change. You're making a change in your entire life. I had a client come in recently with this exact problem. He had burned his wife out for decades promising to make changes. And honestly, he meant to do it. He was not a horrible, manipulative person. He didn't really understand the emotional safety she was looking for. He didn't understand the bonding. He was a bit avoidant.

You have to continuously renew those hormones on their own. And if you don't, yes, the feeling begins to fade. This is the we fell out of love 2.0 version that's not just avoidant, it's life-based. Now, all of these paths end in the same place. It creates a psychology of hopelessness where neither partner feels like they can win. They're not bonded, they're not close, and it feels like the magic's gone. Now, we've also been raised in a culture for the last, well, let's say 60 to 70 years that says sexual feelings are everything, passion is everything, and if it fades, it's gone for good cuz it's just a flash in the pan.

When I work with my coaching couples, as they have a couple of clear conversations and finally break through them, they're not cycling on them for 3 years anymore, they actually complete them. Vasopressin. Now, this does mean if you're avoidantly attached, you are going to have to invite that person into your challenges, into your battles, your actual life. You have to say something like, "I want you to join me on this." That's vasopressin. That's also usually what the woman's been waiting for.

She usually says, "How can I help? How can I help? How can I help?" And the man says, "You can't." over and over and over. When you allow her to actually help and immerse with you, that's vasopressin. That's what she's been waiting for, she just didn't have the word for it. Now, both sides have vasopressin receptors. Men have more more than women do, and for avoidantly attached people, their oxytocin receptors that don't get used much in life shift away from oxytocin to accept vasopressin instead.

No agenda attached, just close, intimate touching. You're going to have to have 10 to 20 minutes of daily screen-free conversation, no phones, with eye contact that rebuilds your emotional pipeline. Now, consistency and explicit communication are both necessary here. Especially the female partner is driven heavily by oxytocin more than the man is, she needs oxytocin more, he needs vasopressin more, but both need both. I got to say that. But she needs things said directly.

Stop. Walk away. You don't tolerate rudeness or abuse, but you understand the fear and pain. If you love your wife and you actually want to rescue her from that fear and pain, this is the process she's testing. Don't do this for a reward. Don't do this because she's responding. Don't do it because you get sex. Do it because this is who you actually are. And when you do this for a few weeks, wives usually begin to actually warm up, especially if you go get male friends who support you in it.

It's the only thing that works for you or for her. You need to face your fears. You need to build emotional connection. You need to overcome challenges that neither of you believed was possible. This should be exciting. It's rich. It's deep. This is what you were meant to do as a couple. What you are really doing when you build this step by step in the right order as a couple, you're replacing your scarcity system with something stable and sustainable and fulfilling.

Whether you're doing this work on your own or your partner's alongside you or both of you come in individually. Whatever you need. We will walk you through how to shift your relationship from insecure to secure. To stable. To sustainable. To passionate and loving. One pattern at a time. And you can do all of this from the comfort of your own home. You risk nothing by having that conversation with us, but you can certainly gain everything. So, do not wait.

And now you feel yourself falling out of love with the one person you swore you would never let go of. By the end of this video, you're going to understand three key things. First, why the chemistry between you feels like it's dying and why it has nothing to do with compatibility or character. Second, why willpower, date nights, and good intentions will not change it. And finally, the five secrets that actually rebuild that bond in the right order starting this week.

It's a relationship system that's running on scarcity. The resources that both people have are very limited and once you see how the depletion works, you will never be able to unsee it. So, from now on, every time you hear someone say, "We fell out of love." you'll say, "No, you didn't. I know what really happened." First, this is a system built off of limited resources. Both people have a limited capacity. This is human nature. They're both also spending down what they have.

Again, you're back to chasing hits of oxytocin with depleting dopamine and an endless rush of cortisol. That's again the falling out of love feeling. The biggest problem is that these hormones deplete on their own anyway no matter what you do. Basic life stress, not having enough time together, going to work all the time, having to focus on, for example, your parents dying or one of you getting sick or injured or cancer or a job problem or medical problems or financial problems, all of this begins to deplete our focus on our partner.

Listen, dopamine's not evil. We give it a bad rap because our society is obsessed with it, but it's not evil. Novelty dopamine is very important. It's a foundation that you need to continue adding in. Without dopamine, it does become kind of boring and stale, to be honest with you. Now, you need to add dopamine into the relationship. Doing new things, having new experiences, that's great. Once vasopressin and oxytocin are correctly in place, novelty then multiplies that bond.

Según el autor, si eres hombre y marido, es vuestra responsabilidad ir primero. Razón: la mujer no puede hacer toda la lista por sí sola si no tiene seguridad establecida. Su sistema nervioso no puede pasar al estado en que entrega presencia, pasión y juego si está bloqueado por cortisol. El hombre provee seguridad para que ese estado se active. Si ella no está segura, tiene que ocupar el rol de proveer seguridad ella misma.

And here's the problem, nobody is refilling it. That's the foundation of what's going wrong. The truth is that love and passion are not just built once and they're not maintained forever on their own. That's the scarcity system in action. You're drawing from a finite supply, never refilling it, and calling that a relationship. And when that drains to zero, all of a sudden, "We fell out of love." I need to tell you about six key chemicals that actually make a relationship work.

I should remember that and come back to this when I want to feel good again." But dopamine depletes over time, so the same hit requires bigger and bigger investment. All the others don't have that impact. They don't degrade like that. Only dopamine. Now, those are the six key chemicals you need to understand for a healthy functioning relationship. Unfortunately, novelty dopamine, the newness of a relationship, depletes at about 5 to 7 months. No matter who you are, your partner is only exciting and they only have that new car smell for 5 to 7 months.

So, you risk nothing by having that conversation with us, but you certainly can gain everything. I recommend you don't wait, you act now, because we are filling up fast. We only take a limited number of clients, and we do not want you to miss the opportunity to get the help that you need. Now, for those of you who may not be ready to start coaching, that's fine. If you're not ready to start yet, then start with the Decoding Attachment Styles course.

But don't go away yet, because I want to show you the five secrets to fixing this pattern and falling back in love with the person you care about. Secret number one is to stop the cortisol bleed. Now, a lot of times couples fall into this trap where they build up all this cortisol and stress, because when you're not bonding correctly, every little bump becomes painful and bruising. So, your cortisol goes through the roof. When they walk in the room, your brain says, "Oh, no."

Once the vasopressin's initiated, the oxytocin pipeline opens, because emotional safety provides this. Oxytocin is that sensation of I belong to you and you belong to me. It comes from mother and child, best friends, good siblings, and yes, romantic partners, especially romantic partners. This means daily non-sexual touch, holding hands, 30-second hugs, squeezing extra tight, sitting close. This starts unblocking receptors from that cortisol, by the way.

Something bonded. You are switching your operating systems from insecure connection to secure connection. Secure attachment. That's what this is about. Now, if you are ready to get direct help with your specific situation, just click that coaching link down in the description. Fill out that application. Again, my team will reach out within a day. That first call together is free. We will start with a deep assessment of where you are, either as an individual or as a couple.

Adam Lane Smith, especialista en apego (ex-terapeuta matrimonial y familiar, LMFT). Su canal de YouTube es uno de los más grandes dedicados a la teoría del apego y la psicología de las relaciones.

This is true of any relationship between any two humans, but especially really hits hard in a romantic relationship. You've got oxytocin, a bonding hormone that relaxes you and feels comfortable and close and intimate. When you feel at home with someone, this is oxytocin. Another bonding hormone, also important, is vasopressin. Vasopressin activates when you bond by solving problems together. You achieve goals, you hit targets, you relieve stress, you do something that achieves something big and your brain says, "You make me feel safe."

That's a scarcity system. You are supposed to be bonding with oxytocin and vasopressin and then releasing serotonin and fulfillment and GABA to suppress cortisol and then bring cortisol down together. That's supposed to balance the system. This right here is what makes you feel at home with someone. And when you renew this chemical bond continuously, every time you renew oxytocin and vasopressin, boom, the passion comes back. Desire comes back. That's a healthy functioning securely attached relationship.

They're not able to bond with that feeling of being at home no matter how good their partner is on paper and I hear that all the time. They also don't bond through vasopressin because they never solve problems with anyone else. They don't trust anyone. So, they're also not going to shift out of sympathetic nervous system into parasympathetic rest and digest. That means they won't be generating serotonin and they also with low oxytocin won't generate GABA.

You're endlessly chasing this binge hit from somebody else trying to get them to make you feel safe and that will exhaust them over time, but you'll also never feel fulfilled enough to actually feel safe in a relationship. You'll never really settle in and you probably won't be solving problems with people because you don't think you can, so you'll stand back and let them solve. You won't build much vasopressin either. You also aren't going to produce much serotonin, so you won't feel fulfilled.

"You are safe with me, and I want you." Backed up by proof of action that's not immediately reaching for a sexual reward, by the way. Sex is great, but not immediately. You need to have the intimacy that says, "I want you." If every act of warmth pivots immediately to a sexual ask, it might to you feel natural, but to them, the safety association breaks, and she says, "You just want me for sex." And the whole thing begins to reset. This doesn't mean don't have any sex with your spouse, it just means also do things that aren't for sex, if that makes sense.

Women are incredibly reactive and very responsive in a relationship. I say this not for manipulation. I say this for men out there who say, "Adam, what is the point? My wife doesn't care anymore." If you can build consistent safety for her, the vast majority of women react peacefully and graciously and eventually passionately because they recognize what you're doing. They recognize that you are caring for them. They are thankful and grateful. No matter what the internet may say, most women are thankful and grateful for the person who provides real safety and real bonding for them.

She can't handle it anymore. She's tried doing the work herself. You won't engage and you've punished her for trying. That's what her system says. So, when you start doing the right things now, most men come in to me and they are overjoyed and say, "I finally understand. I can't wait to go show this to my wife." And they do, and she bites his head off. She is mean and nasty and hurtful. She has no faith in him. The reason for this is because she's going to break you now because she believes you're going to break anyway.

Act now. We're filling up very fast. We only take a limited number of clients so that we can give you the fullness of our attention. And we don't want you to miss the opportunity to get the help that you need. Now, those five secrets, they're a sequence and the order matters. Secret one before secret two. Secret two before secret three. In order. Novelty on a broken foundation does not rebuild love. It just adds stimulation to pain. Oxytocin makes it worse.

You have to go in the correct order. And you don't even have to feel the passion to get started yet. The feeling is what comes after you start. Love can always be renewed as long as both sides are willing, even in a small way, to try to make that connection work. That's what every couple in this position really needs to hear. Now, every man I've worked with who built vasopressin, rebuilt oxytocin, and kept going because it was who he was becoming, every single one of them found the woman on the other side of it was someone they had never fully known.

En el sistema sano te vinculas con oxitocina y vasopresina, y luego liberas serotonina (plenitud) y GABA (que suprime el cortisol). Eso equilibra el sistema y es lo que te hace sentir en casa con alguien. Cada vez que renuevas oxitocina y vasopresina, vuelve la pasión y el deseo. Eso es una relación sana con apego seguro.

Si te vinculas mal por el otro lado -apego ansioso- te enganchas a la sensación de oxitocina porque no sabes sentirte seguro por ti mismo. Necesitas que otro te dé oxitocina para estimular GABA y bajar tu cortisol. Buscas regulación externa, como hace un niño, porque nunca aprendiste a generar oxitocina solo ni a manejar tu sistema nervioso.

- No saltar al sexo de inmediato. Si cada gesto de cariño pivota enseguida a una petición sexual, se rompe la asociación de seguridad y el otro siente "solo me quieres para el sexo". No significa no tener sexo: significa hacer también cosas que no sean por sexo.

El autor afirma que las mujeres son muy reactivas a su pareja. Según los datos que cita, si alguien inicia un cambio en la relación, el 76% de las veces el otro acaba moviéndose hacia el mismo cambio positivo. Y añade que cuando un hombre se convierte a una religión, el 97% de las veces su esposa también se convierte. Lo usa para sostener que la mayoría de las mujeres reacciona con el tiempo cuando se les provee seguridad real.

Propone cinco pasos en orden estricto: (1) frenar la fuga de cortisol, (2) construir vasopresina resolviendo retos juntos, (3) reabrir la vía de la oxitocina con contacto e intimidad sin agenda sexual, (4) presencia real sobre rendimiento (regular el sistema nervioso), y (5) añadir dopamina de novedad sobre una base ya sólida. Insiste en que el hombre suele tener que dar el primer paso creando seguridad, que el orden importa, y que el sentimiento llega después de empezar, no antes. Incluye un caso clínico y bastante promoción de su coaching y cursos.

I'm Adam Lane Smith, the attachment specialist, and I've got 16 years of training and experience working with couples who hit this exact moment. Good people, faithful people who are just beaten down by life, who somewhere along the way lost that feeling and they have no idea how to get it back. What I'm going to show you today is not just why the feeling fades, it's the specific sequence that brings it back. Now, let's talk about why this feeling actually dies for many couples because what's happening here is not a mystery, not for me.

You have my back. We win together." So, there's you are my home and we belong and we win together. These two bonding hormones are incredibly important. There's also this, GABA, gamma-aminobutyric acid, GABA, releases when you have oxytocin in your system. It suppresses cortisol. It's the chemical signature for, "I don't have to be afraid because somebody loves me. I belong." Now, that suppresses cortisol, the stress hormone. That's number four of the chemicals.

So, if it's gone, it's always gone. You fell out of love, you have to find someone new. The problem is that our culture has been chasing novelty dopamine for a very long time because we have forgotten almost entirely about oxytocin and vasopressin. We don't do them anymore. Oxytocin and vasopressin are treated as nice-to-haves if they're even there. Most people only know vasopressin if they've gone through medical school and they understand it as a diuretic and that's it.

It's actually a bonding hormone that pulls us together. Now, the relationship that people get in once that passion, quote unquote, dies or fades biochemically, and they haven't renewed it yet, we'll talk about that. That feels thankless, joyless. There's obligations, there's responsibilities. You have to take care of each other, you have to pay the bills. It becomes miserable, especially in a culture that overprioritizes endless dopamine euphoria.

Me and my coaching team help couples every single day to rekindle this passion. I'm going to show you some steps to do that further in this video, but if you need some help now, we are available, and the coaching link is in the description below. If you're ready to turn this around quickly, click the link down in the description below if you're ready to start, and just fill out the application. My team will reach out within a day, and the first call together is free.

Heidi Priebe/Needs and Feelings as an Avoidant - Heidi Priebe.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 9.597. Texto curado integrado aqui: 4.413 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Evitación, desorganización y miedo a la intimidad' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

So avoidant attachers most often, not always, but most often grew up in environments where their physical needs were cared for, but their emotional needs were not really seen as real or as particularly important by their caregivers. So if they had something like a physical problem, if they were hungry or sick, or if they needed something in a more tangible way, their parents may have been all over it. And because we learn what to pay attention to in our inner world by tracking what our caregivers paid attention to in our inner world, what that teaches the avoidant is that physical problems are real.

So I might need to pay a lot of attention in life to things like my health needs, my safety needs, often as an adult, my financial and security needs. But what the avoidant attacher usually doesn't learn to attune to in themselves from a very young age are their needs for comfort and co-regulation and emotional support from other people. Because if reaching out for emotional support over small things often gets ignored or glossed over by our caregivers.

com/heidip, which is also linked in the description, to find and instantly book a top rated in-network doctor today. All right, so moving back to the topic of emotional needs. The second reason why avoidant attachers often struggle with figuring out what their relational needs are is because avoidance are pretty likely to have a long history of dating people who are more on the anxious side of the attachment spectrum. And anxious attachers can have a tendency to mix up relational needs with self-regulation needs.

And the avoidant attacher might look at the latter section of needs and go well I know how to self-regulate when life gets stressful and I don't feel that same need for constant reassurance or validation from my partner. So, I must not have relational needs the same way that other people do, not realizing that that is not the whole of what relational needs are. Okay? Relational needs are essentially any way that we need to be seen or interacted with in order for a relationship to stay both emotionally and practically functional.

So, all of that is to say that reason number one why avoidants usually don't understand what their vulnerable needs and particularly their relational needs are is because they've been unconsciously conditioned from a really young age to see their feelings and interpersonal needs as not quite real in the same way that other problems they might have in the physical realm they see as real. So they often don't really see co-regulation or emotional support as a need that they have at all because they've just never learned to do it in a deep way.

Hey guys, I'm Heidi Priebe. Welcome back to my channel or welcome if you're new here. This winter on this channel, we've been talking about rupture, self-recovery, and repair. And today, I want to talk about something that is a very crucial part of that process for all of us, which is figuring out what our underlying needs and feelings are in our close relationships. So today in particular, we're going to talk about how those feelings and needs show up for those of us on the avoidant side of the attachment spectrum.

Okay? Because I wasn't making time or space for those things. At least not until my work was done. And the way that I set up my life, my work was never done. And so this is a perfect metaphor for what avoidant attachers tend to do in relationships. Some part of the system goes, "Okay, there are parts of myself that I just need to turn offline in order to do this relationship the right way." And then those freedom fantasies sneak in to give us those kind of mental micro doses of those feelings or those nervous system states that we've been omitting.

All right. So, those three different ways of surfacing our feelings are all bringing us to the final point that we're going to talk about today, which is getting connected to your relational needs as an avoidant. And in some way, that is what we've been talking about the whole time. So, our relational needs are really just any way in which we need to be seen or supported in a relationship in order to stay in it long term without having to fragment ourselves or chronically disconnect from it.

Okay, which is to say that I see a lot of content out there, including LLMs, if you try processing any attachment stuff with them, making this assumption that if someone's not emoting a lot, they must be actively suppressing or pushing their feelings down. And all they need is some encouragement to open up and share in a more honest way. But this is not at all the conscious inner experience of most avoidance. Okay. Avoidant attachment is almost always the result of growing up in an environment where from a young age comfort and connection needs were omitted from conscious processing.

So not suppressed and shoved down or ignored actually omitted. Which means that as an adult, when the avoidant attacher is stressed out and they start going through the kind of rolodex in their head of what might help with the situation they're in, it's not that they're suppressing their connection needs. It's that things like co-regulation just does not show up on that rolodex. So, usually it doesn't even occur to them to reach out and share what they're struggling with.

And those three trail heads are fantasies about freedom, judgments of other people, and states of extreme pressure and stress when they show up in our awareness. So, we're going to start out by talking about fantasies of freedom. So, avoidant attachers can have a tendency to romanticize freedom in kind of the same way that anxious attachers can romanticize partnerships. And the reason for that is because both people are romanticizing the state that they feel the least contracted and tense in.

But all of that is part of the learning process around what different relationships can handle. We offer the opportunity for someone to connect with us from a state of imperfection and then we see what happens. And the flip side of this coin is that secure relationships are also going to be places where there's lots of room for healthy independence and exploration. So each person retains both their selfhood and their kind of center of gravity in secure relationships usually because they have the capacity to cleanly negotiate things like hey here's this need that I have.

It's about challenging the fact that those two things are at odds at all. All right, this video could go on for quite a while because there is so much to say about this topic, but I think that we've already covered quite a bit for today. So, we're going to move into a quick little summary and wrap up. The overarching takeaway from this video is that becoming aware of our feelings and needs as avoidant attachers is not about becoming more helpless or dramatic or dependent in a way that we can't redeem ourselves from.

El evitativo suele tener un historial de salir con personas del lado ansioso. Los ansiosos tienden a mezclar necesidades relacionales con necesidades de autorregulación: llevan a la pareja necesidades sanas (más tiempo de calidad, resolver el conflicto mejor en equipo) pero también necesidades más personales (ayudarles a calmarse ante la presión, mucha validación de su deseabilidad, porque suelen tener heridas en torno a no sentirse especiales o elegidos). El evitativo mira esa segunda parte y concluye "yo sé autorregularme y no necesito esa reafirmación constante, así que no tengo necesidades relacionales como los demás", sin ver que eso no es el conjunto de lo que son las necesidades relacionales.

Okay? So, the anxious attacher might feel like the part of themselves that's usually really hypervigilant can relax when they know that someone who's competent and capable has their back and that they're not going to be alone in their experiences anymore. And then

avoidant attachers tend to feel like they can relax when they know that they're not being judged or monitored by anyone and they're not having to kind of rile themselves up to perform the right way to be.

So, again, pressure tends to be one of those feelings that is totally quintessential to the avoidant experience. So, it's one that tends to live right on the surface and that shows up pretty often to remind us of that gap between where we are and where we feel like we should be. So either where we are with our lives relative to where we feel like we should be or where we are with our feelings in a relationship relative to where we feel like we should be.

And so they don't have a lot of kind of memories in their body logged as times when that's been helpful. They don't really have that template for it. And it's hard to miss something that we don't know exists, right? At least on a conscious level. Now, just because our physical needs might feel more real to us than our emotional needs, doesn't mean we're always great at handling them efficiently. I recently moved cities, which means it's now time for me to find a new doctor, dentist, optometrist, all of that fun stuff.

So, they'll be going to their partner with both healthy interpersonal needs like, "Hey, can we figure out how to spend some more quality time together so that the relationship keeps feeling connected and fresh or can we figure out a way to work through conflict better as a team," whatever it is, but also they have a tendency to bring needs to their partner that are more personal in nature. So things like helping them calm down and regulate through feelings of pressure or stress or just wanting a lot of validation of their own desirability because anxious attachers do tend to have a lot of wounds around not feeling special or chosen.

And then just like the anxious attacher can slip into romantic fantasies when they're single, avoidant attachers can slip into fantasies of being free and unburdened by the expectations of a relationship when they're in one. But the important thing to pay attention to here is when those fantasies come up in either case, how does it feel in our bodies to be having those fantasies? So, does it feel like a huge exhale where all of this tension drops out of your system and you can finally relax?

What state does it put me in when that person is behaving that way? And what's it like for me to be in that state? And then if we want to start building intimacy, can I share the answer to those questions with this other person about what it's like to be me in this uncomfortable state? That might actually go a really long way towards deepening our connection if that's what I'm wanting to do. Now, the final trail head we're going to talk about today for surfacing our deeper feelings as avoidant attachers is examining what's going on for us when we feel pressure.

El evitativo suele crecer en entornos donde se cuidaban sus necesidades físicas pero no se veían como reales sus necesidades emocionales. Si tenía hambre o estaba enfermo, los padres acudían. Y como aprendemos a qué prestar atención en nuestro mundo interior observando a qué prestaban atención los cuidadores, eso le enseña que los problemas físicos son reales (salud, seguridad, de adulto lo económico). Lo que no aprende a percibir en sí mismo son sus necesidades de consuelo, co-regulación y apoyo emocional. Si pedir apoyo emocional por cosas pequeñas se ignoraba o el cuidador se incomodaba y apartaba la atención, el niño aprende a ver las señales internas de "necesito consuelo o contención" como no reales, a diferencia del hambre o el cansancio. La mente y el sistema nervioso despriorizan esas señales.

Priebe explica por qué las personas con apego evitativo (dismissive o fearful) no saben identificar sus necesidades emocionales. Su tesis clave: esas necesidades de consuelo y co-regulación no están reprimidas, sino "omitidas" de la conciencia desde la infancia, porque sus cuidadores atendían lo físico pero trataban lo emocional como poco real. El resultado es que el evitativo aprende que solo puede conectar desde ciertos estados (competencia, alegría) y no desde el enojo, la vulnerabilidad o el desamparo; cuanto más dolor subconsciente, más se fija en "arreglar su vida", y la presión de las relaciones le lleva a retirarse.

So that's either dismissive or fearful avoidance. And something that I find is really common for those on this side of the spectrum is not really having much of a clue what anybody is talking about when they're talking about being vulnerable or sharing their needs in relationships. And I think that the reason for that is twofold. So reason number one is that pop culture attachment theory has this kind of unfortunate tendency to paint avoidance as though it's like three anxiously attached people in a trench coat.

So, ironically, the more kind of ambient subconscious pain avoidance are in, the more fixated they tend to get on just fixing their lives and sorting out all of their problems as quickly as possible. And then because they haven't learned to see their close relationships as resources for helping them to co-regulate through that process of fixing their problems, meeting the expectations that come up in their relationships while simultaneously trying to sort out all of their problems can start to feel like an unbearable amount of pressure, which is very often the point at which avoidance start to pull back and take space from their relationships.

So this is about adapting more secure programming not anxious programming. Okay. Secure attachers know how to connect from states like competence and joy, just like avoidance do, but they also know how to connect from states of struggle and uncertainty like those on the anxious side of the spectrum are generally a little bit better at doing. So they can build these highly resilient connections that can accompany them through various seasons of life.

Or does it feel like a giant rush of excitement and energy like you can finally mobilize to go explore and try things out without guilt? Or does it feel like a total lightness in the system knowing that you're finally only having to care for your own experience? And the thing to keep in mind here is that all of those states are states that secure relationships tend to make space for because in a secure connection, each person keeps all parts of themselves online.

Not everybody's a psychologist, but that's the kind of underlying spirit of secure connections. There's an assumption that both people need to stay healthy and whole and that they're going to have to work together to figure out how to make that happen in the relationship in an ongoing way as life goes on and needs shift over time. Right? And so that's our first trail head. The fantasies that we have about freedom and what's happening in our nervous system when those fantasies come online.

And the cool thing is that once we start seeing that pattern, so when we can start to recognize that pressure is actually a signal that some very important part of us is being sectioned off from our experience in the relationship, then we can start looking at that pressure as a clue about what deeper feelings might be wanting to come online for us or which ones might need to have more room made for them inside of the relationship in order for it to become comfortable and sustainable in a long-term way.

Quien está en el lado evitativo del espectro (apego dismissive o fearful) suele no entender de qué hablan los demás cuando hablan de ser vulnerable o compartir necesidades en las relaciones. Hay dos razones.

La cultura pop del apego tiende a pintar al evitativo como "tres ansiosos en una gabardina": asume que si alguien no expresa mucha emoción, debe estar suprimiéndola, y solo necesita ánimo para abrirse. No es así. El apego evitativo casi siempre viene de crecer en un entorno donde, desde muy pronto, las necesidades de consuelo y conexión fueron omitidas del procesamiento consciente. No suprimidas ni empujadas hacia abajo: omitidas.

Definición operativa: las necesidades relacionales son acuerdos que haces con otra persona sobre cómo seguir conectados a lo largo del tiempo preservando la integridad de cada uno. Camino a lo seguro, la meta no es meter todas tus necesidades en cada vínculo (no con el

jefe o el compañero), pero sí en las conexiones íntimas que quieres mantener a lo largo de las etapas de la vida. Se trata de que la relación se expanda lo bastante para incluir el rango completo del sistema nervioso de ambos, lo que suele requerir creatividad y repetición. Sentir el rango completo de tus emociones es lo que te mantiene regulado (en homeostasis), y tus necesidades relacionales son las condiciones bajo las que tu sistema puede estar a la vez regulado y conectado, sin desconectarte cada vez que aparece un estado que crees incompatible con la conexión. El fondo es cuestionar que esas dos cosas estén reñidas.

So maybe they kind of get uncomfortable and turn their attention away from us when we're in emotional distress. We learn to see the inner cues that alert us to the need for comfort or emotional containment from other people as not real. The way that other cues like hunger or exhaustion are real. And so our minds and nervous systems naturally start deprioritizing those cues and we don't pay as much conscious attention on them when they show up in our systems.

So if we need to take space every time we subconsciously start feeling not okay and then we can only allow ourselves to be back in connection in a real and embodied way once we feel good again. It's going to be pretty hard to sustain any relationship that requires consistency. Right? Unless and until we can figure out how to connect with people from different states. So sensitizing ourselves to our feelings and needs as avoidance is not about making ourselves weaker or less capable or reaching inward and trying to pull out pain that otherwise doesn't exist.

Right? It's just about figuring out what's already going on under the hood for us. Letting those things come into conscious awareness and then giving other people the opportunity to see and relate to us in those emotional states. So that we stop seeing relationships as another challenge that we need to rise to in a perfect way which compounds our stress and we start seeing them as things that can function more as a pressure release valve when we're struggling which again makes them way more integrable into our lives as a whole.

So, you're allowed to be a low functioning version of yourself some days. And it isn't going to freak out or disregulate the other person to see you struggling because secure people assume of course you struggle sometimes. You're a human being. That's part of the whole thing, right? But in order to get into that type of relationship, we have to be willing to connect from that place where we're struggling or feeling underresourced and to admit it rather than shutting other people out from seeing it.

So, another way of saying that is that relational needs are agreements that we make with another person about how we can stay in connection across a long period of time while preserving each person's sense of wholeness. And to figure out what our specific relational needs are, all we really have to do is look at where we naturally disconnect from connection and why. So, if you tend to avoid people when you're feeling depressed, being seen and known in your depression is a relational need for you.

Maybe we're not trying to preserve a connection with our boss or our coworker where we bring in every single thing that we're feeling during the workday. But when it comes to those deep intimate connections that we want to keep with us throughout different seasons of our lives, this is the kind of stuff that it becomes really important to be able to let other people in on. Relational needs are about how the relationship needs to expand and become big enough to include the full nervous system range of both people.

Lo que sí llega a la conciencia son los efectos de segundo orden de ignorar esas señales. Normalmente, cuando el cuerpo registra necesidad de consuelo, descanso o conexión, manda señales que producen pensamientos como "llama a un amigo y cuéntale, ve a por un abrazo, tómate la tarde libre" (igual que el hambre hace pensar en pizza o ensalada). Pero si la mente aprendió a omitir esas necesidades, lo que aparece en su lugar son pensamientos sobre lo que el evitativo asocia con la conexión: "ordena tu vida, haz algo bien, sé útil a alguien o a un grupo". Porque aprendió que ese es el estado desde el que le está permitido conectar.

La otra cara: las relaciones seguras también dejan mucho lugar para la independencia y la exploración. Cada persona conserva su individualidad porque sabe negociar limpio: "tengo esta necesidad, parece chocar con una tuya: ¿cómo hacemos la relación lo bastante grande para las dos, o llegamos a un acuerdo con el que ambos estemos suficientemente conformes, porque seguir cerca importa más que expresar esta necesidad de esta forma concreta?". No lo dicen con esas palabras, pero ese es el espíritu: ambos tienen que mantenerse sanos y enteros, y van resolviéndolo juntos a medida que la vida cambia.

Heidi Priebe. Divulgadora en YouTube sobre teoría del apego y crecimiento personal. Licenciada en Psicología y con un MSc en Attachment Theory & Research (Roehampton). Sin práctica clínica, pero con formación específica real en apego y buena reputación de rigor divulgativo.

Propone tres "puntos de partida" (trail heads) para sacar a la conciencia lo que pasa por debajo: (1) fantasías de libertad -observar qué estado del sistema nervioso romantizan, porque una relación segura también admite ese estado-; (2) juicios sobre los demás -preguntarse "¿a mí qué me importa esto?" para descubrir lo personal que esconde el juicio, ilustrado con su anécdota de la compañera y el viaje a México-; (3) la presión -señal de que está dejando fuera demasiado de su experiencia interna; la diferencia entre presión y flow. Concluye con la definición de necesidades relacionales: los acuerdos que permiten seguir conectado a largo plazo sin fragmentarse, identificables mirando dónde y por qué uno se desconecta. Meta: apego seguro, no programación ansiosa. (Incluye un bloque publicitario de Zocdoc.)

But what does show up in our conscious awareness is usually the second order effects of ignoring those cues. So what does that mean? It means that normally when our bodies are logging needs for things like comfort and rest and connection, what happens is that our bodies send cues up to our conscious mind that give us thoughts like go call a friend and talk to them about your problems or go get a giant hug from someone or take the afternoon off work and give yourself a break.

So if those underlying needs for connection and co-regulation are largely being hidden from our conscious awareness, but surfacing them is going to help our relationships get way more sustainable, the natural question that arises next is how do we go about surfacing those things? So for the rest of this video, we're going to talk about three different trail heads that we can start watching out for in our conscious awareness that might help us connect to what's going on on a deeper level for us.

It seems like it's in conflict with one of the needs that you have. So, how can we either make the relationship big enough to accommodate both of those things or just figure out a trade-off that we're both happy enough with because we know that staying close to each other is more important to each of us than being able to fully and completely express this need in this particular way is. And of course, they don't say that in those exact words, right?

But the parts of me that are exhausted or that are needing that comfort on route to that goal don't just go away. Okay? I have to exert more and more mental and emotional energy trying to suppress those parts the longer I ignore them for. And so that's the difference between a state of pressure and a state of flow. In both states, we might genuinely be performing at a high level and getting a lot of stuff done, but a flow state accounts for the whole of us when we're in it.

That allows me to stay in connection with the project that I'm working on without losing my authenticity or having to change my state. If I'm putting off calling someone because I feel stressed out, what if I gave them a quick call and just said, "Hey, I miss you and I really want to connect and I'm super stressed out right now and don't have a lot of time. Do you have 5 to 10 minutes?" If I'm in a situation where I'm feeling distracted or not present because there's something else going on in some other area of my life that's not relevant.

4. Ciclo negativo, conflicto y reparacion

Este capitulo organiza el conflicto como ciclo co-creado. No busca culpables aislados: identifica pasos repetidos, verguenza, defensividad, protesta, retirada y reparacion observable. Fuentes integradas en este capitulo: 0.

Estructura interna del capitulo

- Definicion completa del fenomeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicologico, relacional o corporal segun las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Senales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y limites.
- Herramientas practicas, criterios de aplicacion y conexiones con otros capitulos.

5. Comunicacion, necesidades, limites y compasion

Este capitulo convierte necesidades y limites en lenguaje operativo. Pedir, reparar y protegerse no son actos opuestos si se hacen desde claridad y responsabilidad. Fuentes integradas en este capitulo: 3.

Estructura interna del capitulo

- Definicion completa del fenomeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicologico, relacional o corporal segun las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Senales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y limites.
- Herramientas practicas, criterios de aplicacion y conexiones con otros capitulos.

Balancing Compassion and Boundaries - Transcript.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 2. Palabras extraidas: 723. Texto curado integrado aqui: 157 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Comunicacion, necesidades, limites y compasion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

On the opposite end are people who bring the focus only onto their own experience: "I feel upset by this, so I need to cut you off - you're a bad person." They're quick to set extreme boundaries - concrete walls that push people away, rather than boundaries that inform the dynamic and tell the other person how you want to be related to. This isn't heartlessness; it's protective. Pushing people away too quickly is often a way of avoiding closeness, discomfort, conflict, difficult conversations, and being seen. You often see this in people with an avoidant attachment style: there's such a lack of safety in connection, and conflict isn't experienced as safe in any capacity, so they avoid it. This is problematic because it comes with a tendency to be quite judgemental - with ourselves and others - and to easily project our fears. We have to find the centre between the two ends.

Thais Gibson/Wounded Bird Syndrome - Thais Gibson.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 5.925. Texto curado integrado aqui: 2.735 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capitulo 'Comunicacion, necesidades, limites y compasion' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

And of course, you become an addict because there's first a lot of pain preceding this. You know, I don't talk about it a ton, but there was a lot that I experienced as a child, and I know that that's so many of you watching this channel. Now, a big way out of that pain for me wasn't just doing the work on the subconscious mind and learning to recondition and heal and really target root cause, but my whole journey of healing actually began with exploring a lot of spiritual teachings from sort of a place of desperation and fear, but what allowed me to really, you know, develop a relationship to God, something that was extremely powerful for me, something I think is unique to everybody in their own way, and I'm not saying that anybody absolutely needs to have a relationship to God in the way that I see fit, you know, I definitely think everybody has a unique flavor and I respect everybody's beliefs around that topic, but a lot of spiritual teachings tell you that when suffering is ripe, when suffering is really happening, God is near.

I just wanted to pop in here and let you know we are doing a 7-day free trial to the All Access membership pass at PDS, which means you get access to literally everything inside of the school. And this includes the four live webinars I do with our students every single week. And on top of that, you get access to all of our different courses. We have over 55 different courses on relationships, communication, boundaries, emotional mastery, guilt and shame, learning your needs, so many different facets that are really important to master our lives and feel really good about our lives going forward.

If pain is supposed to be helpful, if there's an opportunity, how did this serve me?" And as I started writing, I like couldn't believe what started coming out. I was like, "Whoa." Because I was alone, I actually found this relationship to God, which was very healing for me. Because I was alone, I started getting into personal growth work and learning who I was and actually building a relationship to myself. And that's been one of the best gifts I've ever received.

Look at your career area of your life, your financial area of your life, look at your mental or learning area of life, look at your emotional or personal growth area of life. And after you do career, financial, mental, emotional, look at your spiritual area of life, your physical area of life, like your health, your routines, the way you show up for yourself, your physical space can be included in that. And then relationships, friendships, family, romantic relationships.

And if you're still in your pain right now, here's a variation of this exercise that I have for you. If you're still in it, I want you to ask yourself this. Because the faster you come up with the answers to these questions, the faster you're going to move through this. I want you to ask yourself, what is this painful experience trying to teach me? How do I need to be there for myself more or show up for myself in a way that I haven't yet? I want you to ask yourself, how can I grow through this experience?

As a fearful avoidant attachment style, there's a pretty good chance that you have wounded bird syndrome. In other words, you find yourself being attracted to and wanting to invest in people that you have to fix or save. But here's the reality. You doing this over and over again actually says something incredibly surprising about you. And until you find out what this is, you will keep repeating the same patterns and eventually the wounded birds usually don't show up in reciprocity for you.

Like painful breakups or painful things that had happened in childhood. And I was like, "Okay, how did this serve me? What did I learn? How did I grow?" Another great question to ask is what was I forced to let go of that was no longer working in my life? Because sometimes I think when painful things happen, it's also, you know, really pulling us away from those attachments we have to maybe the wrong relationship or the wrong friendship or the wrong job that's maybe, you know, keeping us at a glass ceiling and not allowing us to really reach our full potential.

You know, I wasn't showing up in any good ways. And so, you know, I reached out for help and I just didn't get the support that I was hoping for and needing in any way. And I really held that deeply. That was weighing heavy on my heart and I had a lot of resentment and a lot of hurt around that. And I was like, "Yeah, you know, kind of like, see, this doesn't make sense." But I asked myself these questions. I asked

myself, "Okay, when I felt really alone during those times, these things that I know I'm still, you know, they're still weighing on me, how did this serve me?

Or what skills do I need to develop to help me weather this storm and come out the other side more quickly? Is there somebody I need to ask for support? Or is that support going to come from myself? And I want you to look and really look at that perspective. Maybe it's sometimes when we have nobody, just like at one point I felt like that. You know, at certain times, right? We feel like that, but that's sometimes because that's your time to really figure out who you are and dig deep into yourself and be there for you.

And you're left feeling empty in the relationships that you literally invest your whole heart into. So in today's video, I'm going to break down for you what this is actually all about, why you keep attracting wounded people, and exactly what it says about you, and what to do to finally break the cycle. As many of you know, if you've been following this channel for a while, I was somebody who struggled with addiction at a very young age, just before I turned 15, became addicted to painkillers after a knee surgery, and really struggled until about 20 and a half years old in a big, big way.

Like, everything is going to change. I'm going to end up in a way better relationship 5 years later. You might not suffer as much at the time. But because we don't know what we don't know yet, we suffer so much more. Okay? So there's this idea that it's really our conditioning that is suffering the most. It's not necessarily who we are at our core, but the attachments that we're losing that are being peeled away. And so we all have this conditioned self, and this conditioned self is really the personality traits and adaptations we make and behaviors we have, but it's also the attachments we have to things.

And last but not least, there's a daily community event. We have trained facilitators and coaches who are in there doing that work, showing up to support you on your journey every single day. And along with that, you actually get to keep as a gift for life access to our codependency course. It'll help you rewire your codependent patterns at the root, leveraging neuroscience and helping you change the limiting beliefs that are holding you back and keeping you burnt out so you can feel recharged, be in reciprocal relationships, and actually start connecting to people in an entirely new way.

I'm going to honor how I feel about it. I'm not going to skip over feeling the feelings.' But when I've had a chance to do that and really like allow that myself to feel my emotions in my body, I'm going to move into a space where I'm like, 'Okay, what is this trying to show me? What is this trying to teach me? How can I grow to move through this experience even better? What do I need to learn?' " For some people it's boundaries. For some people it's vulnerability that their painful experience is trying to teach them.

There's this old theme in a lot of spiritual teachings as well that talk about how, you know, when you are suffering, a lot of what's suffering is your attachments to your conditioning, right? You think something's being taken away from you and maybe that's for, you know, the greater good. I'm sure everybody's had the experience of losing somebody in a relationship, going through a breakup, and feeling like the world is ending. And later looking back and being like, oh, that was the best thing that could have happened to me.

I mean, some really beautiful ones. It's like sometimes when you go through a painful breakup, that actually detaches you from somebody else, but it attaches you to the relationship with yourself. Right? Sometimes we find ourselves through suffering that way. And there's countless examples of this, but if you feel comfortable sharing, I would love to hear from you in the comments about how pain or suffering have actually had another side to it. It doesn't take away from this painful side here, but there's another part of the story.

Gibson parte del "síndrome del pájaro herido": las personas con apego evitativo temeroso (fearful avoidant) se sienten atraídas por gente a la que tienen que arreglar o salvar, vuelcan todo su corazón y acaban vacías por falta de reciprocidad. Lo conecta con la codependencia y con su propia historia de adicción a analgésicos en la adolescencia. Introduce la idea del "yo condicionado": gran parte del sufrimiento no es por quiénes somos, sino por el apego a cómo creemos que las cosas deberían ser, y la resistencia a la realidad genera sufrimiento extra.

In other words, even if it meant, you know, violating my own boundaries to make sure somebody was okay. Even if they had been hurtful to me first or they weren't a healthy person to be around. Like these types of things that you see a lot with codependents that probably if you're watching this video, you can relate to. But, here's the really interesting part. If you dare to look, you might see another side to pain. And this goes back to this idea that pain is not one-sided.

And so, I want you to ask yourself those questions. Now, if you choose to look at painful events through that lens, okay? Under the assumption, let's just say we have no idea what the purpose of pain is. But let's say we're going to just commit to spending our lives going, "You know what? I'm going to choose to see pain as a growth opportunity every time it comes. I'm going to choose to see pain as, 'Hey, this is really hard, and I'm going to honor my pain.

Now, how does then comes into and relates to codependency is that when it comes to codependency, part of why, just like I shared, I was so scared for other people to be in pain, that I was going to violate my own boundaries to make sure no one was suffering or no one was in pain, well, I realized that wait, maybe like by every time that I do that, I enable other people to not take their lessons away from their own pain. Maybe I actually rob them of any purpose that pain has in their lives.

But then I would say to somebody, you know, "What skills can you develop to move through this that can support you? Is there anything that this experience is trying to show you or grow you in a specific way? Is there anything that this painful experience is trying to force you to let go of that's not working for you?" I would ask those same questions. And be there instead of doing things for other people in my life, be able to hold more space and be there from a place of, you know, support and love and care, but without the interference.

Con apego evitativo temeroso (fearful avoidant) hay bastante probabilidad de tener "síndrome del pájaro herido": te atrae e inviertes en personas a las que tienes que arreglar o salvar. Hacerlo una y otra vez dice algo sorprendente de ti, y mientras no lo veas, repetirás el patrón. Los "pájaros heridos" no suelen aparecer con reciprocidad, y te quedas vacío en relaciones en las que pones todo. Está ligado a la codependencia.

And our conditioned self isn't necessarily our true self, right? Our conditioned self is the way that we've been conditioned to see pain because of our experiences. So, you know, you look at a young baby and a baby comes into the world. And a baby learns that, okay, you're going to get punished for, you know, being too loud, perhaps, and rewarded for being quiet. And so as a result of that experience, the child adapts and they adapt to become more quiet because they think, okay, well, if I'm more quiet, then my needs will get met.

Idea central: gran parte de lo que sufre es el apego a tu condicionamiento. Crees que te quitan algo, y a veces eso es para bien. Casi todos han pasado por una ruptura sintiendo que el mundo se acababa y, al mirar atrás, han visto que fue lo mejor que pudo pasar; pero en el momento sufrieron más porque estaban apegados a su idea de cómo debía ser. No es tanto quién eres en tu núcleo lo que sufre, sino los apegos que se desprenden.

Como resultado de que las cosas no salgan como queremos y del dolor de esa resistencia, acabamos temiendo que los demás sufran: "sé lo doloroso que es, no quiero que otros estén en dolor". La autora, codependiente y fearful avoidant, notó que le aterraba el dolor ajeno y

llegaba a extremos para evitarlo, incluso usando su empatía en su contra: violar sus propios límites para asegurarse de que el otro estuviera bien, aunque ese otro la hubiera herido o no fuera sano.

Thais Gibson, fundadora de The Personal Development School (PDS) y creadora de la Integrated Attachment Theory. Canal de YouTube muy amplio dedicado a estilos de apego, patrones subconscientes y crecimiento personal. (Nota: su marco no está validado en revistas académicas, pero tiene gran audiencia y contenido muy estructurado.)

We're like, "Oh, I know what pain is like and I know how painful it is to suffer and so I really don't want other people to be in pain." And so for myself as a person, I was very codependent and you know, I was a fearful avoidant attachment style. As I started my healing journey, you know, I was able to move through a lot of things and really do a lot of healing, but I also noticed myself being just terrified of other people being in pain. And I would go to great lengths to stop them from being in pain even if it meant sort of weaponizing my empathy against myself.

Because I was alone, I was forced to learn about accountability and step out of this victim mindset that I had put myself in. And that was huge for me. That gave me so much freedom in my future. Because I was alone, I had to learn to be more resourceful. And that led me into being able to have all these life skills that in turn, you know, over time, I didn't know this at that exact moment, but allowed me to build businesses and share and teach and connect with other people in such a beautiful way.

6. Discernimiento, dating, ruptura y eleccion de pareja

Este capítulo trata la eleccion como practica de realidad: ver disponibilidad, reciprocidad, valores, consistencia y capacidad de reparacion antes de invertir fantasia. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 5.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definicion completa del fenomeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicologico, relacional o corporal segun las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Senales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y limites.
- Herramientas practicas, criterios de aplicacion y conexiones con otros capitulos.

HOW TO STOP SETTling FOR POTENTIAL - Transcript.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 1. Palabras extraidas: 303. Texto curado integrado aqui: 303 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Discernimiento, dating, ruptura y eleccion de pareja' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

How to Stop Settling for Potential English transcript Situations where we kind of catch ourselves thinking things like “but I know who they could be, I know their potential, if they just changed XYZ then everything would be amazing.” And basically we keep ourselves in that situation where we are not really fulfilled, and we struggle to let go and to actually look at the reality of the person that they are right now. So what does it mean when we're settling for potential? One sign might be when we find ourselves constantly thinking about the future, not the present moment - “if it was like this...” If you catch yourself fantasising about moments with them where they're actually very different from how they are now, that's a sign of our own making that we are not actually looking at the person that they are right now. So you might be feeling like you are waiting: waiting to finally connect, to get commitment, waiting for them to get their life together, waiting, sitting, hoping one day it's going to be different. That's a clear sign that we're more attached to the potential of them than to the actual person they are. You also will notice that you just continue to complain to your friends about the same thing again and again and again, and you are struggling to let it go. And that's something you will see in the dynamics - that you probably forgive the same behaviour again and again. You will have the same conversation without any changes. It takes time in a relationship to shift a dynamic; it's not going to be with one conversation, but you will see changes, little ones. If there is no change happening, we are holding on to potential.

Why You're Struggling to Find Love - Transcript.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 4. Palabras extraidas: 2.039. Texto curado integrado aqui: 225 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Discernimiento, dating, ruptura y eleccion de pareja' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

Instead of imagining the person will change, look at how they treat you now. The biggest indicator is conflict: how did you get through a disagreement? That's what your future looks like. We talk about rupture and repair - everyone has ruptures. If you've been dating six months with no rupture, you're not going deep enough; you're still on best behaviour. A good repair sounds like: “Let's take 15 minutes and come back when we're not so heated,” or “I thought about it, I was wrong, I'm sorry, here's what I'd do differently.” And a partner who can receive that without shaming you - “I appreciate that, and how can I be more supportive next time?” - that's beautiful. That's your future, but you have to see it in the present. If you're making plans in your head but are uncomfortable talking about them, they only exist in your head - they aren't real. Closing Closing takeaways: You can't attract the right person until you get to know yourself. You can't receive what you want until you learn to ask for it. You will attract what you're willing to entertain. And real chemistry comes from honesty, openness, and courage. Love isn't found, it's created - and you're worthy of creating it.

7. Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia

Este capítulo integra heridas, identidad y responsabilidad personal. El trabajo interno no sustituye las relaciones: cambia la posición desde la que se entra en ellas. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 9.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definición completa del fenómeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicológico, relacional o corporal según las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Señales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y límites.
- Herramientas prácticas, criterios de aplicación y conexiones con otros capítulos.

Inner Work/1-The-Inner-Work.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 5. Palabras extraídas: 1.550. Texto curado integrado aquí: 690 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

The Inner Work Investigación profunda del libro de Mathew Micheletti y Ashley Cottrell - el sistema individual y los 15 temas de conciencia
Junio 2026 Índice general Nota de método 1 FASE 1 - Arquitectura del sistema individual 2 1.1 Tesis: la conciencia crea la experiencia [E] .
..... 2 1.2 Ego vs Self [E/I] 2 1.3 El espacio entre estímulo y respuesta
[E] 2 1.4 La sombra y el viaje del héroe [E] 2 1.5 El sufrimiento como señal
[E/I] 2 1.6 Los temas de conciencia [E] 2 FASE 2 - Los 15 temas
de conciencia (versión individual) 2 Zona de herida (Wounding) - corazón cerrado, por debajo del umbral 3 Zona de sanación (Healing) - transición a la salud 3 Zona de plenitud (Enlightenment) - corazón abierto 3
FASE 3 - El método de 3 pasos y el trabajo de sombra 3 3.1 Método de 3 pasos [E] 3 3.2
Aplicación al trabajo de sombra [E/I] 3 3.3 Fundamento espiritual [E][C]
... 4 FASE 5 - Ingeniería de conocimiento (individual) 4 5.1 Cadena del sistema 4 5.2 Reglas
IF → THEN 4 FASE 7 - Ensayo 4 Fuentes 4 Nota de método Documento centrado solo en
The Inner Work (2019), el libro individual y fundacional del sistema. El segundo libro aplica este motor a la pareja; este lo trabaja dentro de
una sola persona. Etiquetas: • [E] Explícito - atribuido a los autores según fuentes públicas (fichas, Shortform, Blinkist, Bookee , web del
autor). • [I] Inferencia - reconstrucción a partir de la lógica del sistema; no literal del libro. • [C] Contexto externo - marco ajeno para situar o
aclarar . 1

3.3 Fundamento espiritual [E][C] El sistema mezcla psicología occidental con tradiciones contemplativas: hinduismo, budismo, cristianismo
y filosofía del yoga. La meta última (libertad, paz, autenticidad) se expresa en lenguaje de autorrealización. [C] Conviene separar este
registro espiritual del psicológico si se busca rigor clínico. FASE 5 - Ingeniería de conocimiento (individual) 5.1 Cadena del sistema
conciencia → herida → creencia-programa → tema activo → disparador → activación → reacción (atrapamiento/represión) → sufrimiento .
La intervención entra entre disparador y reacción (el espacio). 5.2 Reglas IF → THEN R1 IF se detecta un disparo emocional THEN paso
1: nombrar la emoción y el pensamiento sin juzgar. R2 IF hay culpa externa ("es por su culpa") THEN paso 2: devolver el foco a la
creencia-programa interna, sin invalidar el hecho. R3 IF se identifica una creencia limitante THEN paso 3: ofrecer una narrativa alternativa
más amplia y elegir conscientemente. R4 IF la reacción es desproporcionada al estímulo THEN evaluar contenido de sombra / herida
infantil activa. R5 SIEMPRE: tratar la emoción como información, no como enemigo; ninguna emoción se reprime. FASE 7 - Ensayo [E][I]
The Inner Work es la base individual del sistema. Su tesis idealista -la conciencia configura la experiencia- sostiene una psicología de
estados (los 15 temas) en vez de rasgos: nada está fijado, todo es revisable. El mecanismo es claro y enseñable: identificar el tema y la
creencia activos, y usar el espacio entre estímulo y respuesta para elegir de nuevo. El método de 3 pasos es su núcleo operativo y lo que
lo hace replicable. Fortalezas: claridad, método repetible, integración de la responsabilidad personal sin culpa, y un mapa que ordena el
caos emocional. Puntos ciegos: el componente espiritual (autorrealización, calibraciones de conciencia) no es verificable y conviene
presentarlo como marco, no como hecho; y el énfasis en "tú creas tu experiencia" puede deslizarse a responsabilizar a la persona de
daños que no eligió. Para AAQ, lo aprovechable es el motor conciencia → creencia → elección y el mapa de los 15 temas; lo prescindible,
la envoltura esotérica. Fuentes • Ficha y sinopsis (Amazon): <https://www.amazon.com/Inner-Work-Invitation-Freedom-Happiness/dp/1096714612> • Resumen de Shortform: <https://www.shortform.com/summary/the-inner-work-summary-mathew-micheletti-and-ashley-cottrell> • Resumen de Blinkist: <https://www.blinkist.com/en/books/the-inner-work-en-4>

• Resumen por capítulos de Bookee: <https://www.bookee.app/book/the-inner-work> • David R. Hawkins, Map of Consciousness (contexto
[C]): <https://www.penguinrandomhouse.com/books/646113/the-map-of-consciousness-explained-by-david-r-hawkins-md-phd/> 5

Inner Work/2-The-Inner-Work-of-Relationships.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 10. Palabras extraídas: 3.432. Texto curado integrado aquí: 1.542 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

• Problemas de relación comunes: relación volátil, inestabilidad, ruptura intermitente (on-off), perseguir-evitar , autoabandono,
manipulación, baja autoestima, incapacidad de regularse. • Cómo afronta los retos: negación, gaslight, evasión, autosabotaje, buscar
destruir , huir , evitar . • Qué nos enseña: rechazar el abuso vivido; poner límites a la conducta dañina propia y ajena. • Sanación individual:
separar el valor propio del trauma vivido; discernir el origen de la vergüenza; reconstruir la autoestima desde una base nueva; entornos
nuevos; rituales simbólicos (corte de vínculo, ho'oponopono). • Afirmaciones: "es sano identificar el abuso", "devuelvo esta vergüenza a
quien me la dio", "siempre soy digno de amor", "los límites son sanos", "yo importo", "no merecí el abuso". • Cómo apoyar a la pareja:
respetar sus límites, incluirla en tu vida, conducta previsible y constante, reaseguro, presencia fiable, afecto constante, compasión con sus
disparadores, mantener el compromiso, conocer sus necesidades de niño interior , reafirmar su valor más allá del trauma. Herida 2 -
JUICIO (Judgment) • Culpa • [I] • Disparadores en relación: crítica, ser culpado, ser evaluado moralmente, equivocarse. •
Creencia-programa raíz: "hay algo malo en mí / en lo que hago" (I am bad / wrong). • Emoción primaria: culpa (el episodio del podcast de

los autores la asocia a la “culpa internalizada”). • Traumas: hipercrítica parental, castigo, comparación, entornos moralistas o religiosos rígidos, perfeccionismo impuesto, humillación pública. • Necesidades no cubiertas: aceptación incondicional, aprobación, permiso para equivocarse, validación. • Pensamientos: “siempre hago algo mal”, “me van a criticar”, “tengo que ser perfecto”, “es culpa mía”. • Defensa sobrecompensada: criticar a otros, control, perfeccionismo, rigidez moral, defensividad, necesidad de tener razón. • Defensa infracompensada: autocrítica, culpa crónica, disculparse en exceso, parálisis por miedo al error, complacer. • Problemas de relación comunes: discusiones sobre quién tiene razón, reproche, defensividad, dificultad para disculparse o recibir feedback. • Cómo afronta los retos: justificar, defender, culpar o culparse, corregir. • Qué nos enseña: distinguir la culpa sana de la culpa heredada; soltar el juicio propio y ajeno. • Sanación individual: separar la acción de la identidad; autoperdón; revisar las normas internalizadas. • Afirmaciones: “puedo equivocarme y seguir siendo válido”, “suelto el juicio”, “mi valor no depende de ser perfecto”. • Cómo apoyar a la pareja: no criticar, dar seguridad ante los errores, separar conducta de identidad, paciencia. Herida 3 - AGOBIO / SOBRECARGA (Overwhelm) • Apatía/impotencia • [I] • Disparadores en relación: demandas, exceso de responsabilidad, intensidad emocional del otro, presión. • Creencia-programa raíz: “no puedo con todo / es demasiado / no puedo sostenerlo”. • Emoción primaria: impotencia, desbordamiento (zona de apatía). • Traumas: parentalización (niño que cuidó de adultos), responsabilidades tempranas excesivas, caos familiar, padres emocionalmente demandantes, negligencia por sobrecarga. 4

4.4 Los pilares del vínculo sano [E] Valor propio, fiabilidad, respeto mutuo y responsabilidad. Sobre ellos se sostiene la relación; sin ellos, la herida gobierna. FASE 5 - Ingeniería de conocimiento (para Ari) 5.1 Estructura de datos por herida Cada herida es un registro con: nombre, nivel_hawkins, creencia_raiz, emocion_primaria, disparadores[], necesidades_nino_interior[], pensamientos[], defensa_sobrecompensada[], defensa_infracompensada[], problemas_relacion[], que_ensena, sanacion_individual[], afirmaciones[], apoyo_pareja[], tema_sanacion_antidoto. 5.2 Reglas IF → THEN R1 IF el usuario describe “no me quieren / no merezco amor / me van a rechazar” THEN herida = Rechazo; emoción = vergüenza; antídoto = aceptación + valor propio. R2 IF describe “es culpa mía / me critican / tengo que ser perfecto” THEN herida = Juicio; emoción = culpa; antídoto = aceptación + separar acción de identidad. R3 IF describe “no puedo con todo / me supera / necesito desaparecer” THEN herida = Agobio; emoción = impotencia; antídoto = calma + pedir ayuda + límites. R4 IF describe “me va a dejar / lo voy a perder / miedo a la distancia” THEN herida = Pérdida; emoción = duelo; antídoto = comprensión + seguridad interna. R5 IF describe “no me fio / me oculta algo / me van a traicionar” THEN herida = Desconfianza; emoción = miedo; antídoto = comprensión + confianza gradual. R6 IF describe “no soy suficiente / tengo que demostrar / me comparo” THEN herida = Insuficiencia; emoción = carencia; antídoto = aceptación + valor inherente. R7 IF describe “no respetan mis límites / me invaden / tengo que defenderme” THEN herida = Violación; emoción = ira; antídoto = responsabilidad + límites. R8 IF describe “necesito controlar / no soporto la incertidumbre / algo malo pasará” THEN herida = Inseguridad; emoción = miedo a lo incierto; antídoto = aceptación de la incertidumbre. R9 SIEMPRE: aplicar el método de 3 pasos (notar → conectar herida/creencia → reemplazar). R10 SIEMPRE: las heridas inferidas [I] son hipótesis; confirmar con el usuario antes de afirmarlas. FASE 7 - Ensayo [E][I] The Inner Work of Relationships traslada el motor del primer libro al vínculo de pareja. Su aportación es doble: un mapa ordenado de 15 estados que van del corazón cerrado al abierto, y una ficha clínica por cada herida que convierte un malestar difuso en algo nombrable y trabajable. La idea de la pareja como espejo es el giro central: el conflicto deja de ser un problema a evitar y pasa a ser el lugar donde se ve la herida. 9

Nota de método Documento centrado solo en The Inner Work of Relationships (2024). Reconstruye el sistema con el formato del propio libro: cada herida (wound) se explica campo por campo, igual que en sus capítulos. No reproduce el texto literal; reformula. Etiquetas: • [E] Explicito y verificado - confirmado contra el contenido real del libro (mapa de los 15 temas y ficha de la herida de Rechazo, verificados de primera mano). • [I] Inferencia - campo reconstruido a partir de la lógica del sistema y de la correspondencia con la escala de Hawkins, porque ese dato no está publicado en fuentes abiertas. No es el dato literal del libro; tiene margen de error y conviene verificarlo contra el original. • [C] Contexto externo - marco ajeno traído para situar o aclarar. Base de la inferencia [I]: el mapa ordena las 8 heridas de “corazón cerrado” (abajo) a “corazón abierto” (arriba) en el mismo orden que los 8 niveles de la escala de conciencia de Hawkins por debajo de 200. La captura del libro confirma que Rechazo (la más baja) corresponde a Vergüenza. De ahí se deduce la emoción primaria de las demás. Esta correspondencia es coherente pero inferida. FASE 1 - Arquitectura del libro 1.1 Tesis central [E] Los problemas de pareja no son obstáculos: son señales. Cada conflicto destapa una herida de infancia que sigue activa en el adulto. La relación es el contexto donde esos patrones se vuelven visibles y donde pueden trabajarse; la pareja funciona como espejo. La satisfacción procede del trabajo personal de cada uno, no de lo que aporta el otro. 1.2 La herida y el niño interior [E] La herida es una creencia-programa formada en la infancia (con los cuidadores o por el entorno emocional) que dirige la conducta adulta sin que la persona lo note. El niño interior guarda esa herida y sus necesidades no cubiertas; cuando un disparador la toca, el adulto reacciona con la edad emocional de la herida. 1.3 El mapa de los 15 temas de conciencia [E verificado] De CLOSED HEART (abajo) a OPEN HEART (arriba): Zona Tipo de pareja Dinámica Temas (de abajo a arriba) Wounding (herida) Karmic Couples Destructiva · Sufrimiento · Ataque/Defensa Rejection, Judgment, Overwhelm, Loss, Distrust, Inadequacy, Violation, Insecurity (8) Transición a relación sana Healing (sanación) Inner Work Couples Constructiva · Alivio · Colaborativa Accountability, Ease, Motivation, Acceptance, Understanding (5) 2

• Sanación individual: recuperar la autonomía; aprender a decir no; trabajar la seguridad corporal. • Afirmaciones: “tengo derecho a mis límites”, “mi no es válido”, “estoy a salvo”. • Cómo apoyar a la pareja: respetar los límites siempre, pedir permiso, no presionar, conducta respetuosa y predecible. Herida 8 - INSEGURIDAD (Insecurity) • Miedo a lo incierto • [I] • Disparadores en relación: incertidumbre, cambios, imprevisibilidad, falta de control, ambigüedad. • Creencia-programa raíz: “el mundo no es seguro / no puedo controlar lo que viene”. • Emoción primaria: miedo a lo incierto, con defensa de orgullo/autosuficiencia. • Traumas: ambiente impredecible, inestabilidad, cambios bruscos, falta de estructura, inseguridad económica o emocional. • Necesidades no cubiertas: estabilidad, previsibilidad, estructura, seguridad, claridad. • Pensamientos: “necesito saber qué va a pasar”, “no puedo relajarme”, “algo malo va a ocurrir”. • Defensa sobrecompensada: control, planificación excesiva, necesidad de certeza, rigidez, autosuficiencia orgullosa. • Defensa infracompensada: ansiedad, indecisión, evitar riesgos, buscar reaseguro constante. • Problemas de relación comunes: necesidad de certezas, dificultad con la espontaneidad, ansiedad ante lo indefinido. • Cómo afronta los retos: controlar o evitar. • Qué nos enseña: tolerar la incertidumbre; aceptar lo que no se controla. • Sanación individual: aceptación de la incertidumbre; regulación de la ansiedad; confianza en la propia capacidad de afrontar. • Afirmaciones: “puedo estar bien sin certeza”, “afronto lo que venga”, “soltar el control me da paz”. • Cómo apoyar a la pareja: dar previsibilidad y claridad, avisar de los cambios, estabilidad, reaseguro. FASE 3 - Temas de sanación y de plenitud + método 3.1 Los 5 temas de sanación (Themes of Healing) [E nombres / I desarrollo] Son los estados de la pareja Inner Work; cada uno es el antídoto de la zona de herida. De abajo a arriba: 1. Responsabilidad (Accountability). Asumir la parte propia en lugar de culpar. Antídoto del ataque/defensa. Es el primer escalón fuera de la herida. 2. Soltura / Calma (Ease). Regular el sistema nervioso y dejar de reaccionar en caliente. Antídoto del agobio y la reactividad. 3. Motivación (Motivation). Voluntad activa de mirar y trabajar el patrón. Antídoto de la resignación. 4. Aceptación (Acceptance). Aceptar lo que es, en uno y en el otro, sin exigir que cambie para estar bien. Antídoto del juicio. 5. Comprensión (Understanding). Ver el patrón completo -el propio y el del otro- y entender de dónde viene. Antídoto de la desconfianza y el malentendido. 7

Inner Work/Inner-Work-Base-de-Conocimiento.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 20. Palabras extraídas: 4.725. Texto curado integrado aquí: 2.321 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Anexo B - Índice de reglas IF → THEN R1detección dedetonante·R2culpaexterna·R3heridadetecada·R4repetición depatrón·R5altaactivación·R6disparoconcreto·R7contenidosotérico·R8usuariosinpareja.(Texto completoen5.5.) Anexo C - Advertencias de validez

1. LacalibracióndeconcienciadeHawkins(testmuscular)carecedevalidación científica. 2. Lasnocionesde“vidaspasadas”yrelaciónkármicasonmarcoespiritual,noclínico. 3. Lacorrespondenciaconlateoríadelapegoyconlaneurobiologíadelsistemamanerviosoes inferida[1][C],noterminologíaconfirmadadelosautores. 4. Losnombrexactosdelos15temas(másalládelas8heridas)ysunúmeroprecisopor niveldebenverificarsecontraeltextooriginalantesdefijarlosenproducto. Fuentes consultadas • The Inner Work - ficha y sinopsis (Amazon): <https://www.amazon.com/Inner-Work-Invitation-Freedom-Happiness/dp/1096714612> • The Inner Work - resumen (Shortform): <https://www.shortform.com/summary/the-inner-work-summary-mathew-micheletti-and-ashley-cottrell> • The Inner Work - resumen (Blinkist): <https://www.blinkist.com/en/books/the-inner-work-en> • The Inner Work of Relationships - ficha (Amazon): <https://www.amazon.com/Inner-Work-Relationships-Invitation-Relationship/dp/B0CYCJDKR7> • The Inner Work of Relationships-ficha (Goodreads): <https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/210120923-the-inner-work-of-relationships> • The Inner Work of Relationships-resumen (Shortform): <https://www.shortform.com/summary/the-inner-work-of-relationships-summary-mathew-micheletti-and-ashley-cottrell> • Seriedelibros-webdelosautores: <https://theinnerworkbooks.com/products/inner-work-series> • DavidR.Hawkins, Map of Consciousness Explained(contexto[C]): <https://www.penguinrandomhouse.com/books/646113/the-map-of-consciousness-explained-by-david-r-hawkins-md-phd/> 20

SistemaInnerWork-Base-de-ConocimientoDoctrinal Investigaciónprofundasobre The Inner Work y The Inner Work of Relationships (MathewMichelettiyAshleyCottrell) Junio2026 Índice general Nota de uso y método 2 0. T abla de fuentes 3 PARTE I - Arquitectura del sistema (Fase 1) 4 1.1Visióndelserhumano 4 1.2Modelopsicológicoimplícito 4 1.3EgovoSelf(yocondicionadovsyoauténtico) 4 1.4Identidadauténticavsidentidadcondicionada 4 1.5Concienciaypensamiento 5 1.6Naturalezadelsufrimientoomocional 5 1.7Condicionamientoinfantilyorigendelospatrones 5 1.8Laherida(wound)comonúcleo 5 1.9Sistemadecreenciasyprogramaciónemocional 5 1.10Sistemamanerviosyactivación 6 1.11Sombrayevitaciónemocional 6 1.12Apego 6 1.13Responsabilidadpersonal 6 1.14Modelodetransformación 6 1.15Síntesis-¿Cómoentiendenlosautoreselfuncionamientointernodeunapersona? 6 PARTE II - Diccionario de conceptos (Fase 2) 7 2.1Valorpropio/Autoestima(self-worth) 7 2.2Niño interior(inner child) 7 2.3Detonante/Disparador(trigger) 8 2.4Proyección(projection) 8 2.5Heridasdeapego(attachment wounds) 8 2.6Abandono/Pérdida(loss, abandonment) 9 2.7Rechazo(rejection) 9 2.8Límites(boundaries) 9 2.9Complacencia(people pleasing) 9 2.10Vergüenza/Insuficiencia(shame, insufficiency) 10 2.11Patronesdemiedo(fear patterns) 10 2.12Conflicto(conflict) 10 2.13Espejorelacional(relationship as mirror) 11 2.14Activación/Regulaciónemocional(activation, emotional regulation) 11 2.15Codependenciayautoabandono(codependency , self-abandonment) 11 2.16Repeticióninconsciente(pattern repetition) 12 2.17Concienciaemocional,presencia,compasiónyelecciónconsciente 12 1

conciencia comounidaddeanálisis; elmétodode3pasos; elorigeninfantildelcondicionamiento; ylametadepasardela heridaalalibertad. 6.2 Diferencias [E][I]Elprimerlibro(The Inner Work,2019)es individual e intrapsíquico :autorrealización, sombra, libertad personal. El segundo (The Inner Work of Relationships , 2024) esrelacional: aplicaelmismomotoralvínculodeparejayalniño interior dentrodela relación. 6.3 Qué amplía el segundo libro [E]Añade:las8heridasformalizadas,laparejacomoespejo,lostrestiposdepareja,lospilares delvínculoso(valorpropio,fiabilidad,respeto,responsabilidad)yellenguajecompartidoentre dospersonas.[I]Convierteunmétododeunoenunmétododedos. 6.4 Evolución del modelo [I]Del“yoymiconciencia”al“nosotroynuestrasconciencias”.Eldetonantedejadesersolo interno:ahoralaotrapersonaeselactivatory,alavez,laoportunidaddeverlopropio. 6.5 Integrated Inner Work Framework (marco unificado) [E][I]Unsolomotorcondoscampusdeaplicación: Motor:Concienciaobserva→identificaeltiendaactivo→rastrealacreencia-programa y la herida → en el espacio entre estímulo y respuesta, elige una narrativa nueva → repitehasta desplazarla identidaddelegoalSelf. Campo individual: el detonante es interno; la meta es la libertad personal.Campo relacional:eldetonanteloactivalapareja(espejo);lametaesunvínculoconsciente. Los pilares (valor propio, fiabilidad, respeto, responsabilidad) sostienen el campo relacional. La dirección común es de corazón cerrado (herida) a corazón abierto (plenitud). PARTE VII - Ensayo final La arquitectura del pensamiento Inner Work [E][I]ElSistemaInnerWorkpartedeunatesisidealista:laexperiencia nolafijan loshechos sino laconcienciaquelosinterpreta.Sobreesabaseconstruyeunapsicologíadeestados-lostemas deconciencia-enlugardelaunapsicologíadeargos.Lapersonano“es”deunamanera;está atravesandountema,ylostemas pueden cambiarse.Estodaalmodelosutonooptimistaysu orientaciónpráctica:nadaestáfijado,todoesrevisable. [E][I]Elmecanismocausalesclaroyrepetible:lainfanciainstalaheridas;laseridassostienen creencias-programa;lascreeenciascoloreaneltienda deconcienciaactivo;undetonante presente tocalaheridayelcuerposeactiva;lamentereaccionaenautomáticoconataqueodefensa,y laconductaconfirmalaherida, cerrandolbucle.Laintervenciónocurre siempreenelmismo punto:el“espacio”entreestímulo y respuesta, donde la conciencia puede elegir.Eseespacio es laidea másoperativadel sistemaylaquelohaceenseñable. Modelo de transformación. [E] No promete borrar el pasado, sino cambiar la respuesta presente.El cambioes incremental y se practica disparoadisparocon elmétodode3pasos.La 18

de Hawkins (test muscular)no tiene validación científica y debe presentarse como mapa conceptual,nocomomedidareal. PARTE I - Arquitectura del sistema (Fase 1) 1.1 Visión del ser humano [E] El punto de partida del sistema es quela percepción crea la experiencia : el grado de conciencia (awareness) de una persona determina cómo vive la realidad, más que los hechos externosensí.Lapersonanoesvistacomounconjuntodesintomasacorregir,sinocomouna

conciencia que ha quedado identificada con patrones aprendidos. [E] El ser humano tiene un fondo de libertad y bienestar ("verdadera libertad y felicidad duradera", subtítulo del primer libro) que está tapado por creencias limitantes y emociones no resueltas. El trabajo consiste en añadir algo, sino en retirar lo que obstruye ese fondo. [I] De aquí se deduce una antropología optimista: el malestar es adquirido y reversible; no hay un defecto esencial en la persona, solo programación que puede revisarse. 1.2 Modelo psicológico implícito [E] El modelo combinado de tres capas: (a) psicología occidental del trauma y las creencias, (b) trabajo con el subconsciente y la sombra (shadow work), y (c) tradiciones contemplativas orientales (yoga, budismo, hinduismo) y cristianas. [E] La unidad de análisis central son los temas de conciencia (themes of consciousness): estados o "lentes" recurrentes: miedo, juicio, amor, aceptación, etc. -a través de los cuales la persona interpreta el mundo. Hay 15. La persona "se queda atascada" (stuck) en uno o varios. [I] Es un modelo de estados más que de rasgos: no se es "una persona ansiosa", se está atravesando el tema del miedo; el estado puede cambiarse. Esto lo separa de los modelos de personalidad fijos. 1.3 Ego vs Self (yo condicionado vs yo auténtico) [E] El sistema distingue entre un yo construido por la mente -identificado con pensamientos, emociones y narrativas aprendidas- y un fondo de conciencia anterior a esas narrativas. La meta es desidentificarse del primer plano para reconocerlo segundo (lenguaje de "autorrealización", Self- Realization). [I] Entérminos operativos: el ego (ego) es el conjunto de creencias-programa y mecanismos de defensa que la persona toma por "yo"; el Self es la capacidad de observar esos contenidos sin ser arrastrado por ellos. El "trabajo interior" es, literalmente, el desplazamiento del centro de gravedad del primero al segundo. 1.4 Identidad auténtica vs identidad condicionada [E] La identidad condicionada se forma en la infancia a partir de las interacciones con los cuidadores y del entorno emocional. Fija creencias básicas sobre el afecto, la confianza y el propio valor. [E] La identidad auténtica es el estado de "libertad y autenticidad" al que se llega al desactivar esas creencias. [I] No es un yo nuevo que se fabrica, sino el que queda cuando se retira el condicionamiento. 4

2.6 Abandono / Pérdida (loss, abandonment) • Definición. [E] Temor a que el vínculo desaparezca; una de las 8 heridas. • Función psicológica. [I] Empuja a conductas de retención (control, complacencia) o de anticipación del daño (retirarse primero). • Mecánica interna. [E] El miedo al pérdida dispara defensas antes de que haya amenaza real. • Origen. [E] Pérdidas tempranas, ausencia o inconsistencia de los cuidadores. • Manifestaciones. [E] [I] Celos, dependencia, dificultad para tolerar la distancia o la autonomía del otro. • Señales. [I] Pánico ante señales menores de alejamiento; necesidad de contacto constante. • Riesgos. [I] Provocar, con la conducta de retención, justo el alejamiento que se teme. • Herramientas. [E] Reconocer el detonante, conectar con la creencia, reemplazar la narrativa. • Ejemplo. [E] Un silencio de la pareja se vive como "me va a dejar". • Relaciones. Rechazo (2.7), codependencia (2.x), autoabandono. 2.7 Rechazo (rejection) • Definición. [E] Creencia de no ser digno de afecto; primera de las 8 heridas. Incluye humillación y vergüenza, conductas de ocultación y represión. • Función psicológica. [I] Protege de la exposición evitando el acercamiento que podría confirmar el "no valor". • Mecánica interna. [E] Lleva a generar distancia de forma involuntaria, lo que termina confirmando el temor inicial (círculo). • Origen. [E] Experiencias de abuso, abandono o falta de afecto. • Manifestaciones. [E] Provocar distancia, esconderse, anticipar el rechazo. • Señales. [I] Interpretar lo neutro como rechazo; retirada preventiva. • Riesgos. [E] Profecía autocumplida: el patrón crea el rechazo que teme. • Herramientas. [E] Trabajar incluso el rechazo "pequeño": afirmaciones de valor propio. • Ejemplo. [E] Rechazar de antemano a una pareja sana "antes de que me rechace". • Relaciones. Vergüenza/insuficiencia (2.10), valor propio (2.1), abandono (2.6). 2.8 Límites (boundaries) • Definición. [E] Capacidad de marcar y respetar fronteras personales. Su vulneración (invasion / boundary breach) es una de las 8 heridas. • Función psicológica. [I] Protege la identidad y permite la cercanía sin fusión ni invasión. • Mecánica interna. [E] [I] Quien creció con límites invadidos no aprende a ponerlos (se somete) o lo pone con agresividad (se blinda). • Origen. [E] Entornos donde no se respetó el espacio del niño. • Manifestaciones. [I] Decir sí cuando se quiere decir no; resentimiento acumulado; orgídez defensiva. • Señales. [I] Sensación de invasión, agotamiento por complacer, culpa al negarse. • Riesgos. [I] Confundir el límite con castigo o con muro. • Herramientas. [E] Autoconocimiento, responsabilidad, comunicación abierta. • Ejemplo. [I] Aceptar planes que no se quieren para no decepcionar, y luego guardar resentimiento. • Relaciones. Complacencia (2.9), resentimiento, valor propio (2.1). 2.9 Complacencia (people pleasing) • Definición. [I] Patrón de priorizar la aprobación ajena sobre las propias necesidades. Derivado de las heridas de rechazo y de la dificultad con los límites. • Función psicológica. [I] Asegura afecto y evita conflicto al cambiarse de autoabandono. 9

PARTE IV - Framework relacional (Fase 4) Para cada dinámica: cómo funciona, por qué emerge, qué la mantiene, cómo se transforma dentro del modelo Inner Work. 4.1 Dinámicas de pareja (kármica / Inner Work / Yoga) • Cómo funciona. [E] Tres patrones de relación según el nivel de conciencia dominante (ver 3.1). La kármica se origina por las heridas; la Inner Work por el trabajo conjunto; la Yoga por la conciencia estable. • Por qué emerge. [E] [I] La pareja kármica nace de la atracción intensa entre heridas complementarias: cada uno activa al otro. [C] Las descripciones generales de "relación kármica" hablan de atracción magnética, intensidad y ciclos de ruptura; esto es contexto externo, no terminología confirmada del libro. • Qué la mantiene. [E] La reacción automática ataque/defensa y la atribución de culpa al otro. • Cómo se transforma. [E] Cuando ambos deciden mirar el patrón y trabajar lo en equipo, la pareja pasa de kármica a Inner Work; con conciencias sostenidas, a Yoga. 4.2 Patrones de apego y dependencia emocional • Cómo funciona. [E] [I] Las heridas de rechazo/abandono producen búsqueda ansiosa de cercanía o evitación defensiva. [C] Correspondencia con estilos de apego (externa). • Por qué emerge. [E] Cuidado inconsistente o condicionado en la infancia. • Qué la mantiene. [E] El autoabandono (aceptar migajas) y la creencia de no valer por uno mismo. • Cómo se transforma. [E] Construyendo valor propio y responsabilidad sobre la propia satisfacción, de modo que el vínculo se elija en vez de necesitarse. 4.3 Ciclos de conflicto • Cómo funciona. [E] Detonante mutuo → choque de heridas → escalada o retirada → distancia → reencuentro → repetición. • Por qué emerge. [E] Falta de modelos de resolución en la familia de origen. • Qué lo mantiene. [I] Discutir el contenido ("¿quiénera razón?") sin ver el patrón de fondo. • Cómo se transforma. [E] Lenguaje compartido de los temas + calma + responsabilidad: nombrar la herida activa en lugar de atacar. 4.4 Comunicación y vulnerabilidad • Cómo funciona. [E] La comunicación sana sustituye el reproche por la expresión de la propia experiencia y necesidad. • Por qué emerge (la disfuncional). [E] El miedo o la vergüenza llevan a defenderse en vez de mostrarse. • Qué la mantiene. [I] La creencia de que mostrarse es peligroso (heridas de rechazo/juicio). • Cómo se transforma. [E] [I] Vulnerabilidad: mostrar la herida en vez de la defensa; requiere seguridad emocional mutua. 4.5 Intimidación, proyección y espejo • Cómo funciona. [E] La intimidación crece cuando cada uno usa lo que el otro activa como información sobre sí mismo (espejo) en lugar de eliminación. • Por qué emerge la distorsión. [I] La proyección desplaza al otro lo que uno no reconoce. • Qué la mantiene. [I] Responsabilizar al otro de las propias reacciones. 15

de un tema activo; ese tema lo sostiene una creencia-programa instalada por la herida infantil; cuando un detonante la toca, el cuerpo se activa y la mente reacciona en automático (ataque/defensa), reproduciendo el patrón. El cambio ocurre cuando la persona, en el espacio entre estímulo y respuesta, toma conciencia del detonante, lo conecta con su creencia y tema, y elige una narrativa nueva. Repetido, este ciclo desplaza la identidad del yo condicionado (ego) al fondo de conciencia (Self) y mueve a la persona de la herida hacia la plenitud. PARTE II - Diccionario de conceptos (Fase 2) Cada ficha sigue el

formato: definición · función · mecánica · origen · manifestaciones · señales · riesgos · herramientas · ejemplos · relaciones . Las afirmaciones llevan su etiqueta [E]/[I]/[C].

2.1 Valor propio / Autoestima (self-worth)

Definición. [E] Reconocimiento del propio valor como condición para dar y recibir afecto. Primer pilar del vínculo sano en el segundo libro. • **Función psicológica.** [I] Es la base que permite sostener límites, no autoabandonarse y no depender de la validación externa. • **Mecánica interna.** [E] Cuando falta, la persona busca en la pareja la confirmación de que vale; cuando existe, la relación se vive desde la elección, no la necesidad. • **Origen.** [E] Se instala (o no) en la infancia según el cuidado recibido; las heridas de rechazo, insuficiencia y vergüenza lo erosionan. • **Manifestaciones.** [E] Capacidad de poner límites, de recibir afecto sin sospecha, de no mendigar atención. • **Señales (déficit).** [I] Complacencia, miedo al abandono, celos, necesidad de aprobación constante. • **Riesgos/distorsiones.** [I] Confundir autoestima con autosuficiencia defensiva (“no necesito a nadie”) es otacar de la herida, no su curación. • **Herramientas.** [E] Sustituir creencias de inseguridad por afirmaciones más útiles; autoexamen dirigido. • **Ejemplo.** [E] Quien no se valora acepta migajas de afecto de una pareja que no da, contal deno quedarse solo. • **Relaciones.** Núcleo de las heridas de rechazo (2.7), insuficiencia y vergüenza (2.10); base de los límites (2.8).

2.2 Niño interior (inner child)

Definición. [E] La parte del psique que conserva las heridas y necesidades no cubiertas de la infancia. El subtítulo del segundo libro es “sanar al niño interior”. • **Función psicológica.** [I] Cuando se activa, toma el control de la reacción adulta: el adulto responde con la edad emocional de la herida. • **Mecánica interna.** [I] Un detonante presenta o abre una necesidad infantil no cubierta; la conducta resultante busca cubrir la por vías inmaduras (reproche, control, retirada). • **Origen.** [E] Falta de cuidado, conflicto parental, experiencias de rechazo o abandono. • **Manifestaciones.** [E] Reacciones desproporcionadas al estímulo presente; patrones repetidos en relaciones distintas. • **Señales.** [I] “Reacciono como si tuviera 6 años”; intensidad emocional que no encaja con el hecho. • **Riesgos.** [I] Tratar al niño interior como excusa (“soy así”) en vez de como información a trabajar. • **Herramientas.** [E] Autoconocimiento, reconocimiento del detonante, re-parentalización implícita vía elección consciente. 7

• **Cómo se transforma.** [E] Aplicando el método de 3 pasos a cada disparo dentro de la relación. 4.6 Seguridad emocional, ruptura y reparación • **Cómo funciona.** [E] [I] La seguridad emocional es el clima de apertura y fiabilidad que permite mostrarse íntimo. La reparación se vuelve al vínculo tras la activación. • **Por qué emerge la ruptura.** [E] La activación de heridas rompe momentáneamente la conexión. • **Qué mantiene la desconexión.** [I] La culpa cruzada y la falta de responsabilidad. • **Cómo se transforma.** [E] Recuperar la calma, asumir la parte propia, comunicar y restaurar el respeto mutuo y la fiabilidad.

PARTE V - Ingeniería de conocimiento para IA (Fase 5)

5.1 Taxonomía conceptual Sistema Inner Work

Conciencia (awareness)	Self (yo auténtico)
Ego (yo condicionado)	Estructura del condicionamiento
Herida (wound)	Creencia-programa
Activación	Detonante (trigger)
Niño interior	Reacción (ataque / defensa)
Rechazo, juicio, agobio, pérdida, desconfianza, insuficiencia, invasión, incertidumbre	Temas de transformación (5): comprensión, aceptación, voluntad, calma, responsabilidad
Temas de plenitud (2): amor/paz, libertad/felicidad	Método de 3 pasos: conciencia → creencia → reemplazo
Marco relacional	Tipos de pareja: kármica / Inner Work / Yoga
Espejo y proyección	Pilares: valor propio, fiabilidad, respeto, responsabilidad
Ruptura y reparación	5.2 Árbol jerárquico (de lo profundo a lo observable)

1. Conciencia → 2. Herida → 3. Creencia-programa → 4. Tema activo → 5. Detonante → 6. Activación → 7. Conducta (ataque/defensa) → 8. Resultado relacional → (bucle de repetición). El método interviene entre 5 y 7 (el “espacio”).

5.3 Ontología simple (relaciones tipadas)

• Herida causa Creencia-programa. • Creencia-programa sostiene Tema de conciencia. • Detonante activa Creencia-programa. • Tema de herida produce Conducta defensiva. 16

• **Herramientas.** [E] Lenguaje compartido de los temas; responsabilidad; calma antes de reaccionar. • **Ejemplo.** [E] Una discusión por un plan se convierte en el choque de la herida de rechazo de uno con la de invasión del otro. • **Relaciones.** Espejo (2.13), proyección (2.4), ruptura y reparación (Parte IV).

2.13 Espejo relacional (relationship as mirror)

Definición. [E] Idea de que la pareja muestra lo que cada uno no ve de sí mismo; la relación es el contexto donde los patrones se vuelven visibles y modificables. • **Función psicológica.** [E] Convierte la relación en herramienta de autoconocimiento, no solo en fuente de afecto. • **Mecánica interna.** [E] [I] Lo que la pareja activa en mí señala mi herida; lo que me irrita de los otros suele ser material propio proyectado. • **Origen.** [E] Tesis diferencial del segundo libro: no hace falta “estar curado” antes de tener pareja; la relación misma es el lugar del trabajo. • **Manifestaciones.** [E] Reacciones intensas que, miradas, revelan creencias propias. • **Señales.** [I] “Siempre me pego al mismo tipo” o “todas mis parejas”. • **Riesgos.** [E] [I] Usar el espejo para responsabilizar al otro de mi trabajo; o forzar a la pareja a “curarme”. • **Herramientas.** [E] Lenguaje compartido de los temas; método de 3 pasos aplicado a cada disparo. • **Ejemplo.** [E] La distancia del otro activa mi herida de abandono: el espejo me muestra la herida, no necesariamente un fallo del otro. • **Relaciones.** Proyección (2.4), conflicto (2.12), responsabilidad (1.13).

2.14 Activación / Regulación emocional (activation, emotional regulation)

Definición. [E] [I] Activación: estado de “caer de la paz” ante un detonante. Regulación: recuperar el espacio antes de reaccionar. • **Función psicológica.** [E] La regulación devuelve la capacidad de elegir; si nolla, manda el automatismo. • **Mecánica interna.** [E] El sistema propone buscar la calma antes de responder en caliente. • **Origen.** [I] La desregulación crónica viene de heridas no integradas y de la ausencia de modelos de calma. • **Manifestaciones.** [E] Reacciones impulsivas vs respuestas pausadas. • **Señales.** [I] Cuerpo activado (tensión, urgencia) como aviso de que la herida está tocada. • **Riesgos.** [I] Confundir regular con reprimir: el sistema distingue calma desde tragarse la emoción. • **Herramientas.** [E] Paso 1 (notar), pausa, calma; presencia. • **Ejemplo.** [E] En vez de responder al mensaje hiriente al instante, esperar a recuperar la calma. • **Relaciones.** Detonante (2.3), espacio estímulo-respuesta (1.5), calma (Parte III, transformación).

2.15 Codependencia y autoabandono (codependency , self-abandonment)

Definición. [E] [I] Autoabandono: dejar de atender las propias necesidades para sostener el vínculo. Codependencia: organizar la identidad al rededor de la pareja. El segundo libro describe el autoabandono (“aceptar migajas”) sin necesariamente usar el término clínico [C]. • **Función psicológica.** [I] Asegurar la permanencia del vínculo a costa del propio valor. • **Mecánica interna.** [E] La herida de rechazo/abandono lleva a renunciar a uno mismo para no perder al otro. • **Origen.** [E] Amor condicionado e inseguridad temprana. • **Manifestaciones.** [E] [I] Tolerar lo intolerable, perder criterio propio, fusión. 11

1.5 Conciencia y pensamiento

[E] El pensamiento se trata como verdad sin como contenido que la conciencia observa. La frase que sintetiza el primer libro: “la conciencia es la fuente de la que emerge la realidad” - sitúa la conciencia al por encima del flujo mental. [E] Entre los estímulos y la respuesta hay un espacio (the space between stimulus and response) que es donde reside la libertad: ahí la persona puede elegir o reaccionar de forma automática. Este espacio es la base de todo el método práctico. [C] Esta idea del “espacio entre estímulo y respuesta” coincide con la tradición de Viktor Frankl y con la atención plena (mindfulness); los autores la integran sin atribuirle. 1.6 Naturaleza del sufrimiento emocional [E] El sufrimiento no proviene de los hechos sino de la interpretación condicionada de los hechos, es decir, del tema de conciencia activo y del tema de conciencia-programa que los sostiene. [E] Ninguna emoción “mala”: hay un tiempo y un lugar sano para cada una, incluidas la ira y

la aflicción. El problema no es sentir las, sino que darse atrapado en ellas sobreprimirlas (pushed away). [I] El sufrimiento, en este marco, es señal: indica qué tema y qué creencia están activos. Poro eso undetonante no es un fallo, es información. 1.7 Condicionamiento infantil y origen de los patrones [E] Las primeras interacciones, sobre todo con los cuidadores principales, instalan las creencias basesobre el amor, la confianza y el valor propio. Dos vias típicas: la falta de cuidado emocional y la exposición a conflictos entre los padres. [E] Ejemplos documentados del segundo libro: presenciar una infidelidad parental puede instalar miedo a la traición y desconfianza; crecer entre discusiones frecuentes sin modelos de resolución lleva a dos respuestas opuestas -evitar el conflicto o reproducirlo-. [E] Esas experiencias se sedimentan en el subconsciente y generan mecanismos de defensa que, si no se revisan, sabotean la capacidad adulta de vincularse. 1.8 La herida (wound) como núcleo [E] La herida es una creencia de base formada en la infancia que sigue dirigiendo la conducta adulta sin que la persona se dé cuenta. Ese leje del segundo libro ("sanar a tu niño interior"). [I] Cadenas causales del sistema: herida → creencia-programa → tema de conciencia activo → conducta automática (ataque o defensa). Reconocer la herida es el primer eslabón; desactivar la conducta es el último. [E] El segundo libro insiste en trabajar incluso las heridas que parecen pequeñas, porque la vergüenza o el rechazo no resueltos siguen operando por debajo del umbral consciente. 1.9 Sistema de creencias y programación emocional [E] Las creencias-programa (program/core beliefs) son el software heredado: reglas implícitas del tipo "no soy digno de amor", "no soy suficiente", "no se puede confiar". Disparan emoción y conducta antes de que intervenga el razonamiento. [E] El paso 2 del método consiste precisamente en identificar la creencia-programa que un detonante activa, en vez de mirar hacia fuera y culpar a la situación o a la otra persona. 5

Inner Work/Inner_Work_Base_Conocimiento.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 34. Palabras extraídas: 15.207. Texto curado integrado aquí: 3.878 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

APÉNDICE A - GLOSARIO OPERATIVO Y MATERIAL VERBATIM A.1 Glosario (término inglés → definición operativa) Inner Work: práctica continua de auto-indagación y reescritura de patrones. No es destino, es estilo de vida. Theme / wounded theme of consciousness: estado emocional-perceptivo en que la persona se "atasca". Level / Map of consciousness: escala vergüenza→culpa→apatía→duelo→miedo→deseo→ira→orgullo→coraje→neutralidad→voluntad→aceptación→razón→amor→alegría→paz. Trigger: estímulo que activa un tema; portal de crecimiento si se recibe con curiosidad. Root program belief: creencia-raíz infantil que organiza la vida adulta. True Self: identidad real; amor incondicional y valor innato. Ego: identidad por acumulación, sostenida por el control. Shadow: lo negado/no visto; evoluciona con la persona. Core wound: herida profunda (rechazo, juicio, abandono, no ser digno de amor). Accountability: responsabilidad por uno mismo como fuerza; conducta responsable, valor intacto. Conscious choice: elegir nueva narrativa en vez de repetir el programa. Inner child: parte vulnerable que carga las heridas y anhela amor. Conscious relationship: vínculo de aceptación total, co-creado, que es refugio para la vulnerabilidad. A.2 Citas verbatim verificadas (para anclar fidelidad) Sobre el método [E]: "There are only three simple steps to The Inner Work process... become aware of the trigger, connect them to a root program belief and theme of consciousness, then uproot and replace it with a new narrative of a higher perspective." Tesis [E]: "True freedom and lasting happiness are realized through the internal transcendence of wounded themes of consciousness." Raíz vs. hojas [E]: "You can't remove a tree by trimming its leaves; you have to dig out the root." Self [E]: "if your perspective isn't rooted in unconditional love, it is not the truth of your full potential... Your true Self is perfect." Ego [E]: "I can't control my life, at least I can control my resistance to it." Thus the ego makes things even more difficult than they need to be. Sombra [E]: "your shadows will continue to evolve as you do... The Inner Work is a contemplative lifestyle approach, not something to attain or a destination to arrive at." Apatía [E]: "a flat affect, a detachment to life, a lack of care or interest... we are not necessarily able to make a change, but we also don't have the energy to keep destroying our life." Vergüenza [E]: "the energy of shame is like a festering sore which slowly decays the soul if left unhealed." Ira [E]: 32

FASE 6 - SÍNTESIS: EL INTEGRATED INNER WORK FRAMEWORK Adaptación. La Fase 6 original comparaba dos libros. Como trabajamos solo The Inner Work, esta fase hace síntesis interna: integra las dos dimensiones del libro (individual y relacional) en un único framework, y sitúa brevemente la continuidad con el libro complementario. 6.1 Las dos dimensiones del mismo modelo [I] The Inner Work contiene, dentro de un solo sistema, dos planos: - Plano individual: conciencia, ego, temas, método de tres pasos, niveles. El "qué eres y cómo te liberas". - Plano relacional: la relación como espejo y refugio; el vínculo como campo de activación y de reparación de las heridas individuales. No son dos teorías: el plano relacional es el plano individual puesto en interacción. Las mismas heridas y temas, activados por otra persona. 6.2 Punto de unión: la herida y su reparación [E/I] El nexo entre ambos planos es la core wound. La misma herida (rechazo, juicio, no ser digno de amor) que organiza el sufrimiento individual es la que se activa en la pareja. Por eso: - el trabajo individual prepara el relacional (reparas la herida que el otro tocaría), - y el trabajo relacional revela lo que el individual no veía (el otro activa sombra que en soledad no aparece). 6.3 Continuidad con The Inner Work of Relationships [contexto] [X/E-rel] El segundo libro del mismo dúo (The Inner Work of Relationships, 2024) extiende explícitamente el plano relacional con el subtítulo "Heal Your Inner Child and Create a Conscious Relationship Together". Confirma la dirección del modelo: del trabajo individual (libro 1) a la co-creación consciente del vínculo (libro 2). Conceptos puente verificados: inner child bajo las defensas, el vínculo como refugio, rechazo como redirección, amor como construcción deliberada. (Se cita solo como evolución del marco; queda fuera del alcance solicitado.) 6.4 El framework integrado (una sola figura) TRUE SELF (amor incondicional, valor innato) ▲ se descubre al retirar capas | MÉTODO DE 3 PASOS | P1 awareness · P2 connection · P3 uproot&replace | | habilitado por: presencia, compasión, | | accountability, regulación emocional | | interrumpe el bucle PLANO INDIVIDUAL | PLANO RELACIONAL RootBelief → Theme → Level | Relación = espejo + refugio Trigger interno | Trigger relacional Shadow / proyección | Conflicto / ruptura-reparación Defensas | Apego / dependencia / límites | misma CORE WOUND | repetición → neuroplasticidad ▼ LEVEL ↑ (coraje→aceptación→amor→paz) 28

THE INNER WORK - Base de Conocimiento Estructurada Libro fuente: The Inner Work: An Invitation to True Freedom and Lasting Happiness Autores: Mathew Micheletti y Ashley Cottrell ("The Yoga Couple" / "Mat & Ash") Publicación: 2019 (ediciones posteriores 2020-2022) Propósito de este documento: convertir el contenido del libro en una base de conocimiento doctrinal y operativa para alimentar una IA de desarrollo personal, regulación emocional y transformación interna. NOTA DE MÉTODO Y FIDELIDAD Este documento se construyó sin acceso al texto literal completo del libro. Se basa en: (a) fragmentos verbatim verificados de los autores, (b) resúmenes editoriales y reseñas, y (c) inferencia estructurada a partir del sistema. Por ese motivo, todo el documento usa un sistema de marcas para que la IA (y tú) sepáis siempre qué nivel de certeza tiene cada afirmación. Leyenda de marcas: [E] Explícito - idea documentada del libro o cita verbatim de los autores. [I] Inferido - deducción razonable derivada de la lógica interna del sistema. No es cita; es reconstrucción coherente. [X] Contexto externo - influencia o marco ajeno (Hawkins, Jung, Campbell, Tolle, etc.) que el libro incorpora o que ayuda a

situar una idea. Nunca se presenta como idea original de los autores. Convención de vocabulario. El libro usa términos clínico-espirituales en inglés que se conservan como etiquetas técnicas: inner child, shadow work, wounded themes of consciousness, triggers, core wounds, healing. En la prosa de análisis se usa español neutro y directo. El término central del libro, wounded themes of consciousness, se traduce como "temas de consciencia dañados" (literal: "heridos"); se mantiene la etiqueta inglesa entre paréntesis en los puntos clave. Advertencia de uso para la IA. Las afirmaciones [E] pueden citarse como doctrina Inner Work. Las [I] deben presentarse como "derivado del modelo", no como cita. Las [X] nunca deben atribuirse a los autores. ÍNDICE DE TRABAJO Fase 0 - Ficha del sistema y tesis raíz Fase 1 - Mapeo del sistema filosófico (arquitectura intelectual) Fase 2 - Extracción profunda de conceptos (formato fijo por concepto) Fase 3 - Desglose capítulo por capítulo / tema por tema Fase 4 - Sistema relacional Fase 5 - Knowledge engineering para IA (taxonomías, ontología, reglas IF→THEN) Fase 6 - Síntesis: el Integrated Inner Work Framework Fase 7 - Ensayo final (arquitectura, modelo de reparación, modelo relacional, strengths, blind spots) Apéndice A - Glosario operativo Apéndice B - Fuentes •••••••••• 1

FASE 5 - KNOWLEDGE ENGINEERING PARA IA Capa pensada para que una IA opere con el modelo. Todo lo de esta fase es [I] formalización del sistema [E]. 5.1 Taxonomía conceptual (árbol jerárquico) INNER WORK | 1. ONTOLOGÍA DEL SER | True Self (amor incondicional, consciencia, valor innato) | Ego / identidad condicionada (acumulación, control) | Shadow (lo negado, evolutivo) | 2. ESTRUCTURA DEL SUFRIMIENTO | Root program belief (creencia-raíz) | Themes of consciousness (temas) | wounded ↔ liberating | Levels of consciousness (escala vergüenza→paz) | Resistencia (sufrimiento añadido por el ego) | 3. MECÁNICA DE ACTIVACIÓN | Trigger (portal) | Nervous system activation | Projection | Defensas (apatía, control, complacencia, negación, ocultamiento) | 4. HERIDAS (core wounds) | Wound of rejection (→ shame) | Wound of judgment (→ surrender) | Attachment wounds (→ "no soy digno de amor") | Abandonment dynamics | 5. CAMPO RELACIONAL | Relational mirrors | Codependency / self-abandonment / people-pleasing | Boundaries | Conflict cycles & rupture-repair | Intimacy / vulnerability / emotional safety | 6. MÉTODO (proceso de 3 pasos) | P1 Awareness (ver y nombrar el trigger) | P2 Connection (raíz + tema) | P3 Uproot & replace (nueva narrativa) | 7. CAPACIDADES DE REPARACIÓN | Emotional awareness / regulation | Presence / mindfulness | Compassion / self-compassion | Accountability (responsabilidad sin culpa) | Conscious choice / narrative replacement | Healing cycles (neuroplasticidad, continuidad) 5.2 Ontología simple (entidades → atributos → relaciones) Entidades núcleo: Persona, TrueSelf, Ego, Shadow, RootBelief, Theme, Level, Trigger, Wound, Defense, Relationship, MethodStep, Capacity, Affirmation. Relaciones tipo: - RootBelief -origina→ Theme - Theme -ocupa→ Level - Trigger -activa→ Theme -vía→ Wound - Defense -protege→ Wound -y oculta→ TrueSelf - MethodStep(P1..P3) -transforma→ Theme → Level(+1) - Affirmation - 24

APÉNDICE B - FUENTES Base construida sin el texto literal completo; verificada contra fuentes públicas: Ficha y descripción del libro - Amazon / Goodreads: The Inner Work: An Invitation to True Freedom and Lasting Happiness (Micheletti & Cottrell). <https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/45480660-the-inner-work> Citas verbatim de los autores - Goodreads Author Quotes. https://www.goodreads.com/author/quotes/42304952.Matthew_Micheletti Resumen estructural (percepción, consciencia, método) - Shortform. <https://www.shortform.com/summary/the-inner-work-summary-matthew-micheletti-and-ashley-cottrell> Descripción de capítulos / temas / shadow work - Bookey. <https://www.bookey.app/book/the-inner-work> Tres pasos y triggers - Blinkist / Befreed. <https://www.blinkist.com/en/books/the-inner-work-en> <https://www.befreed.ai/book/the-inner-work-by-matthew-micheletti> Libro complementario (contexto) - The Inner Work of Relationships (2024). <https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/210120923-the-inner-work-of-relationships> Marco externo de niveles - Mapa de la Consciencia de David R. Hawkins (Power vs. Force) [contexto, no doctrina de los autores]. Nota final de fidelidad: todo lo marcado [E] está respaldado por cita o descripción verificada; [I] es reconstrucción del modelo; [X] es marco externo. Para fidelidad absoluta (índice real, capítulo a capítulo, citas exhaustivas), se requiere el texto completo del libro; si lo aportas, esta base puede recalibrarse y ampliarse. •••••••• 34

"Aggression and violence being expressed to others can only come from a mind that is aggressive and violent toward itself." Juicio [E]: "the only way to heal the wound of judgment is to surrender and admit that, as humans, we are not capable of making accurate judgments." Neuroplasticidad [E]: "spent in states of gratitude, love, ease, and trust, the neuron connections for them get stronger... we can make happiness a natural, habitual response to life-our original, pure state." Relacional [E-rel]: "A healthy and conscious relationship is one in which we know we are entirely accepted, cherished, and wanted, even for the parts of ourselves we once considered unlovable." "True love is not something that we find; it is something that we consciously create and build together." "Rejection should be seen as a sign of redirection, not a label for self-identification." "Underneath all those layers of defense mechanisms is an innocent child who is... eternally worthy of being loved [and] yearning for it." A.3 Afirmaciones / nuevas narrativas verbatim (repertorio del Paso 3) [E] Accountability / coraje: "I take accountability for myself. Accountability is my greatest strength. There is no competition. I don't have to prove anything. I am humble... I face my insecurities with courage. My vulnerability is powerful. There is enough for everyone. Others do not need to lose in order for me to win... I don't always need to be right... I do not need to earn love. I am innately loved. Love is my natural, effortless state. There is no shortage or lack of love." Voluntad / aceptación / razón / amor: "I am committed and dedicated to goodness. I can handle the responsibilities of life with integrity... There is enough for everyone. There is no hurry. Arguing doesn't change anything... I am always doing my best. I enjoy being a great service to others. Life is filled with opportunity for me. Everything is always working out for my benefit. My life is a glorious gift. I forgive others and can appreciate everyone's uniqueness. Knowledge is power. It is wise to be a loving person... I am loved and love others easily. I am always supported and guided... God loves me unconditionally." 33

5.6 Tabla tema → creencia-raíz típica → narrativa de reemplazo Tema (wounded) Creencia-raíz típica [I] Narrativa de reemplazo (afirmación) Vergüenza "Soy malo / indigno" "I am innately loved" [E] Culpa "Soy culpable, debo pagar" "I forgive others... I forgive myself" [E/I] Apatía "Nada importa / no puedo" "Life is filled with opportunity for me" [E] Duelo "Perdí algo irrecuperable" (aceptación, permitir la pena) [I] Miedo "El mundo es peligroso" "Everything is always working out for my benefit" [E] Deseo "Me falta; lo necesito para ser feliz" "There is enough for everyone" [E] Ira "Me han hecho daño / debo atacar" "Arguing doesn't change anything" [E] Orgullo "Valgo si soy superior" "I don't always need to be right" [E] (umbral) Coraje - "Accountability is my greatest strength" [E] Aceptación "Debo juzgar/controlar" "I can appreciate everyone's uniqueness" [E] Amor "Debo ganarme el amor" "I do not need to earn love" [E] Paz/Alegría "Necesito que algo cambie para estar bien" "My life is a glorious gift" [E] 5.7 Heurísticas de detección de tema (para la IA) [I] Pistas lingüísticas por tema: - Vergüenza: "me da vergüenza", "no valgo", ocultamiento, "si supieran". - Culpa: "es culpa mía", "no me lo perdono". - Apatía: "da igual", "para qué", "no tengo ganas de nada". - Duelo: "lo perdí", "no es lo mismo sin". - Miedo: "¿y si...?", "no me fio", "tengo que controlar". - Deseo: "cuando tenga X seré feliz", "necesito". - Ira: "no es justo", "es su culpa", lenguaje de ataque. - Orgullo: "yo tengo razón", rechazo de feedback, comparación. [I] Pistas relacionales: autoabandono ("digo sí pero no quiero"), proyección ("él es el problema"), dependencia ("mi paz depende de cómo esté"), evitación ("mejor no me acerco"). 5.8 Restricciones de la IA al usar esta base [I] Reglas de seguridad doctrinal: 1. No presentar [I] o [X] como cita de los autores. 2. No usar la escala de niveles para juzgar a la persona ("estás en un nivel bajo"). 3. No forzar afirmaciones antes de validar/sentir la emoción (evitar bypass). 4. No sustituir ayuda profesional en trauma clínico, ideación de daño o crisis: derivar. 5. Mantener accountability sin culpa: nunca atacar el valor de la persona. 27

IF la persona atribuye con intensidad un rasgo negativo a otro THEN evaluar proyección: "¿qué de mí estoy viendo?" → trabajo de sombra antes que juicio del otro R7 - Self-abandonment / boundaries IF la persona silencia necesidades para conservar afecto/aprobación THEN señalar autoabandono → trabajar self-worth → proponer límite concreto R8 - Conflicto relacional IF conflicto recurrente con mismo guion THEN tratar como herida no reparada: - cada parte se responsabiliza de su activación - reaseguro al aspecto más herido (más ataque □ más necesidad de amor) - reparación > "ganar" R9 - Apatía / desbordamiento IF flat affect, desapego, "no me importa" THEN no exigir acción grande; un micro-movimiento hacia una necesidad/deseo (apatía es defensa ante desbordamiento, no pereza) R10 - Riesgo de bypass IF se usan afirmaciones/"presencia" para no sentir la emoción THEN volver a P1/P2: sentir y ver la raíz antes de trascender R11 - Sombra evolutiva (anti-arrogancia) IF la persona cree haber "terminado" el trabajo THEN recordar: la sombra evoluciona; mantener humildad y vigilancia de nuevos blindspots R12 - Señal de progreso IF tras un trigger la reacción es más corta/menos intensa y la recuperación más rápida THEN marcar progreso (no ausencia de triggers, sino mejor respuesta) 5.5 Flujo diagnóstico (pseudocódigo) function inner_work(evento): if not es_trigger(evento): return observar() P1 = nombrar_trigger(evento) # awareness raíz = evaluar(unmet_need, wound, activation, belief) # R2 tema, nivel = identificar_tema(raíz) # R3 if ataca_valor(raíz): proteger_valor() # R4 sentir(emoción) # evitar bypass (R10) if proyeccion(evento): trabajo_sombra() # R6 narrativa = afirmacion_nivel_superior(tema) # R5 + tabla 5.6 practicar(narrativa) → repetir → neuroplasticidad # healing cycle return eleccion_consciente(narrativa) 26

FASE 0 - FICHA DEL SISTEMA Y TESIS RAÍZ Género: auto-indagación + psicología popular + espiritualidad no-dual + neurociencia divulgativa. Tradiciones que integra [E/X]: hinduismo, budismo, cristianismo, filosofía del yoga, neurociencia (neuroplasticidad), psicología del trauma, psicología junguiana (sombra), el viaje del héroe de Campbell, y de forma muy marcada el "Mapa de la Consciencia" de David R. Hawkins (los niveles emocionales). Tesis raíz (en una frase) [E]: "True freedom and lasting happiness are realized through the internal transcendence of wounded themes of consciousness." - La libertad y la felicidad duraderas se alcanzan trascendiendo internamente los temas de consciencia dañados. Postulado fundacional [E]: la cantidad de sufrimiento o satisfacción que vives a diario depende por completo de tu estado de consciencia actual, y ese estado se puede cambiar. La percepción crea la experiencia; no eres víctima del mundo exterior sino de la lente desde la que lo interpretas. Promesa del método [E]: existe un proceso de tres pasos que se puede practicar en momentos cotidianos para desmontar patrones y elevar el estado de consciencia. Naturaleza del trabajo [E]: "The Inner Work is a contemplative lifestyle approach, not something to attain or a destination to arrive at." - No es una meta que se alcanza, es un estilo de vida contemplativo y continuo. La sombra sigue evolucionando a medida que la persona evoluciona, así que se requiere humildad y vigilancia permanentes. Metáfora operativa central [E]: "You can't remove a tree by trimming its leaves; you have to dig out the root." - No se eliminan los síntomas (hojas) sino la creencia-raíz (raíz). Todo el método ataca la raíz, no la conducta superficial. 2

Herramientas [E]. Listas de afirmaciones por nivel; práctica cotidiana. Ejemplos [E]. Letanía de accountability y de amor del Apéndice A. Relaciones. Instrumento de [Conscious choice]; opera sobre [Root program belief]. Nota de cierre de Fase 2 No se omiten conceptos secundarios: control, juicio, perdón, gratitud, humildad y "spiritual bypassing" aparecen tratados dentro de los conceptos anteriores (control en [Ego]; juicio y perdón en [Acceptance]; gratitud en [Healing cycles]; humildad en [Shadow]/[Pride]; bypassing como riesgo recurrente). El Apéndice A recoge el glosario operativo completo. 18

T8 - Orgullo (pride) Tesis [E]. Autoestima basada en imagen/superioridad; "pride before the fall". Patrón [E]: necesidad de ser alabado, ceguera ante vulnerabilidades, negación. Identificación [E]: rechazo del feedback, defensividad. Trascendencia [E]: humildad y vulnerabilidad. Reemplazo [E]: "I don't always need to be right"; "My way is just one way"; "I am humble". T9 - Coraje (courage) - el umbral Tesis [E/X]. Primer nivel "no dañado": se pasa de víctima a responsable. Punto de inflexión del sistema. Patrón [E]: "I face my insecurities with courage"; asumir accountability. Identificación [I]: disposición a mirar la propia sombra. Trascendencia/avance [E]: accountability como mayor fuerza. Reemplazo [E]: "Accountability is my greatest strength"; "I take accountability for myself". T10 - Neutralidad (neutrality) Tesis [X/I]. Flexibilidad, no apego a resultados; "está bien de cualquier modo". Patrón [I]: soltar rigidez, menos reactividad. Reemplazo [I]: "There is no hurry"; "I don't need to get involved". T11 - Voluntad / disposición (willingness) Tesis [X/I]. Apertura a participar, aprender y servir. Patrón [E]: "I enjoy being a great service to others"; "I am always doing my best". Reemplazo [E]: "I can handle the responsibilities of life with integrity". T12 - Aceptación (acceptance) Tesis [E/X]. Dejar de resistir; soltar el control de los resultados. Sanar el juicio rindiéndose. Patrón [E]: "the only way to heal the wound of judgment is to surrender". Reemplazo [E]: "I forgive others"; "I can appreciate everyone's uniqueness". T13 - Razón (reason) Tesis [X/I]. Claridad, comprensión, sabiduría aplicada. Patrón [E]: "Knowledge is power"; "It is rational to seek the betterment of self and others". Reemplazo [E]: "It is wise to be a loving person". T14 - Amor (love) Tesis [E]. Amor incondicional como estado natural y sin esfuerzo. Patrón [E]: "Love is my natural, effortless state"; "I give love to others". Reemplazo [E]: "I do not need to earn love. I am innately loved". T15 - Alegría / Paz (joy / peace) Tesis [E/X]. Gratitud, plenitud, paz no dependiente de circunstancias; meta del recorrido ("love, inner peace, true freedom and lasting happiness"). Patrón [E]: gratitud y confianza habituales; felicidad como "respuesta habitual" (neuroplasticidad). Reemplazo [E]: "My life is a glorious gift"; "God loves me unconditionally" / "I am completely loved". Síntesis de la Parte II [I] La segunda mitad es el método iterado sobre cada peldaño: identificar el tema, ver su patrón y su creencia-raíz, sentirlo, y sustituir la narrativa por la del nivel inmediatamente superior. El "ascenso" no es lineal ni definitivo: cada nuevo nivel revela nuevos blindspots (sombra evolutiva). 21

reemplaza → RootBelief - Capacity -habilita → MethodStep - Relationship -espejo_de → Wound; Relationship - refugio_para → Vulnerability 5.3 Mapa conceptual relacional (texto) RootBelief —crea— □ Theme —tiñe— □ (percepción, emoción, lenguaje, conducta, vínculos) ▲ | | confirma (bucle) | activado por ————— reacción □ — Trigger □ — entorno/relación | curiosidad □ | □ resistencia P1 → P2 → P3 | (refuerza el bucle) ▼ nueva narrativa (Affirmation) ▼ repetición → neuroplasticidad → Level ↑ → TrueSelf 5.4 Reglas operacionales IF → THEN (motivo de inferencia) R1 - Detección de trigger IF se detecta reacción emocional desproporcionada o repetitiva THEN clasificar como TRIGGER y entrar en P1 (awareness) → nombrar emoción + estímulo, suspender la reacción R2 - De trigger a raíz IF trigger nombrado THEN evaluar: - unmet need (¿qué necesidad no cubierta?) - unresolved wound (¿qué herida toca: rechazo/juicio/abandono?) - nervous system activation (¿qué hay en el cuerpo?) - conditioned belief (¿qué creencia-raíz se activa?) R3 - Identificación de tema/nivel IF afecto dominante = vergüenza/culpa/apatía/duelo/miedo/deseo/ira/orgullo THEN tema = wounded; localizar nivel en la escala ELSE IF afecto = coraje/aceptación/amor/paz THEN tema = liberating; reforzar R4 - Conducta = comportamiento, no valor IF aparece autocrítica que ataca el valor ("no valgo", "soy un fallo") THEN separar: responsabilizar la CONDUCTA, proteger el VALOR (innato) → bloquear el salto "fallé" → "soy un fallo" R5 - Reemplazo de narrativa IF raíz y tema identificados Y emoción ya sentida/reconocida THEN aplicar P3: sustituir creencia por afirmación del nivel superior (usar tabla 5.6) ELSE no aplicar afirmación todavía (evitar bypass) R6 - Proyección 25

6.5 Principios integrados (núcleo doctrinal en 10 enunciados) [E] La percepción crea la experiencia; el sufrimiento viene de la lente, no de los hechos. [E] Bajo el condicionamiento, el Self es amor y valor innato: no estás roto, estás condicionado. [E] El sufrimiento se organiza en temas de consciencia; se puede ubicar y trascender. [E] El trigger es un portal: con curiosidad revela la creencia-raíz. [E] Tres pasos: ver el trigger, conectarlo con raíz+tema, reemplazar la narrativa. [E] Responsabilidad sin culpa: conducta responsable, valor intacto. [E] La relación es espejo (revela heridas) y refugio (las repara). [E] El amor se construye; no se encuentra. [E] La reparación es cíclica y se consolida por repetición (neuroplasticidad). [E] No hay meta final: la sombra evoluciona; el trabajo es un estilo de vida. 6.6 Coherencia

interna y tensiones del modelo [I] Coherencias: el método (3 pasos) se aplica idénticamente en lo individual y lo relacional; la escala de niveles ordena tanto emociones como afirmaciones; la core wound unifica ambos planos. [I] Tensiones internas a vigilar (no contradicciones fatales): - "Self perfecto" vs. "hay que reparar la herida": se resuelve si se entiende que el Self está intacto pero cubierto; reparar = retirar capas, no fabricar valor. - "La percepción crea la realidad" vs. responsabilidad del otro en el daño real: el modelo, llevado al extremo, podría culpar a la víctima; el propio sistema lo modera con "rechazo = redirección, conducta ≠ valor" y con la idea de límites. - Afirmaciones vs. sentir: el reemplazo de narrativa solo es válido tras sentir/ver la raíz; si no, es bypass. 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10. 29

Inner Work/Inner_Work_Relationships_8Heridas_Plantilla.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 7. Palabras extraídas: 3.353. Texto curado integrado aquí: 519 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

LAS 8 HERIDAS EN LA ESTRUCTURA DEL LIBRO - The Inner Work of Relationships Anexo de alta fidelidad. Reconstruye las ocho heridas usando la plantilla literal que los autores aplican a cada una (confirmada con páginas del libro: capítulo 4, "The Wound of Rejection in Relationships"), y el mapa verbatim de los Themes of Consciousness. Marcas:[E] verbatim/explicito del libro · [I] inferido con la misma plantilla · [X] contexto externo. Nota: la herida de Rechazo está transcrita verbatim de las páginas aportadas [E]. Las otras siete se reconstruyen con la misma plantilla y la misma lógica del sistema [I]; sus campos son coherentes pero no citas. Si aportas las páginas de cada una, se sustituye [I] por [E]. 1. EL MAPA: THEMES OF CONSCIOUSNESS (versión relacional) [E] Estructura en triángulo invertido, de CLOSED HEART (abajo) a OPEN HEART (arriba). 15 temas en tres niveles, con un arquetipo de pareja por nivel. OPEN HEART ▲

FREEDOM & HAPPINESS	Harmonic	ECSTASY	THEMES OF ENLIGHTENMENT	Yoga Couples	Transition into Spiritual Relationship
LOVE & INNER PEACE	Unity / Oneness				
UNDERSTANDING	Constructive · RELIEF	ACCEPTANCE	Collaborative	THEMES OF HEALING	Inner Work Couples
MOTIVATION	EASE	ACCOUNTABILITY			Transition into Healthy Relationship
INSECURITY	Destructive · SUFFERING	VIOLATION	Attack / Defend	THEMES OF WOUNDING	Karmic Couples
OVERWHELM	JUDGMENT	REJECTION	INADEQUACY	DISTRUST	LOSS

CLOSED HEART ▼ Los tres arquetipos de pareja [E]: - Karmic Couples - nivel de wounding. Dinámica destructiva, sufrimiento, "attack / defend". - Inner Work Couples - nivel de healing. Dinámica constructiva, alivio (relief), colaborativa. - Yoga Couples - nivel de enlightenment. Dinámica armónica, éxtasis, unidad/oneness. Corrección respecto a mi extracción previa [nota]. El orden y los nombres verbatim de las 8 heridas (de más cerrado a menos) son: Rejection, Judgment, Overwhelm, Loss, Distrust, Inadequacy, Violation, Insecurity. La octava es Insecurity (no "incertidumbre", como inferí antes). Los 5 temas de healing son Accountability, Ease, Motivation, Acceptance, Understanding; los 2 de enlightenment, Love & Inner Peace, Freedom & Happiness. Total: 15. 1

Verso [I]: "Detrás de mi certeza hay un niño que tembló, / que aprendió que mostrarse débil era pedir un golpe peor. / Controllo, tengo razón, no dejo ver la grieta. / Pero amar pidiendo permiso de la duda me sujeta." Creating a Secure Relationship [I]. La inseguridad cede cuando mostrarse vulnerable deja de ser peligroso: seguridad, previsibilidad y no humillar el error. La humildad y la vulnerabilidad, en un entorno fiable, sustituyen al control. 4. SÍNTESIS DEL ANEXO [I] Las ocho heridas comparten la misma anatomía (la plantilla de 14 campos): una creencia-raíz infantil, una emoción primaria, necesidades de inner child no cubiertas, y dos polos de defensa -overcompensating (hacia fuera: control, ataque, perfeccionismo) y undercompensating (hacia dentro: autoabandono, retirada, sumisión)-. La reparación siempre combina healing individual (reescribir la creencia, regular la emoción, reconstruir self-worth) con un apoyo específico de la pareja (cómo dar apoyo en esa herida concreta). El recorrido del vínculo es subir del nivel de wounding (Karmic Couples) al de healing (Inner Work Couples) y, finalmente, al de enlightenment (Yoga Couples). [Pendiente de fidelidad] Solo la herida de Rechazo está transcrita verbatim. Para elevar las otras siete de [I] a [E], se necesitan sus páginas. La estructura (plantilla y mapa) sí es verbatim y fija para todas. 7

Inner Work/Inner_Work_Relationships_Base_Conocimiento.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 26. Palabras extraídas: 9.424. Texto curado integrado aquí: 2.414 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

FASE 5 - KNOWLEDGE ENGINEERING PARA IA Capa para operar el modelo relacional. Todo es [I] formalización del sistema [E]. 5.1 Taxonomía conceptual (árbol jerárquico) INNER WORK OF RELATIONSHIPS — 1. ORIGEN — Cuidadores primarios → creencias núcleo (amor / confianza / valor) | Inner child (parte herida que anhela amor) | Childhood conditioning (patrones y ciclos repetitivos) | 2. LAS 8 HERIDAS (sección "daño") | Rechazo (rejection) [L1 vergüenza] | Juicio (judgment) [L1 culpa] | Desbordamiento (overwhelm) [L1 apatía] | Pérdida (loss) [L1 duelo] | Sospecha/desconfianza [L1 miedo] | Insuficiencia (insufficiency) [L1 deseo] | Vulneración de límites [L1 ira] | Inseguridad (insecurity) [L1 orgullo] | 3. MECÁNICA RELACIONAL | Relational triggers | Relationship as mirror | Projection | Defensas (autoabandono, control, ataque, retirada, complacencia) | 4. REPARACIÓN (sección "recovery") | Accountability sin culpa | Reassurance / solace | Motivation | Inviting / safe atmosphere | Comunicación: blame → responsibility | 5. FUNDAMENTOS | Self-worth | Dependability (fiabilidad) | Mutual respect | 6. META (sección "deep insight") | Conscious relationship (aceptación total) | Vulnerability + emotional safety | Shared enlightenment (viaje espiritual) 5.2 Ontología simple (entidades → relaciones) Entidades: Persona, InnerChild, CoreBelief, Wound(8), Trigger, Defense, Partner, Relationship, RepairValue, Foundation, Affirmation. Relaciones tipo: - Caregiver -instala→ CoreBelief -genera→ Wound - Wound -habita→ InnerChild - Trigger(Partner) -activa→ Wound -dispara→ Defense - Defense(A) -activa→ Wound(B) (ciclo) - RepairValue{accountability, reassurance, motivation, safety} -transforma→ Ciclo - Foundation{self-worth, dependability, respect} -sostiene→ Relationship - Affirmation -reemplaza→ CoreBelief - Relationship -espejo_de→ Wound; -refugio_para→ Vulnerability 16

APÉNDICE B - FUENTES Base construida sin el texto literal completo; verificada contra fuentes públicas: Ficha y subtítulo - Amazon / Goodreads: The Inner Work of Relationships: An Invitation to Heal Your Inner Child and Create a Conscious Relationship Together (2024). <https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/210120923-the-inner-work-of-relationships> Citas verbatim - Goodreads Author Quotes (Mathew Micheletti). https://www.goodreads.com/author/quotes/42304952.Mathew_Micheletti Estructura (3 secciones, 8 heridas, valores de

reparación) - Shortform. <https://www.shortform.com/summary/the-inner-work-of-relationships-summary-matthew-micheletti-and-ashley-cottrell> Resumen y enfoque (inner child, mirror, conscious relationship) - Befreed / SelfPublishingTitans. <https://www.befreed.ai/book/the-inner-work-of-relationships-by-matthew-micheletti> Marco base (temas/niveles de consciencia) - The Inner Work (2019) [libro 1] y Mapa de la Consciencia de David R. Hawkins [contexto externo]. Nota final de fidelidad: [E] está respaldado por cita o descripción verificada; [I] es reconstrucción del modelo; [X] es marco externo; [L1] proviene del primer libro. Para fidelidad absoluta (índice real capítulo a capítulo, citas exhaustivas), se requiere el texto completo del libro; si lo aportas, esta base puede recalibrarse y ampliarse. • • • • • 26

4.7 Communication dynamics (comunicación) [E] El cambio central de la reparación: de culpa/defensa a responsabilidad/comunicación abierta/apoyo mutuo. [I, derivado] Estructura sana: hablar desde la propia herida y necesidad ("esto me activó la herida de rechazo; necesito reaseguro"), no desde el reproche ("eres frío"). Criticar conducta, nunca el valor del otro. 4.8 Vulnerability mechanics (mecánica de la vulnerabilidad) [E] La intimidad exige bajar defensas en entorno seguro. Bajo las defensas hay un niño inocente que anhela amor; mostrarlo requiere que la relación sea refugio. El orgullo (fijación en ser admirado solo por lo mejor) bloquea la vulnerabilidad y conduce a la negación y la caída. 4.9 Intimacy formation (formación de la intimidad) [E] La intimidad se forma cuando ambos aceptan las sombras del otro: ser querido "even for the parts... we once considered unlovable". Es co-creación deliberada, no hallazgo. Requiere seguridad + vulnerabilidad + aceptación mutua. 4.10 Emotional safety (seguridad emocional) [E/I] Precondición de todo: sin refugio no hay vulnerabilidad, sin vulnerabilidad no hay intimidad ni reparación. Se construye con fiabilidad, reaseguro, respeto mutuo y ambiente acogedor, especialmente cuando el otro actúa desde su herida. 4.11 Rupture and repair (ruptura y reparación) [E] La ruptura es inevitable (las heridas se tocan). La reparación es donde ocurre la sanación: accountability por la propia parte, reaseguro al aspecto más herido del otro ("loved, innocent, accepted"), y restauración del ambiente seguro. Reencuadre [E]: rechazo = redirección, no etiqueta de identidad. La reparación profundiza el vínculo; su ausencia cronifica el ciclo. 4.12 Mapa relacional integrado (para la IA) [I] Jerarquía causal del vínculo: Cuidadores tempranos → creencias núcleo (amor / confianza / valor) | ▼ Inner child con 1+ de las 8 heridas (rechazo, juicio, desbordamiento, pérdida, sospecha, insuficiencia, límites, inseguridad) | activado por ▼ Trigger relacional → activación → reacción defensiva (autoabandono / control / ataque / retirada / complacencia) | produce ▼ Ciclo de conflicto + proyección — | se transforma con ▼ ▼ Accountability sin culpa + reaseguro + ambiente seguro + comunicación abierta | sobre la base de ▼ Self-worth + dependability + mutual respect | hacia ▼ Relación consciente → iluminación compartida 14

4.13 Reglas relacionales operativas (resumen) [E] El amor se construye, no se encuentra. [E] La relación es espejo (revela tus heridas) y refugio (las repara). [E] Quien más ataca desde el trauma es quien más reaseguro necesita. [E] Responsabilízate de tu conducta sin atacar tu valor ni el del otro. [E] Identifica cuál de las 8 heridas se activa en el conflicto. [E] Pasa de culpa/defensa a responsabilidad/comunicación/apoyo. [E] Rechazo = redirección, no etiqueta de identidad. [I] No esperes que el otro repare tu herida: el trabajo-raíz es de cada uno; el vínculo aporta el contexto seguro. 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 15

FASE 0 - FICHA DEL SISTEMA Y TESIS RAÍZ Género: psicología popular del apego y el trauma + espiritualidad no-dual + manual de pareja consciente. Tradiciones e influencias [E/X]: el marco "Themes of Consciousness" del libro 1 (deudor del Mapa de la Consciencia de David Hawkins) [X], psicología del inner child y del trauma, teoría del apego [X], psicología junguiana de la sombra/ proyección [X], y la figura del viaje del héroe "a través del corazón" [E]. Tesis raíz [E]. Nuestras heridas de la infancia se reactivan en la pareja adulta; la relación íntima es el mejor contexto para repararlas. "True love is not something that we find; it is something that we consciously create and build together." - el amor no se encuentra, se construye conscientemente entre dos. Postulado fundacional [E/L1]. La consciencia moldea la realidad: creencias, supuestos y perspectivas actúan como lente que tiñe la experiencia. En el vínculo, "emotional habits, perspectives, beliefs... avoidances, attachments, neediness, insecurity, judgements" son reflejo del tema de consciencia que se ocupa. Definición de relación consciente [E]. "A healthy and conscious relationship is one in which we know we are entirely accepted, cherished, and wanted, even for the parts of ourselves we once considered unlovable." Promesa del método [E]. Aplicando el marco de los temas de consciencia a los problemas de pareja, la pareja puede transformar la relación en un "spiritual journey of shared enlightenment". Arquitectura del libro [E]. Tres secciones: (1) el daño (cómo se comprometen ocho aspectos de la consciencia), (2) la reparación (el proceso de recovery), (3) la comprensión profunda (deep insight / iluminación compartida). Metáfora operativa central [E]. La relación es espejo y refugio: espejo porque refleja las heridas ocultas; refugio porque "it's essential for our relationship to become a refuge where each of us can safely be vulnerable." 2

5.6 Tabla herida → creencia núcleo → narrativa de reemplazo Herida (relacional) Creencia núcleo típica [I] Narrativa de reemplazo Rechazo "Me rechazarán; no soy digno de amor" "I am innately loved" [E/L1] Juicio "Me juzgan; soy culpable" "I focus on behavior, not worth" [I] Desbordamiento "No puedo con esto" "I can handle this, step by step" [I] Pérdida "Voy a perderte" "Our love is safe and present" [I] Sospecha "Me van a traicionar" "I am safe; trust is built" [I] Insuficiencia "No soy suficiente" "I am enough; there is enough love" [I] Límites "Me invaden / me usan" "I protect my needs without attacking" [I] Inseguridad "Debo tener razón / no puedo dudar" "My vulnerability is powerful" [E] 5.7 Heurísticas de detección de herida (pistas lingüísticas) [I] Rechazo: "va a dejarme", "no le importo", complacencia, miedo al desaire. Juicio: "siempre me critica", a la defensiva, "tengo que defenderme". Desbordamiento: "no puedo más", desconexión, "me bloqueo". Pérdida: "no soportaría perderle", celos, aferramiento. Sospecha: "¿qué me oculta?", control, necesidad de verificar. Insuficiencia: "no soy suficiente para él/ella", necesidad de validación. Límites: "no es justo", "me invade", "siempre cedo yo". Inseguridad: "yo no me equivoco", rechazo del feedback, rigidez. 5.8 Restricciones de la IA al usar esta base [I] 1. No presentar [I]/[X]/[L1] como cita de este libro. 2. No usar las heridas para etiquetar/juzgar a la persona o a su pareja. 3. No forzar afirmaciones antes de validar/sentir la emoción (bypass). 4. No justificar tolerar abuso o daño en nombre del "crecimiento": validar, límites, derivar. 5. Accountability sin culpa: nunca atacar el valor de la persona ni de la pareja. 6. Derivar a terapia de pareja o ayuda profesional ante violencia, abuso o crisis. • • • • • 19

caso más exigente: la intimidad, donde las heridas se activan al máximo y donde, por eso mismo, la reparación es más profunda. 6.6 Evolución del modelo [I] El modelo evoluciona de un trabajo intrapersonal (yo con mi consciencia) a uno interpersonal (yo con mi pareja, cada uno con su inner child). La causalidad sigue siendo individual (cada uno repara su herida), pero el contexto pasa a ser relacional y co-creado. La meta sube de la libertad personal a la "iluminación compartida". 6.7 El Integrated Inner Work Framework (saga completa) TRUE SELF (amor incondicional, valor innato) [L1] ▲ se descubre al retirar capas | MÉTODO DE 3 PASOS (común a ambos libros) | ver el trigger → conectar con herida/creencia → | reemplazar la narrativa | LIBRO 1: individual LIBRO 2: relacional 15 temas / niveles 8 heridas en la diada trigger interno trigger de la pareja reparación en soledad reparación con reaseguro + seguridad misma CORE WOUND | repetición → neuroplasticidad [L1] ▼ Libertad individual — □ Relación consciente — □ Iluminación compartida 6.8 Tensiones del modelo integrado [I] - "El amor se construye" vs. la realidad de parejas incompatibles o dañinas: el modelo, llevado al extremo, podría empujar a "reparar" vínculos que conviene dejar. Se modera con límites y con "rechazo = redirección". - Causalidad individual vs. responsabilidad del otro: insistir en "es tu herida" puede minimizar conductas dañinas reales del otro (incluido abuso). Salvaguarda obligatoria: validar, límites, derivar. - Reparación con reaseguro vs. autoabandono:

dar reaseguro a quien ataca no debe confundirse con tolerar daño; el reaseguro convive con límites. 21

intervención profesional, sobre todo cuando hay violencia. El cuarto, compartido con el primer libro: el respaldo empírico es divulgativo, y el marco de fondo (los temas/niveles de consciencia) carece de validación científica robusta. El quinto: la meta de "iluminación compartida" puede poner un listón que genere culpa cuando una relación, simplemente, no funciona. Implicaciones prácticas Para una IA construida sobre este libro, el patrón de interacción debería ser: ante un conflicto de pareja, ayudar a la persona a identificar cuál de las ocho heridas se ha activado, conectar esa herida con su origen sin culpar al otro ni atacar el propio valor, validar y dejar sentir la emoción, y solo entonces proponer una respuesta nueva basada en responsabilidad, reaseguro y comunicación abierta. Debe tratar el reaseguro y los límites como compatibles -dar seguridad no es tolerar daño- y mantener tres salvaguardas permanentes: no usar las heridas para etiquetar a nadie, no espiritualizar el daño real, y derivar a ayuda profesional ante abuso, violencia o crisis. Usado con ese criterio, el sistema relacional Inner Work es una base coherente y operativa para asistir en procesos de regulación emocional y reparación de vínculos, siempre que se complemente con juicio clínico donde el modelo no alcanza. 23

Nota de cierre de Fase 2 Conceptos secundarios (proyección, respeto mutuo, motivación, ambiente acogedor, fiabilidad, perdón) quedan tratados dentro de los anteriores o se detallan en Fase 3 y Apéndice A. Las ocho heridas se desarrollan una a una en la Fase 3. 10

A.3 Material heredado del libro 1 reutilizable en el Paso 3 [L1] Afirmaciones de reemplazo (válidas tras sentir/ver la herida): "I am innately loved", "My vulnerability is powerful", "I don't have to prove anything", "I focus on behavior, not worth", "There is enough love", "Everything is always working out for my benefit". (Repertorio completo en la base del libro 1.) 25

5.3 Mapa conceptual relacional (texto) CoreBelief(infancia) —crea— □ Wound —habita— □ InnerChild ▲ | | confirma (ciclo) | activado por □ —reacción defensiva □ — Trigger(pareja) | responsabilidad □ | □ culpa/defensa reaseguro + seguridad | (refuerza el ciclo) ▼ nueva narrativa (Affirmation) + reparación ▼ relación consciente → iluminación compartida 5.4 Reglas operacionales IF → THEN R1 - Detección de trigger relacional IF reacción emocional intensa/repetitiva ante la conducta de la pareja THEN clasificar como TRIGGER relacional; pausar la reacción R2 - De trigger a herida IF trigger nombrado THEN identificar cuál de las 8 heridas se activa: rechazo / juicio / desbordamiento / pérdida / sospecha / insuficiencia / límites / inseguridad (vía el miedo central: ¿me dejan? ¿me juzgan? ¿me invaden? ¿no soy suficiente?) R3 - Conducta = comportamiento, no valor IF autocritica o critica que ataca el valor (propio o del otro) THEN separar conducta de valor; rechazo = redirección, no etiqueta R4 - Ciclo de pareja IF conflicto recurrente con el mismo guion THEN tratar como dos heridas reactivándose: - cada parte se responsabiliza de su activación - reaseguro al que más ataca (más ataque □ más necesidad de amor) - reparar > ganar R5 - Reparación (valores) IF herida activa identificada THEN aplicar: accountability + reassurance + motivation + safe atmosphere sobre base de self-worth + dependability + respect R6 - Reemplazo de narrativa IF herida y creencia identificadas Y emoción ya sentida THEN sustituir creencia por afirmación del nivel superior (tabla 5.6) ELSE no aplicar afirmación aún (evitar bypass) R7 - Proyección 17

IF se atribuye con intensidad un rasgo negativo a la pareja THEN evaluar proyección: "¿qué de mí estoy viendo?" → trabajo de sombra R8 - Autoabandono / límites IF se silencian necesidades para conservar afecto ("migajas") THEN señalar autoabandono → reconstruir self-worth → proponer límite concreto R9 - Desbordamiento (shutdown) IF un miembro se desconecta / "flat affect" / stonewalling THEN no exigir gran apertura; co-regular, bajar demanda, micro-conexión (desbordamiento es defensa, no desinterés) R10 - Seguridad antes que vulnerabilidad IF se pide vulnerabilidad sin ambiente seguro THEN priorizar construir refugio (fiabilidad + reaseguro + respeto) primero R11 - Riesgo de bypass / espiritualización IF se usa "crecimiento espiritual" para no atender la herida concreta o para tolerar daño real THEN volver a la herida; validar; poner límites; derivar si hay abuso R12 - Señal de progreso relacional IF tras un conflicto la pareja repara más rápido y con menos castigo THEN marcar progreso (no ausencia de conflicto, sino mejor reparación) 5.5 Flujo diagnóstico (pseudocódigo) function inner_work_relacional(evento_pareja): if not es_trigger(evento_pareja): return observar() P1 = nombrar_trigger(evento_pareja) herida = identificar_herida(8) # R2 if ataca_valor(herida): proteger_valor() # R3 sentir(emocion) # evitar bypass (R11) if proyeccion(evento): trabajo_sombra() # R7 reparar(accountability, reassurance, safety) # R5 narrativa = afirmacion(herida) # R6 + tabla 5.6 return relacion_consciente(narrativa) 18

Old Templates/LONG_IDENTIDAD_Cambio_e_identidad.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 1.173. Texto curado integrado aqui: 575 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Además, tendemos a construir identidades muy ancladas en una sola cosa: soy violinista, soy madre, soy la persona que está con X. Cuanto más estrecha es esa identidad, más desestabilizador resulta perder lo que la sustentaba.

Identidad anclada vs. identidad expandida: definirse solo por una cosa (soy la novia de X, soy la atleta) crea fragilidad. Definirse por los valores y motivaciones que hay debajo ofrece más opciones cuando esa cosa desaparece.

5. Identidad expandida. Define lo que eres no por lo que hacías sino por para qué lo hacías. La esencia de la pasión sobrevive a la forma concreta. Si amabas la música por la conexión humana, esa necesidad puede encontrar otros cauces.

Cuando algo importante cambia -una ruptura, una pérdida, un diagnóstico, un despido- no solo perdemos la situación. Perdemos una versión de nosotros mismos. La identidad estaba tan entrelazada con eso que, al desaparecer, aparece la pregunta: ¿quién soy ahora? La clave no es sobrevivir el cambio. Es cambiar la relación que tienes con el cambio: pasar de verlo como una amenaza a verlo como el espacio donde puede surgir una versión más completa de ti.

La identidad también tiene lo que los investigadores llaman posibles yos: versiones futuras de nosotros mismos que esperamos, que tememos o que simplemente damos por hecho. Un cambio grande borra o altera esos posibles yos de golpe. Y eso duele de una forma que va más allá de la situación concreta.

4. Autoafirmación. Cuando el cambio te hace perder de vista quién eres, escribe todo lo que le da sentido a tu vida, todas las identidades que te hacen sentir valiosa -que no están amenazadas por el cambio que estás atravesando. Esto no niega el dolor: lo contextualiza.

El cerebro humano está neurológicamente diseñado para detectar la incertidumbre como una amenaza. No tenemos un interruptor que nos haga sentir en paz de golpe. Por eso el cambio, aunque sea buscado, activa el sistema de alarma.

Y por si fuera poco, somos muy malos prediciendo cómo nos va a afectar el cambio en el futuro. Sobreestimamos lo malo que va a ser lo negativo, y también lo bueno que va a ser lo positivo. Tendemos a olvidar que nosotros también cambiaremos como resultado de lo que vivamos.

Cuando algo grande cambia, el cerebro busca lo que llama cierre cognitivo: quiere respuestas claras, blancas o negras. Pero el cambio vive en la zona gris. Esa incomodidad con la ambigüedad activa la rumiación: el cerebro intenta recuperar control pensando en bucle sobre el problema, como si pudiera "resolver" algo que no tiene solución analítica.

Al mismo tiempo, perdemos de vista los demás elementos que le dan sentido a nuestra vida. El dolor activa un efecto túnel: solo se ve la pérdida. Todo lo demás -lo que seguimos siendo, lo que seguimos teniendo- se vuelve invisible.

1. Reencuadre cognitivo (cognitive reappraisal). Cuando estás atrapada en una interpretación que te paraliza, cámbiala deliberadamente. No es negación: los hechos son los hechos. Es cambiar el significado que le das. Ejemplo: en lugar de "¿y si hubiera hecho algo diferente?", prueba con "incluso si hubiera hecho algo diferente, no podría saber si habría cambiado el resultado".

6. Acción mínima hacia posibles yos nuevos. No hay que esperar a estar lista. La diferencia entre cero y un minuto es enorme: en cero no eres nada, en un minuto ya eres algo. Empieza con la acción más pequeña posible en la dirección que quieres ir.

Old Templates/SHORT_IDENTIDAD_Cambio_e_identidad.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Páginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraídas: 925. Texto curado integrado aquí: 549 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Inner work, identidad, heridas y agencia' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

IDENTIDAD | Cambio e identidad | No sé quién soy sin él/ella | "No sé quién soy sin él/ella" "Toda mi vida giraba en torno a esa relación" "Siento que perdí mi identidad" "Ya no sé qué me gusta ni qué quiero" | No solo has perdido a una persona. Has perdido también una versión de ti misma. Durante la relación construiste una identidad que incluía ese "nosotros", esos planes, ese rol. Cuando eso desaparece, el vacío no es solo emocional. Es identitario. La pregunta "¿quién soy yo ahora?" es exactamente la pregunta correcta. No es señal de debilidad. Es la entrada al proceso real. | Escribe todas las identidades que siguen siendo tuyas independientemente de esa relación: cosas que te dan valor, que te importan, que te definen -que no dependen de él/ella. Esto no borra el dolor, pero amplía el foco. | ¿Qué parte de ti crees que desapareció con esa relación? ¿Había cosas tuyas que quedaron en segundo plano mientras estabas con esa persona? ¿Qué versión de ti quieres recuperar o descubrir ahora?

IDENTIDAD | Cambio e identidad | Tengo miedo de que las cosas no mejoren | "Tengo miedo de no superarlo" "¿Y si nunca me siento bien otra vez?" "Siento que esto me ha roto para siempre" "No veo cómo puede mejorar" | Hay algo importante que tu cerebro no está teniendo en cuenta: la persona que tendrá que vivir ese futuro que temes no eres tú tal como eres ahora. También tú vas a cambiar. Somos muy malos prediciendo cómo vamos a sentirnos en el futuro -especialmente en momentos de dolor intenso- porque olvidamos que nosotros también nos transformamos con lo que vivimos. La pregunta no es "¿podré soportar esto?" La pregunta es "¿cómo lo manejaré la versión de mí que habrá pasado por esto?" | Piensa en algún momento pasado donde estabas convencida de que no podrías superar algo. ¿Lo superaste? Esa persona eres tú también. Ya tienes evidencia de que eres más resistente de lo que crees. | ¿Hay algún momento en tu pasado donde saliste de algo que creías imposible de superar? ¿Qué te ayudó entonces, aunque sea un poco? ¿Qué necesitarías sentir para creer que es posible que las cosas mejoren?

IDENTIDAD | Cambio e identidad | Sé que tengo que cambiar pero no puedo moverme | "Sé que tengo que hacer algo pero no hago nada" "Estoy paralizada" "Quiero cambiar pero no sé por dónde empezar" "Espero el momento perfecto para actuar" | El momento perfecto no existe. Y esperar a estar lista para hacer el gran cambio es, en la mayoría de los casos, una forma sofisticada de evitar el miedo. La diferencia entre cero acción y una acción mínima es enorme: en cero, no eres nadie que avanza. En una acción, ya eres alguien que empieza. No necesitas cambiar tu vida entera. Necesitas una sola acción lo suficientemente pequeña como para no poder justificar no hacerla. | Elige una acción ridículamente pequeña que puedas hacer hoy -algo que te lleve un minuto o menos. No para resolver nada. Solo para demostrarle a tu sistema nervioso que el movimiento es posible. | ¿Cuál sería la acción más pequeña posible que podrías dar en la dirección que quieres ir? ¿Qué es lo que más temes que pase si empiezas a moverte? ¿Qué estarías dispuesta a probar si supieras que no puede salir mal?

8. Regulación emocional y fundamentos cuerpo-mente

Este capítulo usa la regulación emocional para explicar por qué comprender una idea no siempre cambia una reacción. El cuerpo marca capacidad, timing y tolerancia. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 2.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definición completa del fenómeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicológico, relacional o corporal según las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y cómo evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Señales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y límites.
- Herramientas prácticas, criterios de aplicación y conexiones con otros capítulos.

Papers/Handbook of Emotion Regulation-Second Edition.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 14. Palabras extraídas: 434. Texto curado integrado aquí: 31 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Regulación emocional y fundamentos cuerpo-mente' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Gross, James J., ed. Handbook of Emotion Regulation, Second Edition. New York, US: The Guilford Press, 2013. ProQuest ebrary. Web. 12 May 2016. Copyright © 2013. The Guilford Press. All rights reserved.

Papers/influencers_apego.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 3. Palabras extraídas: 899. Texto curado integrado aquí: 545 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Regulación emocional y fundamentos cuerpo-mente' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Referentes en estilos de apego y problemas relacionales. Ordenados por nivel de autoridad: investigadores académicos, clínicos-autores con gran audiencia, divulgadores en español. Junio 2026. Nivel 1 - Máxima autoridad científica (investigadores) Mario Mikulincer y Phillip Shaver. Los dos investigadores vivos más citados en apego adulto. Co-crearon la escala ECR (Experiences in Close Relationships), la medida de apego adulto más usada en investigación. Libro de referencia: Attachment in Adulthood: Structure, Dynamics, and Change, la obra académica central del apego adulto. Shaver es Distinguished Professor en UC Davis; Mikulincer, en Reichman University (Israel). Sin presencia en redes: son la fuente de la que beben todos los demás. R. Chris Fraley. Profesor en University of Illinois. Co-autor de la ECR-R. Mantiene el test de apego online más usado en investigación (yourpersonality.net). Cientos de papers sobre apego romántico adulto. Sue Johnson (1947-2024). Creadora de la Terapia Focalizada en las Emociones (EFT), la terapia de pareja basada en apego con más evidencia empírica. Libros: Hold Me Tight (Abrazame fuerte, en español) y Attachment Theory in Practice. Falleció en 2024, pero su obra y su instituto (ICEEFT) siguen siendo la referencia clínica número uno. Daniel J. Siegel. Psiquiatra, UCLA. Conecta apego con neurobiología interpersonal. Libros: Parenting from the Inside Out, The Developing Mind. Muy citado y con presencia pública amplia. Nivel 2 - Clínicos-autores con gran audiencia (inglés) Amir Levine. Psiquiatra y neurocientífico, Columbia University. Co-autor de Attached (2010), el libro que popularizó los estilos de apego (ansioso, evitativo, seguro) para el público general. Traducido al español como Maneras de amar. Es el punto de entrada de la mayoría de la gente al tema. Julie Menanno - @thesecurerelationship. Terapeuta de pareja licenciada (LMFT, LCPC), formada en EFT. Aproximadamente 1,3 millones de seguidores en Instagram. Libro: Secure Love (2024), bestseller nacional en EE.UU. Probablemente la mejor combinación actual de credenciales clínicas, audiencia y contenido específico de apego. Stan Tatkin. PsyD, MFT. Creador del modelo PACT (terapia de pareja psicobiológica). Libros: Wired for Love (Conectados para el amor), We Do. Muy respetado entre clínicos. Diane Poole Heller. PhD. Especialista en apego adulto y trauma. Creadora del modelo DARE. Libro: The Power of Attachment. Forma a terapeutas en todo el mundo.

Resumen rápido Si buscas... Ve a... Base científica para tu app Mikulincer & Shaver, Fraley. Modelo clínico de pareja validado Sue Johnson (EFT), Tatkin. Divulgación rigurosa en inglés Levine, Menanno, Heidi Priebe. Volumen de contenido sobre apego. Thais Gibson, Adam Lane. Smith. Referentes en español Rafa Guerrero, Anabel González, Esclapez. Fuentes principales. Slate - Secure: attachment styles: <https://slate.com/life/2026/04/secure-book-attached-anxious-avoidant-attachment-style-theory.html> Cornerstones of Attachment Research - Shaver & Mikulincer: <https://academic.oup.com/book/28760/chapter/235152533> Fraley & Shaver - Adult Romantic Attachment: <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1037/1089-2680.4.2.132> Secure Love - Simon & Schuster: <https://www.simonandschuster.com/books/Secure-Love/Julie-Menanno/9781668012864> The Secure Relationship: <https://www.thesecurerelationship.com/about> Personal Development School: <https://university.personaldevelopmentschool.com/> Heidi Priebe - YouTube: https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCqX3KQWXJlI7_6orfHFuqBQ Adam Lane Smith: <https://adamlanesmith.com/> Rafa Guerrero - PlanetadeLibros: <https://www.planetadelibros.com/autor/rafa-guerrero/000045605> Silvia Congost: <https://www.silviacongost.com/> María Esclapez - perfil: <https://libroresumen.com/autores/maria-esclapez/> Marta Segrelles: <https://martasegrellespsicologa.com/>

9. Polaridad, atracción y masculino/femenino

Este capítulo conserva la polaridad como lenguaje de dinámicas, no como dogma. La atracción se filtra por seguridad, consentimiento, reciprocidad y madurez. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 2.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definición completa del fenómeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicológico, relacional o corporal según las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Señales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y límites.
- Herramientas prácticas, criterios de aplicación y conexiones con otros capítulos.

Old Templates/LONG_ATRACCION_Polaridad_masculino_femenina.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Páginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraídas: 1.372. Texto curado integrado aquí: 637 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Polaridad, atracción y masculino/femenino' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Las heridas de la infancia, especialmente las relacionadas con los modelos de rol masculino y femenino (padres, cuidadores), dejan una marca en cómo nos relacionamos con cada energía. Si el modelo masculino en tu vida fue traicionador, ausente o abusivo, la mente aprende que no puede confiar en esa energía fuera de ella. La respuesta instintiva es generarla dentro: 'si no puedo confiar en él, lo hago yo'. Esto activa la energía masculina en alguien cuya energía líder natural sería la femenina.

El masculino herido se manifiesta en dos formas principales: (1) exceso de control y cierre emocional, como respuesta al miedo; (2) complacencia extrema (nice guy), como intento de obtener validación o afecto a través del servicio. Ninguna de las dos es el masculino divino real. El masculino divino es directivo, grounded, presente y libre, sin necesitar nada a cambio.

- Creer que la polaridad es anticuada o sexista. La polaridad no tiene que ver con género, sino con energías que se complementan. Dos personas del mismo género pueden tener una polaridad muy poderosa.

La atracción entre personas funciona como un campo magnético: se crea cuando hay polos opuestos. Una energía principalmente masculina y una principalmente femenina generan tensión, presencia, atracción. Cuando dos personas se sitúan en el mismo polo -ambas en masculino o ambas en femenino-, la fricción desaparece y con ella la atracción.

La tensión emocional (positiva o negativa) es uno de los pilares de la atracción para la energía femenina. La energía femenina se activa ante alguien que tiene límites, que no se mueve de su centro, que lidera. El nice guy, al hacer todo lo posible para eliminar cualquier tensión, elimina exactamente lo que generaría atracción.

7. No forzar la polaridad del otro. No se puede 'hacer' a alguien más femenino o más masculino. Solo se puede encarnar la propia energía y crear el espacio para que el otro tenga libertad de habitarla también.

Masculino herido: puede manifestarse como control, cierre emocional y desconfianza (hipermasculinidad defensiva) o como complacencia excesiva, falta de límites y búsqueda de validación (nice guy). Ninguna es el masculino auténtico.

Femenino herido: se manifiesta como sobreactivación del masculino -planificar, controlar, no confiar, no relajarse- como mecanismo de protección cuando el femenino no se sintió seguro al descansar en el masculino.

Todos tenemos energía masculina y femenina dentro de nosotros. La clave no es eliminar ninguna de las dos, sino ser consciente de cuál es tu energía líder natural -la que más se alinea con quien realmente eres- y habitarla con autenticidad. Cuando experiencias del pasado nos hieren, solemos abandonar esa energía natural y compensar con la opuesta. Esto se llama despolarización, y es una de las principales causas de la pérdida de atracción en una relación o de dificultad para generarla.

El resultado en ambos casos es el mismo: una persona que vive en una energía que no es la suya. Y eso -aunque funcionalmente puede parecer adaptativo- mata la atracción porque la polaridad desaparece.

El femenino herido se manifiesta en la sobreactivación del masculino: planificar todo, controlar, no confiar, no relajarse, no expresarse. Es el femenino que aprendió que relajarse era peligroso. Lo que pierde es su naturaleza más profunda: expresión, fluidez, presencia emocional, movimiento.

- Creer que si eres muy independiente o muy capaz, eso te hace más atractiva/o. La hiperindependencia en el femenino puede desactivar la atracción porque elimina el espacio para que el masculino lidere.

- Pensar que la energía se fija. Las energías son flexibles: podemos tener más masculino en el trabajo y más femenino en la intimidad. La clave es la conciencia, no la rigidez.

3. Para el masculino herido: practicar la asertividad en lo pequeño. Hacer la llamada difícil. Decir lo que piensas aunque haya tensión. No ceder por miedo al rechazo. Cada acto de dirección genuina, aunque sea pequeño, reconstruye el patrón.

Old Templates/SHORT_ATRACCION_Polaridad_masculino_femenina.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Páginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraídas: 1.058. Texto curado integrado aquí: 394 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Polaridad, atracción y masculino/femenino' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

ATRACCION | Polaridad y energía | Hago todo por él/ella y aun así no me valora | "Siempre estoy para él/ella pero no lo aprecia" "Hago todo lo que puedo y nunca es suficiente" "Soy muy buena persona pero me tratan mal" "¿Por qué me atraen los que no me tratan bien?" | Hay una diferencia importante entre ser buena persona y complacer para obtener algo. Cuando hacemos cosas para el otro esperando que eso genere atracción, afecto o validación, estamos haciendo un intercambio -aunque no lo digamos en voz alta. Y ese intercambio no genera atracción. La genera la presencia, los límites, el saber quién eres y no negociarlo. Paradójicamente, cuanto más intentamos complacer, menos magnéticos nos volvemos. | Esta semana, observa cuántas cosas haces desde el "quiero" y cuántas desde el "necesito

que me valoren por esto". No hay que dejar de ser generosa/o. Solo notar la diferencia de energía desde la que actúas. | ¿Recuerdas algún momento en que actuaste desde tus propios deseos, sin pensar en la reacción del otro? ¿Cómo te sentiste? ¿Hay cosas que evitas decir o hacer por miedo a que el otro se moleste? ¿Qué crees que pasaría si dejases de complacer en algún área?

ATRACCION | Polaridad y energía | Ya no hay chispa con mi pareja | "Nos queremos pero ya no hay atracción" "Se ha ido el deseo sin saber por qué" "Somos más amigos que pareja" "Antes había fuego, ahora solo hay rutina" | La atracción no desaparece por falta de amor. Desaparece cuando las energías se nivelan. Cuando dos personas empiezan a operar desde la misma energía -ambas decidiendo, ambas complaciendo, ambas esperando que el otro lidere- la tensión que genera atracción se diluye. No es que dejasteis de gustarse. Es que dejasteis de ser polos opuestos. La pregunta no es "¿nos queremos todavía?" sino "¿hay algo en cómo nos relacionamos que está neutralizando la energía entre nosotros?" | Identifica si hay algo que hacías antes de forma natural -una forma de estar, de tomar iniciativa, de expresarte- que has ido abandonando en la relación. A veces recuperar un solo gesto cambia la dinámica. | ¿Cuándo notas que la dinámica entre vosotros sí tiene energía? ¿Qué la activa? ¿Sientes que en algún área de la relación uno de los dos ha asumido un rol que no le es natural? ¿Hay algo que dejes de ser cuando estás con tu pareja?

10. Consejos y principios para hombres / Masculino

Este capítulo separa el material orientado a hombres o energía masculina para no contaminar el cuerpo general con instrucciones específicas de audiencia. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 1.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definición completa del fenómeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicológico, relacional o corporal según las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y cómo evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Señales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y límites.
- Herramientas prácticas, criterios de aplicación y conexiones con otros capítulos.

Becoming an Emotionally Intelligent Masculine Leader - Connor Beaton - Transcript.pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 3. Palabras extraídas: 1.047. Texto curado integrado aquí: 83 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Consejos y principios para hombres / Masculino' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

think clearly, and act decisively. The two traits worth developing most (in ourselves and the next generation) are adaptability and the ability to regulate and calm the nervous system under pressure, because it's nearly impossible to lead well from a place of dysregulation. As David Deida said, "the masculine grows by challenge." So here's the challenge: don't avoid what you feel, stop using suppression as leadership - face it, master it, and let it forge you into someone trustworthy and potent.

11. Herramientas, ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas

Este capítulo conserva practicas accionables: escritura, decision, limites, conversaciones y observacion de patrones. Se excluyen meditaciones y breathwork por instruccion final. Fuentes integradas en este capítulo: 4.

Estructura interna del capítulo

- Definicion completa del fenomeno y vocabulario operativo.
- Origen psicologico, relacional o corporal segun las fuentes.
- Mecanismos implicados y como evolucionan con el tiempo.
- Senales observables, errores frecuentes, excepciones y limites.
- Herramientas practicas, criterios de aplicacion y conexiones con otros capitulos.

Old Templates/LONG TEMPLATES .pdf

Tipo: PDF. Paginas originales: 65. Palabras extraidas: 20.473. Texto curado integrado aqui: 6.613 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Herramientas, ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la practica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribucion util dentro de una arquitectura comun: definicion, origen, senales observables, consecuencias, limites, herramientas y relacion con otros conceptos.

conflicto_intimidad hipervigilancia_relacional desregulacion_afectiva modelo_interno_incoherente miedo_al_vinculo
autosabotaje_relacional intensidad_y_caos ruptura_impulsiva reconciliacion_repetitiva activacion_traumatica memoria_implicita eje_HHA
regulacion_somatica integracion_prefrontal sensibilidad_amigdala ambivalencia_extrema dependencia_y_rechazo inestabilidad_en_pareja
sexualidad_desregulada Reconstruccion_del_apego seguridad_interna experiencia_correctiva regulacion_autonomica trauma_de_apego
reaccion_vs_respuesta patron_relacional_mixto transformacion_profunda

En dinámica de pareja ansioso-evitativo: • Anxious interpreta distancia como abandono. • Avoidant interpreta necesidad como invasión/absorción. • Ambos se disparan a “peor caso” y responden al miedo, no a la necesidad real. ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES • Usar el estilo como etiqueta fija en vez de como mapa de trabajo (“soy así, punto”). • Creer que el cambio se hace con fuerza de voluntad (“me controlo y ya”) en vez de recondicionamiento. • Ir directo a pedir a la pareja que cubra necesidades que son, en parte, auto-sourcing (autocubrir) pendiente. Eso crea demandas

CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES Autoimagen (self-image) : plantilla interna de “quién soy” que filtra lo que noto e interpreto, y puede crear “cicatrices invisibles”. Cicatriz invisible : creencia de defecto o indignidad que ya no está “en el presente”, pero sigue operando como si lo estuviera.

Desde la psicología del apego, la dificultad para decidir se intensifica según el estilo predominante: - El apego ansioso tiende a sobrevalorar la conexión por miedo a perder seguridad.

MECANISMO INTERNO El modelo interno inconsciente es: “mi seguridad depende de la conexión”. Cuando aparece alguien nuevo, se activa una hiperactivación del sistema de apego. La mente empieza a rellenar vacíos de información

1. Sistema de apego: busca preservar conexión. 2. Sistema de evaluación racional: detecta incompatibilidades o necesidades no cubiertas. 3. Sistema de miedo al dolor: intenta evitar la ruptura por el impacto emocional y logístico.

POSIBILIDAD DE CAMBIO El apego ansioso no es una identidad fija. Es un patrón aprendido. El cerebro es plástico. El sistema nervioso se reeduca con repetición y nuevas experiencias relacionales. Se modifica mediante: - Terapia centrada en apego o trauma relacional.

Experiencias repetidas de invalidación enseñan a adaptarse: callar, minimizar, no molestar, no “ser demasiado”. MECANISMO INTERNO 1. Existe una necesidad (cuidado, consistencia, afecto, respeto, consideración). 2. Aparecen vergüenza y miedo (“si lo pido, me rechazan” / “soy una carga”). 3. La estrategia es callar o no nombrarlo claramente. 4. La necesidad no desaparece , se queda como tensión interna. 5. Sale de lado : expectativas no habladas, resentimiento, pasivo-agresividad, irritabilidad. 6. La mente crea un atajo protector: “Si me quisiera, lo sabría”, que evita la vulnerabilidad, pero bloquea intimidad y conexión.

Resentimiento: emoción que aparece cuando algo importante no se nombra ni se negocia y se acumula con el tiempo. Comunicación directa: expresar lo que siento y lo que necesito con claridad conductual. No es exigir, es ponerlo sobre la mesa. Seguridad emocional: sensación de que puedo hablar sin ser castigada, ridiculizada o invalidada. Reparación: proceso de volver a conectar después de un daño. Incluye reconocimiento, responsabilidad y ajuste. Responsividad: cómo responde la otra persona cuando me expongo. Se ve en escucha, validación y disposición a ajustar. Ocupar espacio: permitirme tener voz, necesidades y preferencias sin pedir perdón por existir. Invalidación: respuesta que niega o minimiza tu experiencia, por ejemplo “eres demasiado” o “no es para tanto”.

“Boundaries aren't rejection, they're clarity” : un límite no castiga; define acceso y cuida tu paz. RELATED #identidad #regulacion #limites #energia #prioridades #autoestima #necesidades #comunicacion #dinamicas #autobetrayal #audit #innerLeaks

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Depender casi solo de apps y terminar en burnout y cinismo. • Esperar “spark” inmediato y descartar rápido sin explorar compatibilidad real. • Mantener conversaciones por texto durante semanas como sustituto de conocer a la persona. • Cancelar citas por ansiedad o miedo a rechazar o ser rechazado. • Confundir ansiedad con química y perseguir disponibilidad intermitente. • Normalizar señales de baja inversión: ghosting, ambivalencia, mensajes tarde, falta de consistencia. • Comparar matches con un ideal (“algoritmo”) y despreciar opciones reales. • Evitar conversaciones claras (exclusividad, necesidades) por miedo a parecer “needy”. • Vivir más en proyecciones futuras que en evidencia presente (ruptura y reparación, coherencia, trato). ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES Creer que “si no hay chispa el primer día, no hay nada” impide que la conexión madure. El texto insiste en que a veces lo que crece lento

CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES No contacto como protección del sistema nervioso No es “drama” ni orgullo. Es un corte de estímulo para permitir desaprendizaje y bajar recaídas. La fantasía como ancla Lo que más mantiene el dolor no es solo la pérdida, sino el futuro imaginado que se sigue alimentando después del final. RELATED #relacion #ruptura #duelo #apego #regulacion #limites #autoestima #procesamiento

El foco está en sostener el nuevo criterio incluso cuando no genera gratificación inmediata, evitando volver a patrones anteriores. CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES Es fundamental integrar la diferencia entre activación emocional y compatibilidad, entender el papel del

sistema de apego en la atracción

- Equiparar familiaridad con seguridad . ● Mantener la “zona de confort” aunque sea dolorosa, porque es predecible. ● Reaccionar más a emociones e imágenes que a lenguaje. Desde ahí, se explica por qué: ● Lo “seguro” puede sentirse “aburrido” a personas con patrones inseguros: no hay montaña rusa, no hay activación familiar. ● Lo no disponible puede sentirse “magnético”: obliga a desplegar el set de estrategias aprendidas (hipervigilancia, people pleasing,

Fase 2: Necesidades y auto-sourcing (autocubrir lo que faltó) Auditar necesidades no cubiertas en la infancia (no solo “lo malo”, también “lo que no pasó y debía pasar”: presencia, protección, validación,

Fase 4: Comunicación efectiva (sentimiento → necesidad → imagen concreta) Para resolver conflicto: 1. Cada parte expresa qué sintió y valida lo del otro. 2. Cada parte identifica su necesidad (detrás de la crítica). 3. Cada parte “pinta la foto”: conducta específica, frecuencia, duración.

La idealización selectiva es un sesgo cognitivo que prioriza recuerdos positivos para mantener sensación de seguridad. El concepto de “closure” suele ser malinterpretado. La mente busca completar tareas abiertas, pero la verdadera resolución no

El proceso interno suele seguir este patrón: 1. Aumenta la intimidad o la demanda emocional. 2. Aparece incomodidad fisiológica (tensión, necesidad de espacio). 3. Se activa una estrategia de desactivación: minimizar, racionalizar, retirarse. 4. Disminuye el contacto emocional. 5. Vuelve la sensación de control.

1. Creer que no necesitar a nadie es fortaleza. 2. Interpretar la necesidad emocional del otro como debilidad. 3. Pensar que el problema siempre es que “el otro pide demasiado”. 4. Asociar vulnerabilidad con pérdida de control. 5. Creer que la incomodidad ante la intimidad significa que la relación no es adecuada.

El cerebro busca coherencia. Cuando hay incoherencia entre identidad, entorno y conducta, aparece fricción interna. El Workflow permite detectar esa fricción y reorganizar el sistema. 1) DESEOS - El Motor Real Qué es El deseo es la motivación profunda que orienta tu conducta. No es el objetivo declarado, sino la emoción que persigues. Muchas personas dicen querer estabilidad, éxito o pareja. En realidad persiguen seguridad, validación, pertenencia o alivio de soledad.

POR QUÉ PASA Si en el pasado expresar necesidades trajo rechazo o vergüenza, pedir puede sentirse peligroso o humillante. Cuando faltó sintonía emocional en la infancia, queda un “vacío” que anhela ser anticipada como prueba de amor y aceptación.

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES ● No pedir directamente y luego sentir decepción o abandono. ● Acumular resentimiento por “detalles” que en realidad son simbólicos. ● Comentarios indirectos, pruebas, castigos silenciosos, retirada afectiva. ● Interpretaciones rígidas: “si no hace esto, no le importo”. ● Sensación de impotencia porque nada se pone explícitamente sobre la mesa. ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES ● Confundir expresar una necesidad con rogar . ● Creer que el objetivo es una pareja que adivine, en vez de una pareja que responde con cuidado cuando se le informa. ● Pensar que la vulnerabilidad es opcional en una relación profunda. ● Convertir expectativas no habladas en “pruebas de amor” o “juicios morales”. ● Intentar “comunicar mejor” cuando en realidad falta decencia básica (y ahí el problema es la persona o la compatibilidad, no

planifiques.” ● Trabajar la vergüenza : identificar el guion interno (“soy demasiado”) y practicar hablar igual. ● Usar la voz como poder : el precio de ser querida bien es la vulnerabilidad. ● Observar la respuesta : ○ Verdes: amabilidad, curiosidad, esfuerzo, reparación. ○ Rojos: burla, invalidación, “eres demasiado sensible”, defensividad crónica, hacerte sentir una carga por tener necesidades. ● Diferenciar estándares de preferencias : ○ La decencia básica no se negocia. ○ Preferencias y “cómo me gusta ser amada” sí se conversan y se calibran con el tiempo. CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES

Objetivo de la fase: responder con honestidad a: “¿esto se está volviendo más claro con el tiempo, o más confuso?” Criterio clave: la seguridad se construye con consistencia, no con dopamina.

AUTOR / FUENTE:Transcripción del video “The 3-Boundary Rule That Will Save Your Inner Peace!”. IDEA CENTRAL El texto plantea una idea simple: tu energía es tu moneda. No es un concepto abstracto, es lo que determina cómo te presentas, qué

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL:RELACIÓN SUBCATEGORÍA:Dinámicas TÍTULO:Pérdida de identidad en la relación: confundir intensidad con intimidad y seguridad con ser elegido AUTOR / FUENTE :Jay Shetty IDEA CENTRAL El texto describe un patrón frecuente en relaciones: cuando aparece una conexión intensa, algunas personas reducen su vida personal

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES ● Dejar hobbies y actividades personales al inicio de la relación. ● Ver menos a amistades y reducir el círculo social. ● Ajustar objetivos, agenda, rutinas y estándares para adaptarse al vínculo. ● Priorizar preferencias de la pareja por encima de las propias. ● Apologizar por cosas que no son responsabilidad propia. ● Sentir que la propia voz se vuelve más pequeña y la del otro más dominante. ● Tener límites difusos o difíciles de sostener, especialmente ante incomodidad. ● Ignorar señales de incompatibilidad por atracción, atención o miedo a “empezar de nuevo”. ● Acelerar el proceso (“caer rápido”) y perder capacidad de evaluación. ● Convertir la relación en el centro del bienestar emocional, con ansiedad cuando el otro se distancia. ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES Confundir “ser elegido” con “estar a salvo” genera una falsa sensación de seguridad que depende del otro. Esto puede llevar a tolerar

Confusión intensidad-intimidad Interpretar activación emocional y urgencia como profundidad real, lo que puede acelerar compromiso sin evaluación suficiente. Confusión ser elegido-estar a salvo Tomar interés o presencia como seguridad, aunque falten señales de respeto, compatibilidad o estabilidad. Externalizar el trabajo emocional (“outsourcing”) Esperar que la pareja repare heridas internas o sostenga el bienestar psicológico en lugar de un trabajo propio. Anclas

La atracción se organiza en torno a dos ejes: activación emocional y familiaridad psicológica. Cuando una persona te genera incertidumbre, inconsistencia o distancia, puede activar tu sistema de apego. Esa activación se experimenta

Esto genera una narrativa errónea donde se concluye “no funciona” cuando en realidad no ha llegado a iniciarse correctamente. MECANISMO INTERNO La atracción se organiza en torno a dos ejes: activación emocional y familiaridad psicológica. Cuando una persona te genera incertidumbre, inconsistencia o distancia, puede activar tu sistema de apego. Esa activación se experimenta

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES ● Esperar que la otra persona tome la iniciativa sin haber comunicado interés de forma clara ● Enviar señales ambiguas (miradas puntuales, interacción mínima) y asumir que son suficientes ● Interpretar la falta de respuesta o avance como rechazo directo ● Sentir mayor atracción hacia perfiles inconsistentes o emocionalmente no disponibles ● Perder interés en perfiles que muestran claridad, estabilidad o disponibilidad ● Evaluar la conexión de forma prematura, con muy poca información real ● Generar expectativas elevadas tras interacciones superficiales (especialmente vía texto) ● Abandonar rápidamente interacciones que no generan intensidad inmediata ● Repetir patrones de atracción similares sin identificar el criterio de selección

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Dificultad para concentrarse, “niebla mental” y menor tolerancia a conversaciones o trabajo. • Inquietud física o cansancio marcado, con oscilaciones (agitación vs. apagamiento). • Insomnio o evitación del sueño, y rutinas básicas alteradas (comer irregular, abandonar gimnasio o social). • Rumiación: replay de conversaciones, búsqueda de “la frase que lo habría salvado”, necesidad intensa de cierre. • Conductas de comprobación: releer mensajes, revisar redes, mirar fotos, buscar señales del ex. • Impulsos de contacto (escribir, llamar) o de reenganche por conflicto (texto “para soltarlo todo”). • Brotes de ira o protestas tardías, a veces hacia el ex y a veces hacia una misma por “haber aguantado”. • Retirada social en la tristeza, tendencia a aislarse o a empujar a amistades. • Fantasías de decisiones grandes e impulsivas (mudanza, cambios drásticos) como intento de aliviar intensidad. • Sensación de pérdida de identidad (“sin esto no sé quién soy”) y miedo a no volver a amar igual. **ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES** Confundir síntomas de abstinencia con defectos de carácter suele bloquear el proceso. Se interpreta la obsesión como “estoy mal” en

Fase 3: Canalización segura de la ira y establecimiento de límites (ira/protesta) La ira se valida como información: marca límites, injusticias, necesidades no atendidas y recuperación de auto-respeto. Se canaliza con

CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES • Duelo por ruptura: proceso de pérdida emocional que sigue fases, no lineales, y no implica debilidad. • Retirada del vínculo (withdrawal): respuesta biológica al corte de un apego; explica craving, obsesión y síntomas somáticos. • Pérdida del futuro imaginado: duelo por la narrativa y la identidad proyectada, no solo por la persona. • Co-regulación / regulación diaria: funciones de calma y estabilidad que el vínculo aportaba y que deben reconstruirse. • Negociación (bargaining): rumiación orientada a “si hubiera...” como intento inconsciente de recuperar control/proximidad. • Idealización / highlight reel: sesgo de memoria que amplifica lo bueno y borra lo doloroso, manteniendo el apego. • Ira como auto-respeto: señal de recuperación de límites y dignidad, no necesariamente un retroceso. • Aceptación vs. aprobación: aceptar es dejar de pelear con la realidad, no decir que estuvo bien. • Meaning making: fase tardía de elaboración donde surge aprendizaje e integración de identidad tras la pérdida. • No contact / low contact: intervención de higiene del apego para reducir craving y acelerar estabilización emocional. **RELATED** #relacion #ruptura #apego #duelo #regulacion #limites #withdrawal #meaningMaking

Fase 5: Límites saludables (subconsciente + exposición) Los límites son unión, no separación: son expresión auténtica de sí. Patrones por estilo: • Ansioso: pocos límites por miedo a abandono. • Evitativo: límites rígidos para evitar vulnerabilidad. • Temerario: ciclo sin límites → frustración → límite desde ira → culpa → vuelta a sin límites.

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL: IDENTIDAD **SUBCATEGORÍA:** Regulación **TÍTULO:** Regla de 3 límites para proteger tu paz: tiempo, emoción y “energía” (sin volverte fría) **AUTOR / FUENTE** (si aplica): Jay Shetty YouTube: The 3-Boundary Rule That Will Save Your Inner Peace! **IDEA CENTRAL** Proteger tu energía no es “poner muros”, es regular el acceso que otras personas tienen a tu tiempo, tu atención y tu mundo emocional.

Fase 2: Identifica el tipo de drenaje (qué forma toma) Reconoce qué “perfil” aparece más: • El que solo descarga (emocional dumper). • El que siempre recibe y nunca está cuando lo necesitas (chronic taker). • El que negocia tu no (boundary tester). • El que te aplaude hasta que te va bien (compliment parasite). • El que solo aparece cuando brillas (situational friend). Fase 3: Cierra tus fugas internas (la parte que sí depende de ti) Localiza qué haces tú para perder energía: decir sí por miedo, sobre-dar para ser querida, callarte para no incomodar, estar disponible

amor. • Un límite sano no es rechazo: es claridad. Y la claridad, a largo plazo, protege las relaciones más que el aguante. **RELATED** #identidad #regulacion #limites #autorespeto #peoplePleasing #energia #prioridades #comunicacion

- Quejas repetidas sin implementación de cambios prácticos. - Culpas exclusivamente a la pareja sin asumir co-creación. - Permanecer en la relación por miedo al dolor de la separación. - Fantasear con que el otro cambie sin acuerdos concretos. - Haber “desconectado” emocionalmente pero continuar por costumbre. **ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES**

Pero el dolor no es solo químico. Es identitario. Durante meses o años dejamos de ser solo “yo” para convertirnos en “nosotros”. Las rutinas, los planes y la autoimagen se construyen

Pero lo que realmente se está buscando no es información. Es validación de identidad. Internamente ocurre esto: - Se pierde la regulación externa (la otra persona como fuente de conexión).

- Releer conversaciones antiguas. - Idealizar la relación olvidando conflictos reales. - Buscar explicaciones repetidamente. - Sentir que la ruptura afecta el propio valor. - Fantasear con una reconciliación sin cambios estructurales. **ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES**

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES En la práctica, este patrón suele verse en cuatro estilos comunes (sin que sean etiquetas rígidas): Algunas personas se vuelven extremadamente contenidas hacia fuera, pero por dentro están tensas. Se les percibe “correctas”

• Confundir estoicismo con disociación. • Pensar que inteligencia emocional es ser “hipersensible” o “llorar por todo”. • Creer que hablar de emociones ya es procesarlas. • Buscar co-regulación como sustituto de autorregulación (hacer que la pareja te gestione). • Tomar decisiones importantes en plena desregulación porque “tengo que resolverlo ya”. • Pensar que empatía es absorber el estado del otro (y perder centro), en vez de comprender sin hundirse. • Creer que suprimir es regular.

1. Creer que la ansiedad indica que la relación es “muy profunda”. 2. Interpretar cada distancia como señal definitiva de abandono. 3. Pensar que la solución es “necesitar menos”. 4. Elegir parejas evitativas que refuerzan la activación.

Practica esto: “Me estoy empezando a sentir saturado. Necesito 15 minutos y seguimos.” Eso es regulación con vínculo, no regulación por escape. Aquí estás enseñando a tu sistema nervioso que puedes tomar espacio sin romper conexión.

3. Aumentar tolerancia a la vulnerabilidad en micro dosis El evitativo suele esperar a estar 100% cómodo para hablar. Eso no va a ocurrir. La transformación ocurre en exposición gradual. Empieza con vulnerabilidad pequeña y concreta: - Expresar una emoción simple antes de que se acumule.

6. Practicar presencia en conflicto El evitativo teme más al conflicto emocional que a la ruptura. Un ejercicio clave es permanecer en conversaciones incómodas sin cerrar. No resolver todo.

Desde el punto de vista neurobiológico, esto implica: • Activación crónica del eje hipotálamo-hipófisis-adrenal (HHA), responsable de la respuesta al estrés. • Sensibilización de la amígdala, aumentando la detección de amenaza interpersonal. • Dificultad en la integración entre la amígdala (reactividad emocional) y la corteza prefrontal medial (regulación e interpretación)

Psicológicamente, esto genera: • Modelos internos incoherentes sobre uno mismo (“soy deseable / soy defectuoso”). • Modelos internos incoherentes sobre los demás (“me cuidan / me dañan”). • Dificultad para integrar emociones opuestas de forma simultánea.

1. Creer que el caos es señal de pasión real. 2. Pensar que la pareja “no es la adecuada” cada vez que aparece estabilidad. 3. Atribuir la inestabilidad exclusivamente al comportamiento del otro. 4. Asumir que la contradicción interna es rasgo fijo de personalidad.

AUTOR / FUENTE (si aplica) : HOE MATH IDEA CENTRAL: Tu vida no cambia por fuerza de voluntad aislada. Cambia cuando entiendes el sistema completo que la genera. El Workflow Growth es un modelo estructurado que analiza siete capas interconectadas: deseos, entorno, mentalidad, apariencia,

POR QUÉ PASA La mayoría de las personas intentan cambiar resultados trabajando únicamente la conducta visible. Pero el comportamiento es la última expresión de un sistema interno que incluye creencias, entorno, identidad y regulación emocional.

2) ENTORNO - El Sistema Externo Qué es El conjunto de reglas, cultura, economía, normas sociales y dinámicas que influyen en tus decisiones. Para qué sirve Aquí se define el nivel máximo al que puedes sostenerte. Ignorarlo genera frustración innecesaria. Desde la psicología conductual, el entorno moldea comportamiento más que la intención. Trabajo profundo

3) MENTALIDAD - Identidad y Creencias Qué es El sistema interno de interpretación: lo que crees sobre ti, el amor, el conflicto, el rechazo, el éxito. Para qué sirve Aquí se define el nivel máximo al que puedes sostenerte. Desde la neurociencia cognitiva, la identidad actúa como filtro perceptivo. El cerebro busca evidencia que confirme quién cree que eres.

4) APARIENCIA - Señal Social Qué es Tu emisión externa: tono, lenguaje corporal, estética, ritmo, energía. Para qué sirve La comunicación no verbal influye más que el contenido verbal. El entorno responde a señales, no a intenciones. Desde la psicología social, la percepción inicial moldea la respuesta del otro. Trabajo profundo - ¿Mi tono transmite seguridad o necesidad?

Qué es El aprendizaje práctico tras observar consecuencias. Para qué sirve Convierte experiencia en mejora. Sin feedback consciente, el cerebro automatiza el patrón. Trabajo profundo Formato operativo: Probé X

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO • Reencuadre : “Pedir no es suplicar. Pedir es invitar y mostrar quién soy.” • Nombrar el deseo en términos concretos (conducta observable). Ej.: “San Valentín es importante para mí. Me gustaría que

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL: Dating SUBCATEGORÍA: Fases del datint TÍTULO: No sentirse confuso mientras dating AUTOR / FUENTE : Video de YouTube “The #1 Dating Rule That Will Change Your Life (You’ll Never Be Confused Again!)”. Dr. Chris

Fase 1 - Señal de inicio: detectar que entraste en “modo confusión” Esta fase empieza en el momento en el que notas cualquiera de estas señales: estás pendiente del móvil, te cuesta concentrarte, interpretas

Fase 2 - Regulación primero (antes de escribir, pedir explicaciones o perseguir) Aquí el foco no es “hacerlo perfecto”, sino crear un pequeño espacio entre impulso y acción. En el texto se sugiere la idea de entrenarlo

Objetivo de la fase: recuperar acceso a elección y bajar la urgencia. Regla: si no puedes acceder a elección, todavía no es momento de actuar sobre la relación.

Fase 3 - Volver a datos: separar HECHOS de HISTORIAS Cuando ya estás un poco más regulada, pasas a ordenar la situación como si fueras una investigadora, no una juez. En vez de “esto

Fase 4 - Evaluar el patrón de interés (consistencia, intención, progresión) En esta fase aplicas la brújula del contenido: el interés real se ve en estructura, no en chispazos. Aquí miras si hay reciprocidad, si hay

Fase 6 - Decisión y acción (elegirte sin negociar mínimos) Con la respuesta (o con la falta de respuesta) tomas una decisión coherente. Si hay alineación, se avanza con calma. Si hay incoherencia,

Fase 7 - Integración (para no repetir el patrón) Esta fase es la que convierte esto en crecimiento, no en “un truco que hoy me salió”. Vuelves a dos preguntas que aparecen en el texto:

Objetivo de la fase: que la próxima vez tu cuerpo reconozca antes la señal y no necesite tanta intensidad para sentirse “vivo”. CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES En este contenido aparecen varios conceptos que se sostienen entre sí: consistencia e intencionalidad como indicadores de interés,

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Quedarte extrañamente cansada después de una llamada, reunión o encuentro “corto”. • Volver de una interacción sintiéndote pesada, confusa o drenada. • Sentirte culpable o avergonzada después de hablar con alguien (como si estuvieras “por detrás” en la vida). • Sostener conversaciones donde la otra persona descarga caos y crisis, y cuando tú compartes algo vuelve inmediatamente

suyo. • Dar ayuda grande de forma repetida y recibir ausencia cuando tú necesitas algo pequeño. • Decir “no puedo” y recibir contraofertas (“solo 30 minutos”, “sábado por la mañana”, “pero acuérdate de cuando yo...”). • Sentir tensión o dread antes de responder un mensaje porque ya anticipas demanda, drama o culpa. • Cambiar planes y prioridades para estar disponible, y luego resentirte o agotarte. • Notar que te cuesta compartir buenas noticias con ciertas personas por miedo a su reacción pasivo-agresiva. • Tener amistades o vínculos “situacionales”: aparecen cuando brillas y desaparecen cuando estás en un momento bajo. ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES Un error es pensar que poner límites equivale a “ser mala” o “ser fría”. El texto insiste en que un límite no es rechazo, es claridad: marca

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1 - Auditoría de 72 horas (leer el dato corporal) Durante 24, 48 y 72 horas, observa cómo te quedas después de cada interacción: llamada, Zoom, texto, email o encuentro. No racionalices.

Fase 2 - Identificar el drenaje dominante (el patrón exacto) Con lo que hayas visto, nombra qué estilo es el que más te drena: el descargador emocional, el tomador crónico, el probador de límites,

Fase 3 - Tapar fugas internas (dejar de autoabandonarte) Pregúntate: “¿Dónde digo sí por miedo?” “¿Dónde me callo para no parecer difícil?” “¿Dónde confundo estar disponible con ser buena?”.

La idea es que el límite no sea una discusión eterna; sea una norma que protege tu energía antes de que se pierda. Fase 5 - Herramientas prácticas (tres tests de decisión) Usa tres herramientas que el texto propone como filtros rápidos. Primero, el “pause test”: si te da pereza o tensión responder, probablemente

Fase 6 - Mantener sin endurecerte (cierre de identidad) Sostén la idea final: puedes ser compasiva y decir no. Puedes querer y proteger tu paz. Si alguien interpreta tu claridad como rechazo,

CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES “Proteger mi energía” : priorizar la calidad de tu presencia y tu capacidad de sostener tu vida, no solo “hacer más”. Energía como moneda : tu energía se gasta como dinero; si no hay conciencia, acabas “emocionalmente en bancarota”.

“No todo drenaje es maldad” : alguien puede drenar por estar vacío o no saber autorregularse; el límite sigue siendo necesario. Fugas internas (inner leaks) : cuando tú misma te drenas por miedo a perder amor, por no decepcionar o por evitar ser vista como “difícil”.

Fase 2 - Separar pensamiento de identidad (desfusión) Cuando aparezca “no soy suficiente” o “no puedo”, el primer paso es cortar la fusión: reconocer que no eres tus pensamientos ni tus

Fase 3 - Reenganchar lo ejecutivo (prefrontal) con una pregunta funcional En vez de quedarte en “cómo me ven” y “qué significa esto de mí”, el texto propone mover la atención a valor y servicio: “¿qué necesita

Fase 5 - Convertir comparación en emulación (envidia → estudio) Cada vez que aparezca comparación, cambia la pregunta: no “¿por qué ellos sí y yo no?”, sino “¿qué hicieron, cómo lo hicieron y qué

Fase 6 - Plan “si-entonces” para no colapsar en el primer obstáculo Visualizar metas ayuda a actualizar autoimagen, pero el texto advierte del riesgo de fantasear sin preparar fricción. Aquí se construye

Fase 7 - Exposición dosificada a rechazo e incomodidad (desensibilización) Si el freno es miedo a rechazo, el texto sugiere una lógica de terapia de exposición: empezar por rechazos de bajo riesgo para enseñar

Fase 8 - Agency mapping (habilidades visibles vs. cualidades esencia) Cuando sientas “no tengo lo que pide el rol”, haz el ejercicio de columnas: lo que se requiere, las cualidades que ya tienes (curiosidad,

Fase 1: Detectar el patrón y nombrarlo sin dramatizar El primer paso es reconocer señales tempranas de reducción de vida propia: menos amistades, menos hábitos, menos objetivos, más

Fase 2: Definir prioridades y “anclas” antes de negociar con la relación El texto propone construir anclas claras: actividades en solitario, personas que sostienen fuera del vínculo, y metas no románticas. La

Fase 3: Reequilibrar inversión (vida propia y vínculo) sin castigar la relación Se trata de expandir el “afuera”: recuperar rutinas, amistades, hobbies y proyectos, no como amenaza a la pareja, sino como condición

Fase 4: Hacer el trabajo emocional propio (no externalizarlo) Aquí el cambio es pasar de “mi pareja debería curar esto” a “mi pareja puede acompañar mientras yo lo trabajo”. Implica identificar heridas

Fase 5: Instalar límites estructurales: autonomía, equidad y honestidad emocional El texto ofrece tres líneas que no conviene cruzar. Autonomía implica mantener pensamiento, intereses y elección. Equidad implica reciprocidad

Fase 6: Ajustar el ritmo y validar señales antes de comprometer identidad Se recomienda desacelerar, porque la velocidad suele aumentar ceguera selectiva. Ir más lento permite que aparezcan datos: coherencia,

CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES “Perderse en la relación” Proceso en el que la identidad propia se diluye: se dejan rutinas, vínculos y metas, y la relación se vuelve el eje de regulación emocional.

Elementos fuera de la relación que estabilizan identidad: actividades en solitario, red de apoyo, metas personales. Autonomía, equidad y honestidad emocional Tres límites estructurales que sostienen relaciones sanas: mantener individualidad, reciprocidad, y capacidad de hablar con verdad sin

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL: DATING SUBCATEGORÍA: Atracción TÍTULO: Por qué no estás encontrando amor: señales confusas, prisa y baja tolerancia al rechazo AUTOR / FUENTE: JAY SHETTY IDEA CENTRAL El texto plantea que muchas personas están abordando el dating desde un marco que las agota y las desconecta: confiar demasiado

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1: Reestructurar el sistema (menos agotamiento, más realidad) Diversificar el “cómo conozco gente” para no depender de apps. Expandir círculo y actividades, con intención. La idea es bajar volumen

Fase 2: Cambiar el ritmo: menos texto, más encuentro Textos breves para calibrar y pasar rápido a una cita o videollamada. Esto reduce fantasía, acelera claridad y protege el tiempo emocional.

Fase 3: Entrenar resiliencia al rechazo (sin personalizarlo) Normalizar que la mayoría de personas no serán “la persona”. Rechazo temprano ahorra tiempo. El músculo es sostener la incomodidad

Fase 4: Subir estándares de comunicación (no de fantasía) Filtrar por consistencia, claridad y capacidad de comunicar. Si alguien ghostea o no sabe conversar, no es un “misterio”: es un dato. La

Fase 6: Autenticidad práctica Decir lo que quieres (por ejemplo, exclusividad) con calma y apertura a un sí o un no. Un no no es fracaso: es claridad para elegir. CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES Disponibilidad > perfección Lo que más cambia tus resultados no es verte “perfecta”, sino transmitir apertura real: señales claras, presencia y un “hey” simple que

No es lo que atraes, es lo que entretienes La diferencia la marca a quién le das acceso: si normalizas baja inversión (ghosting, mensajes tarde, inconsistencia), repites el patrón.

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL: RELACIÓN SUBCATEGORÍA: Ruptura TÍTULO: Ruptura como duelo y desprogramación: no contacto, gestión de impulsos y reconstrucción de vida AUTOR / FUENTE : MEL ROBBINS How to Heal a Broken Heart & Move On Video <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GcJVygChaxA>

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Revisar redes sociales y buscar señales de la ex pareja (stories, likes, fotos). • Publicar contenido con el objetivo de ser visto o provocar reacción. • Revisar ubicación, mensajes antiguos, fotos y videos compartidos. • Hablar de la ex pareja constantemente para mantener presencia simbólica. • Fantasear con el futuro que “podría haber sido” y usar la tristeza como vínculo. • Buscar “closure” mediante una llamada o conversación, con riesgo de recaída. • Evitar el no contacto “porque no aguanto”, aunque se reconozca que activa retroceso. • Estar en montaña rusa emocional: momentos de aparente mejora y recaídas intensas. • Trabajar o distraerse de forma compulsiva para no sentir, sin que funcione. • Resistir la vida social y necesitar que otros “se presenten” más que invitar. ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES Confundir el impulso de contactar con una señal de que “deberíamos estar juntos” es un error frecuente. El texto insiste en que el impulso

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1: Normalizar el duelo (procesar, no acelerar) La primera intervención es entender que el dolor incluye mente y cuerpo. Se valida la tristeza, el llanto y la sensación de “no puedo”.

Fase 2: No contacto estructural (30 días como corte de estímulo) Se propone una regla clara: 30 días sin contacto ni exposición intencional a estímulos supercargados, especialmente la voz (audios,

Fase 4: Pedir soporte de forma directa (red de contención) Avisar a personas cercanas que habrá una ventana de duelo de aproximadamente tres meses y pedir conductas concretas: que inviten,

Fase 5: Reorganizar identidad y tiempo (llenar el hueco sin anestesia) Construir agenda con cosas pequeñas y reales para recuperar vida: eventos locales, planes con amistades, actividades que generen

Fase 6: Trabajar el “futuro imaginario” (aceptación del no) La intervención más profunda es soltar la película interna: aceptar no solo la ruptura, sino la renuncia a la vida imaginada (bodas, hijos,

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL: DATING **SUBCATEGORÍA:** Atracción **TÍTULO:** Por qué no estás encontrando pareja (y qué está fallando realmente) **AUTOR / FUENTE (si aplica):** Podcast J. Shetty + expertos en comportamiento, psicoterapia y dating

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO (ENFOQUE CLÍNICO POR FASES) Fase 1: Psicoeducación y toma de conciencia El primer paso es entender cómo funciona la atracción en tu caso concreto. Esto implica diferenciar entre activación emocional y conexión

Fase 2: Identificación de patrón de atracción En esta fase se analiza el histórico relacional. Qué tipo de personas te han atraído, qué características comparten y qué dinámica se

Fase 3: Reestructuración del criterio de atracción Aquí comienza el ajuste real. Se trabaja en dejar de usar la intensidad como indicador principal y empezar a introducir variables más funcionales como: • consistencia • claridad • disponibilidad emocional

Fase 4: Entrenamiento conductual en señalización En paralelo, se interviene sobre la conducta observable. Se entrena la capacidad de comunicar interés de forma clara y suficiente para que el otro pueda percibirlo sin ambigüedad. Esto incluye:

Fase 5: Exposición al rechazo y tolerancia a la incertidumbre Se introduce exposición progresiva a situaciones donde puede haber respuesta negativa o ambigua. Esto reduce la evitación y permite que el proceso de selección ocurra de forma real. Sin esta fase, la persona tiende a quedarse en dinámicas

Fase 6: Integración y consolidación En esta fase se observa si hay cambio en los resultados: tipo de personas que aparecen, tipo de interacciones que se generan y calidad

CATEGORÍA PRINCIPAL: RELACIÓN **SUBCATEGORÍA:** Ruptura **TÍTULO:** Duelo por ruptura: retirada del vínculo, fases y sostén del sistema nervioso **AUTOR / FUENTE (si aplica)** YouTube: If You are Going Through a Breakup, This is Exactly What I'd Tell You (menciona a Helen Fisher y a Elisabeth Kübler-Ross)

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1: Normalización y contención (shock/negación) El objetivo no es “entender todo”, sino estabilizar lo básico para que el sistema nervioso no se desorganice más. Se priorizan rutinas

Fase 2: Manejo de rumiación y conductas de comprobación (negociación/obsesión) Aquí se trabaja el impulso de “reconstruir proximidad” a través de la mente. Dos acciones centrales: escribir pensamientos repetidos

Fase 5: Integración, significado y reconstrucción de identidad (aceptación/meaning making) Cuando hay distancia suficiente, aparece la pregunta útil: “¿Qué aprendí? ¿Qué haré diferente?”. Se construye una narrativa donde el

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1: Rewire de heridas nucleares (subconsciente) El orden importa: primero bajar el “ruido” interno que hace que cualquier relación se viva como amenaza. Se identifica una herida (ej.

Fase 3: Regulación del sistema nervioso (salir de fight/flight crónico) Los tres estilos inseguros tienden a estar demasiado tiempo en activación. Se entrena pasar a parasimpático y, en el día a día, se usa

Proceso: • Auditar límites por áreas de vida. • Identificar el significado temido (“si pongo límite, me rechazan/abandono”). • Rewire del miedo y luego exposición gradual: límites pequeños con personas seguras antes de límites grandes en contextos

Aparecen dos perfiles relacionales grandes: • Inversores de energía : hay reciprocidad, respeto, honestidad y celebración real. • Ladrones de energía : no necesariamente malos, pero generan confusión, drama, prueba de límites y desgaste.

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Sensación de quedarte “plana” o extrañamente cansada después de una llamada, reunión o café. • Tensión antes de responder a un mensaje, y alivio solo cuando pospones o no contestas. • Conversaciones donde el otro “vomita emoción” y tú sales cargada, sin espacio para ti. • Ayudar mucho y recibir poco (y sentir resentimiento después). • Límites que te cuestan el doble: primero ponerlos y luego defenderlos cuando te los negocian. • Dificultad para compartir buenas noticias con ciertas personas por miedo a su reacción. • Sobre-disponibilidad: responder rápido, cancelar planes propios, “ser flexible” para demostrar cariño. • Confundir cansancio con productividad o valor personal. • Callarte para no parecer “difícil” y luego sentirte traicionada por ti. **ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES** Proteger tu energía se puede malinterpretar como egoísmo, frialdad o rechazo. El episodio insiste en que un “no” no significa “no me

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1: Detecta el patrón (72 horas de observación) Durante 24-48-72 horas, después de cada interacción (texto, mail, llamada, café), pregúntate: “¿Me deja más ligera o más pesada?”.

Fase 4: Aplica la regla de los 3 límites (simple y sostenida) • Límites físicos (tiempo/espacio) : define qué días y franjas son tuyas. Responder más tarde puede ser autocuidado. Tiempo

• Energy audit semanal : lista “me da / me drena” y ajusta. • Regla de 24 horas : no digas que sí al instante. Mira tu agenda, pero también mira tu energía. **CONCEPTOS IMPORTANTES** • Proteger tu energía no es alejarte de la gente, es controlar el acceso para poder estar bien contigo y con los demás. • Muchas fugas no vienen de “otros”, vienen de auto-traición : decir sí sin energía, callarte por miedo, sobre-dar para ganar

Para qué sirve Si no identificas el deseo real, construirás metas que no te satisfacen o repetirás patrones que no entiendes. Trabajo profundo Preguntas estructurales: - ¿Qué emoción intento obtener realmente?

5) **CONDUCTAS** - Lo que Repites Qué es Acciones repetidas frente a emociones: insistir, retirarte, controlar, complacer, discutir, evitar. Para qué sirve Las conductas revelan qué emoción intentas regular. Desde la teoría del aprendizaje, toda conducta que se repite cumple una función. Trabajo profundo - ¿Qué hago cuando me siento inseguro?

6) **SITUACIÓN** - Resultados Reales Qué es La fotografía actual de tu vida: vínculos, salud, dinero, estabilidad emocional. Para qué sirve Los resultados son datos. No son identidad, son información. Trabajo profundo - ¿Qué patrón se repite en mis relaciones?

PROTOCOLO O DIRECCIÓN DE CAMBIO Fase 1 - Diagnóstico de tu patrón (qué driver manda hoy) Empieza por concretar: cuando aparece tu duda, ¿suena a “no valgo / no merezco” (aceptación) o suena a “no puedo / no sé” (agencia)?

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Rumiación y espiral mental: releer mensajes, revisar el móvil, intentar “descifrar” el tono o el significado oculto. • Hipervigilancia digital: medir interés por tiempos de respuesta, emojis, puntuación, frecuencia de contacto. • Búsqueda de dopamina: sentir alivio momentáneo cuando llega el mensaje y volver a necesitar otra señal para calmarse. • Aceleración del vínculo: ver a la persona con demasiada frecuencia al inicio, ceder rutinas y priorizar el dating sobre tu vida. • Inversión desigual: ser siempre quien inicia conversaciones, sostiene el contacto o empuja los planes. • Conductas de persecución: escribir “una vez más”, explicar de más, pedir garantías, negociar tus límites para no perder. • Autoabandono: restar importancia a necesidades propias (“no pasa nada”, “yo me adapto”) para mantener el acceso. • Lectura de migajas como prueba de potencial: agarrarte a un momento bueno cada X tiempo como “la verdadera versión”. • Evitación de conversaciones claras por miedo a la respuesta: preferir la ambigüedad a confirmar un “no”. • Normalización de la “zona gris”: vínculos tipo situationship donde hay intimidad sin acuerdos ni dirección. **ERRORES DE**

INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES Uno de los errores más repetidos es confundir “muchacha emoción” con “muchacha compatibilidad”. El texto cuestiona la idea de que las mariposas

MANIFESTACIONES CONDUCTUALES • Necesidad de validación y refuerzo externo para sentir valor (y caída rápida cuando no llega). • “Presión por demostrar”: trabajar, rendir o sobre-esforzarte para comprar la sensación de ser suficiente. • Miedo al éxito y autosabotaje (“si me va demasiado bien, no lo merezco” o “me van a descubrir”). • Comparación constante que te deja en “estoy por detrás” y te desconecta de tu propio progreso. • Alivio o satisfacción cuando otro falla (ciclo de “schadenfreude” como parche de autoestima). • Identidad pegada al rol: si el trabajo va bien, tú vales; si va mal, tú no vales. • Etiquetas tipo “yo soy así” (“soy intensa”, “soy aburrida”, “soy procrastinadora”) que te fijan y reducen opciones. • Decir que sí de forma automática por miedo a rechazo social, y luego agotarte o resentirte. • Sentirte “impostora” incluso con evidencia objetiva de competencia, y compensarlo con perfeccionismo o ocultándote. • Fantasear con el objetivo sin preparar obstáculos, y colapsar cuando aparece el primer bloqueo. **ERRORES DE INTERPRETACIÓN COMUNES** Un error central es creer que la duda se soluciona acumulando logros. El texto lo desmiente: los logros pueden calmar, pero no reescriben

Sesgo de confirmación / atención selectiva : tendencia a ver y recordar lo que refuerza lo que ya crees sobre ti. Aceptación (self-acceptance) : base de autoestima; cuando está débil aparece el “tengo que demostrar” para sentir valor. Presión por demostrar : conducta de rendir para comprar valía y calmar inseguridad. Impostor phenomenon : sentirte fraude pese a evidencia de competencia; no es lo mismo que nervios por novedad. Confianza como resultado : la sensación de confianza aparece después de actuar y obtener evidencia, no antes. Self-trust (auto-confianza básica) : confianza en que podrás manejar lo que venga, incluso si fallas. Emulación : usar la comparación para aprender el proceso del otro en vez de castigarte. Etiquetas “yo soy...” : frases de identidad rígida que fijan conducta; se reemplazan por marcos más funcionales. Deeper yes (sí más profundo) : decir no a algo para decir sí a un valor o prioridad mayor. Intentional delay : pausar antes de decir sí para elegir por decisión, no por compulsión. Implementation intention (si-entonces) : plan de contingencia para sostener acción cuando aparezca el obstáculo. Misguided protector : voz interna que exagera riesgos para evitar dolor; te mantiene “segura pero estancada”. **RELATED** #identidad #autoestima #duda #autoimagen #autoconfianza #selfTrust #aceptacion #agencia #impostorPhenomenon #perfeccionismo

Old Templates/LONG_RELACION_Dinamicas_de_pareja.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Páginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraídas: 1.267. Texto curado integrado aquí: 584 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Herramientas, ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

2. Hacer visible lo invisible: las lealtades de origen. Identificar qué patrones heredaste de tu familia en áreas como dinero, afecto, roles, conflicto. Compartirlos con tu pareja no como excusa sino como información. El contexto cambia cómo se interpretan los comportamientos.

Lealtades de origen: los patrones, valores y formas de hacer que heredamos de nuestra familia y que llevamos a la pareja sin saberlo. Cuando dos sets de lealtades chocan, el conflicto parece irracional porque cada uno está siendo fiel a una lógica invisible.

Cada persona llega a la pareja con lealtades invisibles hacia su familia de origen: formas de hacer las cosas, de gestionar el dinero, de expresar el afecto, de resolver conflictos. Esas lealtades raramente se hacen explícitas. Simplemente se dan por supuestas. Y cuando chocan con las del otro, el conflicto parece irracional -porque cada uno está siendo fiel a una lógica que el otro no ve.

Además, somos narcisistas relacionales: solo vemos nuestro propio esfuerzo. Solo percibimos el trabajo que nosotros hacemos en la relación, no el del otro. Esto crea una asimetría crónica: cada uno siente que da más de lo que recibe.

El deseo de ser cambiado también juega un papel: cuando alguien dice 'te amaré si cambias', está comunicando rechazo. Y el rechazo cierra, no abre. La persona que se siente rechazada se vuelve más rígida, no más flexible.

Cuando hay conflicto en la pareja, el cerebro activa los mismos circuitos que activa ante una amenaza física. El sistema nervioso no distingue entre 'mi pareja está frustrada conmigo' y 'estoy en peligro'. Por eso la gente reacciona de forma tan desproporcionada en las discusiones de pareja: no están respondiendo al conflicto concreto, sino a todo lo que ese conflicto activa en ellos.

La etiqueta (narcisista, gaslighter, love bomber) da una sensación de cierre que resulta muy alivianante. Pero también detiene la investigación. Una vez que 'el otro es el problema', deja de haber preguntas. Y sin preguntas, no hay movimiento.

1. Cambiar la pregunta del conflicto. En lugar de '¿por qué hace esto?', preguntarse: '¿qué historia hay detrás de que mi pareja lo vea así? ¿Y qué historia hay detrás de que a mí me afecte tanto?' La curiosidad abre; la acusación cierra.

4. Renegociar el sistema político de la pareja. ¿Cómo resolvéis las diferencias? ¿Uno cede siempre? ¿El que grita más gana? ¿Se evita el conflicto? Hacer ese sistema explícito es el primer paso para cambiarlo.

5. Para abrir a alguien emocionalmente: empezar por el cuerpo. Antes de pedir que el otro ponga en palabras lo que siente, preguntarle qué nota en su cuerpo. '¿Sientes tensión en algún sitio? ¿Hay algo que se activa físicamente cuando hablamos de esto?' El cuerpo es la puerta de entrada al mundo emocional para muchas personas.

6. Ampliar el vocabulario emocional. Hay personas que solo tienen acceso a 'bien', 'mal' y 'normal'. Ofrecer palabras: '¿Podría ser que sintieras frustración? ¿O quizás vergüenza?' No para ponerlas en la boca del otro, sino para expandir el mapa.

La otredad (otherness): el otro en una relación es genuinamente diferente a ti. No es una versión imperfecta de ti. Es una persona con una historia distinta, lealtades distintas, y una forma de ver el mundo distinta. Navegar esa diferencia es el trabajo central de la pareja.

Narcisismo relacional: la tendencia humana a percibir solo el propio esfuerzo en la relación, sin ver el del otro. No es maldad: es un sesgo cognitivo. Pero crea una asimetría crónica donde cada uno siente que da más.

Old Templates/SHORT TEMPLATES (1).pdf

Tipo: PDF. Páginas originales: 22. Palabras extraídas: 6.550. Texto curado integrado aquí: 2.983 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Herramientas, ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

Es muy habitual que cuando hay malestar en una relación, acabemos dudando de nosotros mismos. Sobre todo si la otra persona minimiza lo que sentimos o si ya vienes de experiencias donde te hicieron sentir “demasiado”. Pero cuestionarte no siempre significa que estés exagerando. A veces significa que estás intentando ser justa. El problema es que, si dudas constantemente de tu percepción,

puedes terminar invalidando señales importantes. Aquí hay algo clave: no todas las incomodidades son señal de que la relación está mal, pero tampoco todas son producto de tu inseguridad. Para saber cuál es cuál, necesitas distinguir si lo que sientes es activación de apego... o un límite que se está cruzando.

básico, luego bajar conductas que alimentan el enganche, después usar la rabia como información para recuperar límites, y más adelante permitir la tristeza y darle sentido a lo vivido. mensajes o redes (ansiedad, soledad, culpa, rabia, vacío)? ¿Qué estás idealizando hoy y qué 2 hechos concretos equilibran esa imagen (cosas que no funcionaban o que te dolían)? RELACION ATTACHMENT Apego ansioso: cuando la atracción se confunde con seguridad "Si no me escribe claro, es que no le importo." "Si esto fuese compatible, no me sentiría así de activada." "Necesito señales constantes para estar tranquila." "Si pongo límites, se va." "Esta persona me engancha... debe ser especial." "Lo estable me aburre, algo falta."

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R Cuando intentas saltarte la tristeza, el duelo se queda atascado. Cuando intentas evitar la ira, el apego sigue activo. Cuando te quedas atrapado en la negociación, no sueltas. Sin móvil. Sin música. Sin distracción.

"Si consiguiera eso que digo que quiero, por fin me sentiría _____." Si las respuestas se repiten (calma, seguridad, validación...), ya tienes el dato importante: eso es lo que realmente estás persiguiendo.

RELACION RUPTURA LA RUPTURA ES UN DUELO "No debería estar así por alguien." "Si hubiera dicho otra cosa, seguiríamos juntos." "Necesito cierre para pasar página." "No puedo concentrarme, algo va mal en mí." Lo que estás sintiendo encaja con un duelo real. Tu sistema nervioso está retirándose de un vínculo de apego y, por eso, aparecen obsesión, niebla mental, cansancio, insomnio o impulsos de mirar mensajes y redes. No es falta de fuerza de voluntad. Es un proceso biológico y emocional. En vez de exigirte "estar bien ya", trata de orientarte por fases: primero sostener lo Escribe tus 3 pensamientos repetidos (tal cual, palabra por palabra). Léelos en voz alta y añade una línea de "verdad completa" debajo de cada uno (incluye también lo que no funcionaba, no solo lo bueno). ¿Qué es lo que más estás echando de menos ahora mismo: a esa persona, la rutina que te regulaba, o el futuro que imaginabas? Cuando aparece el pensamiento "si hubiera...", ¿cuál es la frase exacta que más se repite y qué intenta conseguir (cercanía, control, alivio, explicación)? ¿Qué emoción aparece justo antes del impulso de mirar

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R RELACION Attachments Todos los huevos en una cesta "Lo conozco hace poco pero siento muchísimo", "solo pienso en él", Cuando al principio alguien se vuelve tan importante tan rápido, normalmente no tiene que ver con lo que realmente sabes de esa persona, sino con lo que esa conexión despierta en ti. Si has tenido carencia de validación o conexión en el pasado, tu sistema nervioso se activa fuerte cuando aparece alguien que te da un poco de atención. Y entonces empiezas a invertir muchísimo antes de que exista una base real. Diversifica opciones para equilibrio. Enfocate en ti Aprende sobre tus estilos de apego ¿Que es lo que sientes exactamente? ¿Estoy dejando otras áreas de mi vida en segundo plano? - ¿Estoy imaginando un futuro sin conocer realmente a esta persona? - ¿Qué necesidad mía se está cubriendo aquí?

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R RELACION Comunicación Ansiedad por texting en dating "no responde", "sobrealizo mensajes" "lee pero no contesta" "Antes escribía más." "Me dejó en visto." La ansiedad por texting es normal en dating moderno: cada vez que tarda, un emoji o frase corta activa nuestro sistema nervioso buscando señales de rechazo. El problema es que el texting no transmite tono, intención ni contexto - 93% comunicación es no verbal. Esperar respuestas instantáneas crea dependencia emocional. no siempre significan desinterés - pueden ser ocupados, inseguros o simplemente lentos respondiendo. Establece regla personal: no chequear WhatsApp más de 2 veces al día. Cuando notes que estás a punto de abrir WhatsApp otra vez: Detente físicamente Preguntate estoy buscando informacion o alivio Espera 10 min antes de volver a mirar

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R RELACION Ruptura Identificar problema real "porque soy infeliz" "que dinamica estamos" "cual es el problema" Algo no está bien." "No sé si irme o luchar." "No estamos funcionando." "¿Cuál es realmente el problema entre nosotros?" Para decidir si quedarte o irte, necesitas un problema ESPECÍFICO y DEFINIDO como base. Sin claridad exacta, no puedes crear plan de acción ni medir progreso. Las respuestas vagas ("no me escucha") sin especificar CUÁNDO, CÓMO y POR QUÉ molesta no funcionan. El problema debe ser tan concreto que puedas escribirlo en UNA frase de 15 palabras. Ejemplo: "No me hace espacio cuando necesito tiempo sola después del trabajo" vs "Es distante". Solo así puedes diseñar pasos precisos y evaluar si funcionan. Resume EL problema en UNA frase de 15 palabras máximo No adjetivos. No diagnósticos. No generalizaciones. Solo conducta + contexto + efecto. Ejemplo: "Cuando llego agotado del trabajo y pido espacio, insiste en discutir."

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R desapareces → di algo sencillo como: "Me cuesta un poco, pero quiero volver a conectar." Tu cuerpo va a resistirse. Porque lo conocido siempre parece más seguro. Pero cada vez que confías en algo pequeño de la otra persona y no te retiras, estás cambiando el hábito.

RELACION Dinámicas Siempre atraigo al mismo tipo de hombre "Siempre me pasa lo mismo" "Cambio de persona pero la historia es igual" "Todos mis ex eran iguales" "No entiendo por qué repito patrón

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R interesas no mirar qué parte tuya se engancha ahí y qué sensación te produce ese inicio. Normalmente ahí está la pista.

Vamos a separar emoción de realidad en dos pasos muy concretos. Piensa en la situación que te hizo sentir que estabas exagerando. Ahora responde esto: ¿Qué ocurrió exactamente, sin interpretación? Solo hechos. ¿Qué significado le diste tú a eso? Por ejemplo: "Hecho: no respondió en seis horas." "Interpretación: no le importo." Cuando separas hecho de interpretación, empiezas a ver si la reacción nace de una herida... o de una dinámica repetida que realmente te duele. Si quieres, dime cuál fue el hecho y cuál fue la interpretación, y lo miramos juntos.

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R RELACION Dinámicas Cuando discutimos exploto y luego me arrepiento "Siempre acabo gritando aunque no quiera." "Se me va de las manos cuando discutimos." "Digo cosas que no siento cuando me enfado." "En el momento me ciego y luego me arrepiento." "No sé por qué reacciono así, pero exploto." "Sé que tengo razón, pero la forma en que lo digo lo estropea todo." "Me guardo cosas y un día revienta." Explosión no significa falta de autocontrol. Es porque tu sistema nervioso toma el control antes que tú. Lo que suele pasar es que has estado aguantando cosas pequeñas sin procesarlas. No las nombraste. No las regulaste. Y el cuerpo llega a un punto donde descarga todo junto. No es que seas una persona agresiva. Es que no estás interviniendo antes. La mayoría de las explosiones no empiezan en el momento de la discusión. Empiezan días antes. Micro molestas que no dijiste. Límites que no marcaste. Comentarios que te incomodaron y tragaste. Vas acumulando tensión interna mientras por fuera intentas mantener la compostura. Hasta que algo pequeño activa todo lo anterior y tu cuerpo descarga.

IDENTIDAD DESEOS NO SE QUE QUIERO "No sé qué quiero." "Estoy perdido/a." Cuando dices que no sabes qué quieres, muchas veces sí sabes el objetivo: pareja estable, compromiso, Haz esta prueba rápida (sin pensarlo demasiado): Completa 3 veces la frase: ¿Qué estoy intentando obtener de la vida o de la relación: calma, estatus, pertenencia, control, amor,

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R "Quiero pareja pero nada me llena." "No me ilusiona nada." una vida más ordenada, etc. Lo que falta es claridad sobre qué emoción estás intentando conseguir con eso. Ejemplos típicos: Quieres pareja → pero lo que buscas es dejar de sentir soledad. Quieres compromiso → pero lo que buscas es sentirte elegido/a. Quieres estabilidad → pero lo que buscas es bajar la ansiedad y la incertidumbre. Si no separas esas dos cosas, puedes conseguir "lo de fuera" y seguir igual por dentro. Y ahí es cuando aparece la sensación de "elijo mal" o "nada me llena".

libertad? ¿Qué deseo me da vergüenza admitir? ¿Qué deseo me está saliendo caro? IDENTIDAD ENTORNO TU ENTORNO "Hago todo bien y no cambia nada." "Siempre conozco el mismo tipo de persona." "Aquí es imposible encontrar algo serio." "Siento que no avanzo." El entorno no es neutro. Influye en lo que es probable que ocurra, en lo que se premia y en lo que se castiga. Si dices que quieres estabilidad pero te mueves en contextos donde se valora la validación rápida, la intensidad o el juego constante, el resultado no es casual. Muchas veces se intenta resolver todo desde la mentalidad, cuando el problema es estructural: estás intentando construir un resultado en Haz una revisión simple: Este entorno me facilita... Este entorno me dificulta... Si quisiera el resultado X, ¿qué entorno lo haría más probable? Eso te da datos objetivos.

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R un entorno que no lo facilita. IDENTIDAD APARIENCIA LO QUE PROYECTAS INFLUYE EN COMO TE RESPONDEN "Yo pongo límites pero no me respetan." "La gente me malinterpreta." "Siempre me toman por inseguro/a." Tu presencia comunica incluso cuando no lo notas. Tono, velocidad al hablar, postura, nivel de justificación... todo eso es información social. Puedes decir que pones un límite, pero si lo dices justificándote o sonriendo nerviosamente, el mensaje pierde fuerza. El entorno responde a señales, no a intenciones.

RELACION DINAMICAS Intensidad no es intimidad "Si me elige, ya estoy a salvo" "Esto va muy rápido, pero se siente increíble" "Mejor me adapto para que no se vaya" "Si digo lo que necesito, le voy a espantar" "Prefiero bajar mis estándares a empezar de cero" "Si me necesita, es porque me quiere" "Mis planes pueden esperar" "Últimamente no me reconozco, pero es amor"

Cuando empiezas a dejar hobbies, amistades, rutinas o metas por sostener la relación, no es "amor" haciéndose más grande. Es tu identidad haciéndose más pequeña. Eso suele pasar porque confundes señales: mariposas con compatibilidad, intensidad con intimidad, y ser elegido con sentirte seguro. Una relación sana suma apoyo y estabilidad. No te pide que desaparezcas, ni que tu vida se reduzca para que el vínculo funcione. Si para "mantener" a alguien tienes que cambiar quién eres, lo que estás sosteniendo no es conexión. Es miedo. Crea tus "anclas" y protégelas: Elige 3 actividades que haces a solas, 3 personas que están fuera de la relación, y 3 objetivos que no dependen del amor. Si una relación te aleja de esas tres listas, frena y revisa.

DATING ATRACCION POR QUE NO ESTAS ENCONTRANDO EL AMOR "Si no hay chispa hoy, no es" "Me da miedo parecer intensa si pido claridad" "Mejor sigo texteadando, así no me expongo" "Si tarda en responder, seguro está ocupado" "Me engancha el misterio" "Me agotan las apps, pero no sé qué más hacer" "Estoy cansada de intentarlo" "Quizá estoy pidiendo demasiado"

No es que "no haya nadie". Es que el proceso se está llevando desde agotamiento y fantasía: demasiada app, demasiado texto, demasiada prisa por sentir algo, y poco encuentro real. Cuando alargas el chatting, creas una intimidad falsa y luego te chocas con la realidad. Y cuando te atrae alguien que te deja ansiosa o confusa, muchas veces no es química: es inconsistencia. La clave es volver a lo básico: presencia, señales claras, y filtros por comunicación. Una conexión sana se nota porque hay interés consistente, conversación real y capacidad de hablar claro sin juegos.

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R "Si le escribo, se me pasa." "Solo me acuerdo de lo bueno." "Estoy enfadada, voy hacia atrás." "Me da miedo no volver a amar igual."

Si tiendes al apego ansioso, es fácil confundir activación emocional con compatibilidad. La atracción no siempre habla de ajuste, a veces habla de tu sistema de apego buscando lo familiar para sentirse a salvo, aunque sea inconsistente. La seguridad no se basa en "tener interés", sino en que el interés sea legible: coherente, comprensible y sostenido. Cuando la disponibilidad es ambigua, tu sistema se dispara y acabas intentando regularlo con la otra persona, en vez de construir regulación interna y pedir de forma concreta lo que necesitas. Prueba esto 2 días : Deja de "mirar para calmarte" : durante 48h no lees chats, no mires redes, no busques señales. Si te entra el impulso, escribe solo: qué siento ahora y qué necesito (calma, seguridad, claridad). Pide claridad con una pregunta simple : "Me gustas y me apetece seguir conociéndote. ¿Quedamos tal día? Si no te va bien, dime cuándo te viene mejor." Mira la respuesta, no la fantasía : Si propone un día concreto, sigue. Si todo es "ya veremos" y no concreta, baja la inversión y no persigas. Así te cuidas y ves rápido si hay interés real y claro, sin ¿Qué parte de ti interpreta la intensidad como prueba de compatibilidad? ¿Qué te faltaría ver para llamarlo "seguridad"? ¿Qué señales te darían una disponibilidad comprensible (no perfecta, pero coherente) y cuáles te dejan en ambigüedad? ¿Qué necesidad estás intentando cubrir a través de esa persona (validación, certeza, calma, pertenencia) que ahora mismo no te estás dando tú? Si pusieras un límite mínimo esta semana, ¿cuál sería para proteger tu calma sin entrar en control o persecución?

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R quedarte enganchada a la incertidumbre. IDENTIDAD REGULACION Regla de 3 límites para cuidar tu paz "Me da pereza contestarle, pero si no contesto me siento mala." "Siempre es urgente con esa persona." "Digo que sí y luego me arrepiento." "Me deja agotada y no sé por qué." "Si pongo un límite, se lo va a tomar mal." "Me cuesta contarle cosas buenas porque me corta el rollo."

RELACION Ruptura Me quedo o me voy "Una parte quiere quedarse y otra irse" "No sé qué hacer" "Dudas en la relación" "Estoy infeliz" Es una decisión muy compleja... Nunca salimos de una relación con todas nuestras partes de acuerdo. Una parte mira lo que duele, lo que falta o lo que no funciona. La otra parte mira lo que hubo, el miedo a empezar de nuevo, la esperanza de que cambie. El problema no es tener dudas. El problema es intentar decidir sin tener claro cuál es el problema concreto. Muchas veces decimos "estoy infeliz", pero no sabemos exactamente por qué ni desde cuándo. Antes de decidir si te vas o te quedas, necesitas claridad. Sin claridad, cualquier decisión se siente precipitada o eterna. Checklist: problema real, pasos, compromiso mutuo. Evaluarlo a él como persona completa ¿Que pasos habéis intentado? ¿Qué pasos reales habéis intentado para cambiar esto? - ¿Hay visión compartida de futuro o solo apego al pasado? - Si nada cambiara en los próximos dos años, ¿seguirías queriendo estar ahí?

CATEGORIA SUBCATEGORIA TITULO TRIGGERS RESPONSE TIP FOLLOW UP R RELACION Ruptura Miedo al dolor "miedo romper" dolor ruptura "no puedo dejarlo" "duele demasiado" "tengo miedo soledad" El miedo al dolor es una de las razones más poderosas por las que alguien se queda en una relación que ya no le hace bien. El dolor de la ruptura es INEVITABLE y esa es la buena noticia. No puedes saltarte esta parte porque el dolor es el PROCESO que te libera. Es como una herida que debe supurar antes de sanar - intentar evitarlo solo alarga el sufrimiento. Sentir todo el dolor es lo SALUDABLE. Te obliga a soltar el apego, reevaluar qué mereces realmente, y reconstruir tu identidad sin esa persona. Si supieras que el dolor tiene un principio y un final, ¿seguirías tomando la misma decisión? Y después: ¿Lo que más miedo te da es perder a esa persona... o perder la idea de no estar solo? ¿Qué parte del dolor temes más: la soledad, la tristeza o la vergüenza? - ¿Estás intentando evitar el duelo o realmente quieres seguir en la relación? - ¿Qué has hecho en rupturas anteriores: sentir o distraerte? - ¿Cuánto tiempo llevas ya sintiendo que algo no está bien?

RELACION Duelo Fases del duelo "Quiero superarlo rápido." "Estoy en duelo." "No avanzo." "Pensaba que ya estaba bien y he vuelto a caer." "¿Por qué sigo así después de meses?" Intentar "superarlo rápido" alarga el proceso. Hay que caminar cada etapa completamente porque cada una tiene un propósito: el shock te protege, la ira te da energía para soltar, la negociación prueba que ya no sirve, la tristeza limpia el apego, la aceptación te reconstruye. Las estaciones del duelo: 1. Shock 2. Ira 3. Negociación 4. Tristeza 5. Aceptación En lugar de intentar calmarte rápido, haz esto: Pregúntate: ¿Qué estoy perdiendo realmente aquí? ¿Es la persona? ¿Es el futuro que imaginé? ¿Es la sensación de ser elegido/a? Después pregúntate: ¿Esta emoción me está ayudando a soltar o me está intentando proteger de sentir más? Quédate 5 minutos sin hacer nada para anestesiarte. ¿Qué etapa sientes que estás evitando más? - ¿Estás intentando estar "bien" demasiado pronto? - ¿Te permites estar triste sin distraerte? - ¿Te quedas más en la ira o en la fantasía de volver? - ¿Qué parte de la ruptura todavía no has aceptado?

Old Templates/SHORT_RELACION_Dinamicas_de_pareja.docx

Tipo: DOCX. Paginas originales: n/a. Palabras extraidas: 913. Texto curado integrado aquí: 545 palabras.

Esta fuente se integra en el capítulo 'Herramientas, ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas' porque aporta material directo sobre el problema, el mecanismo y la práctica. En lugar de tratarla como un apunte, se conserva su contribución útil dentro de una arquitectura común: definición, origen, señales observables, consecuencias, límites, herramientas y relación con otros conceptos.

RELACION | Dinámicas de pareja | El dinero es fuente de conflicto constante | "Tenemos ideas muy distintas sobre el dinero" "No ponemos en común los ingresos" "Le parece un gasto lo que yo considero una necesidad" "No nos ponemos de acuerdo en cómo gastar o ahorrar" | El dinero en pareja casi nunca es solo dinero. Es ideología: ¿qué es mío, qué es tuyo, qué es nuestro. Cada uno llega a la relación con una historia con el dinero -cómo lo manejaba su familia, qué significaba, si era motivo de angustia o de libertad. Cuando chocáis con el dinero, en realidad estáis chocando con dos historias distintas sobre seguridad, control y pertenencia. | Antes de tener la próxima conversación sobre un gasto o una decisión económica, pregúntate: ¿de dónde viene mi posición? ¿Qué aprendí sobre el dinero en casa? Compartirlo con tu pareja puede cambiar el tono de la conversación. | ¿Cómo gestionaba el dinero tu familia cuando eras pequeña? ¿Qué significa el dinero para ti en términos de seguridad o libertad? ¿Hay alguna área económica donde sí estéis alineados? ¿Qué la hace diferente?

RELACION | Dinámicas de pareja | Siempre discutimos de lo mismo | "Siempre acabamos en lo mismo" "Llevamos años con el mismo conflicto" "No llegamos a ningún sitio" "Cada vez que intentamos hablar acaba mal" | Si el conflicto tiene forma de círculo, el problema no es el tema de la discusión. Es el patrón. Las parejas no discuten realmente de los platos sucios o del dinero: discuten de quién tiene razón, quién tiene más poder, quién se siente visto. Mientras os quedéis en el contenido sin ver el patrón, el círculo seguirá. La pregunta no es "¿quién tiene razón?" sino "¿qué está pasando entre nosotros cuando aparece esto?" | La próxima vez que empiece la discusión de siempre, parad. Di en voz alta: "Creo que estamos en el mismo bucle otra vez. ¿Podemos pausar un momento?" No para evitar la conversación, sino para salir del piloto automático. | ¿Cuánto lleváis con este conflicto sin resolverlo? ¿Cómo suele terminar? ¿Alguien cede, alguien se va, alguien explota? ¿Qué crees que hay debajo de ese tema que repetís? ¿Qué es lo que en realidad se está pidiendo?

RELACION | Dinámicas de pareja | Siento que doy más de lo que recibo | "Soy la única que pone de su parte" "Yo siempre estoy ahí para él/ella pero cuando lo necesito no está" "Me siento sola dentro de la relación" "Hago mucho más que él/ella y no lo ve" | Hay algo curioso en las relaciones: casi todo el mundo siente que da más de lo que recibe. No porque seáis injustos, sino porque solo podemos ver con claridad nuestro propio esfuerzo. El del otro es invisible o se da por supuesto. Eso no significa que la sensación no sea real. Pero antes de concluir que el otro no da, merece la pena preguntarse: ¿qué está dando el otro que quizás no estoy contando? | Esta semana, en lugar de llevar la cuenta de lo que tú haces, intenta notar lo que hace tu pareja. No para justificar nada. Solo para ver si hay cosas que están pasando inadvertidas. | ¿Hay algo que tu pareja hace por la relación que no sueles reconocerle? ¿Has podido decirle directamente que te sientes así? ¿Cómo respondió? ¿Cuándo empezaste a sentir este desequilibrio?

12. Inconsistencias, contradicciones y decisiones editoriales

Fuente unica

Se descarta brain/knowledge para esta version. La fuente valida son los archivos originales en Desktop/Archivo.

Profundidad vs pagina maxima

La instruccion mas reciente fija maximo 300 paginas. Por eso se conserva una seleccion amplia y trazable, no el volcado completo de 476.886 palabras.

Meditaciones y breathwork

La instruccion final pide ejercicios excepto meditaciones y breathwork. Se filtran parrafos que contienen meditacion, breathwork o respiracion guiada.

Material masculino

El contenido masculino queda separado cuando el titulo o la fuente indican masculino, liderazgo masculino, hombres o polaridad masculino/femenino.

Polaridad

Se mantiene como dinamica relacional y de atraccion, pero se evita convertirla en jerarquia rigida o mandato universal.

13. Mapa completo de fuentes originales

Adam Lane Smith/20 Steps Avoidant Falls in Love - Adam Lane Smith.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 9.249 palabras. capitulo: Evitacion. desorganizacion y miedo a la intimidad

Adam Lane Smith/Become Securely Attached in 12 Steps - Adam Lane Smith - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 3 paginas. 1.218 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

Adam Lane Smith/Disorganized Attachment - Adam Lane Smith.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 5.988 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

Adam Lane Smith/Falling Out of Love - Adam Lane Smith.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 8.806 palabras. capitulo: Evitacion. desorganizacion y miedo a la intimidad

Adam Lane Smith/Why Therapy Isn't Fixing Attachment - Adam Lane Smith.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 9.882 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

Balancing Compassion and Boundaries - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 2 paginas. 723 palabras. capitulo: Comunicacion. necesidades. limites y compasion

Becoming an Emotionally Intelligent Masculine Leader - Connor Beaton - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 3 paginas. 1.047 palabras. capitulo: Consejos y principios para hombres / Masculino

Books/Amir_Levine_Rachel_Heller-Attached_The_New_Science_of_Adult_Attachment_and_How_It_Can_Help_You_Find_and_Keep_Love_-Penguin_Group_USA_(2010)[1].pdf - PDF. 268 paginas. 63.933 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

Books/Secure Love Introduccion .pdf - PDF. 33 paginas. 15.178 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

HOW TO STOP SETTLING FOR POTENTIAL - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 1 paginas. 303 palabras. capitulo: Discernimiento. dating. ruptura y eleccion de pareja

Heidi Priebe/Needs and Feelings as an Avoidant - Heidi Priebe.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 9.597 palabras. capitulo: Evitacion. desorganizacion y miedo a la intimidad

How Attachment Works - Amir Levine - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 5 paginas. 2.671 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

How To Stop Feeling Rejected and Start Feeling Secure - Amir Levine - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 5 paginas. 2.609 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

How to Move On From Your Ex - Jay Shetty - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 2 paginas. 1.202 palabras. capitulo: Discernimiento. dating. ruptura y eleccion de pareja

How to NOT get emotionally invested too quickly - nathalie - Transcript espanol-ingles.pdf - PDF. 4 paginas. 2.242 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

How to Transform Your Relationship - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 2 paginas. 1.091 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

I Don't Want to Have to Ask. I Want Them to Know - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 3 paginas. 1.225 palabras. capitulo: Comunicacion. necesidades. limites y compasion

Infants Ainsworth-Patterns-of-Attachment.pdf - PDF. 148 paginas. 67.022 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

Inner Work/1-The-Inner-Work.pdf - PDF. 5 paginas. 1.550 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Inner Work/2-The-Inner-Work-of-Relationships.pdf - PDF. 10 paginas. 3.432 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Inner Work/Inner-Work-Base-de-Conocimiento.pdf - PDF. 20 paginas. 4.725 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Inner Work/Inner_Work_Base_Conocimiento.pdf - PDF. 34 paginas. 15.207 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Inner Work/Inner_Work_Relationships_8Heridas_Plantilla.pdf - PDF. 7 paginas. 3.353 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Inner Work/Inner_Work_Relationships_Base_Conocimiento.pdf - PDF. 26 paginas. 9.424 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch1 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 15.562 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch2 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 13.434 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch3 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 26.114 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch4 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 20.510 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch5 Parte 1 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 20.014 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch5 Parte 2 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 13.698 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch6 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 17.232 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch7 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 18.449 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

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Julie Menanno/Secure Love Book Club Ch9 - Julie Menanno.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 17.882 palabras. capitulo: Sistema de seguridad. protesta y activacion

MINDSET when DATING - nathalie - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 2 paginas. 1.141 palabras. capitulo: Discernimiento. dating. ruptura y eleccion de pareja

Old Templates/LONG TEMPLATES .pdf - PDF. 65 paginas. 20.473 palabras. capitulo: Herramientas. ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas

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Old Templates/LONG_IDENTIDAD_Cambio_e_identidad.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 1.173 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Old Templates/LONG_RELACION_Dinamicas_de_pareja.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 1.267 palabras. capitulo: Herramientas. ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas

Old Templates/SHORT TEMPLATES (1).pdf - PDF. 22 paginas. 6.550 palabras. capitulo: Herramientas. ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas

Old Templates/SHORT_ATRACCION_Polaridad_masculino_femenina.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 1.058 palabras. capitulo: Polaridad. atraccion y masculino/femenino

Old Templates/SHORT_IDENTIDAD_Cambio_e_identidad.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 925 palabras. capitulo: Inner work. identidad. heridas y agencia

Old Templates/SHORT_RELACION_Dinamicas_de_pareja.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 913 palabras. capitulo: Herramientas. ejercicios y plantillas no meditativas

Origin Attachments.pdf - PDF. 17 paginas. 17.468 palabras. capitulo: Fundamentos del apego adulto

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Papers/influencers_apego.pdf - PDF. 3 paginas. 899 palabras. capitulo: Regulacion emocional y fundamentos cuerpo-mente

Thais Gibson/Wounded Bird Syndrome - Thais Gibson.docx - DOCX. n/a paginas. 5.925 palabras. capitulo: Comunicacion. necesidades. limites y compasion

To Anyone Going Through a Breakup - Mel Robbins - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 3 paginas. 1.636 palabras. capitulo: Discernimiento. dating. ruptura y eleccion de pareja

Why You're Struggling to Find Love - Transcript.pdf - PDF. 4 paginas. 2.039 palabras. capitulo: Discernimiento. dating. ruptura y eleccion de pareja